

Appendix

The Impact of Media Supply on Bureaucratic Information Collection

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A.1. Qualitative evidence

A.1.1. Contracts for Media Monitoring

The following table contains likely government contracts for custom media monitoring services. They were identified by searching USAspending.gov for contracts involving news and media monitoring as well as reviewing other contracts by companies with one or more custom media monitoring contracts. To see more details about a contract, click on the contract PIID number. You will be redirected to the USAspending page for the contract.

I found four main contractors for custom media monitoring: Bulletin Intelligence/Cision, Barbaricum, TechMIS, and Rendon.

- Bulletin Intelligence's early employees were former members of the Reagan White House who had been previously tasked with producing Reagan's news summaries. See document titled "A Proposal For White House News Summary and Clips Package," produced in response to Bush Library FOIA No. 2024-0154-F.
- As of December 2025, TechMIS has been awarded Department of Defense contracts worth \$11.45M. The DOD is the largest awarding agency. The next biggest is the Department of Homeland Security, which has paid TechMIS \$5.61M.
- As of December 2025, Barbaricum has been awarded Department of Defense contracts worth \$275.57M. The DOD is the largest awarding agency. The next biggest is the Department of Homeland Security, which has paid Barbaricum \$11.15M.
- As of December 2025, Rendon has been awarded Department of Defense contracts worth \$3.67M. The DOD is the largest awarding agency. The next biggest is the Department of Justice, which has paid Rendon \$2.42M.

Table 1: Government contracts for custom media monitoring services.

PIID	Awarding Agency	Sub-Agency	Recipient	Current Value	Start Date	End Date
AID0AA0900029	Agency for International Development (USAID)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$316,732	9/16/2009	9/15/2012
AID0AAC1200073	Agency for International Development (USAID)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$478,762	9/17/2012	10/18/2018
AID0AA09000005	Agency for International Development (USAID)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$65,665	1/15/2009	9/15/2009
AID0AAC1600101	Agency for International Development (USAID)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$113,800	9/17/2016	9/16/2017
CPSCD150005	Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$233,370	12/17/2014	12/21/2019
61320620F0025	Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$276,010	4/10/2020	4/12/2025
61320620F0010	Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$1,493	1/22/2020	1/26/2021
DOCSA130102CN0019	Department of Commerce (DOC)	Office of the Secretary	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$1,113,315	9/23/2002	9/22/2006
HC104722C0015	Department of Defense (DOD)	Defense Information Systems Agency	CISION US INC	\$396,222	9/30/2022	9/29/2025
HE125419C8005	Department of Defense (DOD)	Department of Defense Education Activity	CISION US INC	\$275,000	9/28/2019	3/27/2025
W911SD15P0454	Department of Defense (DOD)	Department of the Army	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$117,692	9/21/2015	9/29/2016
W9124J12F0014	Department of Defense (DOD)	Department of the Army	BARBARICUM LLC	\$605,599	7/25/2012	10/31/2015
HQ002806C0023	Department of Defense (DOD)	Defense Media Activity	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$501,626	5/18/2006	2/29/2008
EDED04C00147	Department of Education (ED)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$993,258	9/23/2004	9/22/2009
EDOC009C0047	Department of Education (ED)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,146,354	9/22/2009	11/25/2014
EDOCO14C0118	Department of Education (ED)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$942,918	9/23/2014	9/22/2019
91990019P0016	Department of Education (ED)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,191,784	9/23/2019	9/22/2024
91990024P0007	Department of Education (ED)		CISION US INC	\$142,932	9/23/2024	2/4/2025
DEAC0106PA00495	Department of Energy (DOE)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$1,374,295	9/23/2006	3/22/2012
DEPA0000011	Department of Energy (DOE)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$0	3/23/2012	9/22/2017
DEDT0013970	Department of Energy (DOE)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$1,129,930	9/19/2017	4/3/2023
HHSF223201010870P	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Food and Drug Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$5,479	6/29/2010	7/29/2010
HHSF223200800252A	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$40,667	9/19/2008	11/14/2008
HHSP233200900044P	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$94,648	11/17/2008	1/30/2009
HHSP23320095658WC	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$3,079,663	2/27/2009	3/2/2015
HHSP233201400028A	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$4,020,942	2/17/2014	11/16/2018
75P00119P00012	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$5,738,582	11/17/2018	11/16/2023
75P00121P00115	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration	CISION US INC	\$51,840	9/13/2021	1/13/2022
HHSP23337006	Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration	BARBARICUM LLC	\$55,956	5/15/2013	10/25/2014
HSFEHQ06P0328	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Federal Emergency Management Agency	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$1,069,935	3/23/2006	6/27/2009
HSFEHQ09C1147	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Federal Emergency Management Agency	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,365,047	7/27/2009	1/26/2015
HSFE7015C0118	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Federal Emergency Management Agency	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$814,846	9/27/2015	7/26/2018
HSFE7015C0145	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Federal Emergency Management Agency	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$21,705	8/27/2015	9/26/2015
HSFE9015P0012	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Federal Emergency Management Agency	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$151,937	1/27/2015	8/26/2015
HSHQDC06P00005	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Office of Procurement Operations	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$611,625	11/11/2003	10/11/2004
HSHQDC05P00038	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Office of Procurement Operations	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$1,078,125	8/3/2005	9/25/2008
HSHQDC06P00072	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Office of Procurement Operations	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$2,295	3/14/2006	6/2/2007
HSHQDC08C00194	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Office of Procurement Operations	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,588,752	9/26/2008	11/18/2013
HSHQDC13C00122	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Office of Procurement Operations	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$0	9/20/2013	11/27/2018
70RDAD19C00000001	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Office of Procurement Operations	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$2,008,596	11/14/2018	8/27/2023
70RDAD23C00000004	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Office of Procurement Operations	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$851,150	8/28/2023	8/27/2025
HSTS0515FCOM014	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Transportation Security Administration	CISION US INC	\$106,467	9/16/2015	9/22/2017
70T05022F5500N004	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	Transportation Security Administration	FOUR LLC	\$729,867	9/25/2022	9/24/2025
HSSCCG16P00104	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,073,975	7/8/2016	1/31/2022
70SBUR22P00000010	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$754,254	2/1/2022	1/31/2026
HSCEOP07P01238	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$169,080	7/5/2007	7/18/2008
HSCEMD08P00173	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$175,000	7/8/2008	7/18/2009
HSCEMD09P00279	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$400,002	7/15/2009	9/30/2011
HSCEMS11C00006	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,228,568	9/30/2011	3/29/2017
HSCEMS17P00017	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$24,502	4/3/2017	4/29/2017
HSCEMS17C00001	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$908,163	5/1/2017	4/27/2022
70US0919F2GSA0113	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Secret Service	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$235,934	9/17/2019	3/16/2021
70US0921F2GSA0028	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Secret Service	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$242,236	3/17/2021	9/29/2022
70US0923F2GSA2239	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Secret Service	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$172,989	9/30/2023	9/29/2024
HSBP1017F00204	Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	U.S. Customs and Border Protection	BARBARICUM LLC	\$195,257	8/14/2017	9/30/2018
DU100200208DCOPC22208	Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$834,704	9/5/2002	9/4/2007
HUDCOPC23172	Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$1,356,863	9/1/2007	12/17/2012
DU100A13C01	Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$207,983	12/1/2012	9/30/2013
DU100A13C04	Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$1,678,463	9/30/2013	9/29/2018

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86543B18C00002	Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$1,862,521	9/30/2018	3/29/2024
86615124C00002	Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$299,940	4/1/2024	3/31/2025
IND12PX50827	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,001,116	12/2/2011	6/11/2017
IND17PX00272	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$49,600	8/10/2017	11/11/2017
140D0418P0009	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$148,800	11/20/2017	8/16/2018
140D0418P0080	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$33,067	8/14/2018	10/16/2018
140D0419P0002	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	BARBARICUM LLC	\$177,087	10/16/2018	11/5/2019
140D0419P0005	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$16,533	4/5/2019	5/5/2019
140D0419P0051	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$41,000	7/26/2019	7/25/2022
140D0421F0796	Department of the Interior (DOI)	Departmental Offices	LDSS, INC.	\$125,985	9/24/2021	9/23/2022
DEA03C0003	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Drug Enforcement Administration	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$349,368	12/1/2002	2/11/2008
15DDHQ19P00001028	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Drug Enforcement Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$139,874	9/24/2019	9/25/2020
15DDHQ20P00001130	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Drug Enforcement Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$144,070	9/24/2020	9/25/2021
15DDHQ21P00001006	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Drug Enforcement Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$166,924	9/26/2021	9/25/2022
15DDHQ22P00000824	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Drug Enforcement Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$203,170	9/26/2022	9/25/2023
15DDHQ23P00000954	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Drug Enforcement Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$210,247	9/22/2023	9/21/2024
15DDHQ24P00000823	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Drug Enforcement Administration	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$452,557	9/26/2024	9/25/2026
DJFA9C0915400	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Federal Bureau of Investigation	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$216,324	9/15/2009	8/31/2010
DJFA0M0915401	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Federal Bureau of Investigation	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$57,000	8/29/2010	8/28/2011
DJFA3D0915405	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Federal Bureau of Investigation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$271,569	8/29/2013	8/28/2014
DJF141200K0011379	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Federal Bureau of Investigation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,580,717	8/29/2014	2/24/2020
15F06720P00000551	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Federal Bureau of Investigation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$310,704	2/28/2020	2/28/2021
15F06721C0002778	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Federal Bureau of Investigation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$155,352	2/28/2021	8/31/2021
15F06721C0003578	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Federal Bureau of Investigation	BARBARICUM LLC	\$1,358,721	7/21/2021	8/1/2026
DJ13FEIR010173	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$85,748	9/1/2013	8/31/2016
DJ13FEIR010173	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$27,200	9/1/2013	8/31/2014
DJ116EOIRP0101	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$91,112	9/1/2016	2/28/2018
15JE1R18P00000039	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$30,371	3/8/2018	8/31/2018
15JE1R18F00000201	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$139,630	9/1/2018	8/31/2020
DJ107C1529	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$1,427,019	4/1/2007	9/30/2012
DJ113C2355	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$2,052,440	10/1/2012	5/31/2018
15JPSS18PPZM00023	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	RENDON GROUP INC	\$1,929,609	5/31/2018	9/19/2022
15JPSS22C00000016	Department of Justice (DOJ)	Offices, Boards and Divisions	BARBARICUM LLC	\$1,836,063	20-Sep-22	19-Dec-25
15M10321PA4700129	Department of Justice (DOJ)	U.S. Marshals Service	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$65,012	3/9/2021	3/13/2023
DOLJ149635484	Department of Labor (DOL)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration and Management	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$187,205	1/15/2014	1/16/2015
DOLOPS14C0020	Department of Labor (DOL)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration and Management	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$69,525	9/25/2014	9/24/2015
DOLOPS15C0011	Department of Labor (DOL)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration and Management	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$909,355	3/17/2015	3/15/2020
1605DC20F00080	Department of Labor (DOL)	Office of the Assistant Secretary for Administration and Management	TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$1,139,930	3/3/2020	3/15/2025
SAQMPD06C0027	Department of State (DOS)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$2,003,962	12/22/2005	6/8/2012
SAQMMA12C0174	Department of State (DOS)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$432,600	6/8/2012	6/8/2013
SAQMMA13C0228	Department of State (DOS)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$2,290,656	9/11/2013	5/10/2019
19AQMM19C0050	Department of State (DOS)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$1,756,327	5/11/2019	5/10/2022
19AQMM19C0050	Department of State (DOS)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$1,756,327	5/11/2019	5/10/2022
19P05021P0313	Department of State (DOS)		CISION PORTUGAL - DISTRIBUICAO DE INFORMACAO GERAL, S.A.	\$39,504	5/13/2021	7/31/2022
19P05022P0615	Department of State (DOS)		CISION PORTUGAL - DISTRIBUICAO DE INFORMACAO GERAL, S.A.	\$32,900	7/28/2022	8/1/2022
19AQMM21F3150	Department of State (DOS)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$696,826	6/21/2021	6/20/2026
19AQMM22F4511	Department of State (DOS)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$327,311	9/29/2022	9/29/2025
19AQMM23F3385	Department of State (DOS)		TECHNOLOGY - MANAGEMENT & INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS, LLC	\$355,918	9/29/2023	9/29/2025
TPDCFP1200037	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Bureau of the Fiscal Service	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$145,833	9/4/2012	11/3/2013
953CB19F0015	Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$332,108	1/3/2019	2/2/2022
TD011F079	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$317,000	1/3/2011	1/2/2012
TD016F068	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$128,440	7/3/2016	11/2/2016
TOS17F0005	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$415,751	11/3/2016	12/2/2017
2032H18C00003	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Departmental Offices	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,827,749	12/3/2017	6/2/2023
TCC08HQ090095	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Office of the Comptroller of the Currency	BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$847,429	4/1/2008	9/30/2012
TCC12HQ090083	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Office of the Comptroller of the Currency	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,129,439	10/1/2012	9/30/2017
2031JW18P00008	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Office of the Comptroller of the Currency	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,328,844	10/1/2017	3/31/2023
2031JW23C00014	Department of the Treasury (TREAS)	Office of the Comptroller of the Currency	CISION US INC	\$812,165	4/1/2023	3/31/2026
DTOS5910C00406	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,998,358	1/14/2010	2/2/2015

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PIID	Awarding Agency	Sub-Agency	Recipient	Current Value	Start Date	End Date
DTOS5915P00018	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$117,852	4/30/2015	7/31/2015
DTOS5915C00414	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$0	7/31/2015	1/31/2016
DTOS5915C00405	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$0	2/25/2015	2/2/2016
DTOS5916C00016	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$0	1/28/2016	1/31/2021
693JK421P600010	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	CISION US INC	\$23,750	1/29/2021	7/31/2021
693JK421P500022	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	CISION US INC	\$237,278	7/31/2021	7/31/2021
693JK421C500010	Department of Transportation (DOT)	Immediate Office of the Secretary of Transportation	BARBARICUM LLC	\$1,382,270	7/1/2021	6/30/2026
VA101049A3P0250	Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$2,081,976	9/27/2007	2/28/2013
VA79813F0017	Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$347,438	2/15/2013	8/31/2014
VA79810F0002	Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$2,085,266	9/1/2014	8/31/2019
EP155000019	Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)		FOUR LLC	\$66,982	12/31/2014	12/31/2016
EP16H000137	Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$207,597	2/25/2016	2/28/2017
EP18H000025	Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)		DEFINERS CORP	\$0	12/7/2017	12/19/2017
EP185000015	Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)		FOUR LLC	\$100,473	2/21/2018	2/22/2021
68HE0521P0009	Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)		FOUR LLC	\$28,000	2/19/2021	10/29/2021
68HERH22C0001	Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)		CISION US INC	\$1,555,386	11/1/2021	10/31/2025
FCC10P0008	Federal Communications Commission (FCC)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$1,639,576	6/10/2010	8/31/2016
273FCC21F0081	Federal Communications Commission (FCC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$683,312	3/15/2021	3/14/2026
95332419C0065	Millennium Challenge Corporation (MCC)		CISION US INC	\$231,262	7/19/2019	9/21/2024
NNH06PQ29P	National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$738,002	3/1/2006	2/16/2011
NNH11PP62P	National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$19,623	2/17/2011	4/16/2011
NNH11PP85P	National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$10,051	4/17/2011	5/16/2011
NNH11PP90P	National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$520,150	5/17/2011	9/30/2015
80NSSC20P2201	National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)		CISION US INC	\$99,356	10/8/2020	4/8/2021
80HQTR21P0001	National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)		CISION US INC	\$1,018,573	4/11/2021	4/10/2026
NTSBP110059	National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$86,042	9/20/2011	5/17/2012
NTSBC120002	National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$665,627	5/18/2012	7/17/2016
9531BM18C0044	National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB)		CISION US INC	\$1,144,040	8/31/2018	8/30/2023
NRC3405303	Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)		BULLETIN NEWS NETWORK INCORPORATED	\$541,695	9/30/2005	4/29/2009
NRC1609451	Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,048,746	7/1/2009	8/25/2014
NRCDR090077	Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$25,000	5/1/2009	6/30/2009
NRCHQ7K15C0003	Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$1,100,080	3/1/2015	10/15/2019
31310019F0143	Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$724,428	9/20/2019	9/30/2024
31310024F0152	Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$398,202	9/25/2024	9/30/2026
SECHQ114P0237	Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$38,577	9/25/2014	11/25/2014
SECHQ114P0236	Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$25,939	9/26/2014	11/25/2014
SECHQ115C0053	Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$1,054,809	4/27/2015	4/26/2020
50310220F0089	Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)		BARBARICUM LLC	\$1,594,581	4/24/2020	10/26/2025
73351022P0007	Small Business Administration (SBA)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$96,775	3/1/2022	9/30/2022
SBAHQ16C0026	Small Business Administration (SBA)		BULLETIN INTELLIGENCE LLC	\$902,957	8/1/2016	2/28/2022

A.1.2. Excerpts from Media Monitoring Contracts

The following section contains excerpts from contracts for media monitoring found in publicly available databases, including sam.gov and documentcloud.org or produced through FOIA requests (CPSC 25-F-00254, DEA 25-00431-F, DOL 2025-F-06163, EOIR 2019-26810, EPA 2025-EPA-05231, EPA 2025-EPA-01013, FBI No.1657904, JMD FOIA 136110, NRC FOIA-2025-000404, OCC 2025-00151-F, SBA 2025-001843, SS No.20250423). The following quotes come from each contract's section on purpose and requirements, typically titled the Statement of Work (SOW). In certain instances, I reviewed the Statement of Work (SOW) included in the government's solicitation for bids on media monitoring contracts. For some of these solicitations, I also reviewed the questions submitted by potential contractors and the agency's answers.

The excerpts are organized into the following sections:

- a. What is the purpose of daily news reports?
- b. What news sources need to be reviewed?
- c. What is the process for producing daily news reports?

The tables on the following page summarize the contracts solicitation for bids on media monitoring contracts that I reviewed for this paper. Excerpts from those contracts can be found on the following pages.

Department	FOIA No	Contractor	Date Signed	Contract PIID	Current Value	Potential Value	Start Date	End Date	Potential End Date
Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)	25-F-00254	Barbaricum	4/10/2020	61320620F0025	\$276,010	\$276,010	4/10/20	4/12/2025	4/12/2025
Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)	25-00431-F	Bulletin	9/24/2019	15DDHQ19P00001028	\$139,874	\$139,874	9/24/19	9/25/20	9/25/20
Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)	25-00431-F	Bulletin	9/24/2020	15DDHQ20P00001130	\$144,070	\$144,070	9/24/20	9/25/21	9/25/21
Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)	25-00431-F	Bulletin	9/21/2021	15DDHQ21P00001006	\$166,924	\$166,924	9/26/21	9/25/22	9/25/22
Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)	25-00431-F	Bulletin	9/22/2022	15DDHQ23P00000824	\$203,170	\$203,170	9/26/22	9/25/23	9/25/23
Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)	25-00431-F	Bulletin	9/22/2023	15DDHQ23P00000954	\$210,247	\$210,247	9/22/23	9/21/24	9/21/24
Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)	25-00431-F	Bulletin	9/17/2024	15DDHQ24P00000823	\$452,557	\$1,219,835	9/26/24	9/25/26	9/25/29
Department of Labor (DOL)	2025-F-06163	TechMIS	3/3/2020	1605DC20F00080	\$1,139,930	\$1,139,930	3/3/20	3/15/25	8/4/25
Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR)	2019-26810	Bulletin	8/31/2016	DJI16EOIRP0101	\$91,112	\$91,112	9/1/16	2/28/18	2/28/18
Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR)	2019-26810	Bulletin	3/8/2018	15JE1R18P00000039	\$30,371	\$30,371	3/8/18	8/31/18	8/31/18
Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR)	2019-26810	TechMIS	8/29/2018	15JE1R18F00000201	\$139,630	\$726,642	9/1/18	8/31/20	8/31/23
Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)	2025-EPA-05231	Cision	10/29/2021	68HERH22C0001	\$1,555,386	\$3,087,113	11/1/21	10/31/25	10/31/25
Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)	2025-EPA-01013	Bulletin	n/a	EP16H000137	\$207,597	\$1,113,232	2/25/16	2/28/17	2/28/17
Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI)	No.1657904	Bulletin	8/18/2020	15F06720P0000551	\$310,704	\$310,704	2/28/20	2/28/21	2/28/21
Justice Management Division (JMD)	FOIA 136110	Bulletin	9/19/2012	DJI13C2355	\$2,052,440	\$2,052,440	10/1/12	5/31/18	5/31/18
Justice Management Division (JMD)	FOIA 136110	Rendon	5/31/2018	15JPSS18PPZM00023	\$1,929,609	\$1,929,609	5/31/2018	9/19/22	9/19/22
Justice Management Division (JMD)	FOIA 136110	Barbaricum	n/a	15JPSS22C00000016	\$1,836,063	\$2,430,154	9/20/22	12/19/25	12/19/26
Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)	FOIA-2025-000404	Bulletin	9/20/2019	NRCHQ7K15C0003	\$1,100,080	\$1,100,080	3/1/2015	10/15/2019	10/15/2019
Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)	FOIA-2025-000404	Barbaricum	9/20/2019	31310019F0143	\$724,428	\$724,428	9/20/19	9/30/24	9/30/24
Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)	FOIA-2025-000404	Barbaricum	9/25/2024	31310024F0152	\$398,202	\$1,008,106	9/25/24	9/30/26	9/30/29
Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)	2025-00151-F	Bulletin	n/a	TCC08HQPP0095	\$847,429.00	\$847,429.00	4/1/08	9/30/12	9/30/12
Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)	2025-00151-F	Bulletin	1/27/2012	TCC12HQPP0083	\$1,129,439.03	\$1,129,439.03	10/1/12	9/30/17	9/30/17
Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)	2025-00151-F	Bulletin	9/29/2017	2031JW18P000008	\$1,328,844.07	\$1,328,844.07	10/1/17	3/31/23	3/31/23
Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)	2025-00151-F	Cision	3/21/2023	2031JW23C00014	\$812,165.31	\$1,341,177.33	4/1/23	3/31/26	3/31/28
Small Business Administration (SBA)	2025-001843	Bulletin	2/25/2022	73351022P0007	\$96,775.00	\$96,775.00	3/1/22	9/30/22	9/30/22
Secret Service (SS)	No.20250423	TechMIS	2/26/2020	70US0919F2GSA0113	\$235,934.40	\$235,934.40	9/17/19	3/16/21	3/16/21
Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)	Doc Cloud	Barbaricum	2/1/2013	VA79813F0017	\$347,437.50	\$1,315,409.25	2/15/13	8/31/14	8/31/14

Table 2: Government contracts for media monitoring services acquired through FOIAs. Matched to contract on USAspending.gov. VA statement of work uploaded to Document Cloud by Benjamin Krause (DisabledVeterans.org) on July 2, 2014 (<https://s3.documentcloud.org/documents/1212217/131031-contracts-barbaricum.pdf>). Copies of other contracts produced through FOIAs submitted in early 2025.

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Department	Notice ID	Contractor	Contract PIID	Current Value	Potential Value	Start Date	End Date	Potential End Date
Department of Education (EDU)	9199024Q20078	Cision	91990024P0007	\$142,932	\$142,932	9/23/24	2/4/25	2/4/25
Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	ROPA-08-00029	Bulletin	HSHQDC08C00194	\$1,588,752	\$1,588,752	9/26/08	11/18/13	11/18/13
Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	HSHQDC-13-R-00071	Bulletin	HSHQDC13C00122	\$476,308	n/a	9/20/13	11/27/18	11/27/18
Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	70RDAD18R00000012	TechMIS	70RDAD19C00000001	\$2,008,596	\$2,008,596	11/14/18	8/27/23	8/27/23
Department of Homeland Security (DHS)	70RDAD23Q000000050	TechMIS	70RDAD23C00000004	\$851,150	\$2,192,780	8/28/23	8/27/25	8/27/28
Department of the Interior (DOI)	140D0418Q0453	Barbaricum	140D0419P0002	\$177,087	\$177,087	10/16/18	11/5/19	11/5/19
Department of the Interior (DOI)	DOIDFBO210022	LDSS, Inc	140D0421F0796	\$125,985	\$125,985	9/24/21	9/23/22	9/23/22
US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS)	70SBUR22Q00000031	TechMIS	70SBUR22P00000010	\$754,254	\$952,339	2/1/22	1/31/26	1/31/27

Table 3: Government solicitations for media monitoring services posted on sam.gov. Matched to contract on USAspending.gov.

What is the purpose of daily news reports?

- Per the 2020 contract between the **Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)** and Barbaricum (2020, p. 4-14)
 - “The objective is to have the contractor’s staff provide the Commission with timely, comprehensive data involving injuries and accidents associated with consumer products only. Providing coverage of the entire United States, as is based on a formula using reported census population counts as well as providing News Clips that are within the scope of CPSCs data collection requirements, are both of great importance to the success of this contract.”
 - “The Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) has, through Section 15 and Section 5 of the Consumer Product Act and other legislative authority, the requirement to collect, investigate, analyze, and disseminate injury data and information relating to causes and prevention of death, injury and illness associated with consumer products. Data in CPSC’s database is used to respond to public inquiries and in support of compliance and hazard reduction activities.”
 - “Emerging hazards identification, remedial strategy analysis, and regulatory development activities are built upon timely receipt, review, and analysis of news clips covering incidents occurring throughout the country. Through the news clipping contract, serious product-related accidents reported by the news media have been brought to the attention of the Commission. These clips are collected, analyzed for investigation (if appropriate) and made available for use by the Data Intake Branch and CPSC analysts.”
 - “The contractor shall clip: A. Reports of injuries and deaths involving: products produced, distributed, for sale and for use by a consumer in and around a residence, school, or recreational locale.”
- Per the 2019 contract between the **Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)** and Bulletin Intelligence (similar language included in other contracts between Bulletin and the DEA):
 - “DEA’s Office of National Media Affairs (CPN) exists to promote and amplify the mission and accomplishments of the DEA. CPN works to bring public awareness of controlled substances laws and regulations of the United States and their consequences through the media. CPN routinely fields phone calls from the media and speaks on important issues that affect DEA and the communities DEA protects.”
 - “In order for DEA to be effective when engaging media, its employees must have general awareness of and be knowledgeable on the relevant issues trending in media coverage. It is essential for DEA employees to have an understanding of the agency’s image as portrayed through the media. The most effective way to achieve awareness of what is being reported is to consume pertinent news in a concise format delivered to employees daily. This is a common practice throughout federal government as well as in the private sector.”
 - “It is also important that CPN quantitatively evaluate the reach and impact of its media engagement to better shape its media relations strategy. Commonly used by federal agencies and private companies alike, CPN requires a monthly service that analyzes national and international media relevant to DEA.”
 - “The goal of the contract(s) is to enhance DEA’s awareness of public perception and discussion relative to topics pertinent to DEA. DEA also seeks to better understand the effects and reception of DEA’s interaction with the media by tracking and analyzing coverage. These services will allow DEA Leadership and CPN to determine the effectiveness of DEA’s messaging and reach in national and international media stories.”
- Per the 2020 contract between the **Department of Labor (DOL)** and TechMIS (2020, p. 5):
 - “The news clips serve as an alert to emerging issues, leads for potential DOL investigations, and information that can be shared internally about ongoing programs or activities.”
 - “News sources...are searched daily to monitor coverage of the department’s leadership and activities.”
 - “Clips sum up the story of DOL in action, and point to problem areas that DOL agencies may need to address. Further, they are a source of material for the Secretary of Labor and other top officials.”
 - “The Department of Labor’s Office of Public Affairs will manage the contract for the news clipping service in order to fulfill the information needs of Labor Department employees.”
- Per the 2016 contract between the **Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR)** and Bulletin Intelligence (similar language included in 2018 contract with Bulletin and 2018 contract with TechMIS):
 - “The Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR) intends to outsource the daily creation of a morning briefings for the Office of Communications and Legislative affairs and other EOIR officials. In furtherance of EOIR’s mission, agency officials must start each day fully informed about important news printed and broadcast nationwide. EOIR has determined that this will best be accomplished via an expert-edited briefing rather than full-text articles or computer-generated summaries.”
- Per the 2016 contract between the **Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)** and Bulletin Intelligence:

- “This news briefing will afford EPA executives, Public Affairs staff, and other EPA staff comprehensive situational awareness of important developments on EPA issues as reported in the national and international news media...EPA’s Office of Public Affairs (OPA) is the primary office for all EPA communications...In its efforts to respond to media inquiries, strategically manage agency external public communications, and better enable the dissemination of public information during an emergency response activity, OPA needs the ability to monitor breaking news, editorials, longer form journalism projects, and the larger public conversation about health impacts related to the environment and general environmental protection.”
- Per the 2021 contract between the **Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)** and Cision: “The purpose of this contract is to provide EPA’s headquarters and its 10 regional offices with a wide range of media services, including systems to disseminate press releases, track media contacts, and monitor media analytics (at the national and regional levels) and services to provide a daily briefing and news clips at the national level.”
- Per the 2012 contract between the Justice Management Division (JMD) of the **Department of Justice (DOJ)** and Bulletin Intelligence (similar language included in the 2018 contract between the JMD and Rendon and the 2022 contract between the JMD and Rendon.):
 - “The United States Department of Justice (Department or DOJ) has a requirement for news clipping services for the Attorney General and the DOJ components...The Department requires a professional company able to review a wide-ranging scope of news outlets, understand the Department’s complex legal environment, and respond to the evolving news and issues relating to Justice Department activities. As the nation’s chief law enforcement officer, it is critical that the Attorney General remain aware of the current issues and events relevant to the U.S. justice system.”
 - “The required subject matters are: Attorney General/Deputy Attorney General/DOJ; National Security; Criminal Law; Civil Rights; Civil Law; Antitrust; Environment; Tax; Indian Affairs; the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI); the Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA); the Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives (ATF); the U.S. Marshals Service (USMS); the Bureau of Prisons (BOP); U.S. Attorneys; international law enforcement (as it relates to Department matters); Judicial Nominees and Appointments; Editorials/Op-Eds/Letters to the Editor; and the Administration, Congress, and Supreme Court.”
- Per the 2014 contract between Bulletin and the **Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)** and Bulletin (similar language included in 2019 contract between Barbaricum and the NRC):
 - “As stated in the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission’s (NRC) Management Directive 5.5, Public Affairs Program, the NRC Office of Public Affairs (OPA) staff is required to ‘keep NRC management advised of public interest in proposed policies, programs, and projects so that public affairs actions may be developed and executed effectively, and to inform NRC decision-making.’ Further, ‘[OPA] informs senior NRC management of media coverage of interest to the agency. [OPA] provides to the Chairman, the Commission, the EDO, and senior management(a) Early advice on public affairs strategies to deal effectively with the public on issues of interest; and (b) Information on external activities that may affect NRC interests.’ ”
 - “NRC officials and staff must start each day fully informed about local, regional, national and international news that is of interest to, or could impact, the NRC...Additionally, as the NRC’s social media presence has grown, and as social media increasingly is used as an information source by the public, the need for the agency to monitor and measure social media has also increased.”
 - “The contractor shall also cover news of interest of the NRC. News of interest to the NRC means all coverage from the sources impacting the nuclear regulatory activities of the NRC including but not limited to regulation and guidance-rulemaking, policymaking, licensing, decommissioning, certification, research, oversight and enforcement, security, and emergency preparedness and response. In addition to news around the NRC, the news summary shall mention other topics programs and policies outside of those that either explicitly mention the NRC or directly relate to the agency’s regulatory activities. For example, the contractor shall include articles regarding international nuclear matters, articles that involve other government entities such as the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), Department of Energy (DOE), Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA), Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) and Department of Homeland Security (DHS) whose regulations, policies and / or activities may impact operations at the NRC, stories that involve a topic that impacts all federal employees but does not pertain to nuclear activities (i.e. government shutdown) and articles about security and radiation. The audience is all NRC employees, approximately 4,000 individual readers.”
- Per the 2012 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Bulletin Intelligence (similar language found in 2017 contract):
 - “PURPOSE: Provide service to create and deliver daily news briefing packages and provide media analytics of those clips to support the Comptroller of the Currency and other OCC staff.”

- “BACKGROUND: The Office of the Comptroller of the Currency intends to contract a service to provide for the daily creation of an early morning news briefing that summarizes and provides links to top news relevant to the OCC and a more comprehensive morning media briefing that summarizes and provides links to news that is relevant to the OCC. In addition, the OCC requires the vendor to analyze the coverage for reach, tone, topic, source and type and provide analytics that are accessible online on a daily basis. In furtherance of the OCC’s role of supervising the nation’s banks, officials and staff members must start each day fully informed about important news on national banking news printed and broadcast nationwide. The Comptroller has determined this will best be accomplished via an expert-edited briefing with the access to the articles via Web links.”
- “In addition to news specific to OCC and its mission, the vendor must provide a”national news” section in the briefing suitable to the needs of OCC officials who must be made aware of important developments affecting the federal government broadly so they may interact with peers in the Administration and Congress.”
- Per the 2023 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Cision: “The Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC), Office of Acquisition Management on behalf of the OCC’s Public Affairs and Congressional Relations office sought to acquire services for the daily preparation and delivery of an early morning news briefing that summarizes, and provides links to, top news relevant to the OCC. In addition, OCC requires a more comprehensive morning media briefing that summarizes and provides links to news and compiles social media content that is relevant to the OCC...In furtherance of the OCC’s role of supervising the nation’s federally chartered banks, officials and staff members must start each day fully informed about important print and broadcast news, and social media postings, from across the nation related to the federal banking system. The Comptroller has determined this will best be accomplished via an expert-edited briefing of news clips...In addition to news specific to OCC and its mission, the contractor must provide a”national news” section in the Daily News Digest briefing suitable to the needs of OCC officials who must be aware of important developments affecting the Federal Government. The Daily News Digest briefing must also include a compilation of and links to Twitter and other relevant social media coverage of the OCC and other relevant topics.
- Per the 2022 contract between the **Small Business Administration (SBA)** and Bulletin Intelligence:
 - “The following details the U.S. Small Business Administration (SBA) requirement for daily news briefing which will summarize, interpret, and electronically disseminate print, radio and broadcast television news related to SBA interests. This news briefing will afford SBA executives, Public Affairs staff, and other SBA staff comprehensive situational awareness of important developments on SBA issues as reported in the national and international news media.”
 - SBA’s Office of Communication and Public Liaison (OCPL) is the primary office for all SBA communications. The Associate Administrator for the office serves as advisor to the Administrator on all issues concerning short-term and long-term strategic communications...In its efforts to respond to media inquiries, strategically manage agency external public communications, and better enable the dissemination of public information during an emergency response activity, OCPL needs the ability to monitor social media, breaking news, editorials, longer form journalism projects, and the larger public conversation about impacts related to the small business and entrepreneurial community. A daily news briefing service affords OCPL this capability.”
 - “The Office of Communications and Public Liaison seeks to provide all SBA personnel with a customized news briefing service of national and local media coverage focusing on SBA work and other topical areas of interest selected by SBA. This service shall allow personnel to have better situational awareness, as well as better support both proactive and reactive public communications strategies....This news briefing service shall be broad in scope, comprehensive in nature, and shall allow SBA executives and other employees to keep current on SBA media coverage.”
 - “The contractor shall prepare and deliver the morning briefing written and edited by news analysts familiar with SBA’s mission and responsibilities along with news of interest that is more general in nature and contains breaking or major news that is not necessarily focused on SBA.”
- Per the 2013 contract between the **Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)** and Barbaricum: “The primary mission of the Office of Public Affairs (OPA) is to provide Veterans and their families information through various media channels about the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) benefits and programs. Through the preparation and dissemination of various communications materials, the office provides essential information on program eligibility and operations to a variety of public entities. It maintains close liaison with media representatives and monitors print and broadcast news activity. It provides responses to inquiries concerning data and information about agency operations and policy. OPA conducts public affairs training to enhance the ability of public affairs officers to communicate through the news media. It also communicates information on administration policy and priorities through a variety of means, including articles, speeches, and media interviews with agency officials.”
- Per the 2018 **Department of the Interior (DOI)** statement of work: “The U.S. Department of the Interior (DOI) protects America’s natural resources and heritage, honors our cultures and tribal communities, and supplies the energy to power our future. The primary mission of the U.S. Department of Interior, Office of Communications, is the dissemination and communication of information relative to the Department, Secretary, and the Department’s objectives and purpose. To accomplish

this mission, it is essential that the Office of Communications and various senior officials keep abreast of national news events and issues related to the Department. Past experience shows that this is best accomplished by the utilization of expertly edited summary briefings that weave together only the most important elements of relevant news stories, highlighting reporting that Department officials themselves would have identified as important...This briefing will be a high-level review of news related to energy, water and land management, Native American issues, and national news stories...The contractor shall maintain the capability to provide more frequent updates to the briefing page in the event of an emergency”

- Per the 2021 **Department of the Interior (DOI)** Request for Information (RFI):

- “The contractor shall...Focus the briefings and the majority of the news included in them on DOI and its core mission, supplemented by news about the 11 agencies within DOI. Include a section entitled”DOI in the News” which mentions anything about the Secretary and Department, apply its understanding of the Department’s mission and interests and determine which aspects of each story, if any, are important to the various constituencies within the Department.”
- “The contractor shall...Include a national news section highlighting major news of the day on topics not directly related to Interior issues but nonetheless helpful to DOI and agency officials from the standpoint of general awareness. The”national news” section shall be suitable to the needs of Department Officials who must be kept aware of important developments affecting the federal government broadly so they can interact with peers in the administration and congress.”
- “The Contractor will be expected to determine which stories”rise to the level” of the Secretary and/or are appropriate for a generalist audience within DOI.”

- Per the 2022 **US Citizenship and Immigration Service (USCIS)** for the 2022 ‘USCIS Media Monitoring’ Solicitation:

- Per the Statement of Work, “The Office of Public Affairs (OPA), Media Affairs Division is responsible for providing US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) officials with executive news briefings on a daily basis. The Media Affairs Division communicates information about agency policy, procedures and products through interactions with the media. Internally, the Media Affairs Division works closely with the USCIS Director, each directorate and division of USCIS, the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) and other DHS components to ensure that messaging is consistent and accurate through diverse communications channels (print, radio, & television). They are responsible for promoting a consistent USCIS message to external audiences through multiple media outlets (broadcast, print and online). To gauge the effectiveness of these efforts and respond to inaccurate reports, the media team must monitor media outlets and analyze the impact of the agency’s message.”
- Per the Statement of Work, “OPA requires an executive level news briefing of national and local media/social media coverage focusing on USCIS services, operations and critical partnerships, in addition to other topical areas of interest selected by the agency. This briefing shall allow personnel to have better situational awareness, as well as better support both proactive and reactive public communications strategies. An executive news briefing will enhance the agency’s effectiveness when communicating laws, regulations, policies, processes and procedures that affect employees and millions of customers. With the briefing, USCIS will be better equipped to strategically position messages to execute agency priorities.”
- Per the Statement of Work, “The Executive Briefing shall capture the top stories relating to immigration which will allow USCIS executives to formulate communication strategies and allow other employees to keep current on the media/social media coverage of USCIS.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document: “INDUSTRY QUESTION: Does OPA have a definition of what it considers to be major US media outlets that are to be monitored daily? Is this defined by regions, size of the media outlet, readership or viewership etc? GOVERNMENT RESPONSE: Currently, USCIS receives clips from small and large media/newspaper markets because citizenship and immigration issues effect both densely populated areas and rural sparsely populated areas. USCIS uses the Nielson Designated Market Area number as the benchmark for media markets which is currently 210.”

- Per the 2023 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** Statement of Work:

- “The Office of Public Affairs (OPA) is the Department of Homeland Security’s (DHS) public face, dedicated to communicating and fostering an understanding of the department and its components mission through outreach to employees, the media, and the public...DHS requires a summary service that provides a complete and comprehensive review and summary of news stories affecting DHS and its components on a daily basis”
- “The media sources must reflect news topics related to homeland and national security including but not limited to aviation security, border issues, cargo security, citizenship issues, climate change counterfeit goods, Congressional activity, cyber security, domestic violent extremism, emerging technologies, federal law enforcement, immigration enforcement, immigration services, intelligence, international trade, human trafficking, maritime security, national security, national disaster, port security, preparedness, response and recovery, severe weather, and terrorism.”

- Per the 2024 Performance Work Statement for the **Department of Education (EDU)**:

- “The daily news digest service must provide up-to-date news to include what’s being said in state houses, school board rooms, and on the streets around the country, in order to react and determine Department actions best suited to promote educational excellence.”
- “In addition, the daily news digest must display education articles that refer to the President, White House, administration officials, members of Congress, and any significant developments at the state and local level.”
- “The Contractor must provide on a daily basis: “What’s happening today” or this-week sidebar to tell staff of scheduled Department or education related White House events, congressional committee hearings and testimony, major education trade association conferences, and other events.”

What news sources need to be reviewed?

- Per the 2020 contract between the **Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)** and Barbaricum: “The contractor shall monitor daily, Sunday, and weekly newspapers published in all 50 States, plus the District of Columbia...Coverage must be met for each state. 1. The coverage is determined based on a total annual goal of news clips, and census population totals. 2. Each news clip shall count towards coverage for the state in which the incident occurred. 3. Contractor is allowed to exceed coverage goals for individual states, but those news clips do not count towards the total annual goal, and may not be used to substitute meeting the coverage goal for another state. 4. A spreadsheet is attached (Attachment A - Required Coverage for News Clips (MidYear Goal & Annual Goal)) with the mid-year and annual goals for news clips for all covered states (including D.C.) required for this contract. B. By mid-year the contractor shall provide at least 40% of the total annual goal for each covered state. C. The contractor shall provide minimum of 400 and a maximum of 700 news clips monthly” (p. 5).
- Per the 2019 contract between the **Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “The vendor shall compile national and local media stories from domestic and international media outlets that have been published since the delivery of the last product.” Similar language included in other contracts between Bulletin and the DEA.
- The 2022 contract between the **Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)** and Bulletin Intelligence adds to the language in the 2019, 2020, 2021, 2023, and 2024: “Media Monitoring coverage should include premium content, podcasts, and international coverage.”
- Per the 2020 contract between the **Department of Labor (DOL)** and TechMIS: “The contractor shall review media sources, which are to include print, electronic and social media, for relevant news items according to Department of Labor keywords...The vendor’s media sources shall capture news on a local, state, regional, national and global level. The print and electronic sources shall include national newspapers, major international papers, major regional papers, weekly news magazines and industry trades” (p. 5). Contract produced in response to DOL FOIA-2025-F-06163.
- Per the 2016 contract between the **Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “The Contractor shall prepare a daily briefing memo that weaves together the important elements of news stories printed and broadcast nationwide. Stories to be considered will be those that mention EOIR or immigration policy. Redundant and irrelevant news shall be eliminated. Television news must include stories actually broadcast nationally and locally; it is not sufficient to provide links to stories appearing on the websites of local broadcasters, as many of those stories never aired.” Similar language included in 2018 contract with Bulletin and 2018 contract with TechMIS.
- Per the 2016 contract between the **Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “The Office of Public Affairs seeks to provide its personnel, regional public affairs staff, and agency senior leadership with a customized news briefing service of national and local media coverage focusing on EPA work and other topical areas of interest selected by EPA.”
- Per the 2021 contract between the **Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)** and Cision: “EPA’s Office of Public Affairs is looking for a service provider that can...monitor media analytics and services (at the national and regional level) to provide a daily briefing which feature relevant media content... The contractor will provide the agency with regional, program-specific, and national daily briefings that highlights significant news relevant for each target audience. The daily briefings should include brief summaries of public content and content behind paywalls. This coverage should interweave online, print, television, radio, and other media sources.”
- Per the 2012 contract between the **Justice Management Division (JMD)** of the **Department of Justice (DOJ)** and Bulletin Intelligence (similar text in 2018 contract with Rendon and 2022 contract with Barbaricum): “The Department requires comprehensive review of the day’s major news stories from sources including national and local television, national and local newspapers, news wires, internet publications, magazines, legal journals, radio, and specialty press.”
- Per the 2018 contract between the **Justice Management Division (JMD)** of the **Department of Justice (DOJ)** and Rendon: “The Contractor shall base the real-time clips and twice-daily news digests on a comprehensive review of all major national and local newspapers, national and local television, national radio, news wires, internet publications, magazines, legal journals, specialty press/trade journals, and Twitter. The sources shall include subscription-based publications.”
- Per the 2022 contract between the **Justice Management Division (JMD)** of the **Department of Justice (DOJ)** and Barbaricum: “The Contractor shall base the deliverables on all major national and local newspapers, national and local television, national radio, news wires, online news outlets, magazines, legal journals, and specialty press/trade journals. The sources shall include subscription-based publications.”

- Per the 2014 contract between Bulletin and the **Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)** and Bulletin (similar language included in 2019 contract between Barbaricum and the NRC): “The contractor shall find and review articles and broadcasts from all major (and most smaller) daily newspapers, national and local television, newsweeklies, magazines and journals, internet sites, specialty press, international news sources covering nuclear activities and blogs. This includes national, regional and local coverage, wire services and key international English-language media outlets including international wire services, as well as relevant blogs, magazines, and trade or specialty press. This shall not only include online publications of daily news but also relevant stories found in the hardcopy outlets.”
- Per the 2012 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “[the contractor must] Find and review articles and broadcasts from all major (and most smaller) daily newspapers, national and local television, newsweeklies, magazines, journals, internet sites, and specialty press.”
- Per the 2017 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “[the contractor must] Find and review articles and broadcasts from daily newspapers, national and local television, newsweeklies, magazines, journals, Internet sites, and specialty press. For daily newspapers, the sources included on the suggested news sources list must be reviewed at a minimum. Other national, regional, and local newspapers should be considered.
- Per the 2023 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Cision: “Contractor must review the attached suggested news sources list, at a minimum. Television coverage must be those stories broadcasted nationally and locally. It is not acceptable to provide links to stories appearing on the websites of local broadcasters if those stories never aired. If a story aired, the link from a local broadcaster’s website may be used...The news included in the briefing must be current, meaning the OCC Daily News Digest will include stories appearing that morning in the nation’s newspapers and broadcast in the preceding 24 hours by the nation’s national and local television news outlets. Additionally, the OCC Daily News Digest must include social media postings appearing in the last 24 hours.”
- Per the 2022 contract between the **Small Business Administration (SBA)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “Find and review articles and broadcasts from major U.S. newspapers, national television and cable news, radio, newsweeklies, relevant magazines and journals, blogs, specialty press, etc.”
- Per the 2013 contract between the **Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)** and Barbaricum: “Capture news items from newspaper articles, magazines, trade press, blogs, and local and national television news.”
- Per the 2018 **Department of the Interior (DOI)** statement of work: “The Contractor shall monitor all US online and broadcast news, including daily newspapers, national television and cable news, local television and radio, newsweeklies, relevant magazines and journals, internet sites, specialty press, etc. to identify stories with information of potential interest
- Per the 2021 **Department of the Interior (DOI)** Request for Information (RFI): “Monitor, at a minimum, all of the nation’s national and major regional/local newspapers; television news from the broadcast networks, major cable networks, and local television coverage in the top 210 DMA markets; major domestic news wires; appropriate specialty press; and appropriate online news sources (e.g. blogs); all for coverage of matters of potential interest to DOI...Ensure the briefing is current and based on stories appearing that morning in the nation’s newspapers and broadcast and in the preceding 24 hours by the nation’s national and local television news outlets. All content must be extremely fresh, meaning it was published or broadcast concurrent to the most recent previous briefing. The briefing provided each Monday must include all relevant news content from the preceding weekend. Capture national and television news as it is broadcast. DOI and its agencies are interested in news as it is broadcasted to the public, not in stories appearing on the websites of media outlets that may not have ever aired. For broadcast stories in which reviewing the actual audio/video would be particularly useful, the vendor will provide a link to available “video clips” that stream to the reader’s desktop.”
- Per the 2022 **US Citizenship and Immigration Service (USCIS)** Statement of Work: “All content must be extremely fresh, meaning it was published or broadcast essentially concurrent to or since the most recent previous briefing...The contractor shall...Monitor and review English-language articles and broadcasts from major U.S. newspapers, national television and cable news, relevant magazines and journals, internet sites/social media platforms, and specialty press.”
- Per the 2023 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** Statement of Work: “DHS requires the contractor to be capable of reviewing a wide range of news outlets, to understand the wide range of news outlets, to understand the complex national security environment and DHS subject matter, to remove duplicates of non-critical information and disseminate breaking news and issues relating to DHS and its components. Extracting critical information and indicating where stories post is imperative. News summaries and alerts shall be timely, relevant, and focused on the latest developments of DHS, including coverage of all of the components within DHS. The contractor must provide service with access to regional, national, and international news from the complete spectrum of media sources...The contractor shall provide complete and comprehensive access to media sources including but not limited to national and local television, radio internet, magazines and periodicals, newspapers, news wires, trade journals, social media, specialty publications and Spanish-languages media (translated to English) in electronic form.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2023 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** ‘News Clipping Services’ Solicitation: (Q1) Q. “To which extent is international news coverage expected to be translated? Are there any other languages expected to be covered, other than Spanish?” A. “If there is any international news coverage not in English it will need to be translated.” (Q2) Q. “‘The contractor shall compile and distribute a written summary of news coverage to DHS...’ Provide a summary of the articles, does that mean we summarize the full article, or just replicate the first paragraph

or the hit sentence (an extract of the article where the keywords we are searching for appear), or can we use a short blurb?” A. “Please refer to the exhibits A (at the end of this document) and Exhibit B attached to the solicitation record in SAM.gov.”

- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2018 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** ‘News Clipping Services’ Solicitation: (Q1) Q. “Are Spanish-language media sources to be distributed in the original Spanish, translated by the team, or can English-language versions of them be used?” A. “Government’s Response: An English translation of the Spanish-language media source is required. Section 3.1 revised via attached track changes to read, ‘The contractor shall provide complete and comprehensive access to media sources including but not limited to national and local television, radio internet, magazines and periodicals, newspapers, news wire, trade journals, social media, specialty publications and Spanish-languages media (translated to English) in electronic form.’” (Q2) Q. “With regards to the requirement for inclusion of “Spanish-languages media in electronic form,” as described on Page 2 (section 3.1) of the Statement of Work, should it be assumed that the requirement is for the monitoring of Spanish-language publications that are US-based? If not, would DHS provide a source list or list of countries for which media should be covered?” A. “Government’s Response: Yes, it would be for the monitoring of Spanish-language publications that are US-based.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2013 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** ‘News Clipping Services’ Solicitation: “Related to Spanish language press, the requirement is for English language versions of Spanish-language media from all sources. No translation services are required...The requirement is coverage only of the English language version of Spanish-language media. No translation services are required.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2008 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** ‘News Clipping Services’ Solicitation: Q. “Requirement 2.4 on page 2 references “Spanish language media”. Can you expand on this requirement? How comprehensive must this be ... approximately how many outlets? Can DHS provide a list of outlets it is particularly interested in? Does this include television? Is the contractor required to translate from Spanish in writing its summaries?” A. “Government’s Response: DHS no longer requires scans of Spanish media. This requirement will be removed.”
- Per the 2024 Performance Work Statement for the **Department of Education (EDU)**: “The digest must include human-curated abstracts or summaries of at least 40 education articles per issue gathered from newspapers, wire services, network newscasts, news magazines, education trade press, education blogs, college papers and other news outlets. Additionally, the digest must include an English summary of news articles published in Spanish.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2024 ‘Daily News Digest for the U.S. **Department of Education**’ Solicitation: Q16. “Does ED require Spanish language coverage of all topics and keywords of interest? Or are there certain topics/keywords that ED prioritizes for Spanish language coverage?” A. “Spanish articles should follow the same coverage criteria as English articles in accordance with PWS 2.1.2.” (p. 3)

What is the process for producing daily news reports:

- Per the 2019 contract between the **Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “The vendor shall compile a product containing summaries of approximately 25 articles. The summaries shall be three to four sentences summarizing the content of the full article and highlighting important points pertinent to DEA. The vendor shall use *human* analysis to provide human quality-assured content when summarizing articles and determining which articles are most pertinent to DEA, rather than solely using software or keyword searches. The contractor shall read the full article and summarize the article so DEA can consume the news in an efficient manner each day. The summary shall outline key messaging, influential content, and trending themes contained within each article. The product shall also include hyperlinks to the full articles. The vendor shall highlight the top five articles each day that are most pertinent to DEA at the top of the product. These articles should be the most pressing issues being reported in the news that day. The remaining articles shall be organized into categories: DEA News, Federal Government News, National News, International News, and Criminal Justice and Policing News. The vendor shall organize the articles and categories as desired by DEA and shall work with CPN to determine the best way to organize and categorize the articles. The vendor shall include any relevant foreign media articles specifically referencing the DEA or a DEA official and will provide a translated summary.” Similar text included in 2020, 2021, 2023, and 2024 DEA contracts with Bulletin. But the 2022 contract between the **Drug Enforcement Agency (DEA)** and Bulletin Intelligence modifies the language in the 2019, 2020, and 2021: “The vendor shall compile a product containing summaries of approximately 30-40 articles.”
- Per the Statement of Work from the 2020 contract between the **Department of Labor (DOL)** and TechMIS: “The contractor shall review media sources...for relevant news items according to Department of Labor keywords...The vendor shall have the flexibility to add, remove or modify keywords and search terminology in consultation with the U.S. Department of Labor. The list of keywords may be refined over time and could grow or shrink in number...The vendor shall compile relevant and pertinent news stories into a news clip briefing. The vendor shall cross check and remove irrelevant or redundant news clips...The news clip briefing shall contain an Executive Summary so that headlines can be scanned and department officials can drill down into the key stories quickly...The news clip briefing shall be further organized by topic. (i.e Worker Safety, Employment, Retirement, Union). Topics may vary over time depending on news coverage and DOL media outreach efforts” (p. 5). Contract produced in response to DOL FOIA-2025-F-06163.

- Per the 2016 contract between the **Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “The Contractor shall use *human* analysts to: find and review articles and broadcasts from all major (and most smaller) daily newspapers, national and local television, newsmagazines, magazines and journals, Internet sites, specialty press, etc. The Contractor shall apply a complex understanding of EOIR’s mission; determine which aspects of each story, if any, are important to the various constituencies within EOIR; edit out all information (not stories, but parts of stories) that is redundant or irrelevant; weave the remaining (important) information together such that it reads like a single story rather than what it really is, subsets of myriad stories on the same topic. In creating this news story from elements of various original stories, the Contractor shall, as appropriate, characterize the coverage such that EOIR officials can quickly get a sense for how widely various story elements were ran and also for the general tonality of the coverage.” Similar language included in 2018 contract with Bulletin and 2018 contract with TechMIS.
- Per the 2016 contract between the **Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)** and Bulletin Intelligence:
 - “The first news briefing will be delivered each morning by 6:30 am Eastern Time to approximately 40 EPA personnel. The briefing will be a news analysis as described under the Work Requirements below and will contain a link to full news clips obtained from a third-party content provider, such as Factiva, Lexis Nexis or similar service. The third-party content provider may or may not be obtained by EPA. A second news briefing will be sent to other EPA staff by 7:00 am Eastern Time, which will contain identical content as in the first briefing except it will have links to original media coverage on the media outlets’ websites and will not contain links to the full news stories provided by the third-party content provider. A third mid-day news brief will be provided electronically to approximately 20 people by 1:00 pm Eastern Time and will be more general in nature, containing major news or breaking news that affects the United States and not necessarily focused on EPA.”
 - “The contractor’s deliverable product must...Include ability to track click rates on links in the briefs and provide a heat map to see readership interest in reading the full article”
 - “The contractor’s deliverable product must: 1. Provide proven, extensive knowledge of the federal government, EPA, and environmental policy. 2. Utilize *analysts* to: a. Find and review articles and broadcasts from major U.S. newspapers, national television and cable news, newsmagazines, relevant magazines and journals, blogs, specialty press, etc.; b. Apply its understanding of EPA’s mission and interests; c. Determine which aspects of each story, if any, are important to the readership of the deliverable; d. Edit out all information (not stories, but parts of stories) that is redundant or irrelevant; e. Weave the important information together for each daily briefing topic, so that it reads like a single story rather than what it really is, a subset of myriad stories on the same topic; f. Interweave news from all sources, including print and television; and g. Characterize the coverage such that EPA officials can quickly get a sense of how widely various story elements were run. Note that EPA is specifically not requesting toning of articles...7. Provide exceptional customer service, including 24/7 access by EPA to contractor’s account managers, analysts, and senior managers, to permit last-minute changes to topics, deadlines, and specific guidance from the EPA to the contractor regarding stories to be included and the extent of coverage desired.”
- Per the 2021 contract between the **Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)** and Cision:
 - “The purpose of this contract is to provide EPA’s headquarters and its 10 regional offices with a wide range of media services, including systems to disseminate press releases, track media contacts, and monitor media analytics (at the national and regional levels) and services to provide a daily briefing and news clips at the national level.”
 - News Monitoring: The platform shall monitor news coverage based on keywords for each regional office and HQ. The coverage shall have filters available. The coverage should explicitly show the outlet and the web link to the story.”
 - “Media Analytics: The platform shall provide the Agency with up-to-date summaries of references of EPA activities in national, regional and local outlets. In addition, the platform will provide detailed open rates, bounced contacts, and other analytics for all content issued through the platform.”
 - “Daily briefing service: The contractor will provide the agency with regional, program-specific, and national daily briefings that highlights significant news relevant for each target audience. The daily briefings should include brief summaries of public content and content behind paywalls.”
 - “The contractor shall be available to meet monthly or more frequently if requested with each of the regional offices and headquarters to refine and improve the daily briefings. - Keywords: The contractor will review each ensure that each set of keywords is reviewed quarterly to ensure that news tracking remains relevant. The contractor is responsible for sharing a list of keywords at least quarterly or as requested.”
- Per the 2012 contract between the **Justice Management Division (JMD)** of the **Department of Justice (DOJ)** and Bulletin Intelligence:
 - “C.1.1. Clips Package. The Clips Package shall provide full length text articles of the day’s major news stories relevant to the U.S. justice systems. The Clips Package shall be divided by subject matter topics and organized by story...The Clips Package shall incorporate topics and cases of DOJ matters as they occur and develop. The Clips

Package shall also include items such as the day's Washington Schedule, congressional hearings, and the headlines from major newspapers and television networks. If a subject matter topic includes more than five stories of a similar theme, those stories shall be organized under a named subject subheading."

- "C.1.2. News Summary. The News Summary condenses each article included in the Clips Package, clearly highlighting all DOJ-relevant information and references in each article and eliminating redundant and/or extraneous information. The News Summary shall be divided by subject matter topics, organized by story, and must align with the organization of the Clips Package product, which is defined in Section II C.1.1."
- "C.1.3. Early Edition News Summary. The Early Edition News Summary provides a first look at the overnight and early morning leading news stories relevant to the U.S justice system. It shall condense each leading story and clearly highlight all DOJ-relevant information and references in each article, eliminating redundant and/or extraneous information. The Early Edition News Summary shall also provide the full length text version of the news articles noted in summary form."
- "C.1.4. Website. A dedicated searchable Internet Website shall provide real-time access to the News Summary/Clips Package content on a 24-hour basis, 365 days a year. The Website shall also include archived content covering all previously released News Summary/Clips Package information. Secured access to the Website shall be made available by the contractor providing the Department with one or more discrete or contiguous blocks of IP addresses."

- Per the 2018 contract between the **Justice Management Division (JMD)** of the **Department of Justice (DOJ)** and Rendon:

- "The Contractor shall review the day's major news stories and conduct searches that include the subject matters described in the previous and current day's press releases and media advisories and in the relevant categories described in the Specific Requirements."
- "The Contractor shall use human analysts to review articles and broadcasts to prepare the real-time clips and news digests. The human analysts shall apply an extensive understanding of the Department's complex legal environment and respond to the evolving news and issues relating to Justice Department activities when preparing the deliverables."
- "Real-Time news clips shall provide full-length text articles relevant to the U.S. justice system. The Contractor shall provide real-time clips for stories in the following subject matter topics...The real-time clips shall incorporate topics and cases of DOJ matters as they occur and develop."
- The Morning and Afternoon Digests shall provide headlines of the day's major news stories relevant to the U.S. justice system. The Morning and Afternoon Digests shall be a subset of the real-time clips, containing the most relevant, important, and widely covered stories and shall be divided by subject matter topics. The required subject matter topics are: Attorney General/Deputy Attorney General; DOJ; and national news related to the U.S. justice system. The Morning Digest shall also include relevant articles/broadcasts that were posted after 7:00pm of the previous day but not sent as a "Real-Time Clip." The Morning Digest shall also include items such as the day's Washington Schedule, Congressional hearings, headlines from major newspapers, and story line ups from the previous evening's network news.

- Per the 2022 contract between the **Justice Management Division (JMD)** of the **Department of Justice (DOJ)** and Barbaricum:

- "The Contractor shall review the day's major news stories as they relate to the work of the Department and conduct searches that include the subject matters described in the previous and current day's press releases and media advisories and in the relevant categories described in the Specific Requirements. In addition, the Contractor will be provided with a list of terms to use when conducting searches. Unless specifically authorized, the Contractor shall not include original stories that are more than two (2) business days old."
- "The Contractor shall use human analysts to review articles and broadcasts to prepare deliverables. The human analysts shall apply an extensive understanding of the Department's complex legal environment and respond to the evolving news and issues relating to Justice Department activities when preparing the deliverables."
- "The News Briefing shall include consolidated summaries of (1) that day's major news stories and (2) articles that are about the U.S. Department of Justice and/or relevant to the federal U.S. justice system. The Contractor shall provide a consolidated summary of each story. The consolidated summary shall be written by human analysts and shall include DOJ-relevant excerpts from each article. Information/excerpts for each consolidated summary shall be clearly highlighted and the article in which the information appears will be referenced. Redundant and/or extraneous information shall be removed to provide a concise summary. For story topics that have multiple news articles, a single consolidated summary shall be provided. Information/excerpts unique to individual articles on these story topics shall be highlighted in the consolidated summary with source articles referenced. The consolidated summaries shall not be the Offeror's interpretation of the coverage. The consolidated summaries should include only content from each article."
- "The News Briefing shall also include the day's Washington Schedule, Congressional hearings of interest to DOJ, morning headlines from major newspapers, and the story line ups from the previous evening's network news programs and prime time editorial programs from the three largest cable news networks."

- Per the 2014 contract between Bulletin and the **Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)** and Bulletin (similar language included in 2019 contract between Barbaricum and the NRC):
 - “There is an average of 50 individual daily clippings both foreign and domestic each day on an average of 25 different topics that are used for the electronic news monitoring. The human editor using professional judgment must review the articles to ensure relevance, eliminate redundancies and write a summary of each, grouped by topic. The summary must include links and should provide enough context that readers can quickly grasp the general content and tone of the article. Articles that don’t have substantially different content can be characterized in the summary with just a link. Each article, however, must be listed individually in the package. The contractor will not be required to summarize a subset of articles.”
 - “The contractor shall conduct the search for relevant articles using keywords and other means to identify news on topics directly related to the NRC, the nuclear industry both domestic and foreign, and other related topics of interest such as energy, the environment, labor, the federal government, emergency response, cybersecurity, etc. The contractor may need to adjust keywords and search queries to reflect current events.”
 - “The news in the daily briefing package must be current, occurring in the preceding 24 hours, and there should be a very low incidence of missed or day-old stories. The contractor shall respond to email follow-up from the agency for missed clips or other issues within one hour. When links point to content on subscription-based sites, the NRC may at its discretion subscribe. For broadcast stories in which reviewing the actual audio/video would be particularly useful, the contractor shall provide a link to available”video clips” that stream to the reader’s desktop.”
 - “The contractor shall quickly accommodate changes to the package based on the changing needs of the NRC, including adding missed news clips, last minute changes to topics to be covered, deadlines, and the format of the package. The contractor shall also be flexible to respond to occasional special requests from OPA to provide news clips on a fast-breaking event that impacts the NRC. (Note: This is a rare occurrence, however, the capability to quickly expand must exist.)”
- Per a 2009 amendment to the 2008 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “the Vendor must: Analyze all media clips about the OCC delivered through the OCC Daily News Digest product according to key topics (less than 10) identified by the OCC. Analysis should include: Mentions of the OCC in articles on each topic by date and total mentions of OCC in provided clips. Mentions of OCC by media type (Newspaper, Blog, TV, Radio, Trade Journal, Newswire, Magazine). Measure of tonality of all mentions by topic for the period and by date. Mentions of OCC in each topic by story focus (Primary, secondary; or mere mention). Mentions of OCC in each topic by story type (Standard, Op-ed, Editorial). Mentions of OCC in top ten sources identified by the OCC. Analysis of the size of the potential audience of clips by topic and total audience of OCC mentions by date. Analysis of the potential audience and tone showing the size of audience exposed to positive, neutral, negative messages by date. Total audience reached by positive, neutral, negative messages for the given period.” Similar text included in other contracts between OCC and Bulletin. Starting in 2012, the other contract also specify that “Analysis and scores will be assigned by a human analyst or editor rather than automated scoring methods.”
- Per the 2012 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “The vendor must use human analyst/editors to: Find and review articles and broadcasts from all major (and most smaller) daily newspapers, national and local television, newsweeklies, magazines, journals, Internet sites, and specialty press. 2. Apply a sophisticated understanding of OCC’s mission to determine which aspects of each story are important to the various constituencies within OCC; 3. Edit out all information (not stories, but parts of stories) that are redundant or irrelevant; and weave together the remaining (important) information such that it reads like a single story rather than what it really is, subsets of myriad stories on the same topic. In creating this new story from elements of various original stories, the vendor should also, as appropriate, characterize the coverage such that OCC officials can quickly get a sense for how widely various story elements were run and also for the general tonality of the coverage. 4. Summaries shall include source, date, page, circulation and author where available.” Similar text included in later contracts between OCC and Bulletin.
- Per the 2023 contract between the Office of the **Comptroller of the Currency (OCC)** and Cision:
 - “The Daily News Digest briefing is anticipated to average seven (7) to ten (10) pages per day. Contractor shall coordinate the order and outline of the Daily News Digest and Early Bird News Digest products with the COR in advance. Relevant stories from the key sources will be grouped at the front of the Daily Digest product under Leading the News.”
 - “For social media coverage, the contractor must provide a link to the original post. It is not acceptable to provide only a summary of the social media coverage.”
 - “The contractor must use human analysts/editors to: Find and review articles and broadcasts from daily newspapers, national and local television, newsweeklies, magazines, journals, Internet sites, and specialty press. For daily newspapers, the sources included on the suggested news sources list (see Attachment E) must be reviewed at a minimum. Other national, regional, and local newspapers should be considered. Find and review social media coverage of the OCC. Twitter must be reviewed, at a minimum. Apply a sophisticated understanding of OCC’s mission to determine which aspects of each story are important to the various constituencies within OCC.”

- “The Contractor shall use human analysts/editors to analyze all media clips and social media content about the OCC delivered through the OCC Daily News Digest product according to key topics (no more than 15) identified by the OCC. Scoring shall reflect: Person(s) reading and reviewing the article to determine topic, relevancy to the OCC, and potential impacts. Mentions of OCC in each topic by story focus (primary, secondary, or mere mention). Person(s) analysis of the potential audience and tone showing the size of audience exposed to positive, neutral, and negative messages by date. Total audience reached by positive, neutral, negative messages for the given period. Analysis and scores will be assigned by a human analyst rather than automated (i.e., AI) scoring methods.”
- “Media analytics shall include: Mentions of the OCC in articles on each topic by date and total mentions of OCC in provided clips. Mentions of OCC by media type (newspaper, blog, TV, radio, trade journal, newswire, magazine, social media platform). Measure of tonality of all mentions by topic for the period and by date. Mentions of OCC in each topic by story type (standard, op-ed, editorial). Mentions of OCC in top eleven (11) sources identified by the OCC (see Attachment E). Analysis of the size of the potential audience of clips by topic and total audience of OCC mentions by date. Analysis will score on impressions, audiences, and stories. Analysis will be delivered no later than 12:00 PM ET each day that the OCC Daily News Digest is delivered. Analysis will be provided online to OCC points of contact (typically no more than 5) as requested.
- Per the 2022 contract between the **Small Business Administration (SBA)** and Bulletin Intelligence: “The contractor’s deliverable product must provide: 1. Proven, extensive knowledge of the federal government, SBA, and small business policy. 2. A custom briefing. Use of human analysts to: a. Find and review articles and broadcasts from major U.S. newspapers, national television and cable news, radio, newweeklies, relevant magazines and journals, blogs, specialty press, etc.; b. Apply its understanding of SBA’s mission and interests; c. Provide all aspects of each SBA story, to the readership of the deliverable; d. Weave the important information together for each daily briefing topic, so that it reads like a single story rather than what it really is, a subset of myriad stories on the same topic; e. Interweave news from all sources, including social media, blogs, print, radio and television; and f. Characterize the coverage such that SBA officials can quickly get a sense of how widely various story elements were run. Note that SBA is specifically not requesting toning of articles. All articles regardless of tone should be including in the daily briefing. 3. A summary listing of all headlines from major papers and newscasts nationwide; 4. Links within the briefing to the original full-text versions when available on the original publishers’ websites and to streaming video of important television as originally broadcast; 5. Ability to track click rates on links in the briefs and provide a heat map to see readership interest in reading the full article;” Note that the 2022 SBA contract also contains 2.5 pages of possible keywords.
- Per the 2013 contract between the **Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)** and Barbaricum:
 - “The contractor shall: Provide news clippings and media analysis reports on a daily, weekly, monthly, bi-annual and annual basis to the Office of Media Relations, OPA. Provide media analysis reports on specific topics, categories, and sub-categories identified by the customer (the VA) drawn from a collection of news items pertinent to the customer...Categorize media captures as ‘positive’ or ‘negative.’ Determine the circulation or market share audiences of each media capture (i.e. print, radio, television or social media/blog). Format and design the media analysis reports that will at minimum include identified specifications provided by the customer. Upon customer request, add or eliminate topics, categories and sub-categories on a same-day basis to reflect the informational needs of the customer...Have the ability to access ‘pay for subscription’ news sites (for example, Wall St. Journal, New York Times, Military Times/Army Times) to gather full-text articles as required.”
 - “The contractor shall provide daily media news clippings and analysis reports, electronically delivered by 6:00 a.m. ET each weekday, including Saturday and Sunday that consist of news items pertinent to the VA. Regular daily clippings and reports will be provided on both Memorial Day and Veterans Day. Daily clippings and reports are not required for the other eight Federal Holidays noted above in Section 4.0. The contractor will provide web-based access to the report for the customer. The clippings will be drawn from newspaper articles, magazines, trade press, blogs, and local and national television news. The daily media analysis report will consist of a main report with an associated summary sub-report. The contents of the main report will be grouped by up to two dozen categories identified by the customer. The vendor must have the ability to add or eliminate categories on a same-day basis to reflect the informational needs of the department. Each report will include a table of contents listing each story in that day’s edition, a summary of 25-50 words for each listed item and the full text of each story. Whenever available, each listed article should include a web hyperlink for the story. Each listed article, television or radio news story, or blog post entry in the report will include the circulation or market reach/share if available. Each report will include a sub-report that serves as a summary report. The contractor will place the summary sub-report first in order, followed by the main report that contains full versions of pulled stories. The summary sub-report will consist of at minimum the top three daily media stories pertaining to the VA grouped by categories determined by the customer. The main and summary sub-report will be composed in a format approved by OPA.”
- Per the 2018 **Department of the Interior (DOI)** statement of work:

- “The contractor must pay particularly close attention to media coverage of the Secretary and Deputy Secretary of the Interior. The contractor shall utilize human analysts to analyze all referenced news outlets and information sources to synopsise the information in such a way that the pertinent information is presented to the reader in the headings and body of the news listing.”
 - “a. The web-based report shall be neat and professional in appearance and include an index of daily stories, organized by Department, Bureau or Office, to allow for quick review and access. The index topics should provide enough information to provide the reader with an idea of the content of the linked story. Additionally, the report shall include an expanded view section, organized to mirror the order of the index, which includes the story title and a synopsis of content to provide the reader with “click-free” access to the day’s events. All views, index and expanded, shall allow for scrolling. The contractor shall utilize human analysts to distill the pertinent information from the referenced news sources to adjust headings/titles and the synopsis.”
 - “At a minimum, the index and expanded view shall include stories related to the following Departments, Bureaus and Offices: i.Department of the Interior, ii.Bureau Of Indian Affairs, iii.Bureau Of Indian Education, iv.Bureau Of Land Management, v.Bureau Of Ocean Energy Management, vi.Bureau Of Reclamation, vii.Fish And Wildlife Services, viii.National Park Service, ix.Insular And International Affairs, x.Office Of Surface Mining, xi.US Geological Survey. Additionally, the index and expanded view sections shall include a reference to other national news events that, although not directly referencing the Department of the Interior or its associated Bureaus and Offices, may be of import to senior officials in the Department. At a minimum, the contractor shall include the following when material is relevant to the Department of the Interior and/or its associated Bureaus and Offices. i.Opinion Pieces, ii.Trending National News, iii.Editorial Pieces, iv.A wrap up of top stories from the previous night’s network news, v.Importantly planned events in Washington, vi.Late Night Talk Show Topics, vii.Trending Social Media Topics.”
 - “The contractor shall utilize human analysts and its understanding of DOI’s stated mission and interests to determine which aspects of each story, if any, are important.”
 - “The contractor shall provide access to senior managers and/or content editors to allow for adjustments or additions/deletions of provided content. Any changes in scope will be addressed by the Contracting Officer only.”
- Per the 2021 **Department of the Interior (DOI)** Request for Information (RFI):
 - “The US Department of the Interior (DOI)...is conducting market research to determine potential sources with systematic capabilities, staffing, and management experience to (a) aggregate news from national and regional print and broadcast media outlets; (b) apply human judgment in reviewing those stories to isolate information DOI should be made aware of each morning; and (c) weave those story elements together into new multi-source stories that inform completely but in a fraction of the page count represented by the original full-text articles or broadcast transcripts.”
 - “The contractor shall...Not rely exclusively on “keyword” searching of electronic databases. The contractor must use human surveillance of print and electronic sources to identify stories of potential interest to DOI and its agencies, even if those stories do not use keyword combinations that would identify them as such to a computer.”
 - “The contractor shall...Use a team of expert news analysts to apply a complex understanding of DOI’s priorities and determine which aspects of each story, if any, are important to the various constituencies within DOI and its agencies.”
 - “The contractor shall...Edit out all information (not stories, but parts of stories) that is redundant or irrelevant.”
 - “The contractor shall...Weave the remaining (important) information together such that it reads like a single story rather than what it really is: subsets of myriad stories on the same topic.”
 - “The contractor shall...Characterize the coverage such that DOI and its agency officials can quickly get a sense for how widely various story elements were run and also for the general tonality of the coverage.”
 - “The contractor shall...For each story write-up, identify each source publication, author, and date and include a hyper-text link to the full-length story on the Internet.”
 - “The contractor shall...Organize the briefing by story and subject, and include a customized index divided by subject matter in printable form for distribution.”
 - “The contractor shall...Provide analytics measurements of coverage of both traditional media and social media by a variety of metrics, including but not limited to date, coverage type, media type, tone, and prominence.”
 - “The contractor shall...Provide analytics measurements of impressions by media type, prominence, and tone on key issue areas that affect DOI.”
 - Per the 2022 **US Citizenship and Immigration Service (USCIS)** Statement of Work: “The contractor shall prepare and deliver a daily executive news, clips compiled by news analysts familiar with the USCIS’s mission, capabilities and responsibilities. By using extensive knowledge of the public affairs industry, federal government, USCIS, and the Department of Homeland Security’s respective missions, contractors shall...Provide links to news clips grouped by major topics...Use editing and publishing tools to format documents into user-friendly formats...Provide daily access to account managers, analysts, and senior managers to permit last-minute changes, deadlines, and specific guidance...Work with the Agency to customize the executive briefing summary to cover immigration specific categories. Edits to the initial customization must be allowed throughout the life cycle of the contract.”

- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2022 **US Citizenship and Immigration Service** ‘USCIS Media Monitoring’ Solicitation: “INDUSTRY QUESTION: For the ‘Top News’ category of the major topics to be monitored, please clarify if this would include top general news or top news in a particular category or industry such as business or foreign affairs. GOVERNMENT RESPONSE: “Top news” shall be the most covered story for the day as it relates to immigration and USCIS.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2018 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** ‘News Clipping Services’ Solicitation:
 - Q. “With regards to the requirement for “summary of news coverage,” as described on Pages 2 and 3 (section 3) of the Statement of Work, some contractors take the approach of providing only a link and an extract of the first sentence or two of an article, frequently repeating the same information from a large number of media publications. Would DHS prefer that the analyst team producing the service carefully weave together the most salient pieces of information from across sources, no matter where in each article that information is found, and even if the key story elements are not near a keyword?” A. Government’s Response: DHS would like a simple synopsis taken directly from the article.”
 - Q. “With regards to the news topics as described on Page 3 (section 3.7) of the Statement of Work, would DHS also like the contractor to include an option to provide a general “national news” section, suitable to the needs of DHS officials who must be kept aware of important developments affecting the federal government broadly to support their interactions with peers in the Administration and Congress?” A. “Government’s Response: National news should always take priority, but should not ignore local news. However, all coverage shall be inclusive with the Contractor’s proposal. Additional quantity options are not included with this requirement.”
 - Q. “Do you have a targeted list of sources from each media type of interest? Is there a tier 1 source list for the daily report? How do you want similar stories handled?” A. “Government’s Response: DHS will rely on the Contractor’s expertise, judgement and best practices, however; DHS will provide input on preferences.”
 - Q. “Do you have a list of keywords to share?” A. “Government’s Response: We suggest including all component names and their jurisdiction as keywords to start.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2013 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** ‘News Clipping Services’ Solicitation:
 - “The Contractor may be required to provide access to the service for approximately 200,000 government employees in domestic and international locations.”
 - Q. “Regarding coverage of the agencies: may we assume that the daily briefing should have a concept of news that “rises to the level” of DHS OPA and the audience for this briefing, and that much of the news generated by agencies within DHS may not rise to that level?” A. “quoters may not assume that the daily briefing should have a concept of news that only ‘rises to the level’ of DHS OPA and the audience for this briefing, and that much of the news generated by agencies within the DHS may not rise to that level. Quoters should assume that much of the news generated by agencies within the DHS will rise to the level of DHS OPA and audience for this briefing.”
 - Q. “may we assume that FEMA news topics such as small fire grants, flood awards, openings and closing of disaster centers, etc. should be included?” A. “No, quoters should not assume that such news topics should be included. Component topics should be included.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2008 **Department of Homeland Security (DHS)** ‘News Clipping Services’ Solicitation:
 - Q. “Section 1.1, Page 1 - Introduction refers to stories”affecting” DHS. Does this mean DHS only wants stories that explicitly reference DHS or its agencies? Or stories that could potentially involve the agency? If the latter, what criteria should be applied?” A. “Government’s Response: DHS requires stories that explicitly mention the Department and its agencies as well as stories that involve terrorism investigations, national security, and the general threat picture.”
 - Q. “Section 1.2, Page 1 - Scope asks for a”summary of major news coverage” and “a complete collection of daily news coverage.” Presumably “major news coverage” is a subset of the “daily news coverage.” What criteria should be applied in determining “major” and minor items?” A. Government’s Response: Major news includes only those top stories directly involving DHS headquarters and the Secretary or stories in top publications involving major issues within components (border security, immigration enforcement). Minor news includes local stories within a component agency (e.g. port security in Los Angeles, Coast Guard rescue in Alaska, TSA tests paperless tickets in Austin).”
- Per the 2024 Performance Work Statement for the **Department of Education (EDU)**:
 - “Organize the daily news digest into thematic sections (Leading the National News Today, Secretary and Department News, Elementary and Secondary Education, Teaching & Learning, Operations, Digital Learning, School Finance, Safety & Security, Special Needs, American Rescue Plan Elementary and Secondary School Emergency Relief, Post-Secondary Education, Statistics, Other Topics), then archived by date with a keyword search capability that enables users to retrieve summaries of specific articles and links to the actual stories.”

- “Emphasis must be placed on content that includes education articles from the following news outlets...”
 - “In addition, the daily news digest must display education articles that refer to the President, White House, administration officials, members of Congress, and any significant developments at the state and local level.”
 - “The news digest must include stories that mention the Department and its employees, especially senior staff listed at <https://www2.ed.gov/news/staff/bios/index.html?src=rt>. To assure that the Contractor’s list of Department senior staff is current, the site must be monitored for possible changes in senior officers at least weekly.”
- Per the Industry Question and Answer document for the 2024 ‘Daily News Digest for the **U.S. Department of Education**’ Solicitation:
 - Q4. “How large is the intended audience of the daily news digest?” A. “The Daily News Digest can be utilized by all Department personnel.” (p. 1)
 - Q14. “Does ED require each article found to be verified for its relevance, categorized, and ordered by a human analyst?” A. (p. 3)

A.1.3. Who received the briefings?

Because the briefings are circulated using listserves and are also forwarded to additional people, I do not know the full set of individuals receiving these documents. However, I can show that they were sent to a range of employees and were of particular interest to agency leadership.¹

Department of Interior (DOI)

While incomplete, I have been able to confirm that the following individuals were on the DOI news briefing listserve:²

- Sent directly to Felipe Mendoza - Deputy Director Office of Congressional and Legislative Affairs
- Sent directly to Amanda Degroff - Deputy Press Secretary
- Sent directly to Steven Avila - Advisor for Strategic Partnerships and Diversity Engagement
- Sent directly to Jeremy Bratt - Deputy Director of Congressional and Legislative Affairs
- Sent directly to Valerie Smith - currently executive assistant in office of Insular and International Affairs (<https://www.doi.gov/asiia/asiia-leadership>)
- Sent directly to Vicki Dixon - Management And Program Analysis
- Sent directly to John Blair - Director of Intergovernmental and External Affairs
- Sent directly to Laura Pardue - Deputy Director
- Sent directly to Christina Summers - Management and Program Analysis
- Sent directly to Hall, Tricia - Unclear role, accompanied leadership to budget hearing
- Sent directly to Paul Ross - Public Affairs Specialist, Office of Communications
- Sent directly to Scott Hommel - Chief of Staff
- Sent directly to Ryan Zinke - Secretary of the Interior
- Sent directly to Heather Swift - Press Secretary

¹In addition to Google and Linked In, I also used the following sources to determine employee roles: (1) <https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/GPO-PLUMBOOK-2016/pdf/GPO-PLUMBOOK-2016-8-16.pdf> and (2) <https://openpayrolls.com/federal/united-states-department-of-the-interior/office-of-the-secretary-of-the-interior/>

²The following sources were used to identify the DOI briefing recipients. (1.) Emails from 2015-2016. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571555-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-17/> (2.) Emails from 2015-2016. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571399-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-3/>. (3.) Emails from 2016. Document Cloud link: <https://s3.documentcloud.org/documents/4571399/Bear-Ears-Records-Part-1.pdf>. (4.) File 4 - see 3/21/2017 email from Christina Summers to Christine Bauserman with instructions for signing up for the daily news briefing: “It is a great resource, as it compiles the latest media info on Interior, as well as some of the broader political stories. FYI - The bulletin normally gets truncated in your email due to its length, so you can click on the link at the very bottom to view all of the stories” (p. 41 of the 650 pdf). Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191338-18-00323cf/>. (5.) Emails (8/1/17, 7/19/17) from Tricia Hall forwarding daily briefing to numerous people. Email (7/19/17) from Paul Ross to Russel Newell with instructions for signing up for the daily news briefings. Document Cloud link: https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/21031511-00953ca-propose-redactions_redacted/. (6.) Contains numerous DOI briefing emails from 2017-2018 and evidence that briefings were received by top agency leadership. In 2017, the Department of Interior (DOI) forwarded daily copies of the Bulletin-produced news briefing to the secretary (Ryan Zinke). Sent to both government and yahoo email addresses. Forwarded by his Chief of Staff, Scott Hommel. Per a 4/21/2017 email from Hommel to Zinke, “Your yahoo account will be added today to receive this bulletin as a backup should the departments system or your government devices have any delivery troubles” (p. DOI-17-0436-C-000130 from file doi2017_DOI-17-0436). On another instance, the Press Secretary sent Zinke an alternate (see email from Heather Swift to Zinke on 9/7/2017; p. DOI-17-0436-C-000177 of file doi2017_DOI-17-0436). Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6988850-DOI-17-0436-A/>. (7.) Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6559502-2019-11-Release-Set-6-Doc-19-R/>. (8.) Document titled “OS-2019-00338-Dec2019-Interim-Release,” which was uploaded to Document Cloud by Muckrock Staff on December 20, 2019 (<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6590263-OS-2019-00338-Dec2019-Interim-Release/>).

- Sent directly to Laura Rigas - communications director
- Sent directly to Downey Magallanes - Deputy Chief of Staff, Policy
- Sent directly to Lori Mashburn - White House Liaison
- Sent directly to Natalie Davis - Special Assistant to the Secretary
- Sent directly to Mary K. Foley, Ph.D. - Chief Scientist, National Park Service, Northeast Region
- Sent directly to Tanya Joshua - Office of Insular Affairs, Deputy Associate Director of Technical Assistance Programs
- Forwarded to Christine Bauserman - Special Assistant to the Secretary
- Forwarded to Denise Flanagan - Director of Budget
- Forwarded to Adrienne Moss - Deputy Director, Office of Budget
- Forwarded to Thomas Wayson - Division Director Budget Administration and Departmental Management
- Forwarded to Laura Nicholson - Chief of Budget Administration
- Forwarded to Jason Freihage - Assistant Secretary for Indian Affairs
- Forwarded to Patrick Joos - Budget Analysis Office of The Secretary of The Interior
- Forwarded to Taylor, Tiffany - Budget Analyst at US Department of the Interior
- Forwarded to Russel Newell - Senior Public Affairs Specialist, Office of Communications
- Forwarded to Ryan Zinke - Secretary of the Interior
- Forwarded to Bloomgren, Megan - acting deputy chief of staff and communications director
- Forwarded to Natalie Davis - Special Assistant to the Secretary
- Forwarded to Karen Senhadji - Director of Office of International Affairs
- Forwarded to Liza Johnson - Director of the Ocean, Great Lakes, and Coastal Program
- Forwarded to Douglas Domenech - Assistant Secretary for Insular Areas

Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)

The 2020-21 VA documents from the VA History Center are not attached to any emails, but some other VA briefings are available on Document Cloud. Some of these are attached to the original email chain. Note that the VA aggressively redacted some emails and names, limiting my ability to identify recipients.³

- Sent directly to Poonam Alaigh - Acting Under Secretary
- Sent directly to David Shulkin - Secretary of Veterans Affairs
- Sent directly to Jake Leinenkugel - chairman of the Creating Options for Veterans' Expedited Recovery (COVER) Commission
- Sent directly to Hipolit, Richard - Deputy General Counsel
- Forwarded to Kroupa, Laura - Chief Medical Officer at VA Office of Electronic Health Record Modernization
- Forwarded to Darin Selnick - Senior Advisor to the Secretary of the Department of Veterans Affairs
- Forwarded to Ulliot, John - Assistant Secretary of Veterans Affairs, communications
- Forwarded to Tucker, Brooks - Acting Chief of Staff of the Department of Veterans of Affairs
- Forwarded to Peter O'Rourke - chief of staff of the VA
- Forwarded to Shelby, Peter J. - Assistant Secretary of VA's Office of Human Resources & Administration
- Forwarded to Davis, Lynda - Chief Veterans Experience Officer at the Department of Veterans Affairs
- Forwarded to Sandoval, Camilo J. - Chief Information Officer (CIO)
- Forwarded to Cashour, Curtis - Press Secretary
- Forwarded to Byrne, Jim - Deputy Secretary of Veterans Affairs
- Forwarded to Mitrano, Catherine - Acting General Counsel and Principal Deputy General Counsel
- Forwarded to Pope, Brent - Chief Counsel for VA's Midwest District
- Forwarded to Hogan, Michael R - General Attorney for the Office of General Counsel (VA)
- Forwarded to Sheila Hickman - Director of Operations, Office of Accountability Review.
- Forwarded to Casio Spero - senior advisor to the Secretary
- Forwarded to Thomas Beeman - Cochair, Creating Options for Veterans' Expedited Recovery (COVER) Commission
- Forwarded to Jacquelyn Hayes-Byrd - Executive Director, Center For Women Veterans

³The following sources were used to identify the VA briefing recipients. (1.) Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/20394954-va-records-of-secretary-shulkins-personal-emails-concerning-agency-business-part-6/> (2.) Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6225048-VA-Records-Communications-Regarding-Concerned/>. (3.) Combined three documents from Document Cloud: (3a) <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6237573-19-04787-F-Redacted-Docs-Part10/>, (3b) <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6237575-19-04787-F-Redacted-Docs-Part11/>, and (3c) <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6237576-19-04787-F-Redacted-Docs-Part12/>. (4.) Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/25178129-pages-from-18-07090-141-280/>. (5.) Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/20402343-va-records-regarding-concerned-veterans-for-america-part-8-va-18-0457-s-t/>. See also <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6444072-9-16-19-19-08160-F-2nd-Releasable-Records-pdf/>. (6.) Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6929417-5-27-20-19-00614-F-Releasable-Records-000099-000338/>. (7.) Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6266324-8-2-19-18-10575-F-Releasable-Records-pdf/>.

Department of Homeland Security (DHS)

The .html-formatted DHS documents from 2024-2025 are not attached to any emails, but some other DHS briefings are available on Document Cloud. Some of these are attached to the original email chain.⁴

- Sent directly to Gregory (Gregg) Favre - Command Staff Officer for Homeland Security
- Sent directly FRIEL, MICHAEL J - Identity Intelligence Analyst
- Sent directly to Angel L. Vega - Major Crimes Division, Anti-Terrorism, Intelligence Section, Los Angeles Police Department
- Sent directly to Don K. Grote - Texas Law Enforcement Coordinator, Regional Organized Crime Information Center
- Sent directly to Edward Roberts - Officer, U.S. Department of Homeland Security, Office of Intelligence and Analysis, Private Sector Engagement
- Forwarded to bgranda@stlouiscountymo.gov
- Forwarded to mfagan@stlfc.gov
- Forwarded to kfoerst@stlfc.gov
- Forwarded to rfmetz@stlfc.gov
- Forwarded to Joseph.Cichacki2@usdoj.gov
- Forwarded to Derek Rieger (Riegerd@stlouis-mo.gov)
- Forwarded to MCALEENAN, KEVIN K - CBP Acting Commissioner
- Forwarded to FLANAGAN, PATRICK S - CBP Director (Acting), Logistics and Sustainment
- Forwarded to Marlan, Andrew M.

US Citizenship and Immigration Service (USCIS)

The .doc-formatted USCIS documents from 2022-2025 are not attached to any emails, but one 2017 USCIS briefings is available on Document Cloud.⁵

- Sent directly to Dimple D Dhabalia [uscis1] - Senior Advisor for Workforce Enrichment, Refugee, Asylum and International Operations Directorate
- Forwarded to Jennifer B Higgins [uscis1] - Chief of Staff for the DHS Deputy Secretary

A.1.4. Other Qualitative Evidence

Other types of news circulation within agencies

- Agencies also use Google News alerts to track news. For example, in 2017, Timothy Williams (Deputy Director, Office of External Affairs), had a Google News Alert set for the Bureau of Land Management.⁶
- Some agencies also produce news briefings internally. For example, see the October 1, 2014 NOAA Daily Clips produced by the NOAA Office of Communication.⁷ See also the GSA Daily News Clips from December 22, 2020 produced by the Office of Strategic Communications.⁸
- DOI had other methods of monitoring TV news. For example, the press office had a subscription to TVEyes Media Monitoring Suite.⁹ [Evidence: email alert dated March 20, 2016, sent to interior_press@ios.doi.gov.]
- On February 5, 2018, an EPA employee reached out to Kelsey Tamborrino (a Politico Reporter). Jahan Wilcox (strategic communications adviser for the EPA) forwarded a Politico newsletter called 'Morning Energy' and asked why a particular article was not included in the newsletter. After being told that it was circulated in the "Afternoon Energy newsletter," he responded by saying "EPA does pay over 100k for this subscription so if I can get added that would be great." In response, he was told to log into his Politico account and change the newsletter preferences.¹⁰

⁴The following sources were used to identify the DHS briefing recipients. (1.) Emails from 2023 forwarding briefings to individuals in national and sub-national government positions. Document Cloud link: https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/24120824-email__62/. (2.) Emails with 2017 briefings. Document Cloud link: <https://s3.documentcloud.org/documents/5450132/CBP-Records-Regarding-CatchOfTheDay-Hashtag.pdf>. (3.) Email with 2016 briefing. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6776936-19-641720Resp20Records-pdf/>. (4.) Email with 2018 briefing. Document Cloud link: https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/22270257-ssi_texas_foia_tamuk_correspondence_f001287_redacted/. (5.) 2018 emails. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6239507-P452725-Email-1/>.

⁵See email with 2017 USCIS briefing. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/20521884-dhs-records-relating-to-family-separation-from-2017-to-2019-part-8/>.

⁶Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191342-17-00541cacb/>.

⁷<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4554315-0-7-1205-41586-000001/>

⁸https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/24045485-foia_request_number_gsa-2023-000041_2023-000041-ravnitzky-rr-enclosure/.

⁹See page 483 of the following pdf: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571555-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-17/>.

¹⁰See document entitled "8 23 18 Release in Full Part2," which was uploaded to Document Cloud by Nick Schwellenbach (Project On Government Oversight) on February 8, 2019 (<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5732464-8-23-18-Release-in-Full-Part2/>).

Purpose or importance of news summaries

- In 2017, the Department of Interior (DOI) forwarded daily copies of the Bulletin-produced news briefing to the secretary (Ryan Zinke). Sent to both government and yahoo email addresses. Forwarded by his Chief of Staff, Scott Hommel. Per a 4/21/2017 email from Hommel to Zinke, “Your yahoo account will be added today to receive this bulletin as a backup should the departments system or your government devices have any delivery troubles”.¹¹ On another instance, the Press Secretary sent Zinke an alternate.¹²
- Example of instance where government official circulated an abbreviated and amended version of the daily news brief to additional employees. On May 12, 2017, a DOI employee send 48 individuals an email titled “BOEM Bulletin Clips on Friday, May 12, 2017.” This email contains an abbreviated version of the clips, a link to the full clips document, and additional news clips relevant to the Bureau of Ocean Energy Management (BOEM). It also contains the full text of articles from the briefing that were paywalled.¹³
- Case where subset of stories on Electronic Health Record Modernization (EHRM) were forwarded to a smaller set of VA employees.¹⁴
- On November 13, 2017, Jake Leinenkugel forwarded the briefing to high-level VA leaders and made the following comment: “8.2 clearly shows need for”true” Choice and Tr-Care eligibility rules vs. VA clinical. Also nobody trusts VA wait time data. Must be independent as a proof point. Backlogs need new definition as not all claims are the same reclassify those that add-on new claims and those being chronically appealed. Again, hire all veterans to process or consider outsourcing.”¹⁵
- In 2019, VA attorney Richard Hipolit forwarded the daily news briefing to other VA attorneys and agency leaders after adding a summary of the legal news.¹⁶
- In a July 19, 2018 email, the chairman of a Veterans Affairs committee, Jake Leinenkugel, forwarded the news briefing to another committee employee and asked them to: “Please read Clip 5.6 about the Tomah VA. It is very insightful in many aspects as to Mental Health Care and perceptions within VAMC’s. It is well written, factual with no editorialization. I think it is very pertinent for Commissioners to read prior to next week.” The employee responded saying “I can send it out to the commissioners this week and can also add to the desk side binder with the presentations for them.” The ‘Tomak’ article is video from the Cap Times about a report on the Tomah VA opioid scandal.¹⁷
- In a September 30, 2018 email, the chairman of a Veterans Affairs committee, Jake Leinenkugel, forwarded the news briefing and asked the recipients to make sure the the Commissioners reviewed a CNN clip about a veteran who took his life after reaching out the the VA for help.¹⁸
- In a January 29th, 2017 email from Michael Friel to Kevin McAleenan, he points out that “There was some points to CBP to consider in the coverage.”¹⁹
- Evidence of DHS using Heartbeat to generate reports of twitter content in 2017. Email chain shows case where DHS was forced to put out a response after NPR and Propublica reported on a story about the Border Patrol arresting a couple with sick baby.²⁰
- In a June 26, 2017 email, an advisor working for the USCIS’s Refugee, Asylum and International Operations Directorate asked the DHS Deputy Secretary’s chief of staff for more information about a news story. The story concerned a Syrian dissident denied asylum for organizing a conference with Syrian opposition groups. Specifically, she asks “Did you know about the Syrian case highlighted below? I didn’t receive anything to provide the F/O with a heads up.” The chief of staff responds, “Yes. I spoke to them about it! I had asked John to include it in the TPs during the RAIO manager meeting, but I had what I needed even though it didn’t get included.”²¹
- On May 10, 2017, Eileen M. Lainez (FEMA Deputy Director, Public Affairs) sent an email describing FEMA’s news briefings: “We use Bulletin Intel (recently acquired by Cision) – same provider DHS OPA uses. They send us a few different compilations each morning, which are distributed to agency leaders for situation awareness, and which we use to address

¹¹p. DOI-17-0436-C-000130 from file doi2017_DOI-17-0436

¹²see email from Heather Swift to Zinke on 9/7/2017; p. DOI-17-0436-C-000177 of file doi2017_DOI-17-0436. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6988850-DOI-17-0436-A/>

¹³Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191342-17-00541cacb/>

¹⁴See email sent on December 3, 2018 and titled “FW: EHRM in the News - Monday, December 3, 2018.” First page has the following page identifier: VA-18-0298-F, VA-18-0299-F-000021. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/20394954-va-records-of-secretary-shulkins-personal-emails-concerning-agency-business-part-6/>.

¹⁵See three documents from Document Cloud: (1) <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6237573-19-04787-F-Redacted-Docs-Part10/>, (2) <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6237575-19-04787-F-Redacted-Docs-Part11/>, and (3) <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6237576-19-04787-F-Redacted-Docs-Part12/>.

¹⁶Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/20402343-va-records-regarding-concerned-veterans-for-america-part-8-va-18-0457-s-t/>. See also <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6444072-9-16-19-19-08160-F-2nd-Releasable-Records-pdf/>.

¹⁷Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6266324-8-2-19-18-10575-F-Releasable-Records-pdf/>.

¹⁸Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6929417-5-27-20-19-00614-F-Releasable-Records-000099-000338/>.

¹⁹Document Cloud link: <https://s3.documentcloud.org/documents/5450132/CBP-Records-Regarding-CatchOfTheDay-Hashtag.pdf>.

²⁰Document Cloud link: <https://s3.documentcloud.org/documents/5450132/CBP-Records-Regarding-CatchOfTheDay-Hashtag.pdf>.

²¹Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/20521884-dhs-records-relating-to-family-separation-from-2017-to-2019-part-8/>.

misinformation when appropriate. We also have someone on staff who monitors and analyzes the media. The Bulletin Intel software provides statistical graphs, and we can adjust to view specific time periods.”²²

- On May 16th, DOI employees forwarded the news briefing and exchanged emails about how to respond to a story from the Cape Cod (MA) Times about “Petition Seeks Halt To Cape Cod National Seashore Coyote Hunts.” In these emails, Mary K. Foley, Ph.D. (National Park Service, Emerita) and Herbert C. Frost, Ph.D. (NPS Acting Deputy Director, Operations) discuss how to collect more information about the number of Coyotes hunted and whether to call someone named “Bob K.”²³

Interacting with contractors for news briefings

- On March 14, 2017, EPA employees exchanged emails discussing their concerns about the content of the Bulletin News Summaries. Samantha Dravis (one of Scott Pruitt’s aides), forwarded the news briefings to John Konkus (an administrator in the EPA’s public affairs office) and Ryan Jackson (the EPA Chief of Staff) with the following message: “Is it necessary to include all the negative headlines that go out to everyone? I could care less what Al Gore thinks about Scott Pruitt’s position - why is that news?? Who puts this together?” In response John Konkus replied “I totally agree. This has been an ongoing issue. We had them on the phone about a week ago complaining about the tilt and they said they would change. They haven’t.”²⁴
- On February 2, 2017, EPA employees discussed dropping Bulletin’s news service. In an email exchange between David Kreutzer (an EPA Senior Advisor) and former state senator Don Benton (an EPA Senior White House Advisor), David Kreutzer forwarded the Bulletin-produced news clips, writing, “We don’t need to continue disseminating this junk.” Don Benton replied saying “FYI- my scientist here indicates that they disseminate a lot of false/fake news stories here at EPA.”²⁵
- In April 2017, DOI employees exchanged multiple emails with Bulletin Intelligence employees. All DOI employees that could be identified are affiliated with the Office of Communications. On April 6th, 2017, Paul Ross (Public Affairs Specialist, Office of Communications) wrote to Amy Mitchell, Megan Bloomgren (acting deputy chief of staff and communications director), and Heather Swift (Press Secretary) and explained why the categories were changing: “This is put together by Bulletin Intelligence through our guidance. We have a contract with them. When something like new priorities are finalized on the website, it’d be good for the whole team to be informed. That way we can ensure we are using this type of messaging in all of our products, etc. We can also help anticipate things like the categories on our daily news brief needing to be updated. I realize that we have not been having a regular staff meeting to flag these types of things, so it might be good to give our team a heads-up through ‘os_oco@ios.doi.gov.’ I’ll work with Bulletin Intelligence on getting a draft of a briefing with new categories based off the changes in priorities. I’ll share for your review once it’s available.”²⁶
- On May 15, 2017, DOI employees exchanged additional emails to finalize the categories: “I had been working with Bulletin Intelligence on changing the categories in our daily news brief per guidance from Meg and Heather. This got a little lost when Meg headed to the front office and I wanted to circle back to get your okay to proceed. We basically are doing away with the categories and listing news by bureaus. We then have asked that the National News Section contain any stories about regulation reform, infrastructure, the economy, etc. that don’t already fall under one of the bureaus. A draft is below. Please let me know if we can proceed or if you have any other ideas.”²⁷
- Internal emails reveal that the DOI Press Secretary was personally involved in selecting the news briefing contractor. See emails between Heather Swift (Press Secretary) and Russell Newell (Deputy Director of Communications) on Oct 12, 2017.²⁸
- Case where a White House Liaison named Lori Mashburn emailed a DOI employee expressing concern about how clips were chosen. Questions were addressed personally by Press Secretary, Heather Swift.²⁹
- Internal emails show that subagencies give input into the content in their portion of the agency news briefs. On February 6, 2018, Tanya Joshua (Office of Insular Affairs, Deputy Associate Director of Technical Assistance Programs) wrote to Karen Senhadji (Director of Office of International Affairs) and Liza Johnson (Director of the Ocean, Great Lakes, and Coastal Program), “I submit insular areas articles to Bulletin Intelligence on a regular basis because I often find that they don’t include anything for our areas if I don’t propose actual clippings. I do however credit them for finding this Washington Post article for OIA. They will be changing the title from Insular Areas to Insular and International Affairs. If you would like,

²²See <https://epic.org/documents/epic-v-dhs-media-monitoring-services/>.

²³See document entitled “2019 11 Release Set 6 Doc 19 R,” which was uploaded to Document Cloud on November 25, 2019 by Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) (<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6559502-2019-11-Release-Set-6-Doc-19-R/>).

²⁴See document entitled “Definers Excerpts”, which was uploaded to Document Cloud by Rebecca Leber on November 10, 2020 (<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5674678-Definers-Excerpts/>).

²⁵See document entitled “Definers Excerpts”, which was uploaded to Document Cloud by Rebecca Leber on November 10, 2020 (<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5674678-Definers-Excerpts/>).

²⁶Emails can be found in the following Document Cloud document: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6581648-00665cm/>.

²⁷See email exchange from May 15, 2017 between Paul Ross, Laura Rigas, and Heather Swift. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4556659-17-00707cd/>.

²⁸See document entitled “Records from DOI Regarding Ryan Zinke’s Communications and Travel Part 1”, which was uploaded to Document Cloud on September 19, 2019 by the Content Manager for American Oversight (<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6422099-Records-from-DOI-Regarding-Ryan-Zinke-s/>).

²⁹See email exchange between Lori Mashburn and Amy Mitchell from March 31 to April 6, 2017. Document Cloud link: <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191344-17-00541ce/>.

feel free to send me articles that are important to your mission and you think should be highlighted here.”³⁰

News collection by other elites

- In the early 2010s, Richard Willis (2013) interviewed six congressional staffers about their offices’ news collection efforts (Willis 2013). In his sample, all offices collected news about the officeholder, but the sophistication and scope of the collection process differed depending on the features of an officeholder’s district, whether the officeholder was in the Senate or House, and the policy expertise of the staffers tasked with collecting clips.
- There is also evidence of media monitoring by interest groups. For example, a 2020 newsletter from the US National Oceanographic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) provides step-by-step instructions for setting up Google news alerts, explaining that “[f]or years, agencies and nonprofits trying to track media mentions were stuck with two less-than-ideal options. Big companies such as Cision and Meltwater do extremely thorough monitoring jobs, but at a price that is out of reach for most noncommercial public relations departments... Fortunately, Google Alerts is free and can unearth many more media mentions of your news or organization” (National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration 2020, 1).

³⁰See document titled “OS-2019-00338-Dec2019-Interim-Release,” which was uploaded to Document Cloud by Muckrock Staff on December 20, 2019 (<https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6590263-OS-2019-00338-Dec2019-Interim-Release/>).

A.2. Data

A.2.1. News Briefings

Department of Interior (DOI)

A large number of DOI news briefings have been posted on documentcloud.org, which is a website where newsrooms and independent journalists post documents, especially documents produced following FOIA requests. In order to post documents publicly, an account must be verified as belonging to a journalist or other approved organization. Using documentcloud.org, I found daily news reports from the Department of Interior (DOI) from February 19, 2015 to November 13, 2018 ($n = 213$). All of the DOI reports were created by Bulletin Intelligence.

Unlike the other agencies, the DOI sample is not complete and depends on the FOIAs submitted by journalists and non-profits.³¹ Thus, briefings are more likely to be in the sample if they mention topics related to FOIAs from journalists or interest groups. While this could introduce bias, topics become more or less relevant over time. For example, FOIAs prompted by Ryan Zinke's corruption scandal would be limited to time periods where he was suspected of malfeasance. This means that the potential bias is issue-specific and time-bound, rather than systematically skewing the entire dataset. Moreover, if temporary spikes in FOIA-related topics drive the overall results, the results would vary over time. To test for sampling bias, I verify that my results are consistent across the whole time period covered by the briefings.^[40]

Using documentcloud.org, I found 213 daily news reports from the Department of Interior (DOI) from February 19, 2015 to November 13, 2018. All of these reports are briefing- or summary-style reports produced by Bulletin Intelligence. Most of these reports were produced as part of several large FOIA requests related to Bears Ears National Monument. Thus, I am missing most reports for days where Bears Ears was not mentioned. All of the document cloud uploads used to construct the DOI dataset can be found below.

I implemented a multi-stage process to convert pdf documents into structured text data suitable for analysis. The majority of documents were already machine-readable; for the remainder, I applied Optical Character Recognition (OCR) using Adobe Acrobat to extract the underlying text. I employed rule-based pattern matching to identify section headings from the table of contents and parsed each document according to these headings. To see the heading structure of the briefings, see Appendix A.2.6.

To extract named entities corresponding to media sources, I used the Gemini 2.0 Flash large language model (LLM) to perform entity recognition and classification. After splitting the DOI news briefings by page, I used the following prompt to extract the sources from each page using the Gemini LLM:

```
# Define the model
model_id = "gemini-2.0-flash"

# Define response schema
class Citation(BaseModel):
    source: str = Field(description="Name of news source cited in text. Reproduce the
                                exact text. Write 'unable to determine' if not
                                certain or no news source is detected.")
    sourceinfo: str = Field(description="All text related to the the news source and
                                any associated text in () or []. Write 'unable
                                to determine' if not certain or no news source
                                is detected.")
    page: str = Field(description="Page number of pdf")
class Sources(BaseModel):
    """For each page of the pdf, extract the news sources cited in the document."""
    citations: list[Citation] = Field(description="The list of news sources")

# API Call
```

³¹The composition of the DOI briefing sample depends on the documents uploaded to Document Cloud and the FOIAs that produced them. In total, I identified sixty-six relevant uploads. See -Appendix A.2.1 for a list of the documents, links, and relevant metadata. Based on the document titles, tags, and other metadata, some of the FOIAs concerned Bears Ears and Grand Staircase-Escalante National Monuments, but other FOIAs sought information relevant to other topics like Ryan Zinke's corruption scandal in 2018. Many of the documents were uploaded by environmental nonprofits. Out of 213 briefings, 87 mention 'bears ears' at least once and 95 mention 'bears ears' or 'grand staircase.' About half of the briefings are from 2017 (122). Only about a quarter of the briefings are from 2015 to 2016 (43).

```
def extract_source_gemini(file_path: str, model: BaseModel):
    # Upload the file to the File API
    file = client.files.upload(file=file_path,
                               config={'display_name': file_path.split('/')[-1].split('.')[0]})
    # Generate a structured response using the Gemini API
    prompt = f"Extract the structured data from the following PDF file"
    response = client.models.generate_content(model=model_id, contents=[prompt, file],
                                              config={'response_mime_type': 'application/json',
                                                    'response_schema': model})

    # Convert the response to the pydantic model and return it
    return response.parsed
```

The model output was used to generate a candidate list of text snippets corresponding to news outlets. These candidate entities were then cleaned, normalized, and matched to entries in the Abyz News Links dataset using string matching on outlet names. To address gaps and correct misclassifications, I manually validated the matched entities, removing false positives where necessary, and assigned standardized names. For sources appearing multiple times in the LLM output, I also appended corresponding URLs when available. This process resulted in a list of 1,295 standardized media names.

In the document text, news source names were almost always followed by descriptive information enclosed in parentheses. To leverage this pattern, I split the text by “(” and retained the preceding 10 words as context. I then searched each chunk for any of the text snippets that had been originally identified as sources.³² When multiple sources were discovered, I created a new row for each source. Sometimes, this occurred when a story was co-produced by multiple news outlets, but it also occurs when there is a false-positive. In total, I identified at least one source in 31,456 of the 51,856 text chunks that I searched. I identified 1,925 cases with multiple sources. For these cases, I kept the source with more characters because the false positive tended to be shorter (e.g. sun, time, vice, ap). I included both sources in 59 cases where both sources were the same length.

A full list of Document Cloud uploads used to construct the sample of DOI briefings has been provided at the end of the Appendix in the References section.

US Customs and Immigration Service (USCIS) and Department of Homeland Security (DHS)

TechMIS-produced USCIS and DHS news briefings are indexed and can be found through a search engine like Google.³³ USCIS news summaries can be downloaded as word documents (.docx) and are available from January 2022. DHS news summaries can be downloaded as html documents and begin in January 2024. The structure of .docx and .html documents allowed for a far simpler parsing and matching process. All of the USCIS and DHS reports are summary or briefing style documents produced by TechMIS. I collected briefings through June 3, 2025. In total, I collected 922 USCIS briefings from February 1, 2022 through November 5, 2025 and 655 DHS briefings from January 2, 2024 through November 5, 2025. Due to the publishing schedule of the briefings, briefings are not produced every day. USCIS briefings are only produced for weekdays. No DHS or USCIS briefings are produced on national holidays.

In these documents, all of the sources are hyperlinked. After a source was cited, it was immediately followed by additional information about the article in square brackets. Usually, this information includes the publication date/time, article author, a large number, and an indication of whether the article was positive, negative, or neutral. I then used Python packages (docx and BeautifulSoup) to extract all of the URLs, metadata, headings, titles, and text. I then matched the sources to source categories using my hand-coded crosswalk from the DOI reports, the abyzlinks dataset, hand-coding performed by myself, and hand-coding performed by a research assistant.

Where possible, I first attempted to match the articles to the sources in the master crosswalk by host. For matches where this failed, I next attempted to match by domain and then by name. Most articles were linked to the source’s website, allowing for matching based on host or domain. However, for some video and radio sources, the hyperlink pointed to a URL for a hosting service (e.g. “youtube.com”, “api.criticalmention.com”, etc.). These sources were matched by name. A small number of sources were excluded from the analysis because they did not have identifiable names (e.g. “here”, “noon”, “5 o'clock news”). For a full list of unidentifiable hosts, domains, and names, see Appendix A.2.4.

³²e.g. for abc, I searched for phrases like “abc world news”, “abc’s this week”, “abc news”, and “abc’s æthis weekæ”.

³³For example, [https://www.uscis.techmis.com/epub/2022/Dec/28/USCIS%20News%20Briefing%20\(12-28-22\).docx](https://www.uscis.techmis.com/epub/2022/Dec/28/USCIS%20News%20Briefing%20(12-28-22).docx).

Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)

VA daily news briefings from 2020 and 2021 were produced by Barbaricum and collected by the Veterans Affairs History Office as part of a Covid-19 archive collection.³⁴ In total, there are 233 daily news briefings for the VA from June 3, 2020 through February 25, 2021. While these documents are pdfs, the hyperlinks are still functional, so I extracted 6,099 hyperlinks using the `pdfplumber` python package and apply the same process used for the DHS and USCIS reports.

Merging data

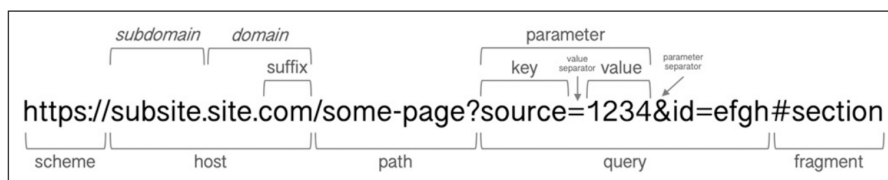


Figure A1: Components of a URL. Screenshot of Figure 2 from Clemm von Hohenberg et al. (2024, p. 1482).

This project requires merging multiple datasets (the briefings, source categories, source partisan slant, and agency ideology scores). Agency-level information was merged using standardized agency abbreviations. Where possible, I first attempted to match the articles to the source categories by host. For matches where this failed, I next attempted to match by domain.

Source-level variables were primarily merged using source websites and sometimes by source name. For best practices on working with URLs, I consulted Clemm von Hohenberg et al. (2024). Figure A1 is a screenshot from their article with the terminology for describing URLs. According to the authors, matching by domain is best-practice. However, in my data, multiple news sources can be hosted at the same domain. To improve the quality of the match, I prioritized matches by host over matches by domain. In practice, I merged most of my data in two stages. First, I merged by the host and split the data into a matched and unmatched sample. Second, I separately merged the unmatched sample by domain.

In a few cases, I also matched by source name. First, source websites were not available for all cited articles. For the whole set of DOI briefings and parts of the other briefings, I constructed a crosswalk between the source names and the websites. However, due to the large number of local general interest sources, to save time, I did not collect all of the websites for all local general interest news. Thus, some of the DOI local data is matched to partisan news sources exclusively by name.

- The following hosts could not be identified: `api.criticalmention.com`, `youtube.com`, `clips-mp4-aka.warnermediacdn.com`, `playlist.megaphone.fm`, `prodamdnewsencoding.akamaized.net`, `open.spotify.com`, `cdn.jwplayer.com`, `content.govdelivery.com`, `drive.google.com`, `soundcloud.com`, `tinyurl.com`, `mms.tveyes.com`, `my.tveyes.com`, `facebook.com`, `m.facebook.com`, `issuu.com`, `videos-cloudfront.jwpsrv.com`, `s24507.pcdn.com`, `google.com`, `video.bb-content.media`, and `25993.mc.tritondigital.com`.
- The following domains could not be identified: `substack.com`, `t.co`, `tveyes.com`, `tveyes.com`, `facebook.com`, `tinyurl.com`, `issuu.com`, `pcdn.co`, `podcasts.apple.com`, `omny.fm`, `video.bb-content.media`, `google.com`, `criticalmention.com`, `youtube.com`, `warnermediacdn.com`, `megaphone.fm`, `akamaized.net`, `spotify.com`, `jwplayer.com`, `govdelivery.com`, `soundcloud.com`, `facebook.com`, `jwpsrv.com`, and `pcdn.com`.
- The following names could not be identified: `here`, `today`, `noon`, `the noon`, `5 oclock news`, `weekend`, `the weekend`, `7news on your side at noon`, `14 news at 1100am`, `10 this morning 6am`, `13news weekend at 600pm`, `14 news at 1100am`, `7news on your side at noon`, `cbs 2 news at midday`, `cbs 2 news this morning`, `kdka tv`, `national report`, `the national report`, `the national news desk`, `national news desk`, `youtube senator katie boyd britt`, `nbc 5 news at 6am`, `fox 17 this morning`, `nbc 6 news at noon`, `nbc 5 today at 6am`, `abc 6 news at noon`, `fox 4 morning news at 9a`, `fox 6 wake up news at 8`, `today in az`, `fox 10 news at 8am`, `fox 4 morning news at 8a`, `news 5 at noon`, `fox13 news at noon`, `cbs 13 news at noon`, `local 10 news at noon`, `cbs 58 news at noon`, `florida live`, `nbc 7 news today 6a`, and `7news on your side at 6am`.

³⁴see <https://department.va.gov/history/wp-content/uploads/sites/10/2024/10/VA-History-Office-COVID-19.pdf>.

A.2.2. Agency names

Because the DOI and DHS news briefings are divided into sections that correspond to some of their sub-agencies, the four sets of briefings can be broken into news compilations for 16 separate agencies. For DHS, DOI, VA, and USCIS, estimates use all of the news articles in the report. Estimates for the other agencies use only a section of the reports corresponding to that agency. See the table below.

Table 4: Summary Stats for Briefings and Agencies

Briefing	Agency	Part of Briefing	Years	Total Articles	Total Dates	Avg Articles per Day	Unique Source Domains	Unique Source Names
DOI	DOI	Whole Briefing	2015-2018	37,848	213	177.7	2,110	2,287
DOI	BLM	Section	2015-2018	1,342	210	6.4	313	321
DOI	FWS	Section	2015-2018	2,154	210	10.3	586	604
DOI	GS	Section	2015-2018	562	160	3.5	240	245
DOI	NPS	Section	2015-2018	3,256	212	15.4	728	767
DOI	BOR	Section	2016-2018	266	104	2.6	128	130
DOI	BIA	Section	2017-2018	454	128	3.5	161	162
VA	VA	Whole Briefing	2020-2021	6,099	233	26.2	1,671	1,261
USCIS	USCIS	Whole Briefing	2022-2025	44,420	922	48.2	1,845	2,159
DHS	DHS	Whole Briefing	2024-2025	70,346	655	107.4	1,295	1,394
DHS	CG	Section	2024-2025	2,648	583	4.5	284	341
DHS	FEMA	Section	2024-2025	6,394	643	9.9	287	284
DHS	SS	Section	2024-2025	3,622	567	6.4	844	830
DHS	TSA	Section	2024-2025	1,379	454	3.0	126	142
DHS	USCBP	Section	2024-2025	4,504	648	7.0	161	168
DHS	USCIS	Section	2024-2025	2,755	591	4.7	145	133
DHS	USICE	Section	2024-2025	7,576	618	12.3	285	281
Total			2015-2025	158,713	1,563	101.5	4,081	4,393

The heatmaps below show how the briefings were divided into sections. The VA and USCIS briefings do not have any headings that correspond to sub-agencies. The DOI news briefings has section headings for the following sub-agencies: Bureau of Indian Affairs (BIA), National Parks Service (NPS), Bureau of Land Management (BLM), Fish and Wildlife Service (FWS), and Bureau of Reclamation (BOR). Because the DOI headings changes partway through 2017, a heading called BIA is only available for 2017-2018. Headings for all other DOI sub-agencies are available for the whole time period from 2015-2018. The DHS news briefing has sections for the following sub-agencies: Immigration and Customs Enforcement (USICE), Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS), Customs and Border protection (USCBP), Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA), Coast Guard (CG), Transportation Security Administration (TSA), and Secret Service (SS).

DHS Briefing Section Headings (2024–2025)

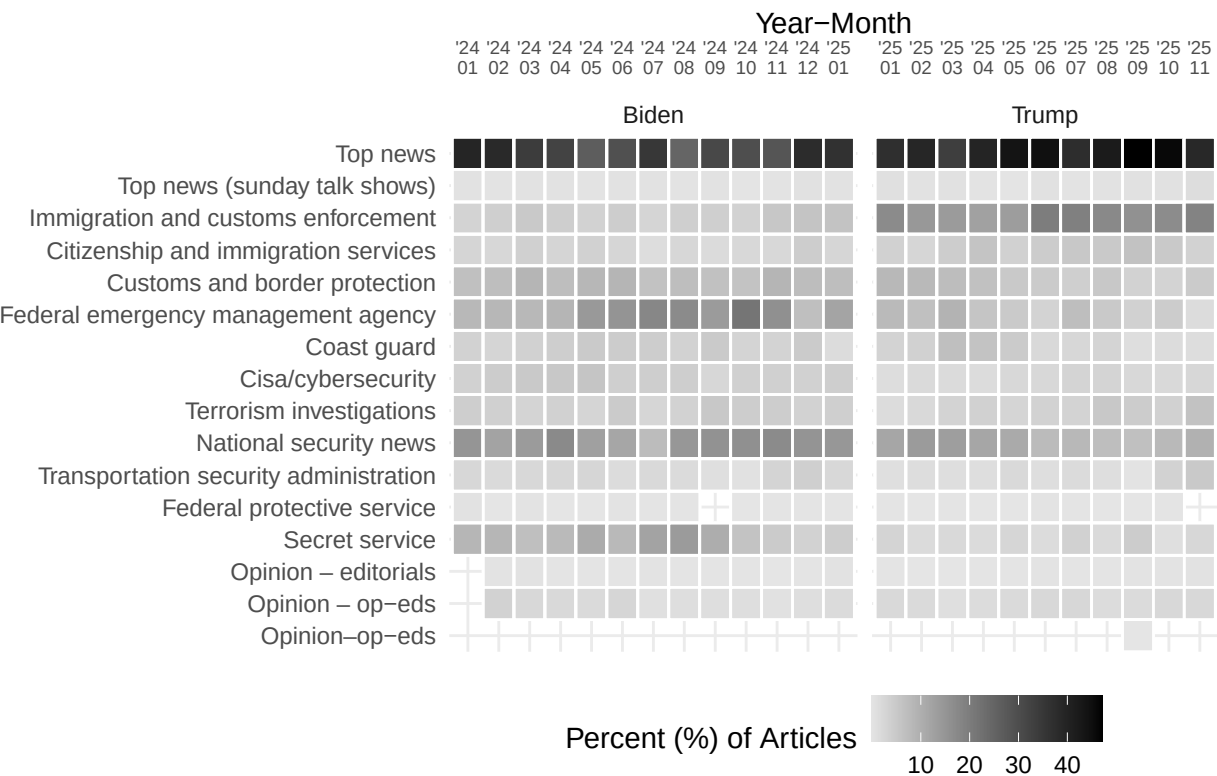


Figure A2: Headings from DHS News Briefings

DOI Briefing Section Headings (2015–2018)

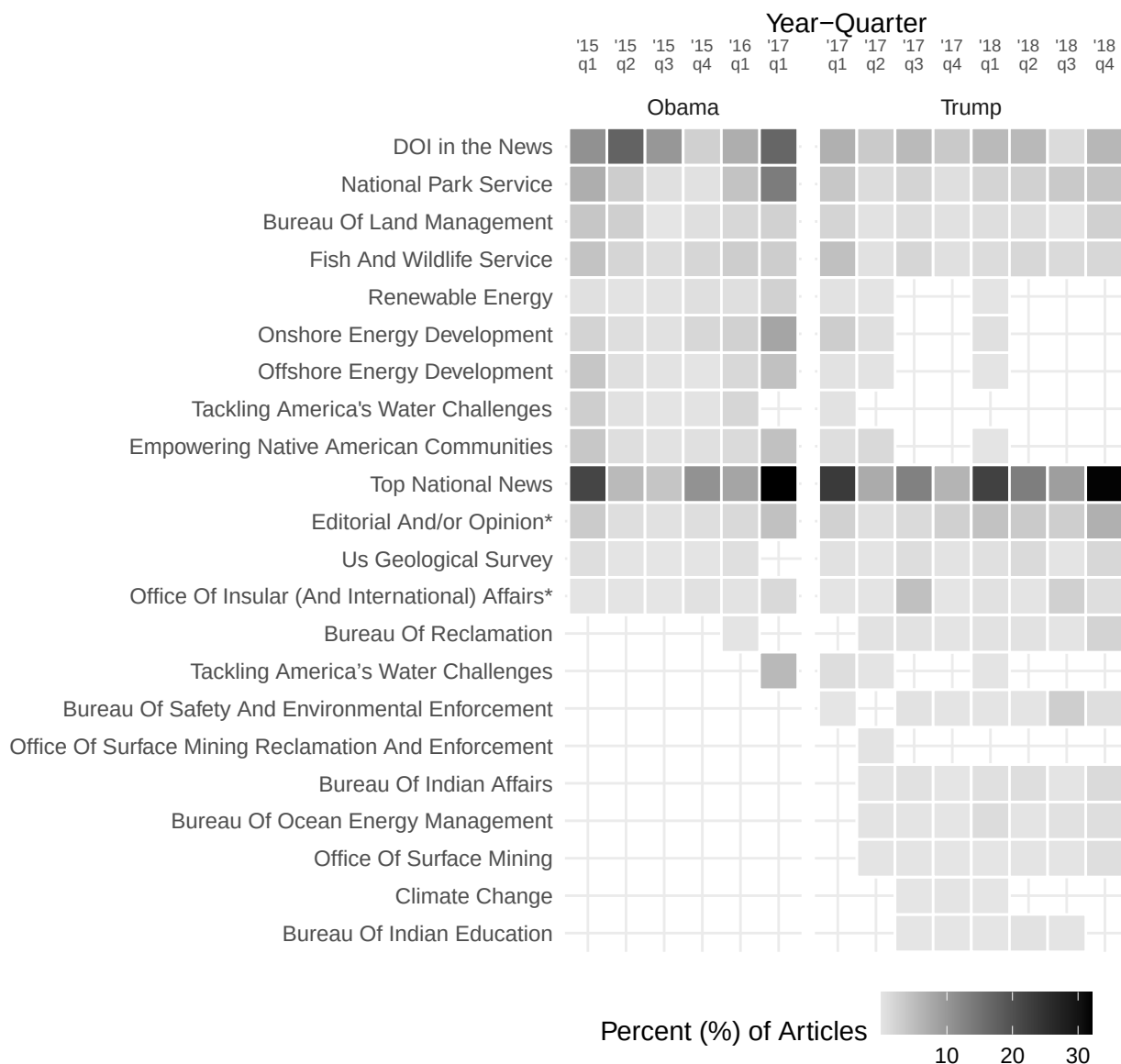


Figure A3: Headings from DOI News Briefings. Removed 'Big Picture' section with schedule for White House and Congress. Removed 'Last Laughs' section with summary of late night comedy. Combined headings for Office of Insular and International Affairs. Combined editorial and opinion sections.

A.2.3. Categorizing source type

In general, I did not change categorization assigned by ABYZ Links unless the website had multiple, conflicting listings for the same news source. For example, sometimes a source would cover multiple geographic jurisdictions, have multiple websites, or be available in multiple mediums. There were a few exceptions. I did recategorize national sources like Politico and the Hill to be 'Government' websites rather than 'General Interest' websites. I also changed ABYZ Links coding for several sources from 'Local' to 'National': nypost.com, washingtonexaminer.com, freebeacon.com, and washingtontimes.com.

Using the ABYZ Links categorizes as a starting point, sources were categorized into the following categories:

1. **Geography** - Determine whether source generally cover local, state, or national news?³⁵
2. **Media Type** - Primary media format of news outlet. If website covers multiple mediums (e.g. CNN.com, NPR.org), put primary/historic
3. **Media Focus** - Categorize the sources as either “General Interest” or more specialized. Some specialties are defined by topic (e.g. industry, policy area) others by audience (e.g. ethnic news, teen vogue).

In the table below, I use these categories to identify the three kinds of sources that are dropped from the main analysis (local general interest, government websites, unidentified sources). Figure A4 shows how the number of articles varies over time, after dropping local general interest source, government websites, and unidentified sources. This figure also shows the distribution of briefings over time.

Table 5: Summary Stats for Briefings and Agencies

Briefing	Agency	Part of Briefing	Years	Total Articles	Local General Interest	Gov Websites	Unidentified	International
DOI	BLM	Section	2015-2018	1,342	817	0	0	825
DOI	DOI	Section	2015-2018	37,848	10,761	4	0	11,071
DOI	FWS	Section	2015-2018	2,154	1,060	1	0	1,138
DOI	GS	Section	2015-2018	562	239	0	0	268
DOI	NPS	Section	2015-2018	3,256	1,751	0	0	1,810
DOI	BOR	Section	2016-2018	266	172	0	0	175
DOI	BIA	Section	2017-2018	454	222	0	0	222
VA	VA	Section	2020-2021	6,099	3,588	87	38	3,664
USCIS	USCIS	Section	2022-2025	44,420	17,596	47	4	17,219
DHS	CG	Section	2024-2025	2,648	725	38	10	681
DHS	DHS	Section	2024-2025	70,346	8,566	200	134	8,541
DHS	FEMA	Section	2024-2025	6,394	1,132	2	17	1,026
DHS	SS	Section	2024-2025	3,622	1,493	148	1	1,658
DHS	TSA	Section	2024-2025	1,379	239	3	9	188
DHS	USCBP	Section	2024-2025	4,504	827	2	11	797
DHS	USCIS	Section	2024-2025	2,755	288	1	7	280
DHS	USICE	Section	2024-2025	7,576	1,140	2	20	1,047
Total			2015-2025	158,713	40,511	338	176	40,495

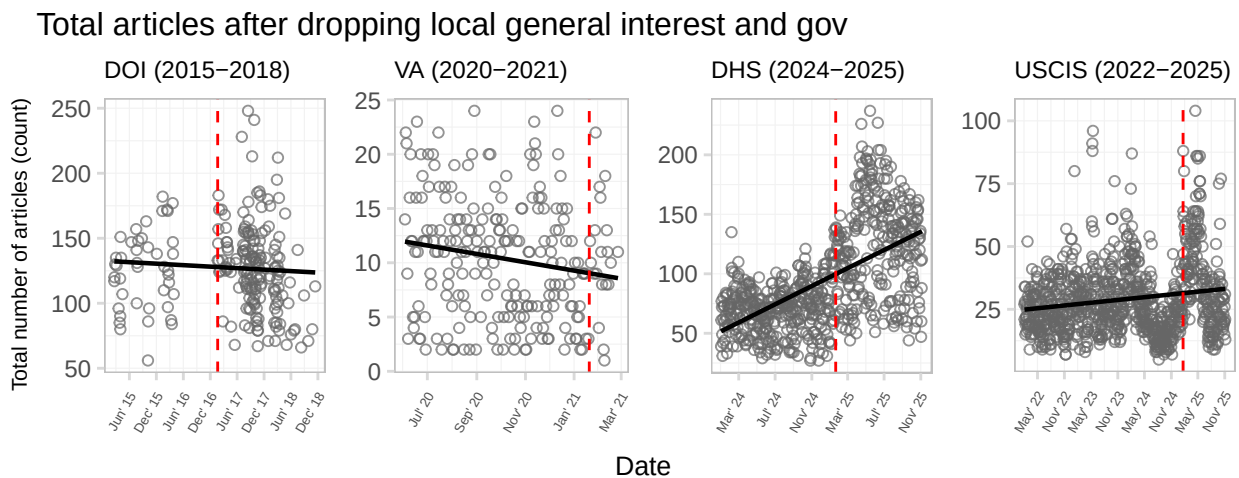


Figure A4: Number of articles cited in news briefings. Dropped local general interest source, government websites, and unidentified sources. Doted red line when a new president takes office.

³⁵Note that I usually collapsed the state and local categories. Unless explicitly stated otherwise, when I describe ‘local’ sources in the paper, I include both local and state sources.

A.2.4. Partisan Bias

Media Bias/Fact Check (MBFC)

According to the MBFC website³⁶, Media Bias/Fact Check (MBFC) was founded in 2015 to provide ratings of political bias, factual accuracy, and credibility for news sources. It uses paid and volunteer human coders to construct ratings.

To determine partisan slant, MBFC uses a weighted scoring system that evaluates four dimensions of political and journalistic orientation: economic ideology (35%), social liberalism vs. conservatism (35%), balance in straight news reporting (15%), and editorial bias (15%). Each media outlet is reviewed based on at least 10 headlines and 5 full articles, with manual analysis of framing, sourcing, tone, and omission. Scores on these dimensions are aggregated to position the source on a -10 to +10 political bias scale, which ranges from “Extreme Left” to “Extreme Right.”

To assess factual reliability, articles are scored independently across four dimensions: failed fact checks (40%), source transparency (25%), sourcing practices (25%), and one-sidedness or omission (10%). Reviewers draw on third-party fact-checking organizations, ownership disclosures, and sourcing depth to calculate a weighted score from 0 (very high factuality) to 10 (very low). A final “credibility rating” is then generated using a point-based system incorporating factuality, bias level, website traffic, longevity, and press freedom in the country of origin.

Table 6: Total articles from sources in partisan slant categories (MBFC). Excluded local general interest, other dropped articles and government websites.

Briefing	Agency	Total Articles	Left-lean	%	Center	%	Right-lean	%	Not Categorized	%
DOI	DOI	27,082	16,399	60.6	4,094	15.1	4,929	18.2	1,660	6.1
DOI	BLM	525	336	64.0	61	11.6	72	13.7	56	10.7
DOI	FWS	1,093	659	60.3	194	17.7	149	13.6	91	8.3
DOI	GS	323	171	52.9	71	22.0	42	13.0	39	12.1
DOI	NPS	1,505	1,027	68.2	179	11.9	185	12.3	114	7.6
DOI	BOR	93	42	45.2	25	26.9	6	6.5	20	21.5
DOI	BIA	232	120	51.7	76	32.8	12	5.2	24	10.3
VA	VA	2,386	623	26.1	852	35.7	211	8.8	700	29.3
USCIS	USCIS	26,773	10,870	40.6	5,085	19.0	9,263	34.6	1,555	5.8
USCIS	USCIS	26,773	10,870	40.6	5,085	19.0	9,263	34.6	1,555	5.8
DHS	DHS	61,446	31,625	51.5	9,299	15.1	18,237	29.7	2,285	3.7
DHS	CG	1,875	1,192	63.6	201	10.7	325	17.3	157	8.4
DHS	FEMA	5,243	3,989	76.1	548	10.5	609	11.6	97	1.9
DHS	SS	1,980	957	48.3	217	11.0	750	37.9	56	2.8
DHS	TSA	1,128	721	63.9	140	12.4	245	21.7	22	2.0
DHS	USCBP	3,664	1,474	40.2	366	10.0	1,282	35.0	542	14.8
DHS	USCIS	2,459	1,261	51.3	319	13.0	698	28.4	181	7.4
DHS	USICE	6,414	3,051	47.6	619	9.7	2,504	39.0	240	3.7
Total		117,687	59,517	50.6	19,330	16.4	32,640	27.7	6,200	5.3

³⁶See <https://mediabiasfactcheck.com/about/>.

Table 7: Total unique sources in partisan slant categories (MBFC). Excluded local general interest, other dropped articles and government websites.

Briefing	Agency	Total Sources	Left-lean	Center	Right-lean	Other	Not Categorized
DHS	DHS	763	263	109	172	0	219
DOI	DOI	1,032	319	135	139	0	439
USCIS	USCIS	455	147	46	75	0	187
VA	VA	396	74	43	41	0	238
DHS	CG	101	24	16	19	0	42
DHS	FEMA	85	44	10	14	0	17
DHS	SS	125	33	19	26	0	47
DHS	TSA	56	23	10	13	0	10
DHS	USCBP	77	29	11	18	0	19
DHS	USCIS	79	31	11	23	0	14
DHS	USICE	91	34	12	28	0	17
DOI	BIA	42	17	7	5	0	13
DOI	BLM	73	28	11	14	0	20
DOI	BOR	32	7	9	5	0	11
DOI	FWS	134	49	21	21	0	43
DOI	GS	80	34	13	8	0	25
DOI	NPS	144	53	20	21	0	50
USCIS	USCIS	455	147	46	75	0	187
Total		2,646	803	333	427	0	1,083

Relationship between partisan slant and credibility

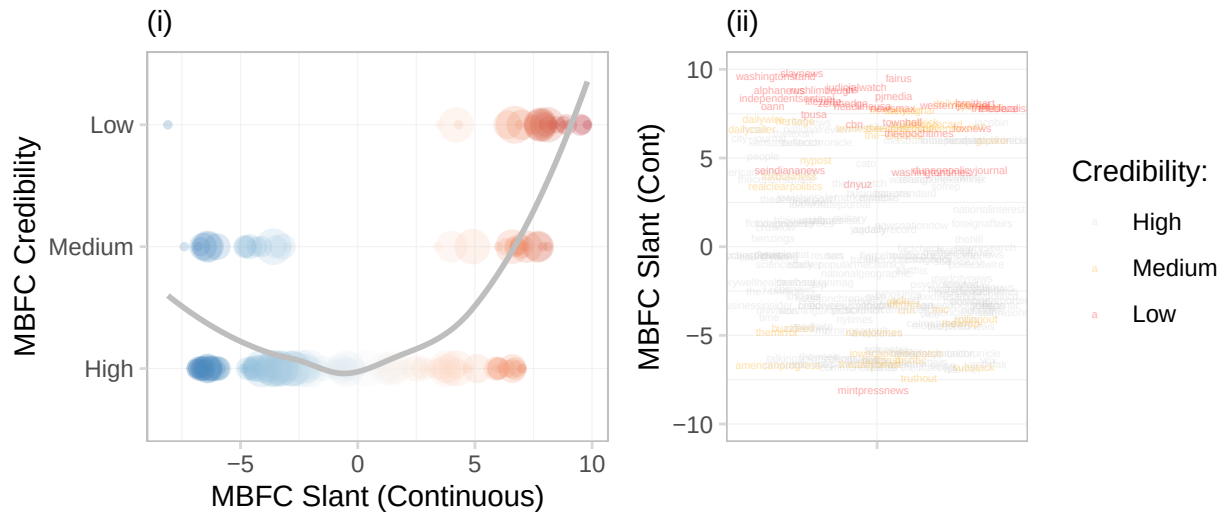


Figure A5: Comparison of MBFC credibility and partisan slant scores. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites. (i) Most low credibility sources are scored as extremely right-leaning. Center sources tend to be most credible. Points sized by the number of articles from the source in the briefings. (ii) Medium and Low credibility sources highlighted in orange and red. All sources arranged by slant (y-axis). Sources randomly arrayed on x-axis.

Distribution of partisan slant and source credibility in Briefings

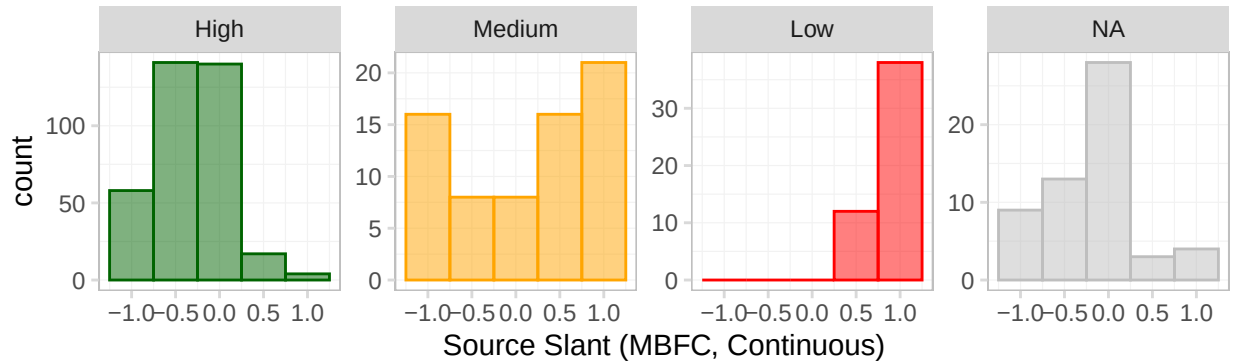


Figure A6: Distribution of source partisan slant and source credibility for articles in Briefings. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

On June 2, 2025, I downloaded MBFC scores using the MBFC API (<https://rapidapi.com/mbfcnews/api/media-bias-fact-check-ratings-api2>). However, I merged the API data with additional information because MBFC combines its scores for partisan slant and factual accuracy. For sources that have been deemed factually questionable, the partisan slant score is replaced by 'Questionable' in the API database. Thus, to obtain partisan slant scores for all sources, I also scraped the MBFC website using the MBFC page URLs provided by the API. I identified several places where partisan slant data could be found on the website (a table in the text and the filename of an image).

To construct a bias variable from these three sources of information (the API, website text, and website image filename), I first created flag variables for each category. I created a variable called `right`, which was 1 if the source was categorized as 'right' by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. I also created a variable called `left`, which would be 1 if the source was categorized as 'left' by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. Lastly, I created a variable called `center`, which would be 1 if the source was categorized as 'least biased' by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. I created a variable called `other`, which was equal to 1 if the source was categorized as a 'satire' by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. Lastly, I created a variable called `notrated`, which was 1 if the source was not categorized as right, left, center, or other (e.g. it was listed as "not rated", "na", "unrated", "pro-science", "pseudoscience", or "junk news"). `notrated` was also 1 if the source was listed as both right and left.

To construct a final partisan bias variable, I used the following rules to determine whether a source was categorized as left, right, center, other, or not categorized:

- Right-leaning: (`right`=1) and (`left`=0)
- Left-leaning: (`left`=1) and (`right`=0)
- Center: (`center`=1) and (`right`=`left`=0)
- Other: (`other`=1) and (`center`=`right`=`left`=0)
- Not Categorized: ((`notrated`=1) and (`other`=`center`=`right`=`left`=0)) OR (`right`=`left`=1)

Some webpages also provided the numeric score for partisan bias as well. However, most of them were missing the negative sign (-) if they were liberal. Thus, I recalculated the numeric scores by multiplying the number by -1 if the score was from a liberal-leaning website. These continuous scores are available for only part of the sample. They are only used in the Appendix as a robustness check and to determine source extremity.

In Tables 6 and 6, I report the total number of articles and sources in each MBFC partisan slant category. MBFC also scores source credibility. Figure A5 reveals the relationship between partisan slant extremity and credibility. Figure A6 shows the partisan distribution of articles in the briefings, broken down by source credibility.

Other Measures

To verify that my results replicate when using other measures of media bias, I use two other measures of partisan slant from Allsides and Guess (2021). Upon request, Allsides provided me with a dataset of its partisan slant scores in June 2025. The Guess (2021) scores can be found in the paper's replication files.

Both of these alternate sources provide measures for fewer sources that appear in the briefings. After dropping local general interest sources and government websites, MBFC provides scores for 529 sources found in the briefings. In comparison, Allsides has scores for 299 sources and Guess has scores for 77 sources.

Allsides sorts news outlets into the following categories: Right, Lean Right, Center, Mixed, Lean Left, and Left. Only one source cited in a briefing is labeled ‘Mixed,’ and its a local general interest news source. Guess (2021) scores the most common news sites based on the partisanship of each outlet’s audience. Each website is scored from -1 to 1.

To better compare these alternate measures with the MBFC results, I generated 4-category versions of them (Right-leaning, Center, Left-leaning, Not Categorized). For the Guess scores, I categorized a source as ‘Left-leaning’ if it had a score <0, ‘Right-leaning’ if it had a score >0, and ‘Center’ if it had a score of 0.

Table 8: Agreement between MBFC and Allsides Scores

Source Type	Total Sources	Total Agree	Percent Agreement
Excluded (local)	577	335	58.1
Included	250	190	76.0

Comparison of MBFC and Allsides partisan slant scores

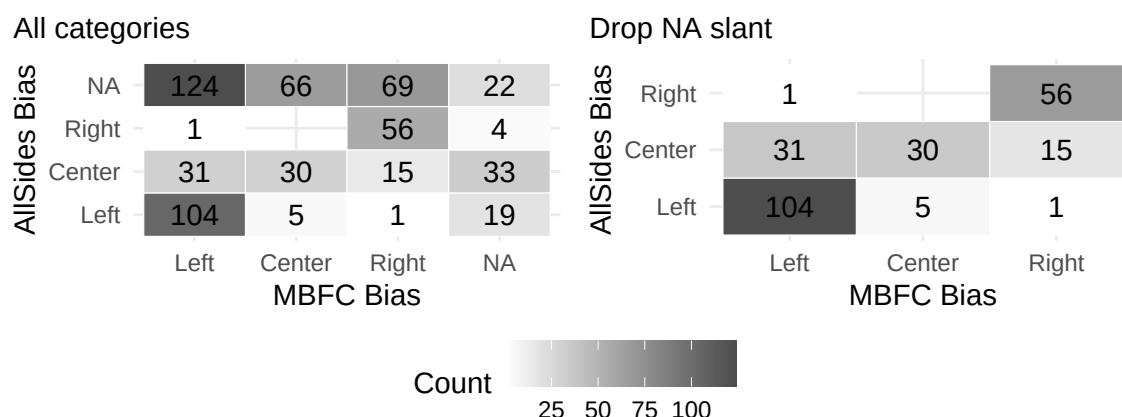


Figure A7: Comparison of MBFC and Allsides scores. Limited to sources cited in briefings and scored by either Allsides or MBFC. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

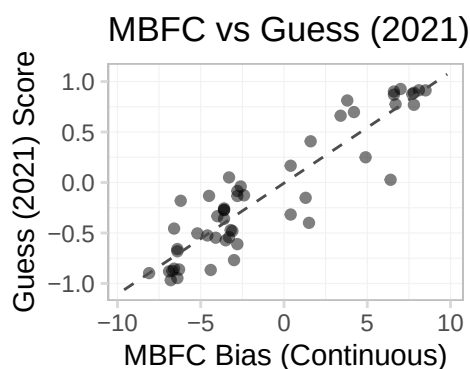


Figure A8: Comparison of MBFC and Guess (2021) scores. Limited to sources cited in briefings and scored by both Allsides and Guess (2021). Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

I compare the MBFC scores with less comprehensive sets of scores from Guess (2021) and Allsides. Unless stated

otherwise, I have removed any local general interest news sources and government websites. I also remove websites that are never cited in the briefings.

- In Table 8, I calculate the agreement between Allsides and MBFC. Of the sources cited at least once in the briefings, the two measures agree in most cases. However, the level of agreement is much higher after removing local general interest news sources. Figure A7 shows that the amount of disagreement is relatively even for right-leaning and left-leaning sources.
- Figure A8 shows that there is a strong correlation between the scores from MBFC and Guess (2021).
- Table 9 contains domains where the Allsides or Guess scores differ from MBFC. I also report the total number of articles in the 85 week Media Cloud sample (see Figure 3(ii)) from each domain.

Table 9: Domains of sources where alternate media slant category (Allsides, Guess) disagree with MBFC category. Excludes international sources, local general interest sources, and government websites. Totals (n) are the number of articles in the 85 week Media Cloud sample (see Figure 3(ii)) from each domain.

MBFC	Allsides	Guess (2021)	Domain	Total (n)
Center	Center	Left-leaning	c-span.org	151
Center	Center	Left-leaning	foreignpolicy.com	2,506
Center	Center	Not Categorized	adweek.com	347
Center	Center	Not Categorized	arstechnica.com	1,763
Center	Center	Not Categorized	bizjournals.com	4,744
Center	Center	Not Categorized	cnet.com	3,064
Center	Center	Not Categorized	constitutioncenter.org	40
Center	Center	Not Categorized	csmonitor.com	2,662
Center	Center	Not Categorized	defensenews.com	1,500
Center	Center	Not Categorized	defenseone.com	1,492
Center	Center	Not Categorized	floridapolitics.com	3,382
Center	Center	Not Categorized	forbes.com	15,776
Center	Center	Not Categorized	foreignaffairs.com	447
Center	Center	Not Categorized	knoxnews.com	1,434
Center	Center	Not Categorized	pewresearch.org	132
Center	Center	Not Categorized	qu.edu	7
Center	Center	Not Categorized	reuters.com	63,471
Center	Center	Not Categorized	rollcall.com	3,514
Center	Center	Not Categorized	scotusblog.com	553
Center	Center	Not Categorized	upi.com	9,326
Center	Center	Not Categorized	voanews.com	7,139
Center	Center	Right-leaning	militarytimes.com	2,123
Center	Center	Right-leaning	nationaljournal.com	444
Center	Center	Right-leaning	stripes.com	3,393
Center	Center	Right-leaning	thehill.com	14,128
Left-leaning	Center	Left-leaning	qz.com	2,058
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	bridgemi.com	118
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	brookings.edu	715
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	calmatters.org	246
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	coloradopolitics.com	180
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	edweek.org	938
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	houstonchronicle.com	943
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	ibtimes.com	8,453
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	insidephilanthropy.com	25
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	lawandcrime.com	1,299
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	mcclatchydc.com	684
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	michiganadvance.com	159
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	migrationpolicy.org	291
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	nevadacurrent.com	62
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	pilotonline.com	2,115
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	publicnewsservice.org	46
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	statnews.com	1,638
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	techerunch.com	1,267
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	thefulcrum.us	13
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	thewrap.com	903
Left-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	yahoo.com	69,867
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	aarp.org	549
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	coindesk.com	1,766
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	dailyyonder.com	35
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	eurekalert.org	4,685
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	indepthnh.org	24
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	livescience.com	884
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	nationalgeographic.com	599
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	oklahomawatch.org	69
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	pri.org	418
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	psychologytoday.com	59
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	saturdayeveningpost.com	112
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	sciencedaily.com	3,759
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	sevendaysvt.com	338
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	smithsonianmag.com	105
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	theappeal.org	51
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	virginiaabusiness.com	422
Not Categorized	Center	Not Categorized	wyomingnews.com	364
Right-leaning	Center	Left-leaning	newsweek.com	13,713

Table 9: Domains of sources where alternate media slant category (Allsides, Guess) disagree with MBFC category. Excludes international sources, local general interest sources, and government websites. Totals (n) are the number of articles in the 85 week Media Cloud sample (see Figure 3(ii)) from each domain. *(continued)*

MBFC	Allsides	Guess (2021)	Domain	Total (n)
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	barrons.com	2,385
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	fortune.com	4,222
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	idahostatejournal.com	63
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	jewishinsider.com	408
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	marketwatch.com	16,001
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	nationalinterest.org	7,644
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	oilprice.com	183
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	reason.com	3,596
Right-leaning	Center	Not Categorized	wsj.com	12,038
Center	Left-leaning	Left-leaning	latimes.com	28,294
Center	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	factcheck.org	1,047
Center	Left-leaning	Right-leaning	military.com	841
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	afp.com	35
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	americanprogress.org	784
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	apnews.com	8,116
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	apple.com	83
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	austinchronicle.com	39
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	axios.com	1,176
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	baptistnews.com	30
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	blackenterprise.com	794
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	bloomberg.com	6,073
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	bustle.com	648
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	buzzfeednews.com	1,434
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	capitalandmain.com	87
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	care2.com	72
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	edf.org	94
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	espn.com	358
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	esquire.com	264
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	fastcompany.com	701
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	gaycitynews.com	125
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	gizmodo.com	1,744
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	go.com	21,541
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	gq.com	151
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	grist.org	870
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	hollywoodreporter.com	507
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	huffpost.com	6,277
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	insidehighered.com	958
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	lgbtqnation.com	402
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	mashable.com	1,136
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	mediamatters.org	770
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	metroweekly.com	276
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	msnbc.com	2,553
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	nbcboston.com	1,850
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	pbs.org	5,251
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	people.com	1,220
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	pogo.org	125
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	propublica.org	1,788
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	prospect.org	1,374
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	rollingstone.com	1,198
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	scientificamerican.com	1,237
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	sierraclub.org	173
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	snopes.com	1,602
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	splcenter.org	172
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	teenvogue.com	157
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	thecity.nyc	65
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	theintercept.com	1,234
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	theverge.com	1,537
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	today.com	631
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	univision.com	120
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	usatoday.com	25,902
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	vanityfair.com	1,137
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	variety.com	608
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	vice.com	2,476
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	washingtonblade.com	1,418
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	washingtonmonthly.com	637
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	wired.com	2,148
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	yahoo.com	80,881
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	yale.edu	153
Left-leaning	Left-leaning	Right-leaning	cnbc.com	11,486
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	afro.com	738
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	chicagocrusader.com	583
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	hstoday.us	56
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	inquisitr.com	2,872
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	insider.com	1,416
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	insidemj.com	89
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	joemygod.com	660
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	marijuanamoment.net	941
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	marylandmatters.org	90
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	northcarolinahealthnews.org	164
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	telemundo.com	1
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	thedailyrecord.com	986
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	thinkprogress.org	3,319
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	truth-out.org	716
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	vogue.com	63
Not Categorized	Left-leaning	Not Categorized	washingtoninformer.com	538

Table 9: Domains of sources where alternate media slant category (Allsides, Guess) disagree with MBFC category. Excludes international sources, local general interest sources, and government websites. Totals (n) are the number of articles in the 85 week Media Cloud sample (see Figure 3(ii)) from each domain. *(continued)*

MBFC	Allsides	Guess (2021)	Domain	Total (n)
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	airforcetimes.com	1,151
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	atlasobscura.com	50
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	benzinga.com	30,686
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	bighink.com	324
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	bleepingcomputer.com	33
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	caranddriver.com	22
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	constructiondive.com	76
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	consumerreports.org	147
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	countryliving.com	3
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	courthousenews.com	543
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	crainscleveland.com	498
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	crainsdetroit.com	118
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	cruxnow.com	176
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	cyberscoop.com	163
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	edscoop.com	9
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	federalnewsnetwork.com	9,481
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	federaltimes.com	136
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	fedcoop.com	1,051
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	fiercehealthcare.com	366
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	geekwire.com	310
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	healthcarelive.com	55
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	healthcarefinancenews.com	23
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	inc.com	357
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	industryweek.com	17
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	jaxdailyrecord.com	193
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	jdsupra.com	238
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	law.com	843
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	law360.com	22
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	medcitynews.com	277
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	modernhealthcare.com	737
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	natlawreview.com	581
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	nextgov.com	387
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	politicalwire.com	2,697
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	spglobal.com	182
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	statescoop.com	321
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thediplomat.com	917
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thefencepost.com	1,068
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thesmokinggun.com	6
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	utilitydive.com	235
Center	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	wearthemighty.com	129
Center	Not Categorized	Right-leaning	armytimes.com	1,318
Center	Not Categorized	Right-leaning	navytimes.com	1,188
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Left-leaning	buzzfeed.com	1,696
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Left-leaning	talkingpointsmemo.com	2,115
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	aldianews.com	328
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	americanimmigrationcouncil.org	26
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	americasvoice.org	299
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	amsterdamnews.com	239
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	aol.com	5,999
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	businessinsider.com	14,439
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	cheddar.com	30
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	cleantechnica.com	196
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	clevescene.com	197
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	colorlines.com	130
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	ebar.com	213
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	ecowatch.com	1,456
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	eenews.net	1,633
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	eldiariony.com	100
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	engadget.com	648
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	filtermag.org	26
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	fivethirtyeight.com	348
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	gawker.com	1,063
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	glamour.com	43
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	governing.com	232
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	govexec.com	1,002
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	harpersbazaar.com	10
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	historynewsnetwork.org	44
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	inquirer.net	10,611
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	insideclimatenews.org	248
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	inthesetimes.com	351
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	latintimes.com	6
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	madinamerica.com	8
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	mensjournal.com	31
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	mic.com	960
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	mintpressnews.com	578
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	mongabay.com	277
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	morningconsult.com	339
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	navajotimes.com	293
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	ncronline.org	412
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	newser.com	1,601
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	nextshark.com	54
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	norml.org	26
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	occrp.org	32
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	onegreenplanet.org	15
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	opednews.com	1,750

Table 9: Domains of sources where alternate media slant category (Allsides, Guess) disagree with MBFC category. Excludes international sources, local general interest sources, and government websites. Totals (n) are the number of articles in the 85 week Media Cloud sample (see Figure 3(ii)) from each domain. *(continued)*

MBFC	Allsides	Guess (2021)	Domain	Total (n)
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	outsideonline.com	234
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	pastemagazine.com	69
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	peoplesworld.org	100
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	progressive.org	383
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	republicreport.org	69
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	revealnews.org	192
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	rollingout.com	162
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	self.com	229
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	si.com	208
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	substack.com	42
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	taskandpurpose.com	1,344
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	the-scientist.com	80
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	the74million.org	599
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thebulletin.org	90
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thecut.com	258
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	themarysue.com	26
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thenewhumanitarian.org	46
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thenextweb.com	224
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	truthout.org	2,242
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	vibe.com	56
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	villagevoice.com	101
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	wilderness.org	33
Left-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	workers.org	35
Not Categorized	Not Categorized	Left-leaning	huffingtonpost.com	12,972
Not Categorized	Not Categorized	Right-leaning	marinecorpstimes.com	1,033
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	amac.us	34
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	americanmilitarynews.com	3,776
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	ammoland.com	155
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	arcamax.com	3
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	breakingdefense.com	1,136
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	business-standard.com	15,688
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	childrenshealthdefense.org	502
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	cis.org	1,057
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	dupagepolicyjournal.com	307
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	fairus.org	121
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	financialexpress.com	4,170
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	independentsentinel.com	1,175
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	insidesources.com	230
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	iwf.org	23
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	jewishjournal.com	318
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	lawenforcementtoday.com	262
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	lifezette.com	1,437
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	meaww.com	46
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	mrcvtv.org	546
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	osvnews.com	6
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	rare.us	2,011
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	ricochet.com	104
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	rushlimbaugh.com	214
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	sofrep.com	54
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	texasscorecard.com	18
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thedefensepost.com	63
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thenationalherald.com	816
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	thetstreet.com	15,210
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	toddstarnes.com	21
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	wabradio.com	450
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	westernjournal.com	4,484
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	worldtribune.com	803
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Not Categorized	yellowhammernews.com	1,464
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Right-leaning	lifeneews.com	816
Right-leaning	Not Categorized	Right-leaning	thenewamerican.com	1,911
Left-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	penncapital-star.com	83
Not Categorized	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	riponadvance.com	22
Not Categorized	Right-leaning	Right-leaning	cnsnews.com	1,109
Not Categorized	Right-leaning	Right-leaning	weeklystandard.com	520
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	cato.org	594
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	cbn.com	799
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	christianpost.com	989
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	city-journal.org	379
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	dailysignal.com	3,695
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	dailywire.com	2,761
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	focusonthefamily.com	20
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	foxbusiness.com	3,299
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	heritage.org	1,427
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	hotair.com	2,310
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	ijr.com	2,791
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	investors.com	961
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	judicialwatch.org	907
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	justthenews.com	334
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	oann.com	2,349
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	spectator.org	955
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	the-sun.com	1,523
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	theamericanconservative.com	750
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	thecentersquare.com	3,785
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	theepochtimes.com	11,351
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	thefederalist.com	1,919

Table 9: Domains of sources where alternate media slant category (Allsides, Guess) disagree with MBFC category. Excludes international sources, local general interest sources, and government websites. Totals (n) are the number of articles in the 85 week Media Cloud sample (see Figure 3(ii)) from each domain. *(continued)*

MBFC	Allsides	Guess (2021)	Domain	Total (n)
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	thefiscaltimes.com	609
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	thelibertarianrepublic.com	87
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	thetexan.news	77
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	tpusa.com	5
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	wng.org	111
Right-leaning	Right-leaning	Not Categorized	zerohedge.com	5,451

A.2.5. News Supply

Media Cloud

To collect news articles through Media Cloud, I queried the Media Cloud API using the `mediacloud` Python package for articles from US news sources that mention each agency name. I then dropped any sources that never appear in the news briefings. I collected all of the news coverage mentioning each agency name (see Appendix A.5.2 for the agency name queries). In May and June 2025, I queried the US media collections on Media Cloud.³⁷ I then excluded all domains that were not included at least once in the news briefing. I also excluded all general interest local sources, government websites, and international sources.

I collected two different sets of data from Media Cloud. First, I collected coverage for all agencies categorized in Richardson, Clinton, and Lewis (2018) (n=165) during 83 randomly sampled weeks from January 2015 through May 2025. I queried Media Cloud multiple times over May and June 2025. I randomly selected 4 weeks every 6 months from January 2015 through May 15, 2025. I also randomly selected another week from April (the week starting April 20, 2025). Removing the added week in April does not affect the results.

Second, I collected all of the media motioning the agencies and during the corresponding time periods where I had briefing data. For this second set of Media Cloud data, I then matched the URLs from Media Cloud to the briefings and excluded sources with no matches (see Appendix A.5 for more details about matching).

GDELT

I also collected articles from the GDELT Project (<https://www.gdeltproject.org/>). I searched the GDELT V2 API for English-language articles from the US and used same agency name queries. In total, I collected data from GDELT for 17 randomly sampled weeks between January 2017 through May 2025. I used Media Cloud as my primary dataset due to better transparency from the database creators and it's availability before 2017. GDELT also does not report the publication date of each article. When I compared the 17 weeks of data from GDELT to the Media Cloud results, I also found more URLs available in the Media Cloud results.

Queries

Table 10 contains the keyword phrases that were used to construct Media Cloud and GDELT API queries. It is possible that the false negative rate is higher for agencies with longer names (due to journalists shortening the agency name, omitting the name, typos, etc.). There is some research suggesting that extreme news sources use simpler language (Sparks and Hmielowski 2023), which could lead them to use less formal versions of agency names. Thus, I tested whether the length of an agency name was correlated with ideology (see Figure A9).

³⁷Specifically, I queried the following collections: US National (n=248), US Most Visited New Online (Mar 2025), U.S. Top Sources 2018 (n=87), Tweeted Mostly by Democrat Voters 2018 (n=196), Tweeted Somewhat More by Democrat Voters 2018 (n=378), Tweeted Evenly by Republican/Democrat Voters 2018 (n=526), Tweeted Somewhat More by Republican Voters 2018 (n=254), Tweeted Somewhat More by Republican Voters 2018 (n=254), Tweeted Somewhat More by Republican Voters 2018 (n=254), Tweeted Mostly by Followers of Conservative Politicians 2019 (US Right 2019) (n=2,728), Tweeted Evenly by Followers of Conservative & Liberal Politicians 2019 (US Center 2019) (n=2,198), Tweeted Mostly by Followers of Liberal Politicians 2019 (US Left 2019) (n=4,027), and Tweeted Somewhat More by Followers of Conservative Politicians 2019 (US Center Right 2019) (n=1,663).

Correlation between Agency Ideology and Query

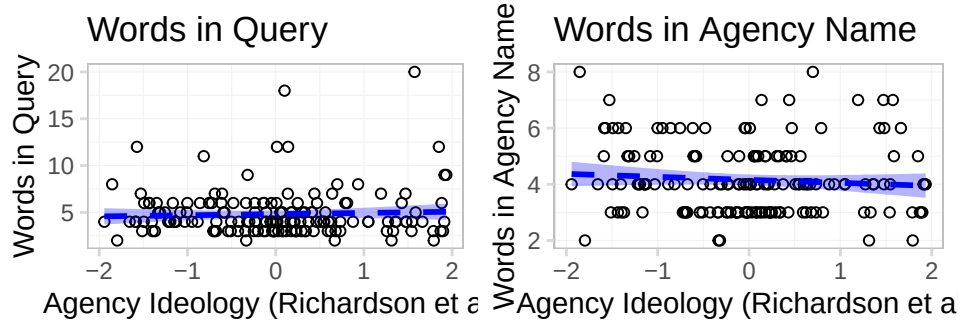


Figure A9: Robustness check: Does the length of an agency's name correlate with agency ideology?

Table 10: Keyword phrases used for Media Cloud and GDELT API queries

	Abb	Agency	Query
1	ACF	Administration for Children and Families	"Administration for Children and Families"
2	ACUS	Administrative Conference of the United States	"Administrative Conference of the United States"
3	AMS	Agricultural Marketing Service	"Agricultural Marketing Service"
4	ARS	Agricultural Research Service	"Agricultural Research Service"
5	APHIS	Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service	"Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service"
6	ACIS	Arms Control and International Security	"Arms Control and International Security"
7	BBG	Broadcasting Board of Governors	"Broadcasting Board of Governors"
8	ATF	Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives	("Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms and Explosives" OR "Bureau of Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms" OR "Bureau of Alcohol* Tobacco* and Firearms")
9	BCA	Bureau of Consular Affairs	"Bureau of Consular Affairs"
10	BDP	Bureau of Diplomatic Security	"Bureau of Diplomatic Security"
11	BEA	Bureau of Economic Analysis	"Bureau of Economic Analysis"
12	BIA	Bureau of Indian Affairs	"Bureau of Indian Affairs"
13	BINLEA	Bureau of International Narcotics and Law Enforcement Affairs	"Bureau of International Narcotics and Law Enforcement Affairs"
14	BLS	Bureau of Labor Statistics	"Bureau of Labor Statistics"
15	BLM	Bureau of Land Management	"Bureau of Land Management"
16	BOP	Bureau of Prisons	"Bureau of Prisons"
17	BOR	Bureau of Reclamation	"Bureau of Reclamation"
18	BFS	Bureau of the Fiscal Service	"Bureau of the Fiscal Service"
19	CDC	Centers for Disease Control and Prevention	"Centers for Disease Control and Prevention"
20	CMMS	Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services	"Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services"
21	CIA	Central Intelligence Agency	"Central Intelligence Agency"
22	CSDHR	Civilian Security, Democracy, and Human Rights	"Civilian Security, Democracy, and Human Rights"
23	CG	Coast Guard	"Coast Guard"
24	CFTC	Commodity Futures Trading Commission	"Commodity Futures Trading Commission"
25	CFPB	Consumer Financial Protection Bureau	"Consumer Financial Protection Bureau"
26	CPSC	Consumer Product Safety Commission	"Consumer Product Safety Commission"
27	CNCS	Corporation for National and Community Service	"Corporation for National and Community Service"
28	CEA	Council of Economic Advisers	"Council of Economic Advisers"
29	CEQ	Council on Environmental Quality	"Council on Environmental Quality"
30	DARPA	Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency	"Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency"
31	DCA	Defense Commissary Agency	"Defense Commissary Agency"
32	DCAA	Defense Contract Audit Agency	"Defense Contract Audit Agency"
33	DCMA	Defense Contract Management Agency	"Defense Contract Management Agency"
34	DFAS	Defense Finance and Accounting Service	"Defense Finance and Accounting Service"
35	DHA	Defense Health Agency	"Defense Health Agency"
36	USDA	Department of Agriculture	("Department of Agriculture" OR "Agriculture Department")
37	DOC	Department of Commerce	("Department of Commerce" OR "Commerce Department")
38	DOD	Department of Defense	("Department of Defense" OR "Defense Department")
39	EDUC	Department of Education	("Department of Education" OR "Education Department")
40	DOE	Department of Energy	("Department of Energy" OR "Energy Department")
41	HHS	Department of Health and Human Services	("Department of Health and Human Services" OR "Health and Human Services Department")
42	DHS	Department of Homeland Security	("Department of Homeland Security" OR "Homeland Security Department")
43	HUD	Department of Housing and Urban Development	"Housing and Urban Development"
44	DOJ	Department of Justice	("Department of Justice" OR "Justice Department")
45	DOL	Department of Labor	("Department of Labor" OR "Labor Department")

Table 10: Keyword phrases used for Media Cloud and GDELT API queries (*continued*)

	Abb	Agency	Query
46	DOS	Department of State	("Department of State" OR "State Department")
47	DOT	Department of Transportation	("Department of Transportation" OR "Transportation Department")
48	VA_LONG	Department of Veterans Affairs	("Department of Veterans Affairs" OR "Veterans Affairs Department")
49	VA	Department of Veterans Affairs	"Veterans Affairs"
50	AF	Department of the Air Force	("U.S. Air Force" OR "US Air Force" OR "United States Air Force")
51	ARMY	Department of the Army	("U.S. Army" OR "US Army" OR "United States Army")
52	DOI	Department of the Interior	("Department of the Interior" OR "Department of Interior" OR "Interior Department")
53	NAVY	Department of the Navy	("U.S. Navy" OR "US Navy" OR "United States Navy")
54	TREAS	Department of the Treasury	("Department of the Treasury" OR "Treasury Department")
55	DEA	Drug Enforcement Administration	"Drug Enforcement Administration"
56	EGEE	Economic Growth, Energy, and the Environment	"Economic Growth, Energy, and the Environment"
57	ETA	Employment and Training Administration	"Employment and Training Administration"
58	EIA	Energy Information Administration	"Energy Information Administration"
59	EPA	Environmental Protection Agency	"Environmental Protection Agency"
60	EEOC	Equal Employment Opportunity Commission	"Equal Employment Opportunity Commission"
61	EOUSA	Executive Office for United States Attorneys	"Executive Office for United States Attorneys"
62	EIBUS	Export-Import Bank of the U.S.	("Export*Import Bank of the U.S." OR "Export*Import Bank of the US" OR "Export*Import Bank of the United States")
63	FCA	Farm Credit Administration	"Farm Credit Administration"
64	FSA	Farm Service Agency	"Farm Service Agency"
65	FAA	Federal Aviation Administration	"Federal Aviation Administration"
66	FBI	Federal Bureau of Investigation	"Federal Bureau of Investigation"
67	FCC	Federal Communications Commission	"Federal Communications Commission"
68	FDIC	Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation	"Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation"
69	FEC	Federal Election Commission	"Federal Election Commission"
70	FEMA	Federal Emergency Management Agency	"Federal Emergency Management Agency"
71	FERC	Federal Energy Regulatory Commission	"Federal Energy Regulatory Commission"
72	FHIA	Federal Highway Administration	"Federal Highway Administration"
73	FHLMC	Federal Home Loan Mortgage Corporation	"Federal Home Loan Mortgage Corporation"
74	FHA	Federal Housing Administration	"Federal Housing Administration"
75	FHFA	Federal Housing Finance Agency	"Federal Housing Finance Agency"
76	FLRA	Federal Labor Relations Authority	"Federal Labor Relations Authority"
77	FMC	Federal Maritime Commission	"Federal Maritime Commission"
78	FMCS	Federal Mediation and Conciliation Service	"Federal Mediation and Conciliation Service"
79	FMCSA	Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration	"Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration"
80	FNMA	Federal National Mortgage Association	"Federal National Mortgage Association"
81	FTC	Federal Trade Commission	"Federal Trade Commission"
82	FTA	Federal Transit Administration	"Federal Transit Administration"
83	FINCEN	Financial Crimes Enforcement Network	"Financial Crimes Enforcement Network"
84	FSIS	Food Safety and Inspection Service	"Food Safety and Inspection Service"
85	FDA	Food and Drug Administration	"Food and Drug Administration"
86	FNS_AG	Food and Nutrition Service	"Food and Nutrition Service" AND ("Department of Agriculture" OR "Agriculture Department")
87	FNS	Food and Nutrition Service	"Food and Nutrition Service"
88	FS	Forest Service	"Forest Service"
89	GSA	General Services Administration	"General Services Administration"
90	GNMA	Government National Mortgage Association	"Government National Mortgage Association"
91	HRSA	Health Resources and Services Administration	"Health Resources and Services Administration"
92	HIS	Indian Health Service	"Indian Health Service"
93	IES	Institute of Education Sciences	"Institute of Education Sciences"
94	IRS	Internal Revenue Service	"Internal Revenue Service"
95	ITA	International Trade Administration	"International Trade Administration"
96	JCS	Joint Chiefs of Staff	"Joint Chiefs of Staff"
97	LSC	Legal Services Corporation	"Legal Services Corporation"
98	MSPB	Merit Systems Protection Board	"Merit Systems Protection Board"
99	MCC	Millennium Challenge Corporation	"Millennium Challenge Corporation"
100	MSHA	Mine Safety and Health Administration	"Mine Safety and Health Administration"
101	MDA	Missile Defense Agency	"Missile Defense Agency"
102	NASA	National Aeronautics and Space Administration	"National Aeronautics and Space Administration"
103	NASS	National Agricultural Statistics Service	"National Agricultural Statistics Service"
104	NARA	National Archives and Records Administration	"National Archives and Records Administration"
105	NCA	National Cemetery Administration	"National Cemetery Administration"
106	NCUA	National Credit Union Administration	"National Credit Union Administration"
107	NFAH	National Foundation on the Arts and the Humanities	"National Foundation on the Arts and the Humanities"
108	NGB	National Guard Bureau	"National Guard Bureau"
109	NHTSA	National Highway Traffic Safety Administration	"National Highway Traffic Safety Administration"
110	NIST	National Institute of Standards and Technology	"National Institute of Standards and Technology"
111	NIH	National Institutes of Health	"National Institutes of Health"

Table 10: Keyword phrases used for Media Cloud and GDELT API queries (*continued*)

	Abb	Agency	Query
112	NLRB	National Labor Relations Board	"National Labor Relations Board"
113	NNSA	National Nuclear Security Administration	"National Nuclear Security Administration"
114	NOAA	National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration	"National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration"
115	NPS	National Park Service	"National Park Service"
116	AMTRAK	National Railroad Passenger Corporation (AMTRAK)	("National Railroad Passenger Corporation" OR "AMTRAK")
117	NSF	National Science Foundation	"National Science Foundation"
118	NSS	National Security Staff	"National Security Staff"
119	NTSB	National Transportation Safety Board	"National Transportation Safety Board"
120	NRCS	Natural Resources Conservation Service	"Natural Resources Conservation Service"
121	NRC	Nuclear Regulatory Commission	"Nuclear Regulatory Commission"
122	OSHA	Occupational Safety and Health Administration	"Occupational Safety and Health Administration"
123	OEDER	Office of Electricity Delivery and Energy Reliability	"Office of Electricity Delivery and Energy Reliability"
124	OESE	Office of Elementary and Secondary Education	"Office of Elementary and Secondary Education"
125	OEERE	Office of Energy Efficiency and Renewable Energy	"Office of Energy Efficiency and Renewable Energy"
126	OEM	Office of Environmental Management	"Office of Environmental Management"
127	OFSA	Office of Federal Student Aid	"Office of Federal Student Aid"
128	OFE	Office of Fossil Energy	"Office of Fossil Energy"
129	OGE	Office of Government Ethics	"Office of Government Ethics"
130	OLC	Office of Legal Counsel	"Office of Legal Counsel"
131	OMB	Office of Management and Budget	"Office of Management and Budget"
132	ONDCP	Office of National Drug Control Policy	"Office of National Drug Control Policy"
133	ONE	Office of Nuclear Energy	"Office of Nuclear Energy"
134	OPM	Office of Personnel Management	"Office of Personnel Management"
135	OPE	Office of Postsecondary Education	"Office of Postsecondary Education"
136	OS	Office of Science	"Office of Science"
137	OSTP	Office of Science and Technology Policy	"Office of Science and Technology Policy"
138	OSC	Office of Special Counsel	"Office of Special Counsel"
139	OCC	Office of the Comptroller of the Currency	"Office of the Comptroller of the Currency"
140	DNI	Office of the Director of National Intelligence	"Office of the Director of National Intelligence"
141	OSD	Office of the Secretary of Defense	"Office of the Secretary of Defense"
142	USTR	Office of the United States Trade Representative	"Office of the United States Trade Representative"
143	OPIC	Overseas Private Investment Corporation	"Overseas Private Investment Corporation"
144	PC	Peace Corps	"Peace Corps"
145	PA	Political Affairs	"Political Affairs" AND ("Department of State" OR "State Department")
146	PDPA	Public Diplomacy and Public Affairs	"Public Diplomacy and Public Affairs"
147	RHS	Rural Housing Service	"Rural Housing Service"
148	SS	Secret Service	"Secret Service"
149	SEC	Securities and Exchange Commission	"Securities and Exchange Commission"
150	SBA	Small Business Administration	"Small Business Administration"
151	SSA	Social Security Administration	"Social Security Administration"
152	TVA	Tennessee Valley Authority	"Tennessee Valley Authority"
153	FED	The Federal Reserve	("The Federal Reserve" OR "Federal Reserve")
154	TSA	Transportation Security Administration	"Transportation Security Administration"
155	USB	U.S. Census Bureau	("U.S. Census Bureau" OR "US Census Bureau" OR "United States Census Bureau")
156	FWS	U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service	"Fish and Wildlife Service"
157	GS	U.S. Geological Survey	("US Geological Survey" OR "U.S. Geological Survey")
158	USPTO	U.S. Patent and Trademark Office	"Patent and Trademark Office"
159	USAID	United States Agency for International Development	"Agency for International Development"
160	USCIS	United States Citizenship and Immigration Services	"Citizenship and Immigration Services"
161	USCBP	United States Customs and Border Protection	"Customs and Border Protection"
162	USICE	United States Immigration and Customs Enforcement	"Immigration and Customs Enforcement"
163	USITC	United States International Trade Commission	"United States International Trade Commission"
164	USPS	United States Postal Service	("United States Postal Service" OR "US Postal Service" OR "U.S. Postal Service")
165	VBA	Veterans Benefits Administration	"Veterans Benefits Administration"
166	VHA	Veterans Health Administration	"Veterans Health Administration"
167	WHD	Wage and Hour Division	"Wage and Hour Division"

A.2.6. Agency Ideology Scores

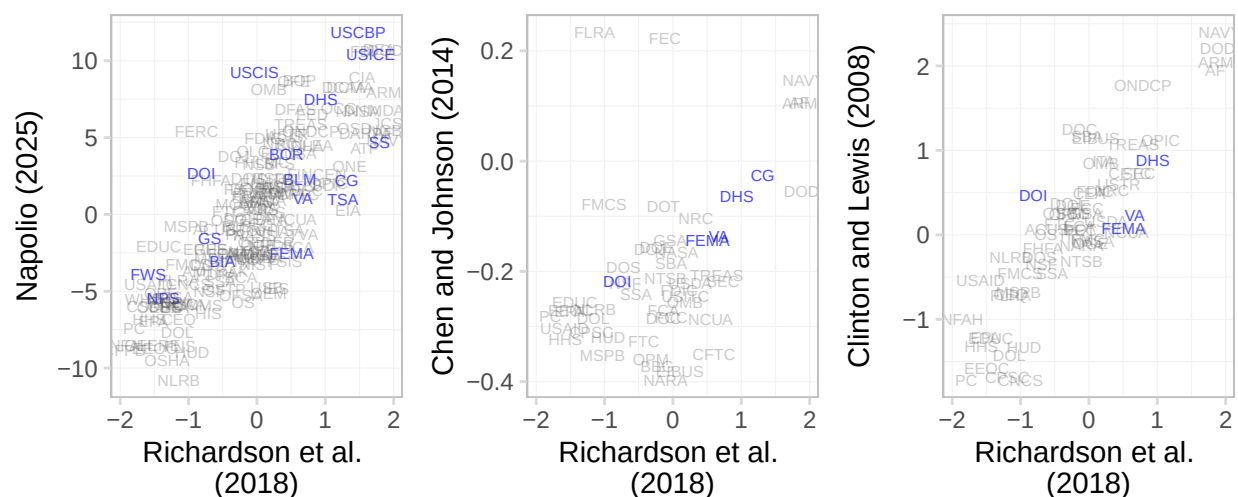


Figure A10: Comparing measures of agency ideology. Chen and Johnson (2014) estimates are from the Obama administration.

For the results in the main paper, I use agency ideology scores from Richardson et al's (2018). Richardson et al's (2018) scores were used because they are available for the most agencies. One other agency ideology measure is available for more than five agencies in my sample (Napolio 2025), but its use of a large language model partially trained on news media raises concerns about reverse causality. Nevertheless, I replicate my results using the Napolio (2025) scores. Additionally, when replicating the results for Figure 3(ii), I also tested two additional alternative measures of agency ideology (Chen and Johnson 2015; Clinton and Lewis 2008). Like Richardson, Clinton, and Lewis (2018), Clinton and Lewis (2008) use expert assessments to construct their scores whereas Chen and Johnson (2015) use the political donations of federal employees. In Figure A10, I compare all four measures of agency ideology.

Table 11: Best fit line in Right-leaning subplot of Figure 2 (aggregated data)

	DV: Proportion of Articles from Conservative Sources					
	MBFC	MBFC, keep NA	Allsides	Allsides, keep NA	Guess	Guess, keep NA
(Intercept)	0.200 (0.024)	0.184 (0.023)	0.162 (0.021)	0.143 (0.021)	0.354 (0.031)	0.170 (0.023)
Agency Ideology	0.062 (0.018)	0.059 (0.017)	0.055 (0.016)	0.056 (0.017)	0.083 (0.020)	0.063 (0.016)
Num.Obs.	17	17	17	17	17	17
R2	0.302	0.293	0.312	0.319	0.363	0.359
R2 Adj.	0.256	0.246	0.266	0.274	0.320	0.316

Note: Models use OLS with robust standard errors (HC1). Data aggregated by agency and media slant.
Dependent variable ranges from 0 to 1.

Table 12: Best fit line in Figure 1 (aggregated data) - Robustness checks, Continuous bias specifications

	DV: Average continuous partisan bias score	
	MBFC (Continuous)	Guess (Continuous)
(Intercept)	0.461 (0.010)	0.496 (0.018)
Agency Ideology	0.025 (0.008)	0.058 (0.012)
Num.Obs.	17	17
R2	0.290	0.453
R2 Adj.	0.242	0.417

Note: Models use OLS with robust standard errors (HC1). Data aggregated to the agency-media slant level. Articles missing slant scores dropped from analysis. Both MBFC and Guess continuous measures of ideology are rescaled from 0 to 1 before being aggregated.

A.3. Figure 1 - Association between sources in briefings and partisan slant

A.3.1. Regression Tables for Fig 1

The ‘MBFC’ column of Table 11 contains the regression used for the slope estimates for the right-leaning subplot in Figure 1. I also recalculate the slope after adding back the Not Categorized sources and coding them as not right-leaning. The results with missing slant coded as 0 are labelled ‘Keep NA’ in the regression tables.

In Tables 11, 12, and 13, I recalculate the slope of the right-leaning subplot in Figure 1 using various alternative measures of partisan slant and agency ideology.

- In Table 11, I test alternative media slant categorical measures from Allsides and Guess (2021). When the MBFC scores are replaced with scores from Allsides, the coefficient is slightly smaller. When the MBFC scores are replaced with scores from Guess (2021), the coefficient is substantially larger.
- In Table 12, I test continuous measures of partisan slant from MBFC and Guess (2021). Each measure is scaled to range between 0 and 1.
- In Table 13, I recalculate the slope of the right-leaning subplot in Figure 1 using alternative measures of right-leaning partisan slant and an alternative measure of agency ideology from Napolio (2025).

In Table 14, I recalculate the coefficient using disaggregated data, where each article-agency pair is a separate observation. To account for clustering, I cluster my standard errors by news source, agency, and article ID. Article ID is the unique number assigned to each citation in the briefing. Articles can be included multiple times if they are included in a subsection dedicated to a subagency. For example, an article in the TSA section of the DHS news briefing would be included once for the TSA and once for DHS.

A.3.2. Robustness Checks for Fig 1

Figure A11 replicates Figure 1 after including articles with missing partisan slant scores. Missing scores are treated as a fourth partisan slant category.

Table 13: Best fit line in Right-leaning subplot of Figure 2 (aggregated data)

	DV: Proportion of Articles from Conservative Sources					
	MBFC	MBFC	Allsides	Allsides	Guess	Guess
Scaled Agency Ideology (Richardson et al)	0.210 (0.062)		0.185 (0.056)		0.282 (0.069)	
Scaled Agency Ideology (Napolio)		0.324 (0.038)		0.259 (0.042)		0.326 (0.057)
Num.Obs.	17	17	17	17	17	17
R2	0.302	0.703	0.312	0.595	0.363	0.473
R2 Adj.	0.256	0.683	0.266	0.568	0.320	0.438

Note: Models use OLS with robust standard errors (HC1). Data aggregated by agency and media slant. IVs rescaled from 0 to 1. Dependent variable is proportion of articles in an agency's briefing from right-leaning sources, ranges from 0 to 1. Articles missing partisan slant dropped from all specifications

Table 14: Best fit line in Figure 1 (disaggregated data)

	DV: 1 if article is from right-leaning source, 0 otherwise	
	MBFC	MBFC, keep NA
Agency Ideology	0.052 (0.012)	0.051 (0.012)
Num.Obs.	136382	144221
R2	0.009	0.009
R2 Adj.	0.009	0.009
Std.Errors	by: Source & Agency & ID	by: Source & Agency & ID

Note: Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors. Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (ID). Slant scores are based on MBFC categories. Dependent variable is 1 if an articles comes from a right-leaning sources and 0 otherwise. Weights are calculated using the agency ideology SD values reported by Richardson et al (2018). Weights are the inverse of the Richardson et al (2018) SD estimates squared.

The results in Figure 1 are also robust to different categorical media slant measures and different agency ideology measures. Figure A12 replicates Figure 1 with alternate missing partisan slant measures. Figure A13 replicates Figure 1 with alternate missing agency ideology measures.

Partisan Composition of News Briefings (MBFC)

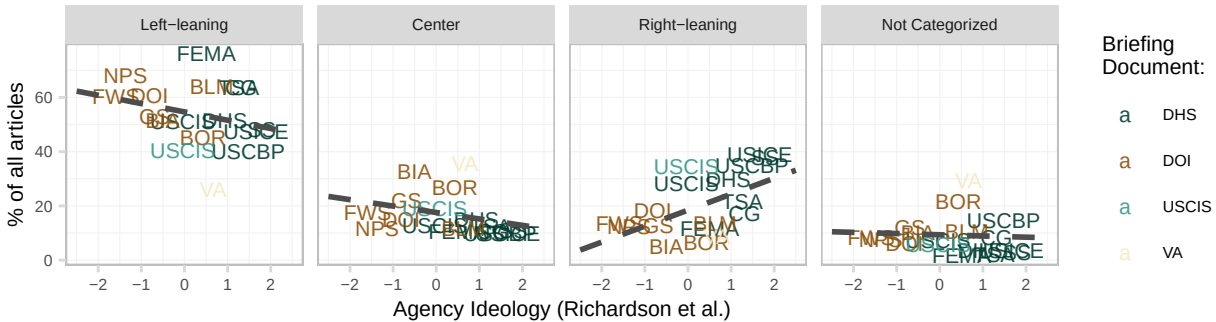
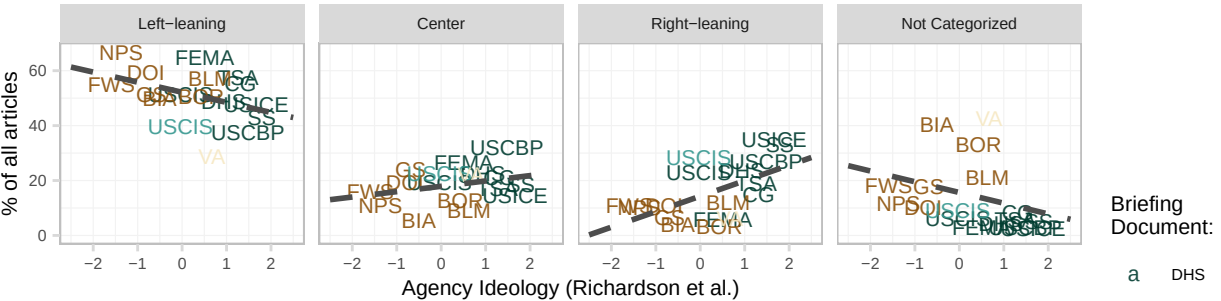


Figure A11: Replication of Figure 2 when articles missing partisan slant are included.

Figure 1 replicates with other partisan slant measures

Partisan Composition of News Briefings (Allsides)



Partisan Composition of News Briefings (Guess)

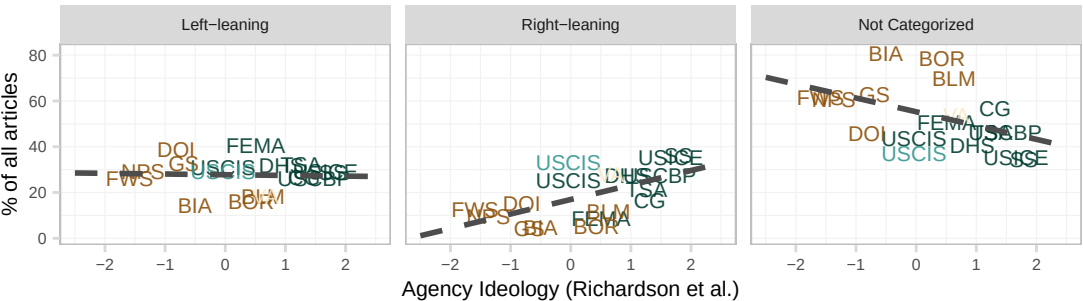
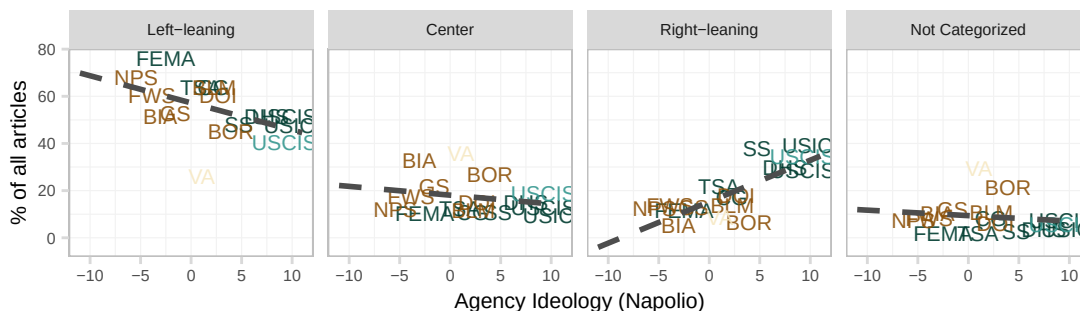


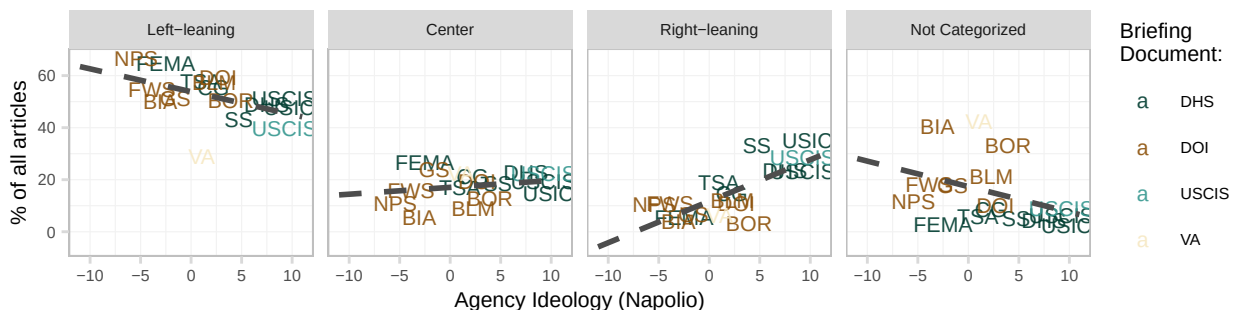
Figure A12: Replication of Figure 2 with Allsides and Guess (2021) partisan slant scores.

Figure 1 replicates with Napoli (2025) agency ideology scores

Partisan Composition of News Briefings (MBFC)



Partisan Composition of News Briefings (Allsides)



Partisan Composition of News Briefings (Guess)

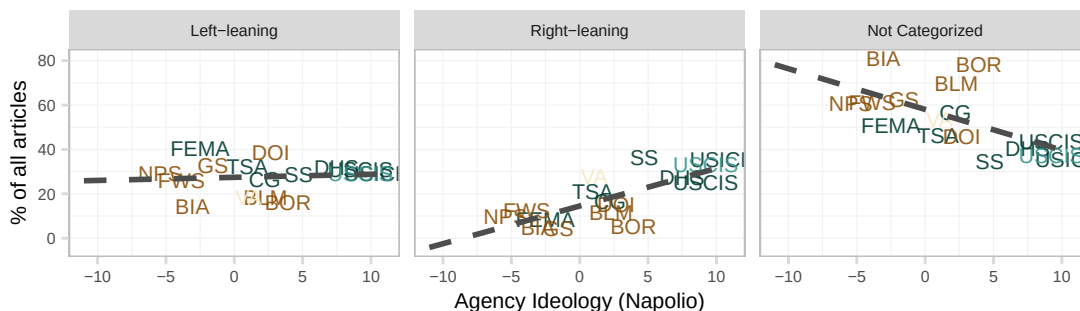


Figure A13: Replication of Figure 2 with Napoli (2025) agency ideology scores.

The results also replicate when using the continuous partisan slant scores. In Figure A14, there is a positive relationship between the continuous measures of partisan slant and agency ideology. Note that the MBFC and Guess partisan slant scores and both agency ideology scores are scaled such that more conservative/right-leaning values are positive.

Average Continuous Partisan Slant and Agency Ideology

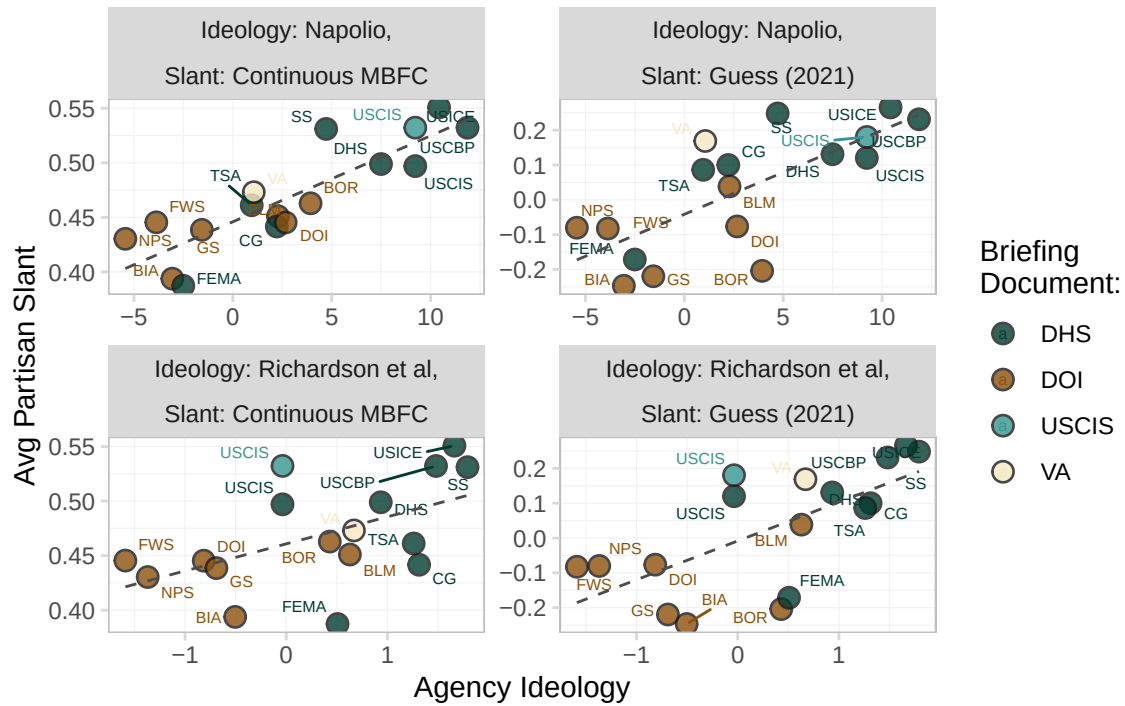
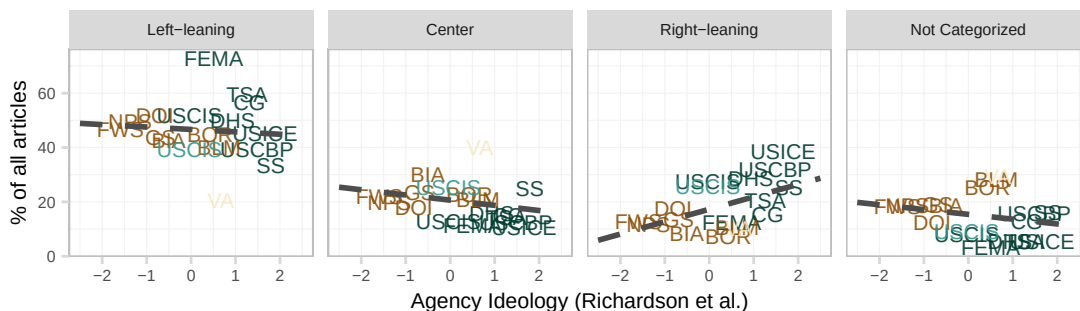


Figure A14: Average continuous partisan slant scores from MBFC and Guess (2021). Both measures rescaled to range between 0 and 1. Note that continuous scores are available for fewer sources.

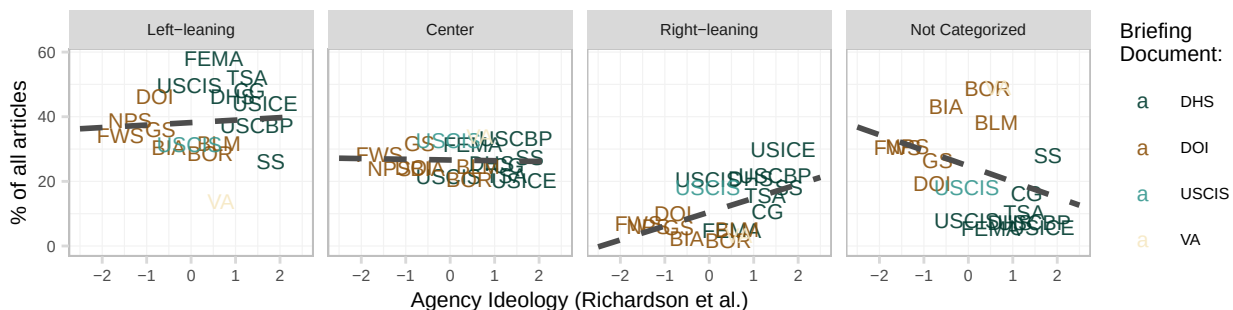
The results also replicate if local general interest sources and government websites are kept in the briefing sample (see Figure A15).

Figure 1 replicates if local general interest and government sources are included.

Partisan Composition of News Briefings (MBFC)



Partisan Composition of News Briefings (Allsides)



Partisan Composition of News Briefings (Guess)

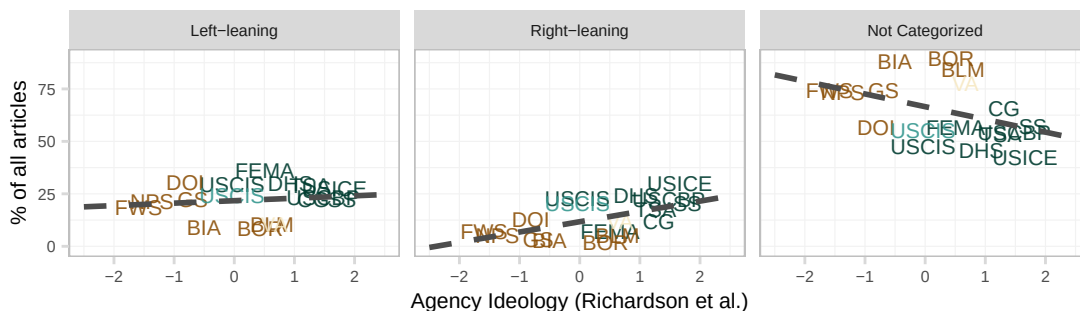


Figure A15: Replication of Figure 2 after adding local general interest sources and government websites. Agency ideology scores from Richardson et al.

Table 15: Coefficient for Figure 3(i) and comparable coefficient for Figure 1 best fit line

	Proportion of Articles from Conservative Sources (0-1)			
	Media Cloud, aggregated	Media Cloud, disaggregated	Briefing, aggregated	Briefing, disaggregated
(Intercept)	0.277 (0.046)	0.249 (0.056)	0.195 (0.026)	0.274 (0.080)
Agency Ideology	0.071 (0.021)	0.107 (0.021)	0.075 (0.019)	0.059 (0.011)
Num.Obs.	17	185253	17	130508
R2	0.157	0.036	0.343	0.011
R2 Adj.	0.101	0.036	0.299	0.011
Std.Errors	Heteroskedasticity-robust	by: Source & Agency & URL	Heteroskedasticity-robust	by: Source & Agency & ID

Note: All models use MBFC media slant and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores.

Cols 1-2: Best fit line in Figure 3(i), which is based on the supply of news (Media Cloud) during the periods/agencies in the briefing sample.

Cols 3-4: Recalculated the regression line from Figure 1 after dropping domains that not collected by Media Cloud Aggregated models use OLS with robust standard errors (HC1). Data aggregated by agency and media slant. Aggregate dependent variable is proportion of articles in an agency's briefing from right-leaning sources. Dependent variable (proportion) ranges from 0 to 1.

Disaggregated models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors. Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (ID). DV is 1 if article is from a right-leaning sources and 0 otherwise.

Table 16: Coefficient for Figure 3(ii)

	Article from Conservative Source (0/1)	
	Fig3(ii)	Keep NA
(Intercept)	0.253*** (0.055)	0.23*** (0.048)
ideo_var	0.020*** (0.003)	0.02*** (0.003)
Num.Obs.	1178863	1295329
R2	0.002	0.003
R2 Adj.	0.002	0.003
Std.Errors	by: Source & Agency & url	by: Source & Agency & url
Clusters (Agency)	165	165
Clusters (Source)	334	589
Clusters (url)	889,440	978,491

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Models use MBFC media slant and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology.

Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors. Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (URL).

DV is 1 if article is from a right-leaning sources and 0 otherwise.

A.4. Figure 3 - Association between news supply and partisan slant

A.4.1. Regression Tables for Fig 3(i) and Fig 3(ii)

The coefficients for the best fit lines in Figure 3(i) and 3(ii) can be found in Tables 15 and 16. The regression tables also contain variations of each regression.

A.4.2. Robustness Checks for Fig 3(i)

To verify the robustness of the results in Figure 3(i), I reproduced the positive relationship in Figure 3(i) using alternative specifications. Instead of dropping articles missing media slant, I included them as a separate category of media slant ('Not Categorized').

First, I test alternative measures of media slant (see Figure A16) and agency ideology (see Figure A17). I then recalculate Figure 3(i) after adding back local general interest news and government websites (Figure A18). I also test whether keeping more domains affects the results. In Figure A19, I include domains if they appear in ANY of the briefings. In the main results, I keep the domains for an agency only if they are included in the briefings for that agency

(although for the USCIS and DHS briefings, I include the domains if they appear in either briefing because both are produced by the same company). In Figure A20, I regenerate the results using a sample from GDELT.³⁸

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Compare measures of media slant

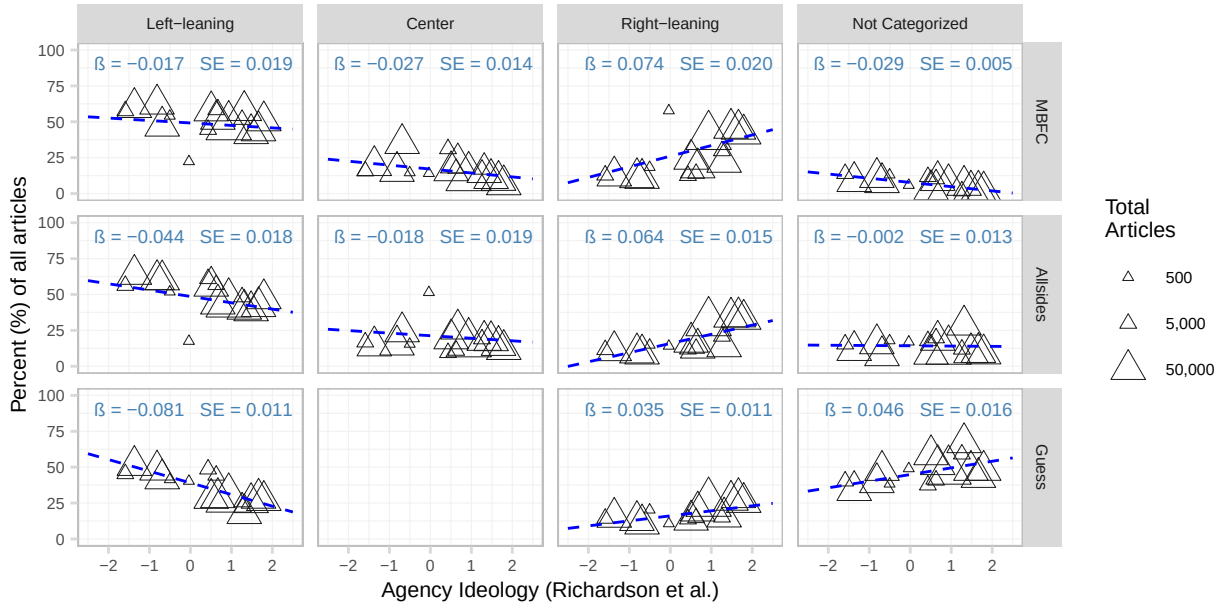


Figure A16: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Compare measures of media slant.

³⁸Note: the GDELT sample only includes DHS and USCIS data through May 15, 2025. The GDELT sample is also much smaller (n=23,181) than the Media cloud sample (n=157,940).

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Compare measures of agency ideology

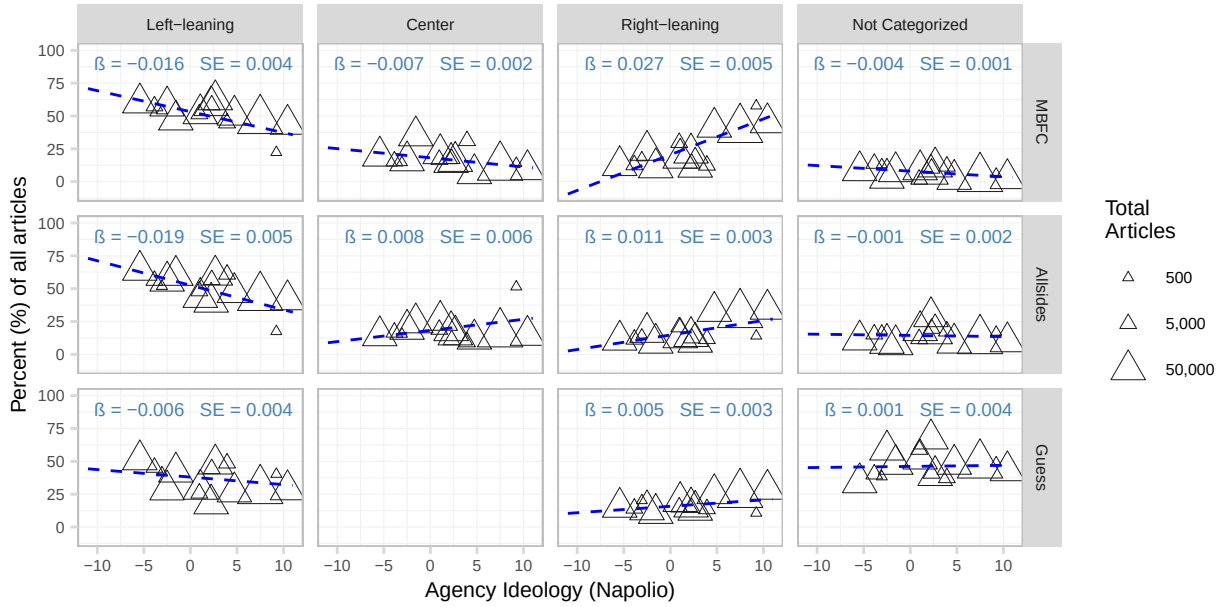


Figure A17: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Replace agency ideology with measure from Napolio (2025).

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Keep local news and government websites

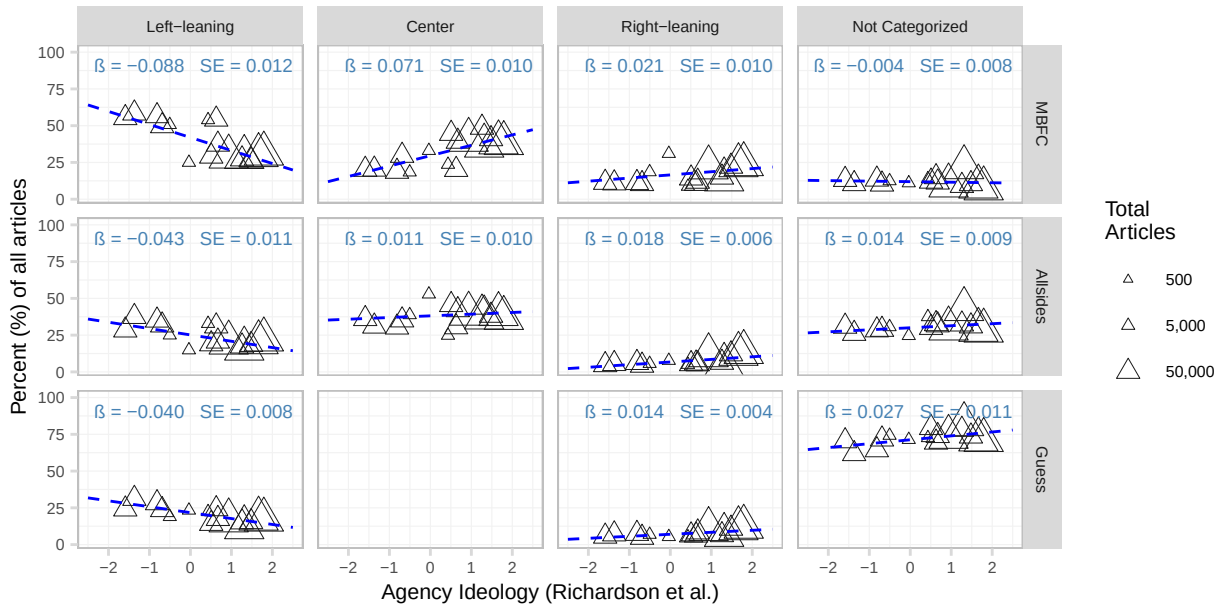


Figure A18: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Include local general interest and government websites.

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Vary domains

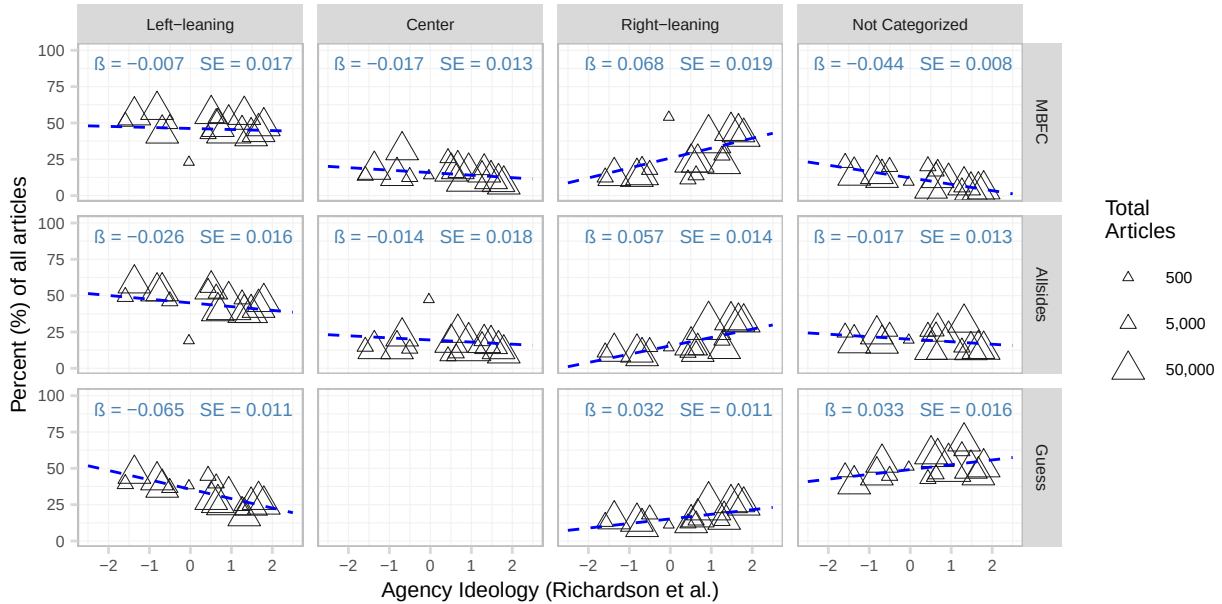


Figure A19: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Include more domains. Include domain if it has been included in ANY briefing, not just a briefing produced by the same company.

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Results with data from GDELT

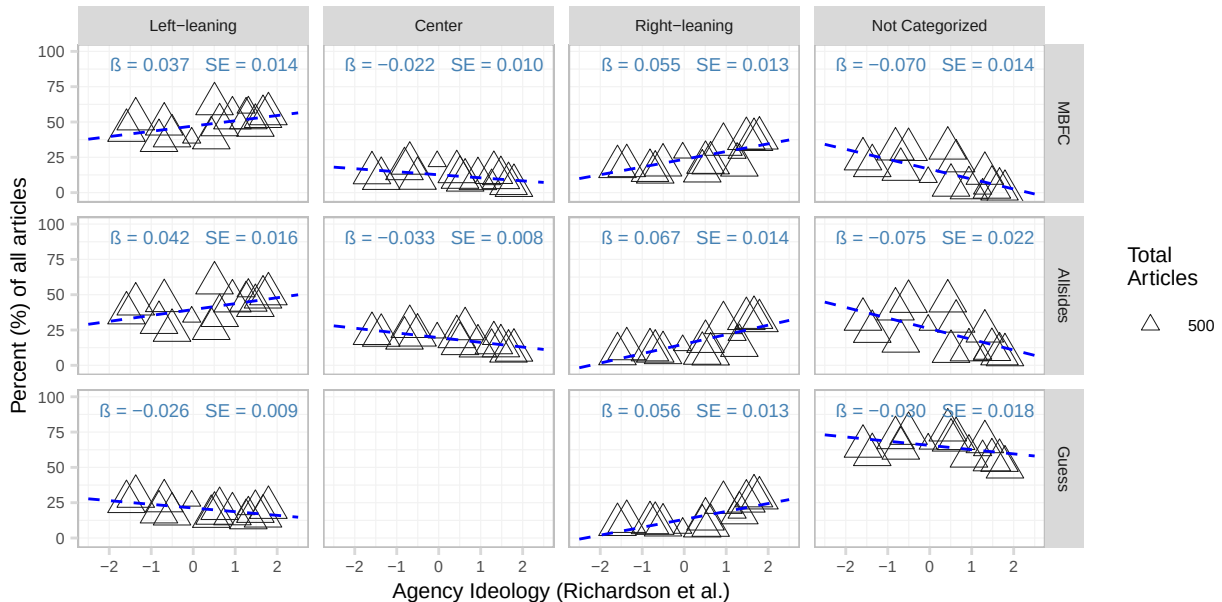


Figure A20: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Use data from GDELT instead of Media Cloud.

Because I do not have the complete set of daily news briefings for the Department of Interior, I had to make an assumption about which articles from Media Cloud should be considered part of the supply used to construct the DOI

briefings.³⁹ In Figure A21, I show that most articles were included in the briefing 1 day after being published. However, there is some variation. Breaking down the distribution by the day of the week that the briefing was published (Monday, Tuesday, etc), we see that Monday briefings include slightly older articles. I did not find any Sunday DOI briefings, suggesting that DOI briefings are not produced on Sundays. Likely, Monday briefings contain coverage from Saturday and Sunday. Thus, when I determined the relevant supply of news for the DOI briefings in my sample, I included an extra day for briefings published on Mondays.

The results reported in Figure 3(i) assume that an article is part of the DOI's relevant supply of news if it is published on the same day as a briefing in my sample or 1 day prior to a briefing in my sample. For briefings published on Mondays, I include articles published up to 2 days before a briefing in my sample briefing. For the matched analysis (Figure 4 in the paper), I only included the days that occur 1 day before a Tuesday-Saturday briefing or 1-2 days before a Monday briefing.

In Figures A22 and A23 below, I show that the results for Figure 3(i) are similar if the window is expanded (include an extra day prior to the briefings) or restricted (do not include articles published on the same day as the briefing). In Figure A24, I include all articles published after first DOI briefing in my sample (2/19/15) and before last DOI briefing (11/13/2018). In all cases, the results are similar.

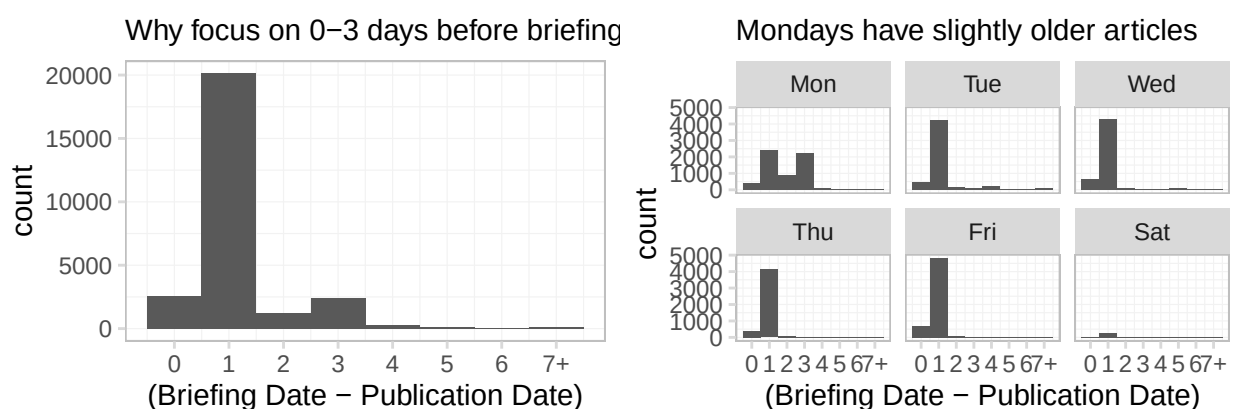


Figure A21: Days between DOI briefing and article publication. Based on article publication date metadata provided in DOI briefing. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites. Plot (ii) shows the distribution grouped by the day of the week of the briefing. No DOI briefings were found for Sundays, suggesting that they are only produced 6 days a week.

³⁹Note that I have not replicated Figure 3(i) using the GDELT data. This is because the GDELT API does not report article publication date.

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Smaller DOI window (only 1 day before briefing)

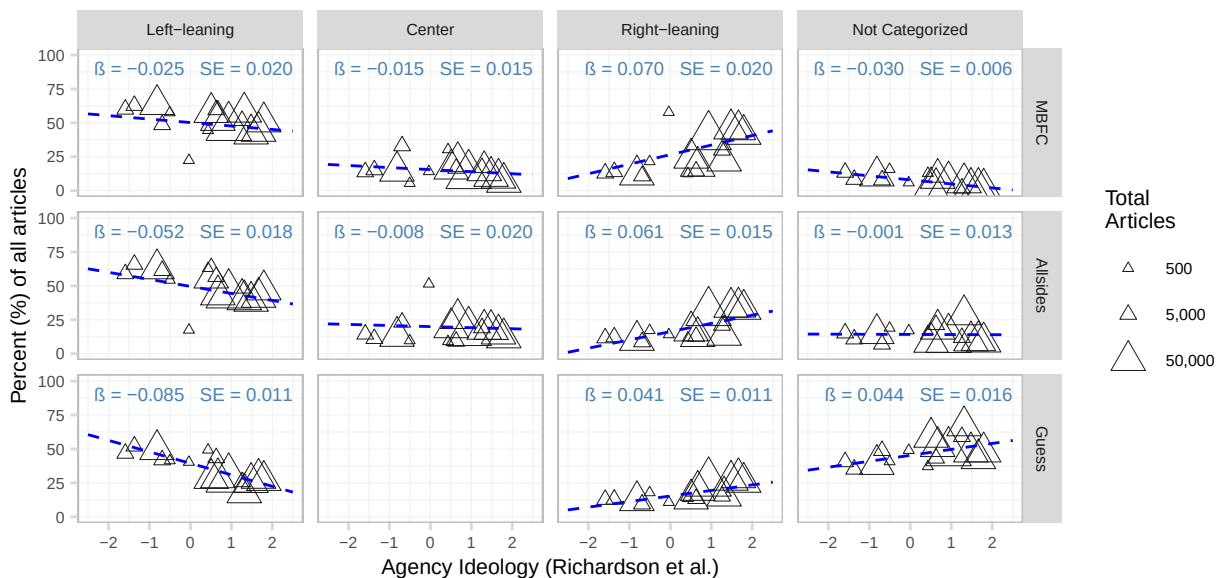


Figure A22: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Narrow window used to determine supply of DOI-related articles. Instead of including article on day of briefing, sample only includes articles published 1 day before Monday-Saturday briefing and 2 days before Monday briefings.

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Larger DOI window (0–3 days before briefing)

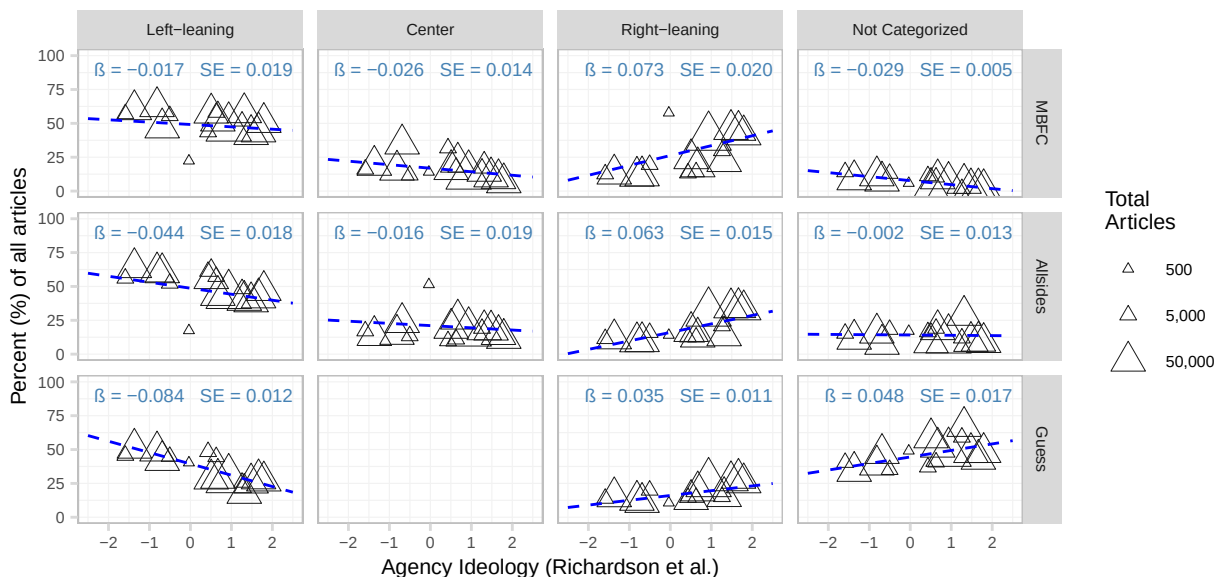


Figure A23: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Increase window used to determine supply of DOI-related articles. Include article on day of briefing and up to 2 days before Monday-Saturday briefing and 3 days before Monday briefings.

Alternative Specifications for Fig 3(i)

Larger DOI window (all dates, 2/19/15–11/13/18)

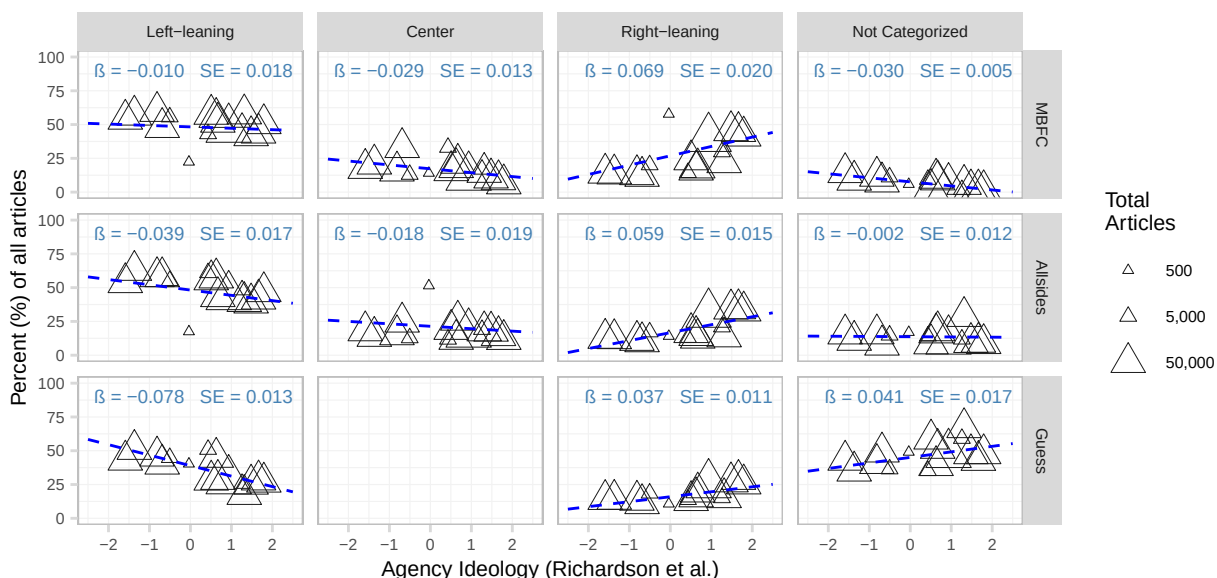


Figure A24: Alternate specifications for Figure 3(i) - Include articles published after first DOI briefing (2/19/15) and before last DOI briefing (11/13/2018).

A.4.3. Robustness Checks for Fig 3(ii)

To demonstrate the robustness of the association between the supply of partisan news and agency ideology in Figure 3(ii), I replicate the results using two other measures of partisan slant (Allsides, Guess 2021) and three other measures of agency ideology (Napolio 2025; Chen and Johnson 2014; Clinton and Lewis 2008). See Figure A26. Each agency ideology measure is linearly rescaled to range from 0 to 1: $I' = \frac{(I - \min(I))}{\max(I) - \min(I)}$. I also check whether the missingness of partisan slant is related to agency ideology (see Figure A27).

Figure A25 is a version of Figure 3(ii) with all of the media slant categories, including articles missing partisan slant. Figure A27 checks whether there is non-random missingness for other combinations of partisan slant scores and agency ideology measures.

Figure A28 is a version of Figure 3(ii) with the continuous measures of partisan slant from MBFC and GUESS (2021). Slant rescaled to be between 0 and 1.

I also replicated Figure 3(ii) using different sets of data. In Figure A29, I add back articles from general interest local sources and government websites. In Figure A30, I test whether substituting the Media Cloud data with similar data from GDELT affects the results.

Distribution of Agency News Coverage (Media Cloud) by Agency Ideology (Richardson et al.)
Randomly sampled 4 weeks every 6 months from Jan 2015 to May 2025.

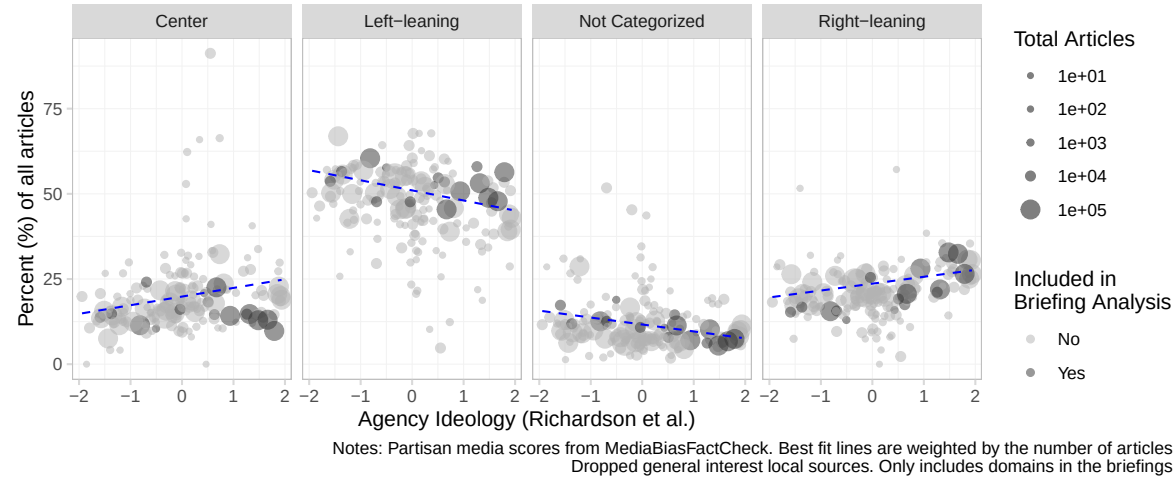


Figure A25: Version of Fig 3 with all media slant categories.

Figure 3 using alternative bias and ideology measures, Media Cloud (2015–2025)

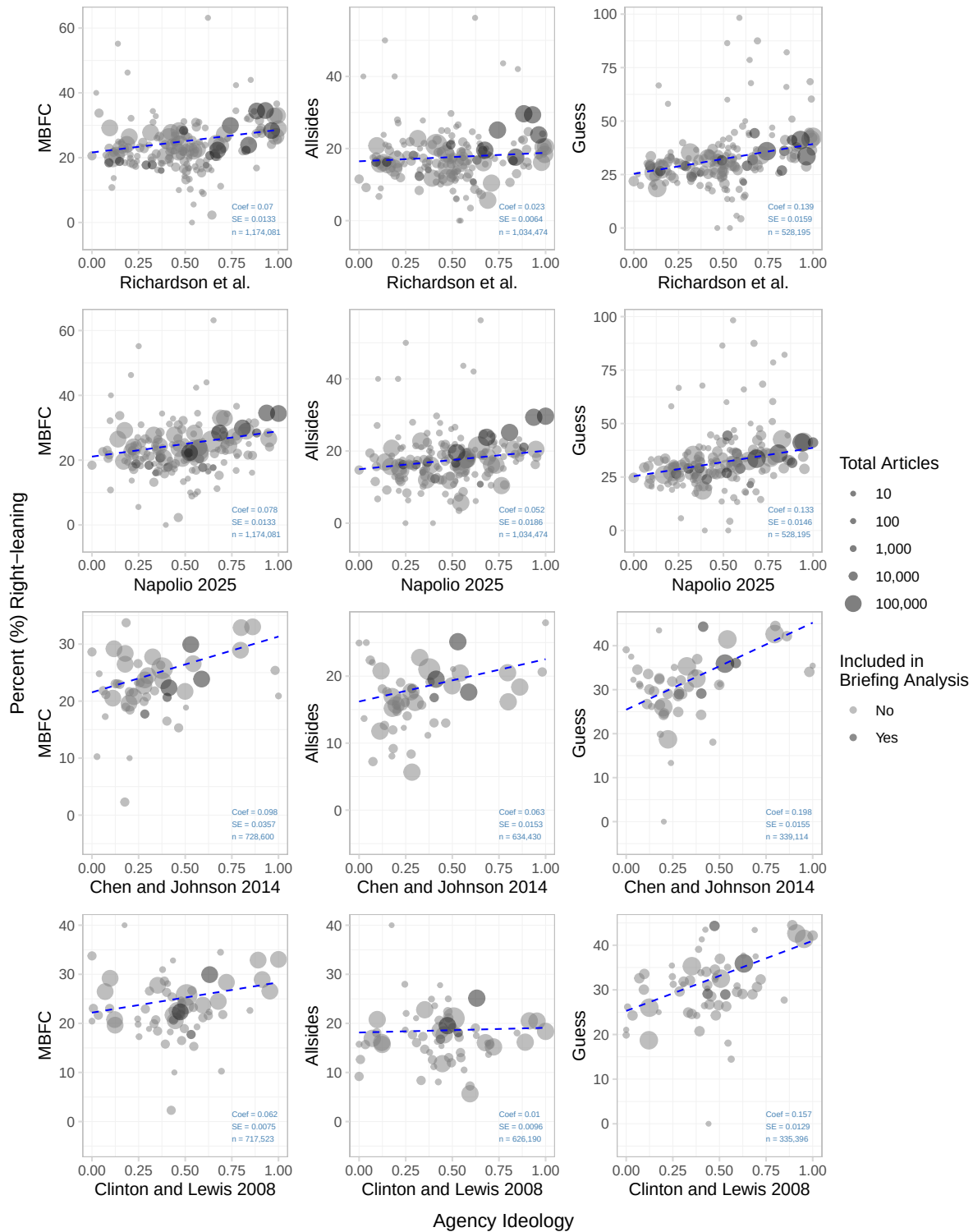


Figure A26: Replication of Fig 3 using alternative measures of news slant and agency ideology.

Missingness of alternative bias and ideology measures, Media Cloud (2015–2025)

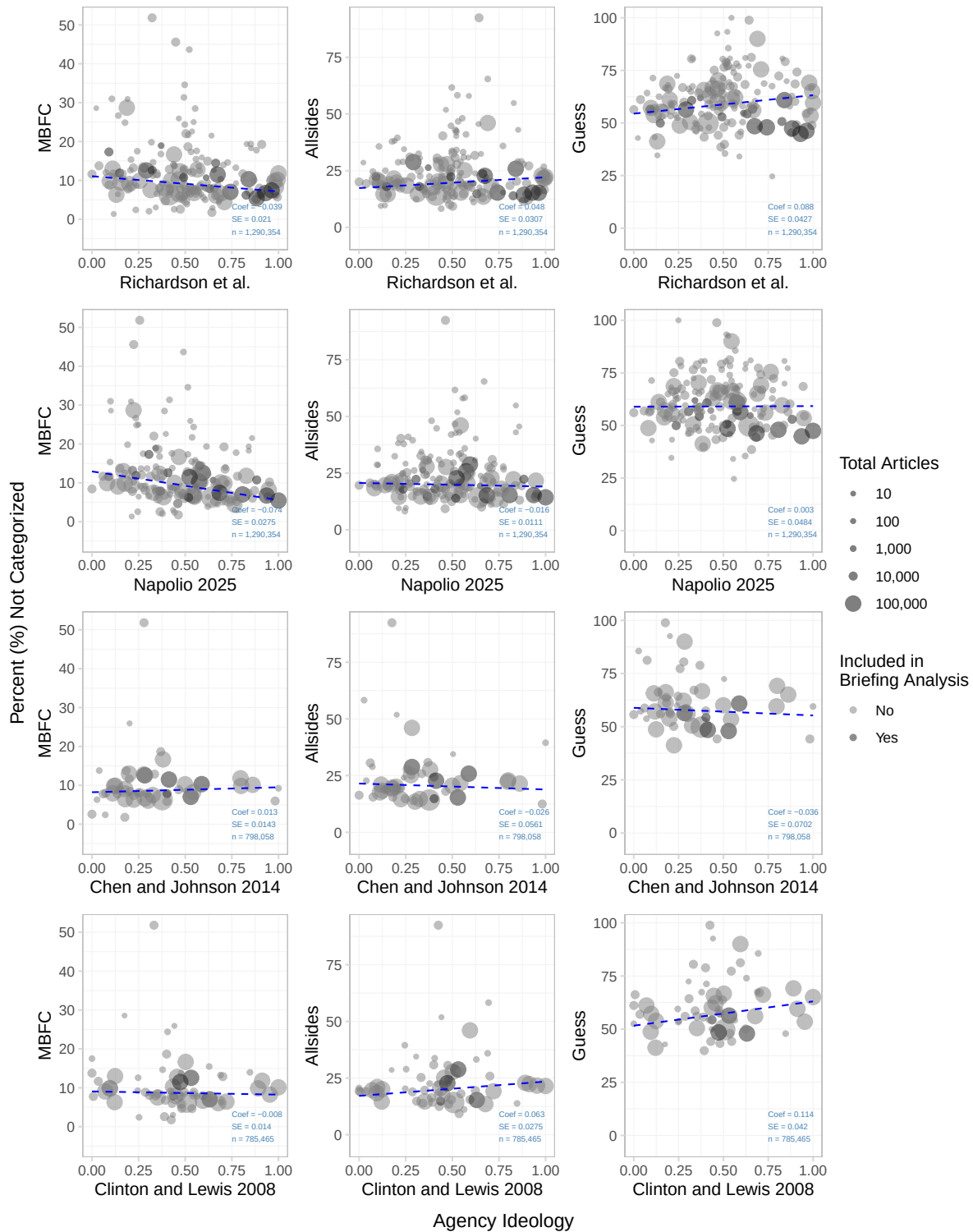


Figure A27: Test for non-random missingness in Figure 3.

Figure 3 using continuous bias measures, Media Cloud (2015–2025)

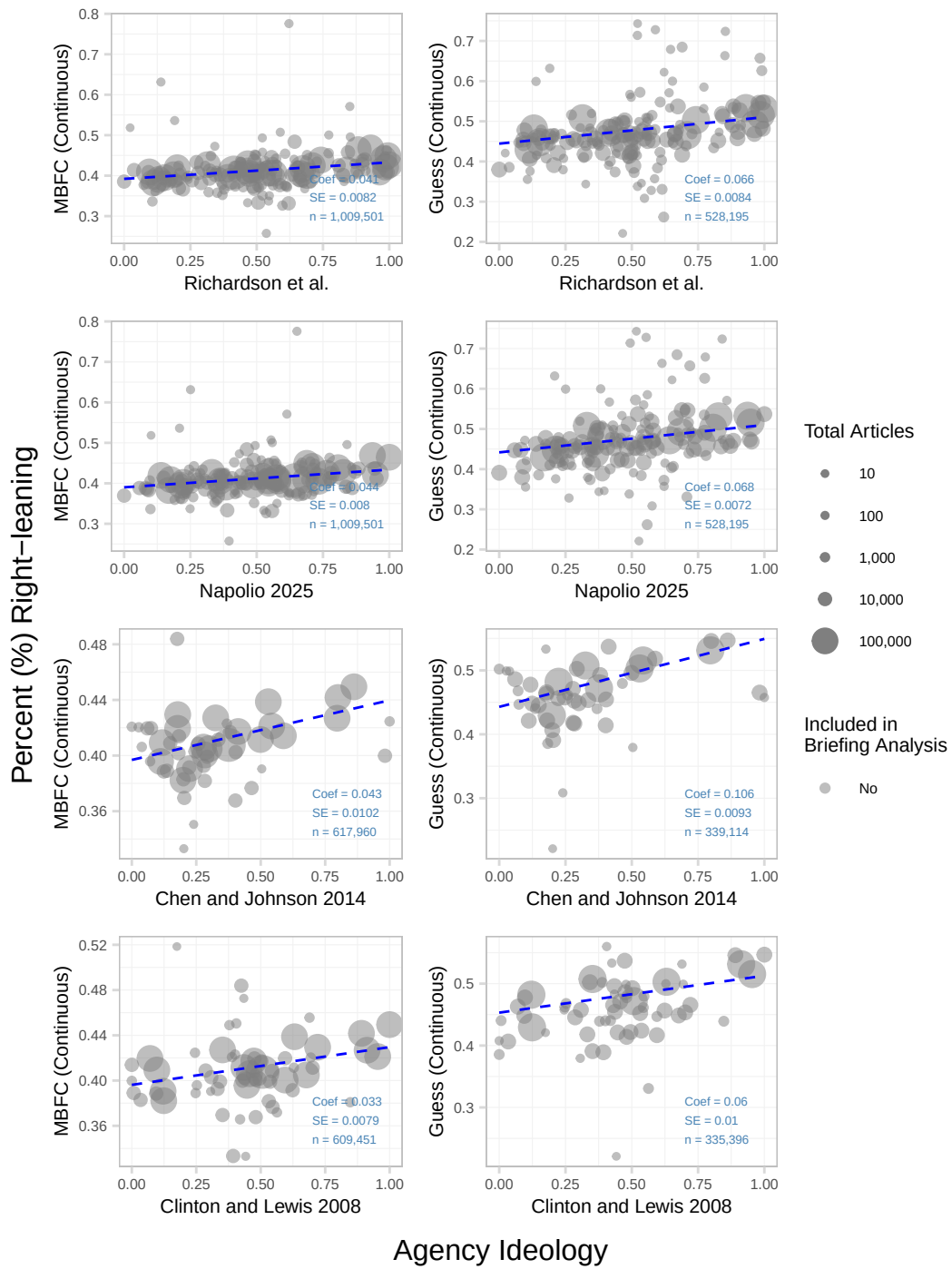


Figure A28: Replication of Fig 3 using continuous measures of slant from MBFC and Guess (2021). Slant rescaled to between 0 and 1.

Figure 3 using alternative bias and ideology measures, Media Cloud (2015–2025)

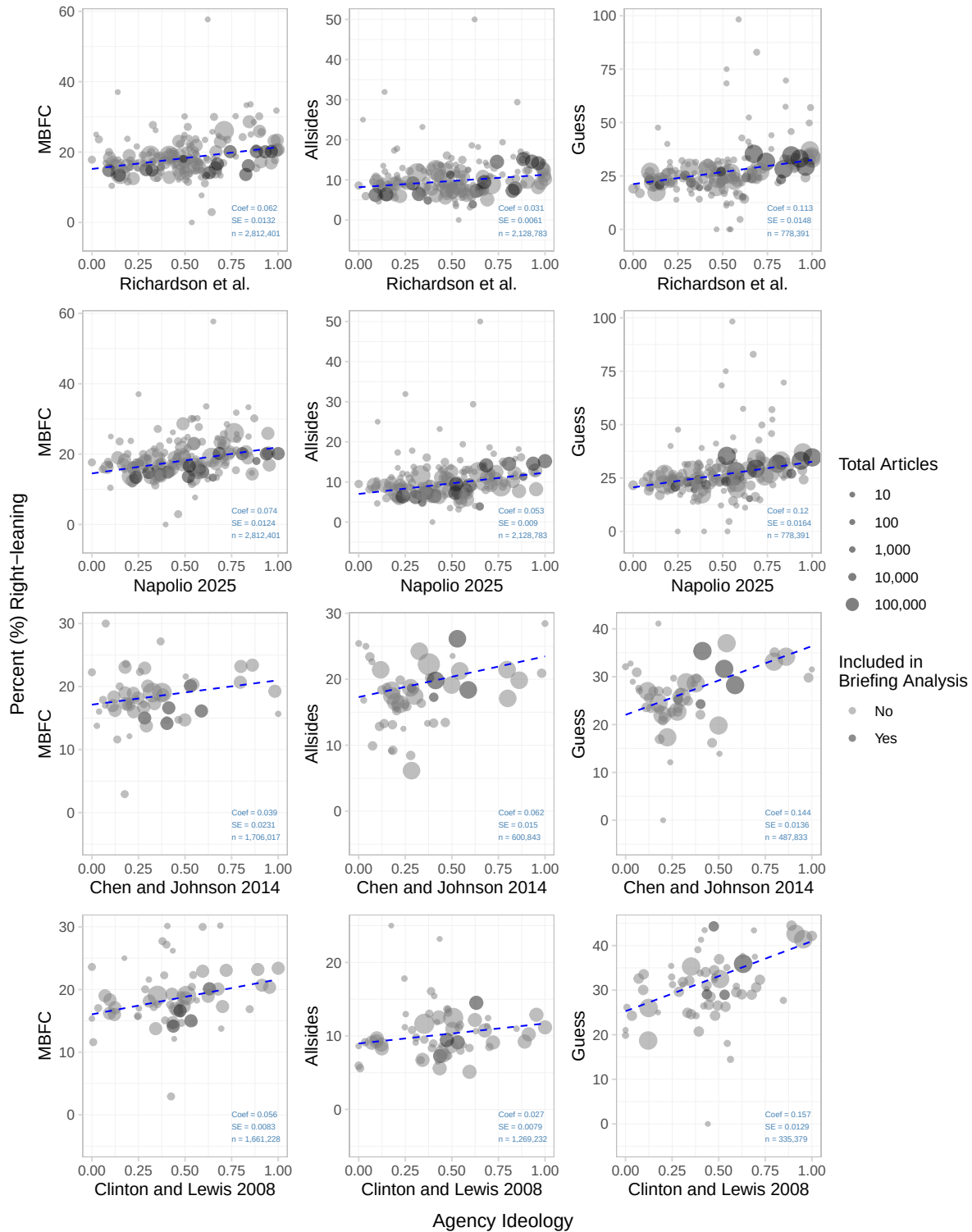


Figure A29: Replication of Fig 3 with local general interest news and government websites.

Figure 3 using alternative bias and ideology measures, GDELT (2017–2025)

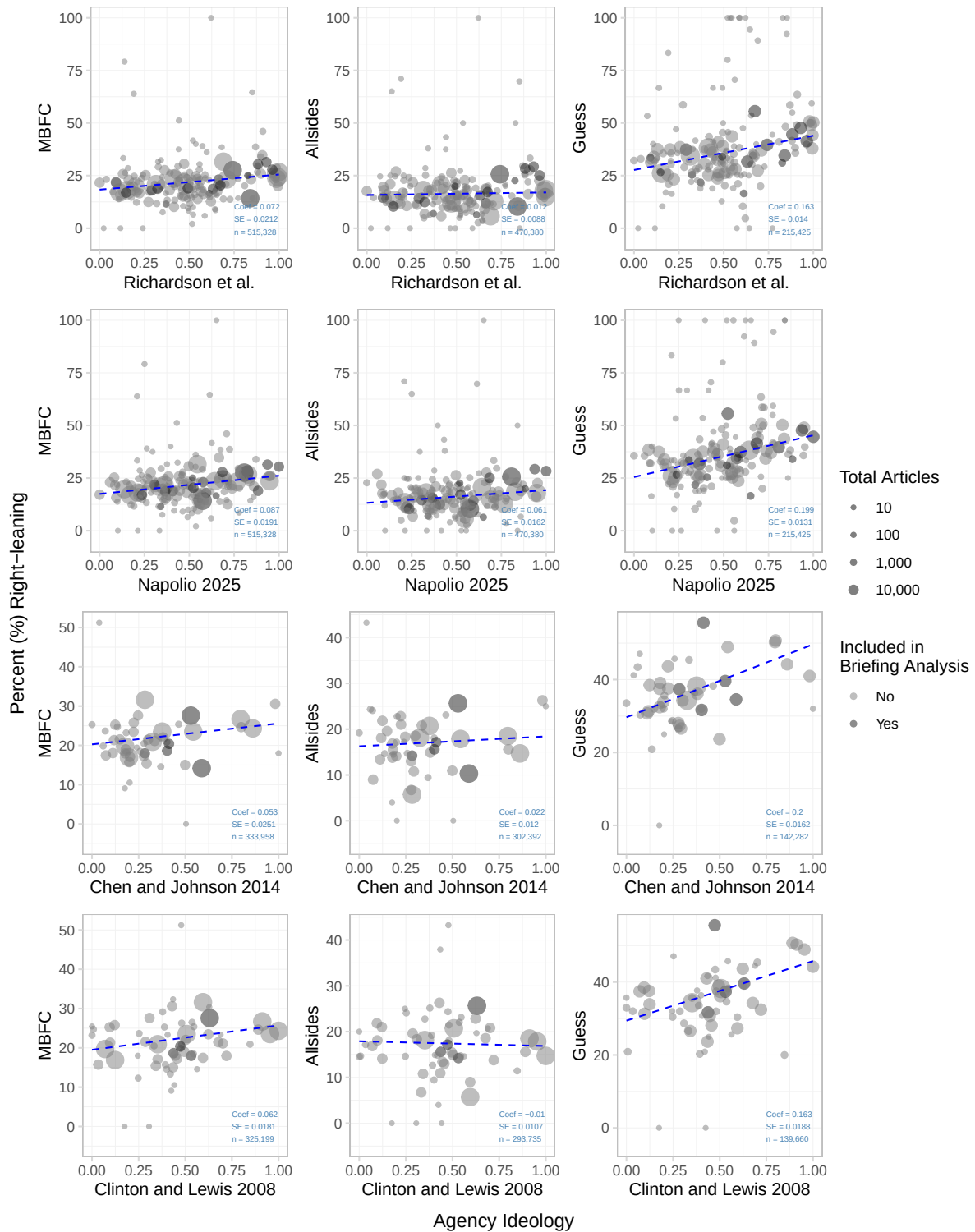


Figure A30: Replication of Fig 3 using GDELT data.

Table 17: Random effects model

	DV: Percent			
	Right	Center	Left	Not Categorized
(Intercept)	3.088*** (0.704)	3.762*** (0.808)	2.500*** (0.212)	12.103*** (1.407)
Agency Ideology	0.309*** (0.073)	-0.062 (0.201)	-0.157*** (0.031)	-0.211** (0.072)
SD (Intercept Source)	6.626	6.731	2.808	23.241
SD (Agency Ideology Source)	0.609	1.595	0.253	0.803
Cor (Intercept~Agency Ideology Source)	0.986	-0.426	-0.693	-0.105
SD (Observations)	2.811	2.970	2.701	4.060
Num.Obs.	6938	4472	12359	8819
R2 Marg.	0.002	0.000	0.002	0.000
R2 Cond.	0.850	0.843	0.522	0.970
RMSE	2.79	2.93	2.68	3.97

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Notes: Data is aggregated to the source-agency level. DV is the proportion of a source's coverage that mentions an agency (out of 100).

Model is run separately for sources belonging to each Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC) category. The following articles were dropped from all models: articles without urls, local general interest sources, government websites, and international news sources.

Estimated random effects model using lmer() from lme4 package. Allows for random intercepts and random slopes for each source.

A.4.4. Heterogeneous Effects

While Figure 3 in the main paper suggests that publication decisions explain why conservative and liberal agencies receive different amount of coverage, the pattern could be the result of several large news outlets. The y-intercept and slope of the best fit line in Figure 3 depend on the ratio of conservative vs non-conservative news sources in the Media Cloud sample, the maximum output of each source, and how each source decides to allocate its resources to different stories. Because the ratio and output are fixed for each time period, any differences in the amount of coverage a news outlet gives to a particular agency will be the product of publication/editorial decisions.

To test for heterogeneous effects, I first run a mixed-effects model, allowing the slope and intercept of the regression to vary for each source (see Table 17). To run this model, I first aggregate the data to the source-agency level. For every source, I calculate the proportion of coverage that it dedicates to each agency (pct_{ij}). This proportion, scaled from 0 to 100, is the outcome variable. To account for the possibility that different media outlets respond differently to agency ideology, I include random intercepts and random slopes for agency ideology by news outlet, allowing both the baseline level of coverage and the ideological effect to vary by outlet. This specification captures outlet-specific deviations from the average relationship and models heterogeneity in how agencies cite different sources. Formally, the model can be written as $pct_{ij} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 I_{ij} + \mu_{0j} + \mu_{1j} I_{ij} + \epsilon_{ij}$ where I_{ij} is the ideology of agency, i , which varies within media outlet, j . Rather than include interactions between agency ideology and media slant, I split the sample and run separate models for each media slant category (see Table 17).

Distribution of conditional (posterior mode) coefficients

Coefficients output from lmer() function

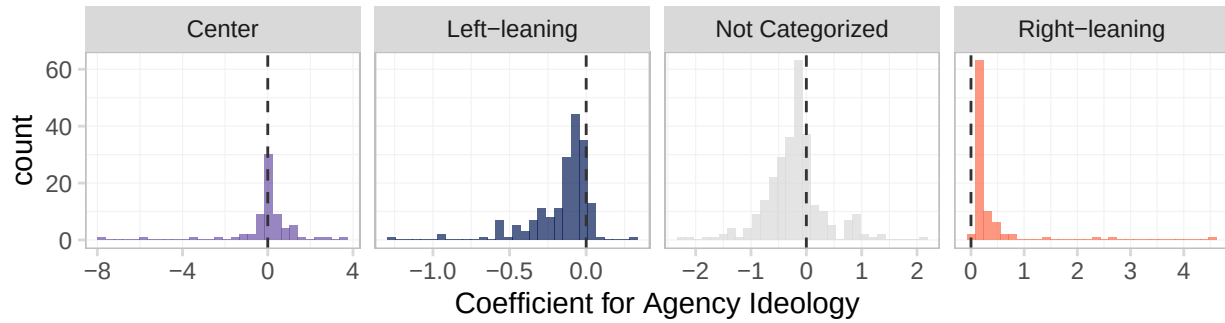


Figure A31: Effect of agency ideology on the proportion of news dedicated to liberal vs conservative agencies. Coefficients from calculated separately for each news source. Resulting coefficients grouped by the slant of the media outlet (MBFC). Outcome is the percent of news (0-100) that an agency receives from a news source. Uses same data as Figure 3, aggregated to the source-agency level.

Distribution of agency ideology coefficients by media slant category

Independently estimated for each source

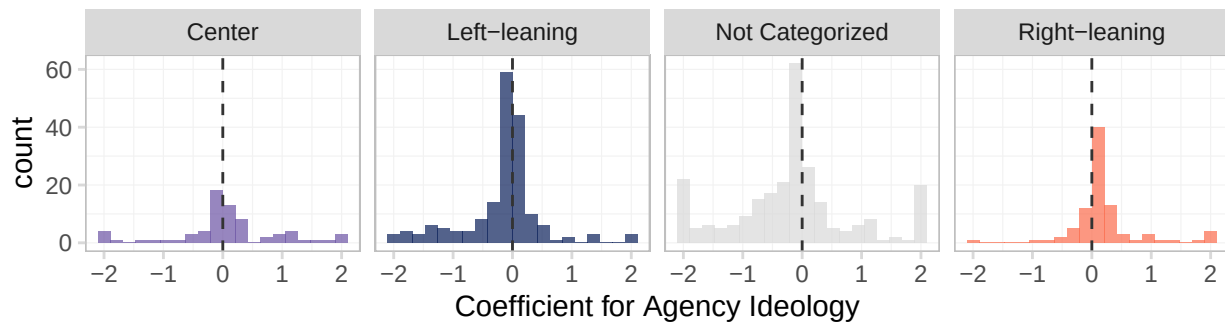


Figure A32: Effect of agency ideology on the proportion of news dedicated to liberal vs conservative agencies. To get coefficients, ran separate regression for each news source. Source dropped if regression could not be computed (e.g. 1 data point). Resulting coefficients grouped by the slant of the media outlet (MBFC). Outcome is the percent of news (0-100) that an agency receives from a news source. Uses same data as Figure 3, aggregated to the source-agency level. Truncated coefficient values above 2 or below -2.

To ensure that these results were not driven by a small number of high-frequency outlets, I also estimated separate linear regressions of the share of citations on agency ideology for each news source. For each news source, j , I run a separate OLS regression ($pct_{ij} = \beta_{0j} + \beta_{1j}I_{ij} + \epsilon_{ij}$) for each news outlet, j , and plot the resulting coefficients (β_{1j}). The resulting distribution of coefficients (see Figure A32) mirrors the general pattern in the conditional estimates from the mixed-effects model, suggesting that the findings are not the artifact of a single dominant outlet.

Like the initial OLS results, the results of the mixed-effects model also indicate a positive relationship between agency ideology and the share of coverage from right-leaning outlets. On average, more conservative agencies cited right-leaning sources more frequently. To verify that this relationship is not limited to a few news outlets, I plot the the distribution of conditional (posterior mode) coefficients for agency ideology (see Figure A31). These coefficients are outlet-specific estimates of the effect of agency ideology, extracted from a mixed-effects model that allows both intercepts and slopes to vary by media outlet. They reflect how the ideology of an agency affects the amount of news a source publishes about that agency.

In Figure A31, nearly all of the right-leaning sources are positive, indicating that right-leaning sources publish more articles about conservative agencies, relative to liberal ones. Figure A31 also shows that left-leaning sources

right-leaning publish more articles about liberal agencies, relative to conservative ones. The coefficients for center and not categorized sources are both centered close to zero. Together, these results suggest that the supply-side asymmetry is driven by both left- and right-leaning news sources.

Table 18: Comparison of exact and partial matching by URL. Percent of articles matched using each option.

Option 1A: Whole URL	Option 1B: Domain+Slug	DHS (%)	USCIS (%)	VA (%)
0	0	85.9	70.8	88.7
0	1	1.7	0.0	1.2
1	0	0.1	0.4	0.1
1	1	12.3	28.8	9.9

A.5. Figure 4 - Testing Biased Selection

A.5.1. Match Quality

For the analysis in Figure 4, I match the articles in the Media Cloud dataset to the briefings. The resulting ‘matched sample’ contains all published articles that mention each agency name and an outcome variable that is 1 if the article is matched to the briefings and 0 otherwise. I used two different methods to match the Media Cloud results to the briefings:

1. **URL match:** If an article with the same URL (identified by EITHER option A or B below) could be found in the relevant briefing the article was counted as included. In practice, both URL matching options produce almost identical results (see Table 18). When matching by URL, I consider the whole briefing, not just the appropriate section. Thus, if an article mentioning US Immigration and Customs Enforcement (USICE) is placed in the “Top News” section, I count it as being included in the briefing. When determining which Media Cloud sources to include, I include any source used in the entire briefing, not just the section relevant to an agency. The DOI briefings do not contain article URLs, so this method was only possible for the VA, DHS, and USCIS briefings.
 - Option 1(A): Match by whole URL.
 - Option 1(B): Match by domain and ‘slug.’ The slug is defined as the longest text segment of the URL path. In practice, I first removed the query text and text following the query. I then split the text between the domain suffix and the end of the URL by forward slash. If there were multiple segments, I selected the longest one. See Figure A1 for URL component terminology.
2. **Source+Date match:** If an article with the same news source and publication date could be found in the relevant briefing or section of briefing, all articles from that news source were counted as included. For the subagencies, I only searched for a match in their subsection of the briefing. Thus, if an article mentioning an agency name is included in another section (e.g. the ‘Top news’ section), it will not be counted. The VA briefings do not report publication date, so this method was only possible for the DOI, DHS, and USCIS briefings. To reduce false positives, I removed three national news sections from the DOI briefing before matching (“TOP NATIONAL NEWS”, “BIG PICTURE”, “EDITORIAL WRAP-UP”).

In the paper, I use the first matching strategy (Source+Date) to generate Figure 4 because dropping the DOI briefings reduces the sample size. Additionally, matching by Source+Date produces reasonably similar results as the URL match. To test the accuracy of the Source+Date matching strategy, I compare the results of the matching strategies for USCIS and DHS briefings.

Table 19 shows how often the Source+Date matching strategy produced different results from the URL matching strategy. For about 20% of articles, the Source+Date strategy produces a possible ‘false positive’ (where the Source+Date strategy identifies a match and the URL strategy does not identify a match). Note that some of these are not true false positives because they include cases where the URL matching strategy produced a false negative. For example, if an article has multiple URLs, URL matching may undercount the number of included articles.

Note that the ‘False Negative’ rate in Tables 19, 20, and 21 is mostly an artifact of the matching process. This can occur when an article mentioning an agency name is included in a different section of the briefing (e.g. an article mentioning ICE is included in the ‘top news’ section). It can also occur when the publication date is wrong in one of the datasets. To reduce false positives for subagencies, I only considered articles from the subagency’s section of the news briefing for the Source+Date matches. Table 19 shows that the ‘false positive’ rate is much higher for the whole briefings (DHS-DHS, USCIS-USCIS). This is because there is a higher chance that another article from the same source is included.

Table 19: Comparison of URL and Source+Date matching methods.

'Error' Type	Briefing	Total	%
'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)	DHS	121,483	77.8
'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)	USCIS	168	81.6
'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative)	DHS	4,885	3.1
'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative)	USCIS	1	0.5
'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive)	DHS	29,863	19.1
'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive)	USCIS	37	18.0

Table 20: Comparison of URL and Source+Date matching methods.

'Error' Type	DHS-CG	DHS-DHS	DHS-FEMA	DHS-SS	DHS-TSA	DHS-USCBP	DHS-USCIS	DHS-USICE	USCIS-USCIS
'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)	86.6	70.0	75.7	85.5	88.6	83.0	83.2	79.2	81.6
'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative)	4.1	0.1	4.7	3.2	5.1	8.1	8.7	5.9	0.5
'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive)	9.3	30.0	19.5	11.3	6.3	8.9	8.1	14.8	18.0

In Figure A33 I plot the 'false positive' rate (percent of articles that are matched by the Source+Date method and not matched by the URL method) by the number of articles from each source.

Figure A33 also raises another possible issue. For some audio and video media formats, the briefings provide a link to a server rather than the original source website. If the story was also posted on the source website and scraped by Media Cloud, the URL match would be incorrect. To verify that the results are not biased by the inclusion of audio and video formats, I replicate the results after dropping TV and Radio media sources.

Table 21 shows the error rate after dropping Yahoo. Especially for the DHS briefings, dropping Yahoo reduces the 'false positive' rate by approximately 5 percentage points.

Figure A34 shows the proportion of articles missing partisan slant in the matched sample. Especially for the Source+Date match, partisan slant is missing for slightly more of the unmatched articles.

Table 21: Comparison of matching methods after dropping Yahoo.

'Error' Type	Briefing	Total	%
'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)	DHS	114,463	80.8
'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)	USCIS	147	79.5
'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative)	DHS	4,828	3.4
'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative)	USCIS	1	0.5
'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive)	DHS	22,380	15.8
'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive)	USCIS	37	20.0

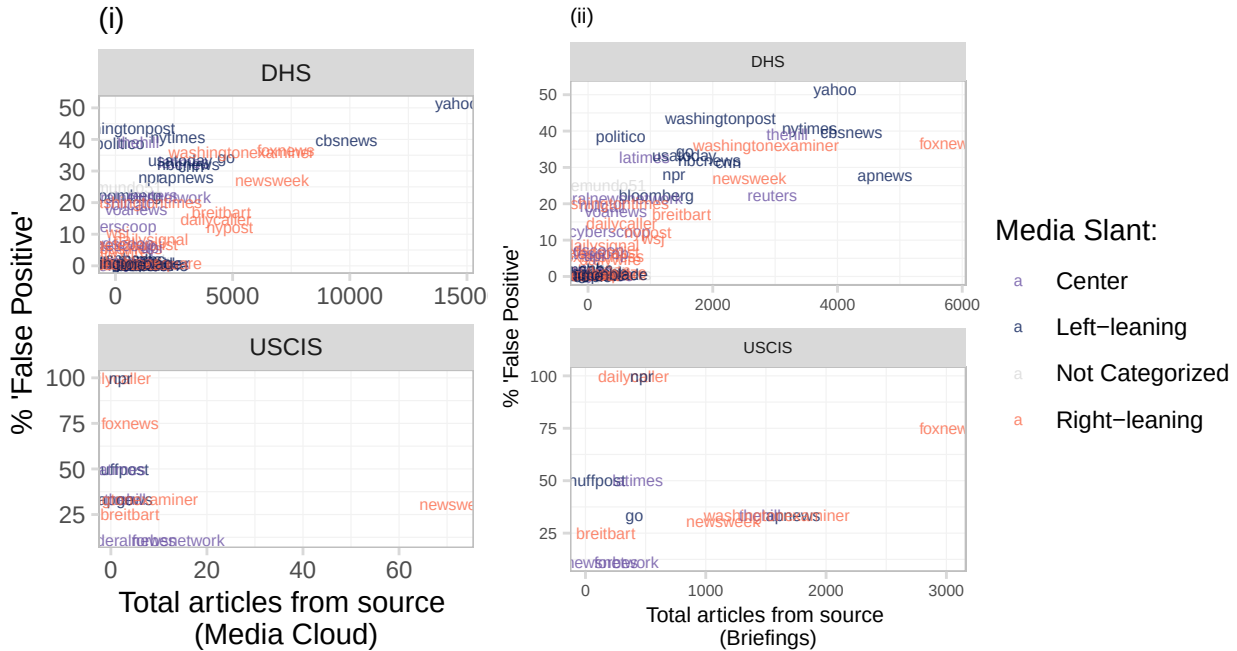


Figure A33: Association between 'false positives' (articles that are matched by the Source+Date method and not matched by the URL method) and the number of articles from each source. In subplot (i), the x-axis is the total number of articles in the Media Cloud sample from each sources. In subplot (ii), the x-axis is the total number of articles in the Briefing sample from each source.

Articles missing partisan slant in matched sample

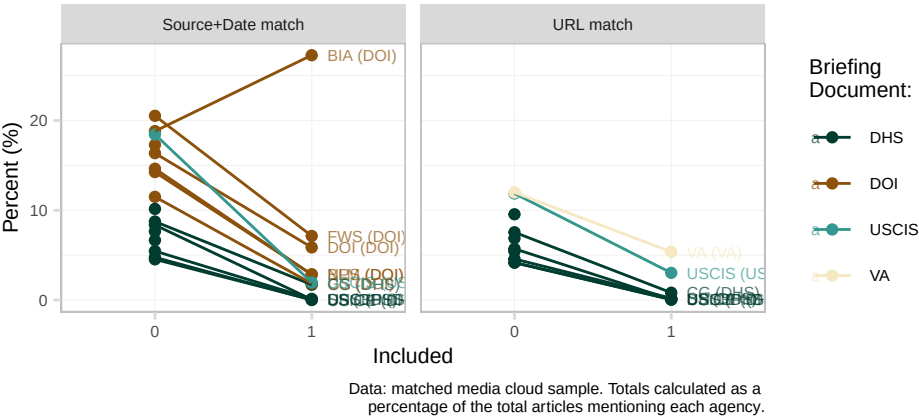


Figure A34: Percent of articles in matched sample that are missing partisan slant. In Source+Date match, dropped yahoo.com.

A.5.2. Are agency name keywords a good method for defining potentially relevant news?

Should agency names be used as a proxy for the keywords used to define potentially relevant news? - I also tested whether the articles that I identified as ‘included’ are representative of the larger briefing sample. If the matching strategy was perfect and the Media Cloud sample was complete, matching would identify all articles that mention an agency name. While the matching strategy is not perfect, it can help us understand how many articles mention each agency’s name.

Using the URL match, I identify the proportion of briefing articles matched to the media cloud sample. In other words, I estimate the minimum number of articles in the briefings that mention an agency by name (see Table 22). To make the results as comparable as possible, I only include domains and dates that are included in the matched dataset.

For most sub-agencies, over a third of the articles could be matched to the briefings, suggesting that at least a third of the articles mention the agency by name. However, there are a few outliers. In the DHS briefing, only 18.0128588% of articles could be matched to an article with the agency’s name. This is probably because many articles in the DHS refer to subagencies. Of the articles in the DHS briefing, 24.8902083% contain the agency name or the name of one of the 7 subagencies. FEMA is another outlier, probably because it contains articles about developing natural disasters, even when the articles do not mention the agency by name. USCIS is a major outlier. Very few articles in the USCIS briefing or section of the DHS briefing contain the name of the agency – likely because this agency is mentioned so rarely in the news.

Table 22: Articles from briefings that could be matched by URL to Media Cloud sample.

Agency	Briefing	Matched	Total	%
CG	DHS	853	1695	50.3
DHS	DHS	10591	58297	18.2
FEMA	DHS	664	5096	13.0
SS	DHS	928	1879	49.4
TSA	DHS	364	1081	33.7
USCBP	DHS	1005	3040	33.1
USCIS	DHS	19	2309	0.8
USCIS	USCIS	66	24573	0.3
USICE	DHS	2389	6016	39.7
VA	VA	737	1899	38.8

Representativeness of matched vs unmatched articles in briefings

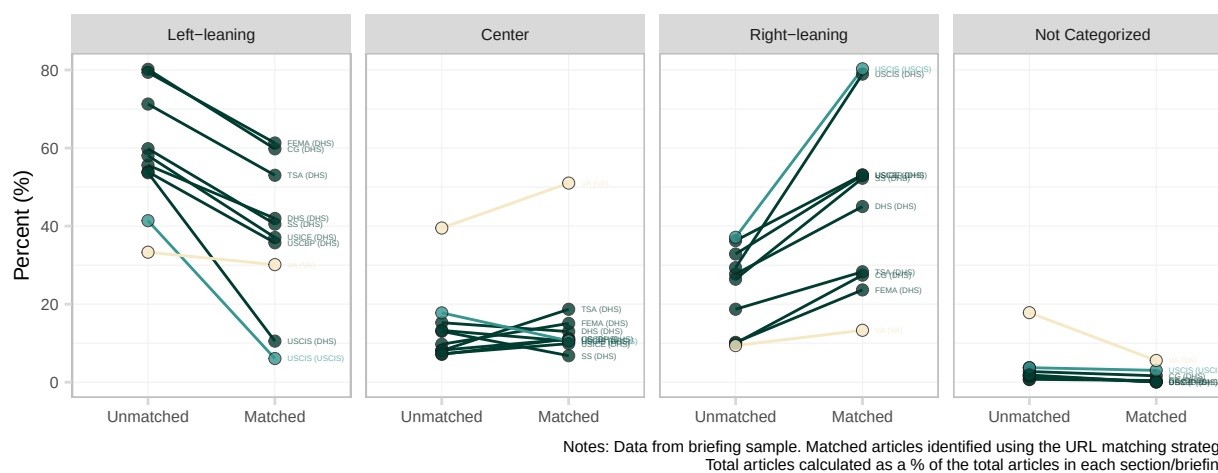


Figure A35: Comparing articles in briefings to subsample of briefings that was matched to the Media Cloud dataset. Matched by URL.

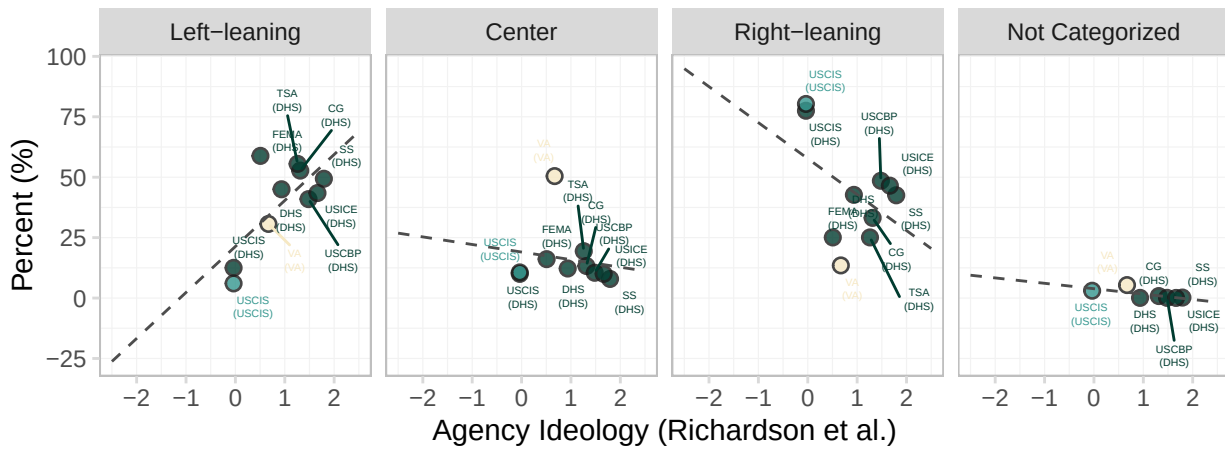
Representativeness

Are articles with agency names representative of the whole briefing sample? - To test the representativeness, I then compare the subset of matched articles in the briefing to the whole briefing sample (see Figure A35). This graph shows the proportion of each sample (all articles in briefings vs only articles matched to media cloud sample) in each media slant category. Overall, the proportion of right-leaning news is slightly higher in the matched sample compared to the whole briefing sample, but USCIS is an outlier.

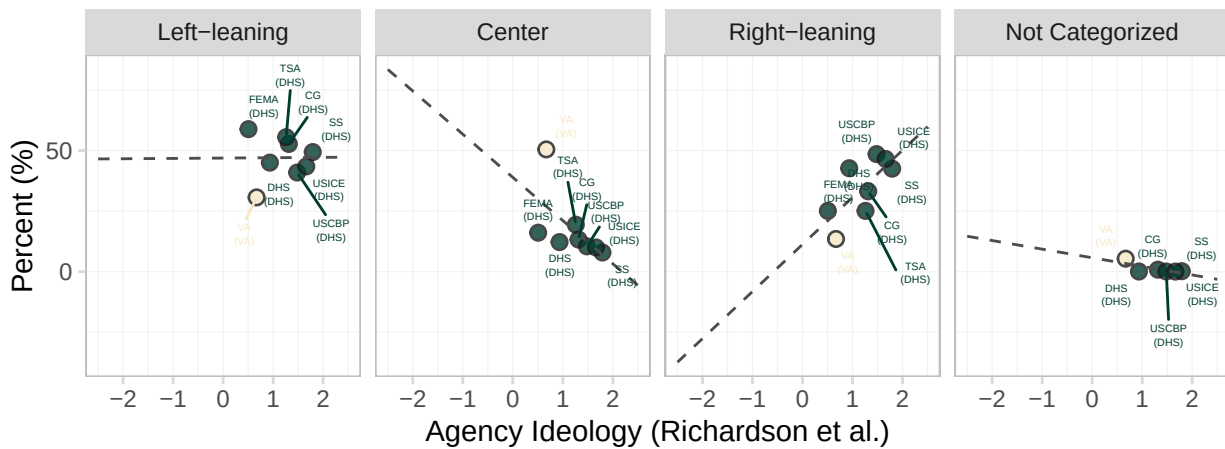
I also verify that the pattern in Figure 1 exists when I limit the briefing sample to only the articles matched to media cloud. If this is not true, I could not use the matched sample to identify the cause of the pattern in Figure 1. To verify this, I isolate the articles in both the briefings and media cloud and use them to replicate Figure 1 (see Figures A36 and A37). Figure A36 replicates Figure 1 using only the articles from the briefings that were matched to the briefing sample by URL. These plots show that the USCIS is a major outlier. But the other agencies generally show the same pattern observed in Figure 1. Figure A37 replicates Figure 1 using only the articles from the briefings that were matched to the briefing sample by Source+Date. These plots also show that the USCIS is a major outlier. But the other agencies generally show the same pattern observed in Figure 1.

Representativeness of matched articles (URL match)

All Agencies



Drop USCIS

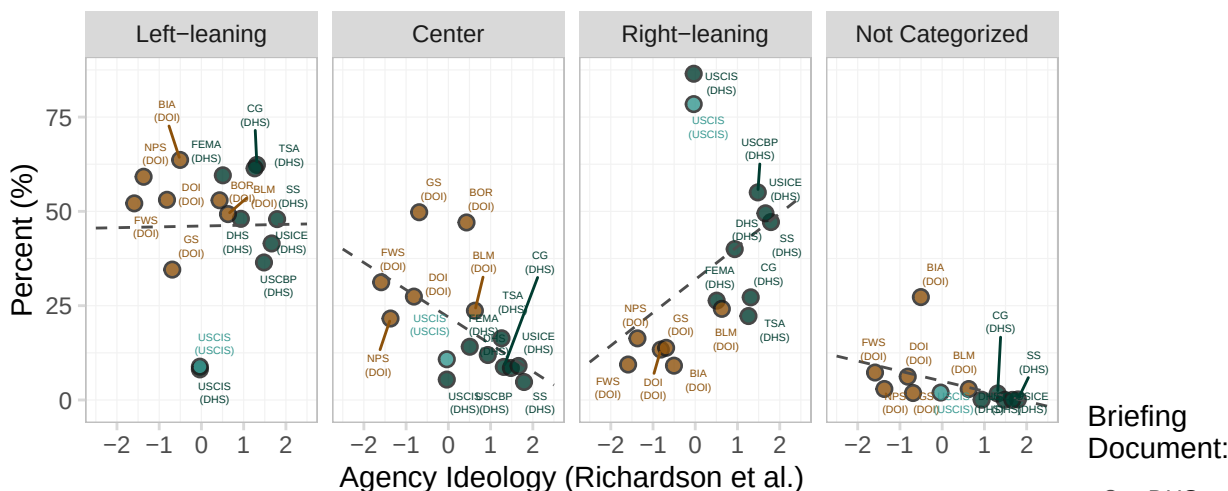


Briefing Document: ● DHS ● USCIS ● VA

Figure A36: Replication of Figure 1 using only the sources and articles included in the matched dataset (URL match) and the briefings. The y-axis is the proportion of articles in a partisan-slant category (Center, Left-leaning, or Right-leaning). Partisan slant is determined by the source of an article.

Representativeness of matched articles (Source+Date match)

All Agencies



Drop USCIS

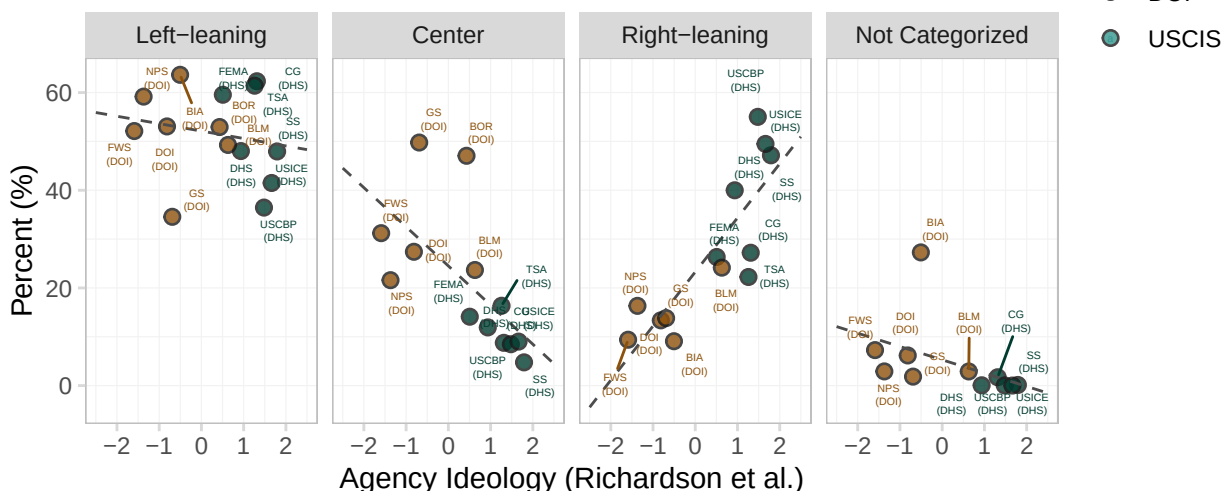


Figure A37: Replication of Figure 1 using only the sources and articles included in the matched dataset (Source+Date match) and the briefings. The y-axis is the proportion of articles in a partisan-slant category (Center, Left-leaning, or Right-leaning). Partisan slant is determined by the source of an article. Dropped yahoo.com.

A.5.3. Regression Tables for Fig 4

Formally, to test whether the slant of an outlet still affects its inclusion after accounting for supply, I use the following model: $Incl_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 S_i + \beta_2 I_i + \beta_3 (S_i \times I_i) + \epsilon$. For each article i , $Incl_i$ is 1 if the article is included in the briefing, S_i is the slant of the news outlet, and I_i is the ideology of the agency mentioned in the article. If agencies are preferentially selecting articles from ideologically-aligned sources, the interaction between agency ideology and right-leaning slant would be positive. In contrast, the results suggest a weak, possibly negative relationship. Across various specifications, the interaction estimates are small, not significant, and usually negative (see Tables 23 and 24). Additional robustness checks can be found in Appendix A.5.3 below.

In the first column of Tables 23 and 24, I show the results without any interactions. While not relevant to testing the interaction, these results do show that center and right-leaning sources are not more likely to be included in the briefings than left-leaning sources. The other columns include interactions. The second column shows the primary specification, which is the one used to produce Figure 4. Each of the following columns shows one possible modification of the

Table 23: Coefficient for Figure 3(ii)

	Article included in briefing (Source+Date match)						
	All	All	All	Keep NA Slant	Drop USCIS	Drop Wire	Drop Nevermatched
(Intercept)	0.389** (0.103)	0.368** (0.097)	0.359** (0.091)	0.368** (0.097)	0.368** (0.098)	0.354** (0.094)	0.466*** (0.108)
Slant Right-leaning	-0.052 (0.076)	0.018 (0.031)	0.027 (0.028)	0.018 (0.031)	0.016 (0.030)	0.033 (0.031)	-0.011 (0.033)
Slant Center	-0.082 (0.065)	-0.042 (0.051)		-0.042 (0.052)	-0.042 (0.052)	-0.052 (0.042)	-0.128* (0.044)
Agency Ideology	-0.036 (0.044)	-0.016 (0.046)	-0.022 (0.043)	-0.016 (0.046)	-0.016 (0.046)	-0.016 (0.044)	-0.059 (0.056)
Slant Right-leaning × Agency Ideology		-0.061 (0.043)	-0.055 (0.042)	-0.061 (0.043)	-0.060 (0.043)	-0.061 (0.044)	-0.024 (0.046)
Slant Center × Agency Ideology		-0.043 (0.047)		-0.043 (0.047)	-0.042 (0.047)	-0.040 (0.039)	-0.001 (0.053)
Slant Not Categorized				-0.296* (0.101)			
Slant Not Categorized × Agency Ideology				-0.029 (0.046)			
Num.Obs.	168153	168153	168153	174053	167806	160988	144363
R2	0.008	0.010	0.006	0.022	0.010	0.009	0.015
R2 Adj.	0.008	0.010	0.006	0.022	0.010	0.009	0.015
Std.Errors	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL
Clusters (Agency)	15	15	15	15	14	15	15
Clusters (Source)	241	241	241	339	241	238	100
Clusters (url)	138,115	138,115	138,115	143,114	138,009	132,352	118,157

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Models uses MBFC media slant measure and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores.

Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors. Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (URL). Slant scores are based on MBFC categories.

Dependent variable is 1 if an article is matched to the articles cited in the agency briefings and 0 otherwise.

Yahoo.com is dropped.

Table 24: Coefficient for Figure 3(ii)

	Article included in briefing (URL match)						
	All	All	All	Keep NA Slant	Drop USCIS	Drop Wire	Drop Nevermatched
(Intercept)	0.196*** (0.032)	0.183*** (0.020)	0.196*** (0.012)	0.183*** (0.019)	0.184*** (0.020)	0.167*** (0.021)	0.199*** (0.025)
Slant Right-leaning	0.026 (0.059)	0.048+ (0.025)	0.033 (0.023)	0.048 (0.028)	0.041 (0.025)	0.064* (0.024)	0.075* (0.027)
Slant Center	0.029 (0.060)	0.063+ (0.030)		0.063+ (0.031)	0.061+ (0.030)	0.061 (0.041)	0.056 (0.033)
Agency Ideology	-0.035 (0.023)	-0.026 (0.029)	-0.033 (0.025)	-0.026 (0.028)	-0.026 (0.029)	-0.025 (0.027)	-0.025 (0.033)
Slant Right-leaning × Agency Ideology		-0.017 (0.029)	-0.010 (0.026)	-0.017 (0.033)	-0.012 (0.029)	-0.018 (0.029)	-0.022 (0.032)
Slant Center × Agency Ideology		-0.028 (0.028)		-0.028 (0.027)	-0.027 (0.028)	-0.035 (0.023)	-0.029 (0.029)
Slant Not Categorized				-0.132* (0.056)			
Slant Not Categorized × Agency Ideology				-0.004 (0.040)			
Num.Obs.	157257	157257	157257	161926	156910	150920	138229
R2	0.003	0.003	0.002	0.007	0.003	0.004	0.004
R2 Adj.	0.003	0.003	0.002	0.007	0.003	0.004	0.004
Std.Errors	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL
Clusters (Agency)	9	9	9	9	8	9	9
Clusters (Source)	206	206	206	299	206	203	121
Clusters (url)	129,200	129,200	129,200	133,245	129,094	124,176	113,402

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Models uses MBFC media slant measure and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores.

Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors. Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (URL). Slant scores are based on MBFC categories.

Dependent variable is 1 if an article is matched to the articles cited in the agency briefings and 0 otherwise.

regression in column 2. The third column shows how changing the reference category for media slant affects the results. The fourth column drops articles from not categorized sources, and the fifth column drops all USCIS articles. The sixth column treats the major wire services (AP, UPI, and Reuters) as international sources and drops them. The last column drops sources that are not successfully matched to the briefing at least once. This last specification undercounts sources that are rarely included, but it also removes sources that could not be matched due to problems with the matching process.

Table 23 contains the results when the data is matched by source and date. Table 24 contains the results when the data is matched by URL. Regardless of the specifications, the results are fairly consistent. While the point estimates vary slightly, the direction and significance of the results do not change. In each case, interacting agency ideology and right-leaning slant produces a small, negative estimate. More importantly, the coefficient is insignificant.

A.5.4. Robustness Checks for Fig 4

Due to their importance, I generate coefficient plots for two alternate specifications: (1) Replication of Figure 4 with URL matching, and (2) Replication of Figure 4 with Yahoo.com included.

1. First, I replicate Figure 4 using the URL matched sample. In Figure A38, the null result is even more evident. This is critical because the URL match strategy is less likely to produce false matches. While only available for half of the sample, the null result in Figure A38 strongly suggests that there is no positive relationship between agency ideology and partisan slant after accounting for disparities in the supply of news.

2. Second, I replicate Figure 4 directly with two alternate specifications. In Figure A39, I show the results when I keep Yahoo.com in the sample. Because Yahoo is labelled as ‘Left-leaning’ by Media Cloud, the large number of false-positives bias the estimates. When relatively few of an agency’s articles mention it by name (e.g. DHS, FEMA), the bias is larger. In the paper, I choose to show the results without Yahoo to avoid confusion. Comparing the results in Figure A39 to Figure A38 reveals how including Yahoo can bias the coefficients.

Alternate specifications for Figure 4

Match by URL

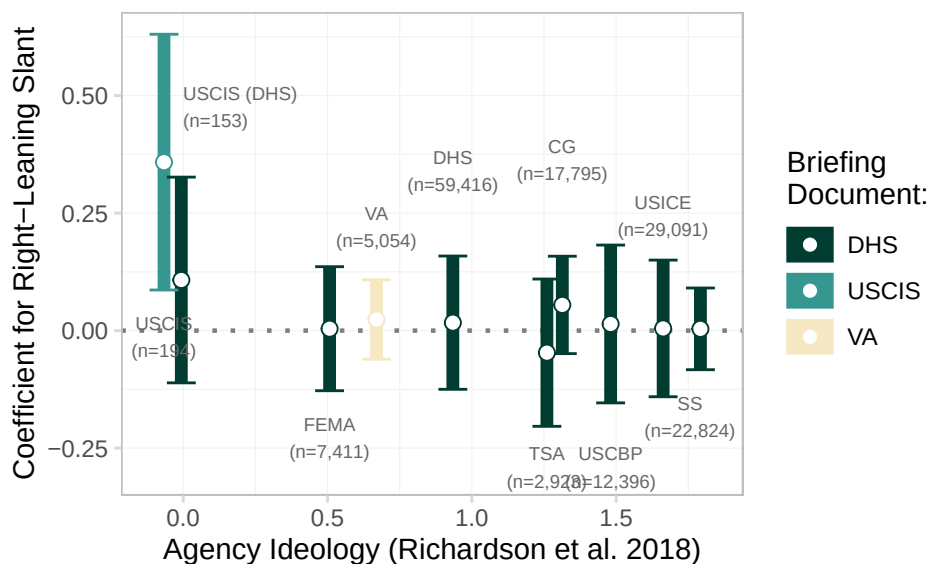


Figure A38: Alternate specifications for Figure 4 - Matched by URL.

Alternate specifications for Figure 4

Keep Yahoo.com

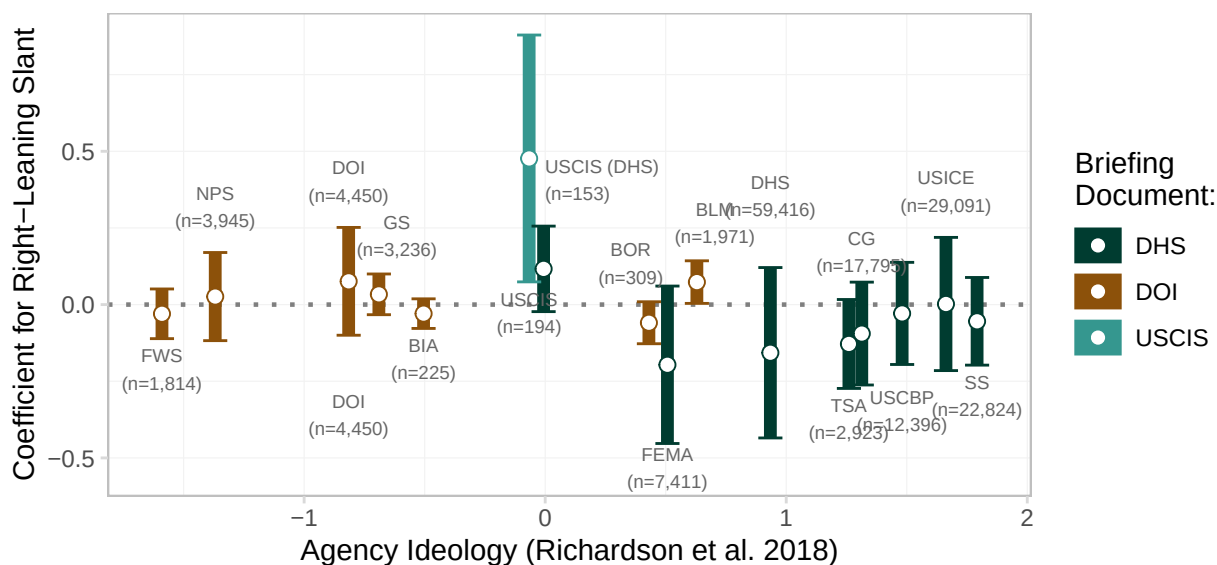


Figure A39: Alternate specifications for Figure 4 - Keep Yahoo.com.

Table 25: Coefficient for Figure 3(ii) - Source+Date Match, Alternative Samples of Articles

	Article included in briefing (Source+Date match)					
	Keep Yahoo	Drop Print	Expanded Domains	Add Local+Gov	Add Local+Gov+Int	Drop Apr-Nov'25
(Intercept)	0.368** (0.097)	0.187** (0.054)	0.305** (0.082)	0.337** (0.092)	0.200** (0.063)	0.290** (0.079)
Slant Right-leaning	0.018 (0.031)	0.156* (0.066)	0.037 (0.039)	0.049 (0.035)	0.046 (0.043)	0.004 (0.035)
Slant Center	-0.042 (0.051)	0.107* (0.042)	-0.010 (0.056)	-0.011 (0.051)	-0.032 (0.054)	-0.012 (0.052)
Agency Ideology	-0.016 (0.046)	-0.057+ (0.028)	-0.022 (0.035)	-0.024 (0.041)	0.020 (0.031)	-0.019 (0.040)
Slant Right-leaning × Agency Ideology	-0.061 (0.043)	-0.036 (0.031)	-0.042 (0.039)	-0.053 (0.044)	-0.046 (0.027)	-0.048** (0.014)
Slant Center × Agency Ideology	-0.043 (0.047)	-0.006 (0.032)	-0.047 (0.036)	-0.034 (0.043)	-0.026 (0.025)	-0.063+ (0.034)
Num.Obs.	168153	106468	171905	153297	230751	89604
R2	0.010	0.030	0.008	0.007	0.004	0.015
R2 Adj.	0.010	0.030	0.008	0.007	0.004	0.015
Std.Errors	by: Agency & Source & URL					
Clusters (Agency)	15	15	15	15	15	15
Clusters (Source)	241	214	279	243	778	237
Clusters (url)	138,115	86,729	140,435	124,714	192,770	76,088

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Models uses MBFC media slant measure and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores. Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors.

Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (URL). Slant scores are based on MBFC categories.

DV is 1 if an article is matched to the articles cited in the agency briefings and 0 otherwise. Dropped Yahoo unless specified otherwise.

In addition to the specifications described in Appendix A.5.2, I also vary the measures of media slant and agency ideology as well as the data included in the matched sample. Tables 25 and 27 use the Source+Date matching strategy to identify articles included in the briefings. Tables 26 and 28 use the URL matching strategy to identify articles included in the briefings.

First, I vary the sample. In Tables 25 and 26, I test the following alterations:

- Keep/Drop Yahoo - Depending on the matching strategy, I show what happens when we add or drop Yahoo.com. For the Source+Date match, I keep Yahoo. For the URL match, I drop Yahoo.
- Drop Print - I drop all TV and Radio sources. Because links to outside video/audio hosts, I have fewer website links for articles/clips from TV and Radio sources. Without these links, I cannot match as many radio and tv citations to the Media Cloud data.
- Expanded Domains - By default, I keep only domains that are cited at least once by the company that produces each briefing. Thus, for the DOI, FWS, NPS, etc Media Cloud results, I only keep articles from sources cited in the DOI briefing. Similarly, for the VA Media Cloud results, I only keep articles from sources cited in the VA briefings. For the USCIS and DHS, I keep articles from sources cited in either briefing because they are produced by the same vendor. In this alternate specification, I allow Media Cloud results to be included if their domains were cited in any of the briefings (DOI, VA, DHS, and USCIS).
- Add Local+Gov - I add back the articles from local general interest news sources and government websites.
- Add Local+Gov+Int - I add back the articles from local general interest news sources, government websites, and international websites.
- Drop Apr-Nov'25 - I drop all articles published after April 1, 2025.

Second, I vary the measures of media slant and agency ideology. In Tables 27 and 28, I test the following alterations:

- Replace Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores with scores from Napolio (2025).
- Replace MBFC partisan slant measures with ones from Allsides and Guess (2021). I convert the Allsides and Guess scores to a 3-category scale (Left-leaning, Center, Right-leaning) to make the results more comparable.

Table 26: Coefficient for Figure 3(ii) - URL Match, Alternative Samples of Articles

	Article included in briefing (URL match)						
	Drop Yahoo	Drop Print	Expanded Domains	Add Local+Gov	Add Local+Gov+Int	GDELT	Drop Apr-Nov '25
(Intercept)	0.211*** (0.017)	0.085*** (0.010)	0.164*** (0.018)	0.182*** (0.019)	0.141*** (0.033)	0.125*** (0.030)	0.150*** (0.017)
Slant Right-leaning	0.020 (0.024)	0.098*** (0.017)	0.039 (0.023)	0.049+ (0.025)	0.035 (0.022)	-0.001 (0.043)	0.014 (0.029)
Slant Center	0.035 (0.028)	0.112** (0.024)	0.050 (0.029)	0.064+ (0.029)	0.011 (0.023)	0.030 (0.054)	0.086 (0.091)
Agency Ideology	-0.024 (0.028)	-0.025 (0.016)	-0.021 (0.027)	-0.026 (0.028)	-0.020 (0.032)	-0.014 (0.020)	-0.029 (0.017)
Slant Right-leaning × Agency Ideology	-0.019 (0.028)	-0.012 (0.018)	-0.014 (0.027)	-0.017 (0.029)	-0.016 (0.025)	0.000 (0.022)	-0.005 (0.027)
Slant Center × Agency Ideology	-0.029 (0.027)	-0.024 (0.023)	-0.031 (0.025)	-0.028 (0.028)	-0.016 (0.032)	-0.010 (0.019)	-0.049 (0.056)
Num.Obs.	141970	113325	175999	158151	216948	13666	92055
R2	0.002	0.021	0.002	0.003	0.002	0.001	0.003
R2 Adj.	0.002	0.020	0.002	0.003	0.002	0.000	0.003
Std.Errors	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL
Clusters (Agency)	9	9	16	9	9	8	9
Clusters (Source)	205	182	303	207	800	166	204
Clusters (url)	115,434	93,585	160,579	129,916	182,996	12,955	79,330

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Models uses MBFC media slant measure and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores. Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors.

Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (URL). Slant scores are based on MBFC categories.

DV is 1 if an article is matched to the articles cited in the agency briefings and 0 otherwise. Included Yahoo unless specified otherwise.

Table 27: Coefficient for Figure 3(ii) - Source+Date Match, Alternate Slant and Ideology Measures

	Article included in briefing (Source+Date match)					
	MBFC	MBFC, Alt Ideo	Allsides	Allsides, Alt Ideo	Guess	Guess, Alt Ideo
(Intercept)	0.339** (0.093)	0.236** (0.067)	0.314** (0.083)	0.219** (0.062)	0.404*** (0.097)	0.308*** (0.067)
Slant Right	0.047 (0.035)	-0.034 (0.050)	0.088* (0.035)	0.001 (0.061)	0.057 (0.035)	-0.042 (0.060)
Slant Center	-0.013 (0.052)	-0.019 (0.060)	-0.002 (0.055)	-0.035 (0.053)		
Agency Ideology	-0.023 (0.042)		-0.023 (0.039)		0.010 (0.049)	
Slant Right × Agency Ideology	-0.055 (0.044)		-0.046 (0.048)		-0.073 (0.052)	
Slant Center × Agency Ideology	-0.036 (0.043)		-0.044 (0.028)			
Agency Ideology (Napolio)		0.014 (0.009)		0.013 (0.008)		0.019* (0.009)
Slant Right × Agency Ideology (Napolio)		-0.002 (0.006)		0.001 (0.005)		-0.001 (0.005)
Slant Center × Agency Ideology (Napolio)		-0.003 (0.005)		-0.003+ (0.002)		
Num.Obs.	152376	152376	158276	158276	89356	89356
R2	0.007	0.016	0.008	0.017	0.004	0.025
R2 Adj.	0.007	0.016	0.008	0.017	0.004	0.025
Std.Errors	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL
Clusters (Agency)	15	15	15	15	15	15
Clusters (Source)	240	240	338	338	64	64
Clusters (url)	123,973	123,973	128,972	128,972	72,500	72,500

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Models uses MBFC media slant measure and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores. Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors.

Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (URL). Slant scores are based on MBFC categories.

DV is 1 if an article is matched to the articles cited in the agency briefings and 0 otherwise. Dropped Yahoo unless specified otherwise.

Table 28: Coefficient for Figure 3(ii) - URL Match, Alternate Slant and Ideology Measures

	Article included in briefing (URL match)					
	MBFC	MBFC, Alt Ideo	Allsides	Allsides, Alt Ideo	Guess	Guess, Alt Ideo
(Intercept)	0.183*** (0.020)	0.099* (0.038)	0.188*** (0.012)	0.102* (0.036)	0.264*** (0.015)	0.171** (0.050)
Slant Right	0.048+ (0.025)	0.011 (0.032)	0.074* (0.026)	0.021 (0.039)	0.071* (0.027)	-0.002 (0.047)
Slant Center	0.063+ (0.030)	0.058 (0.053)	-0.008 (0.023)	0.010 (0.021)		
Agency Ideology	-0.026 (0.029)		-0.033 (0.024)		-0.022 (0.031)	
Slant Right × Agency Ideology	-0.017 (0.029)		-0.018 (0.030)		-0.053 (0.032)	
Slant Center × Agency Ideology	-0.028 (0.028)		0.003 (0.025)			
Agency Ideology (Napolio)		0.008+ (0.004)		0.007+ (0.004)		0.010** (0.003)
Slant Right × Agency Ideology (Napolio)		0.000 (0.008)		0.003 (0.007)		0.000 (0.004)
Slant Center × Agency Ideology (Napolio)		-0.004 (0.005)		-0.002 (0.009)		
Num.Obs.	157257	157257	161926	161926	81851	81851
R2	0.003	0.008	0.005	0.009	0.002	0.006
R2 Adj.	0.003	0.008	0.005	0.009	0.002	0.006
Std.Errors	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL	by: Agency & Source & URL
Clusters (Agency)	9	9	9	9	9	9
Clusters (Source)	206	206	299	299	59	59
Clusters (url)	129,200	129,200	133,245	133,245	66,190	66,190

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Models uses MBFC media slant measure and Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores. Models use OLS with robust standard errors and clustered standard errors.

Errors clustered by the agency (Agency), news sources (Source), and article (URL). Slant scores are based on MBFC categories.

DV is 1 if an article is matched to the articles cited in the agency briefings and 0 otherwise. Included Yahoo unless specified otherwise.

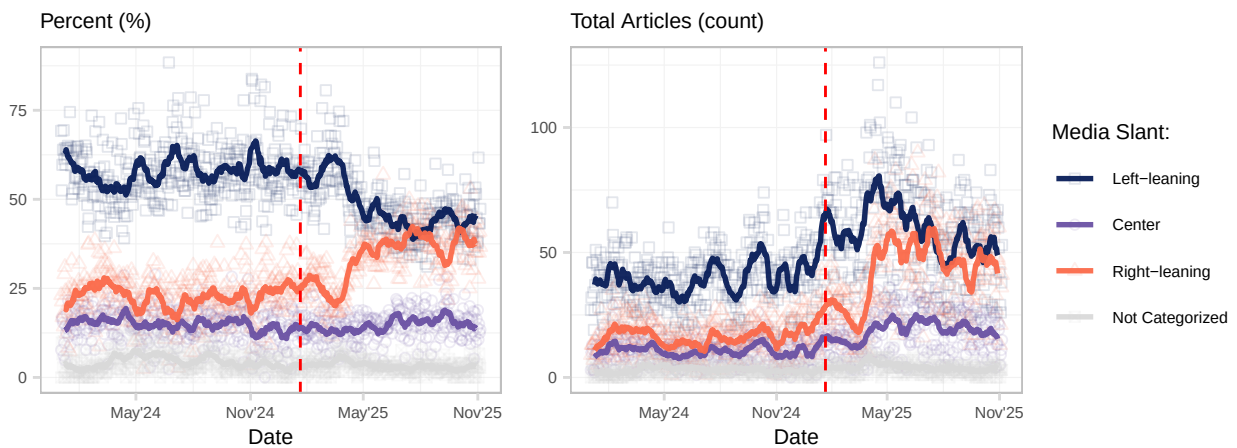
A.6. Figure 5 - Over-time partisan slant of sources

A.6.1. Over-time trends

Totals by briefing

Over-time Trends in Partisan Composition of Briefings

DHS Briefings



USCIS Briefings

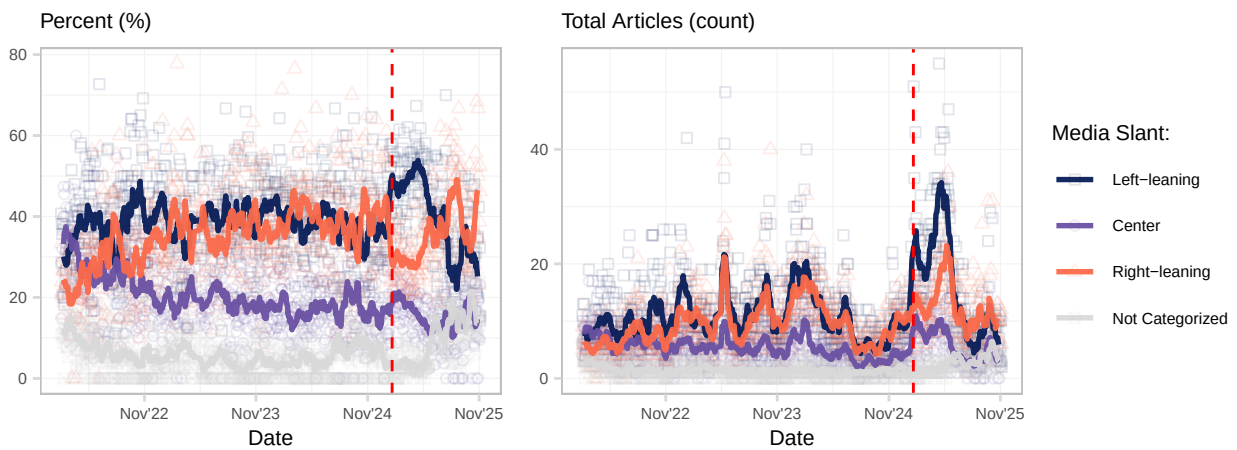
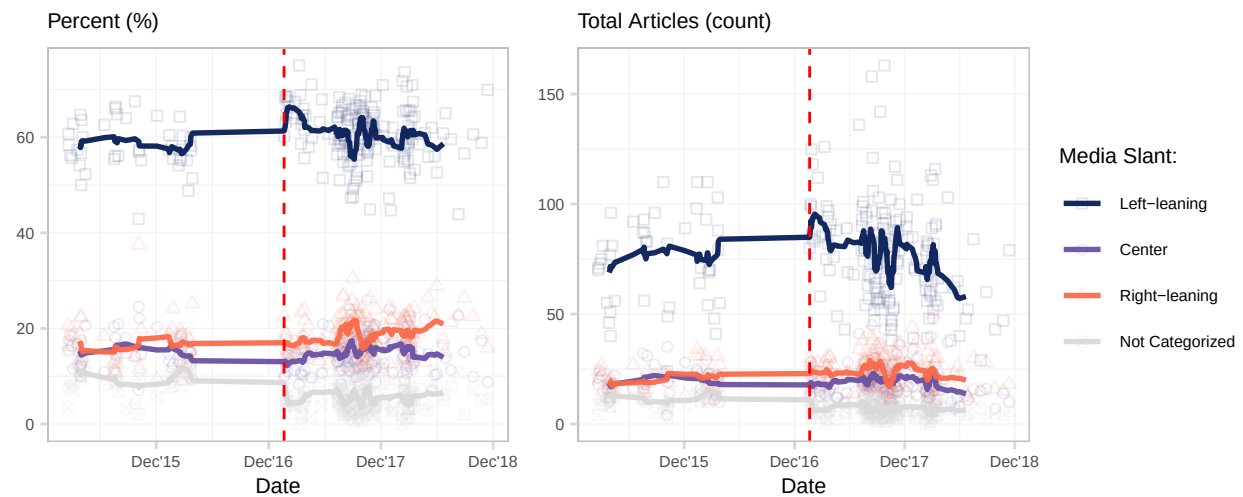


Figure A40: Over-time coverage from partisan sources in the DHS and USCIS news briefings. Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages.

Over-time Trends in Partisan Composition of Briefings

DOI Briefings



VA Briefings

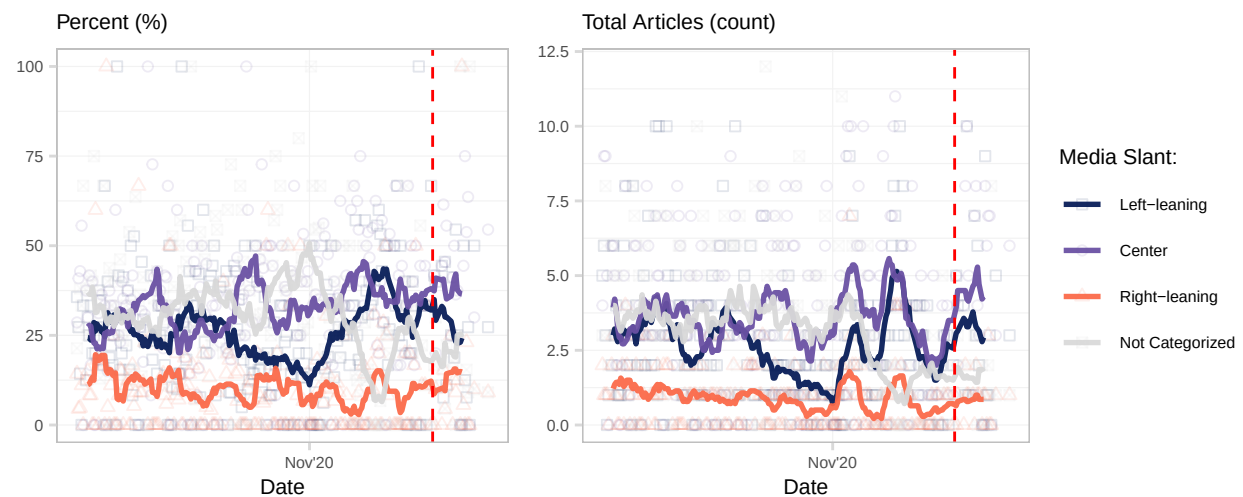
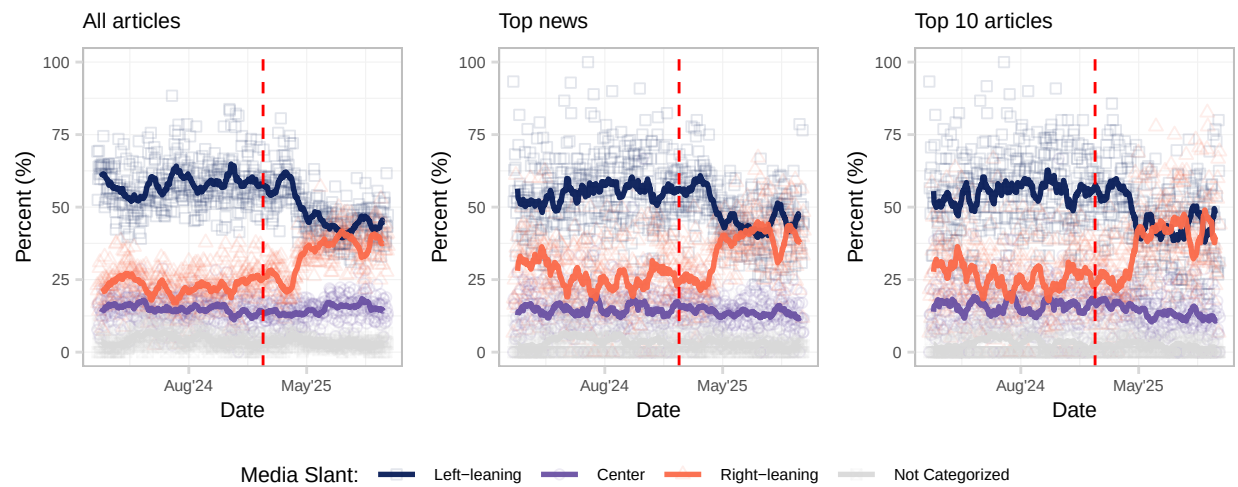


Figure A41: Over-time coverage from partisan sources in the DOI and VA news briefings. Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Dotted line at inauguration dates. Lines are 14-day rolling averages.

Top news sections

In Figure A42, I show how the composition of the news briefings changes when we look at only the beginning of the news summary. This is done in two ways. First, I subset to the 'Top news' section, which is the first and most important section of the briefing. Second, I subset to only the top 10 stories (note: each story can and usually does cite multiple articles).

Change in Top News Section DHS Briefings



USCIS Briefings

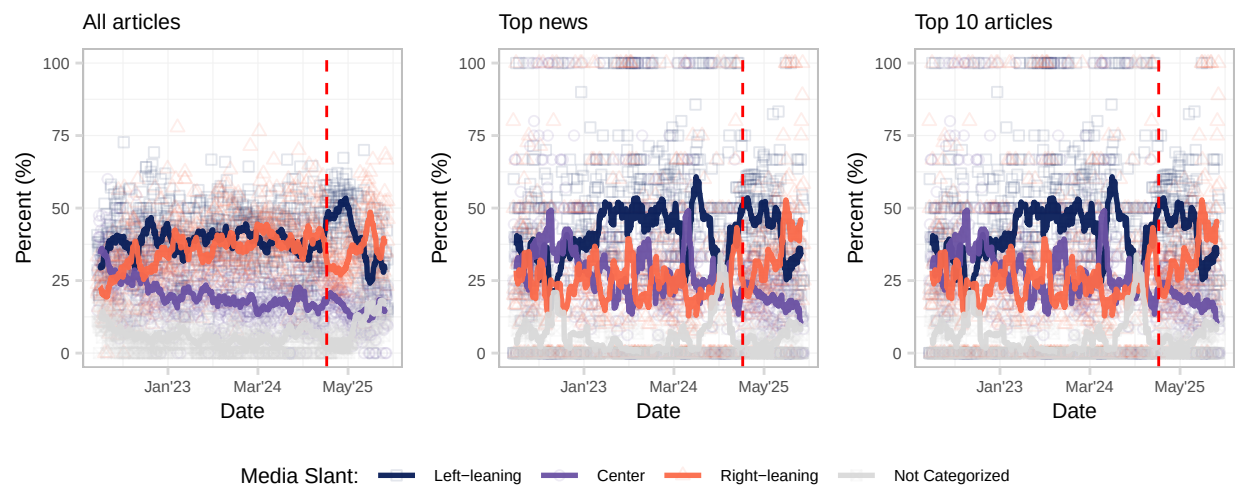


Figure A42: Over-time coverage from partisan sources at the beginning of the DHS and USCIS news briefings. Compares all articles to composition of articles in the 'Top News' section and the composition of the first 10 articles cited in each briefing. Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 3-week rolling averages.

Totals by briefing section

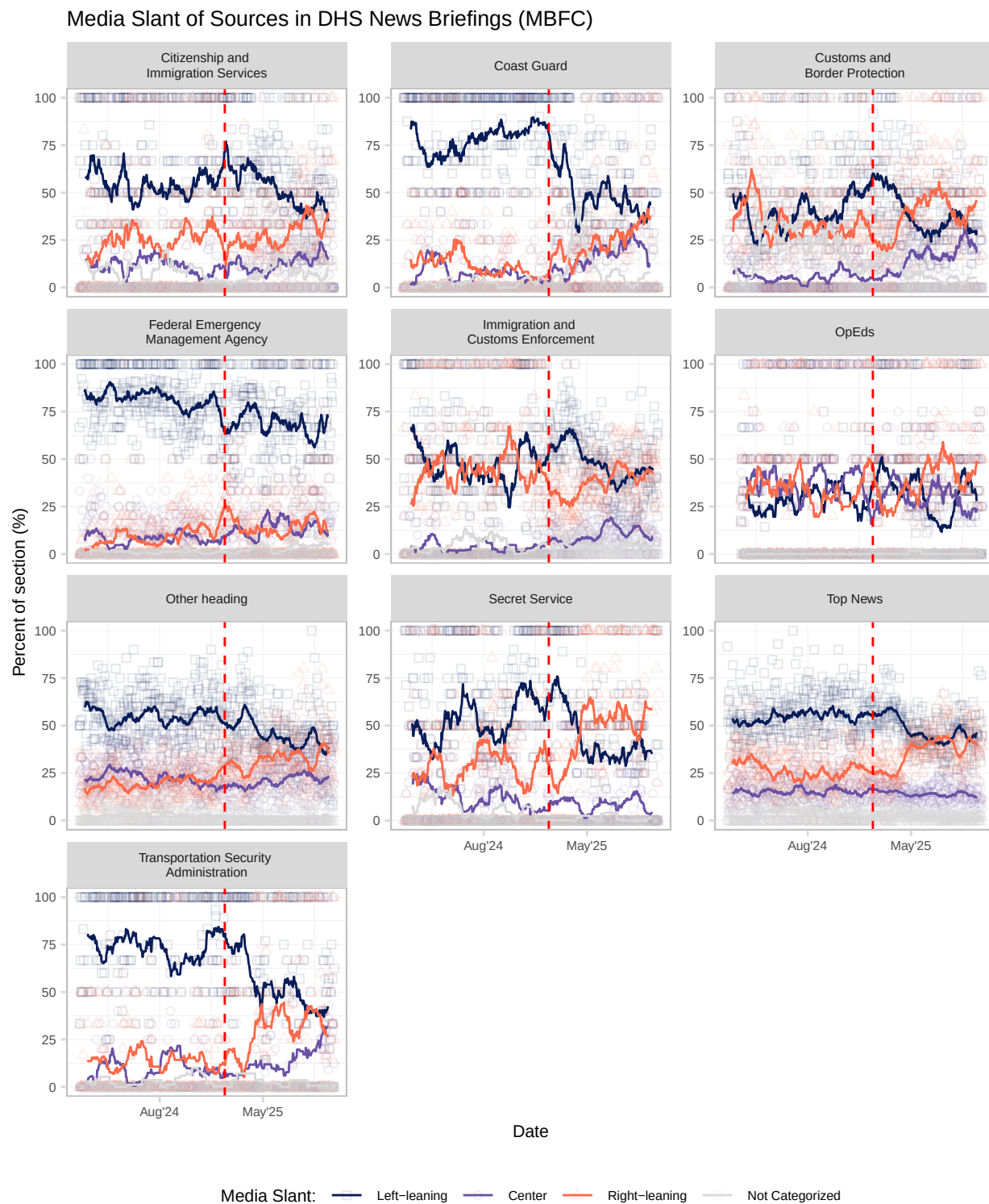


Figure A43: Over-time coverage from partisan sources in the DHS news briefings by heading. Each partisan slant category plotted as a percentage of total articles in the section. Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 28-day rolling averages.

Media Slant of Sources in DHS News Briefings (MBFC)

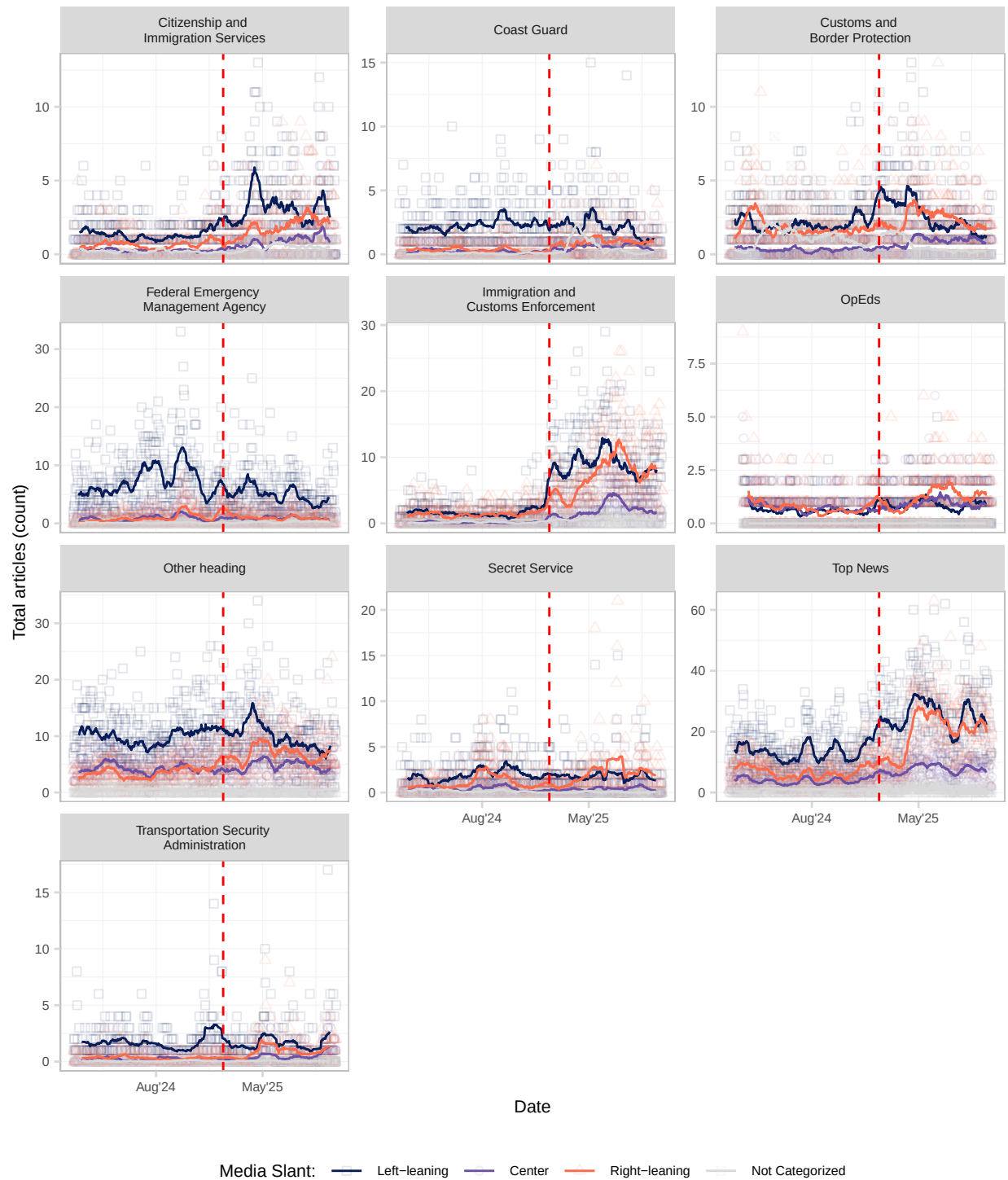


Figure A44: Over-time coverage from partisan sources in the DHS news briefings by heading. Total articles in each partisan slant category. Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 28-day rolling averages.

Media Slant of Sources in DOI News Briefings (MBFC)

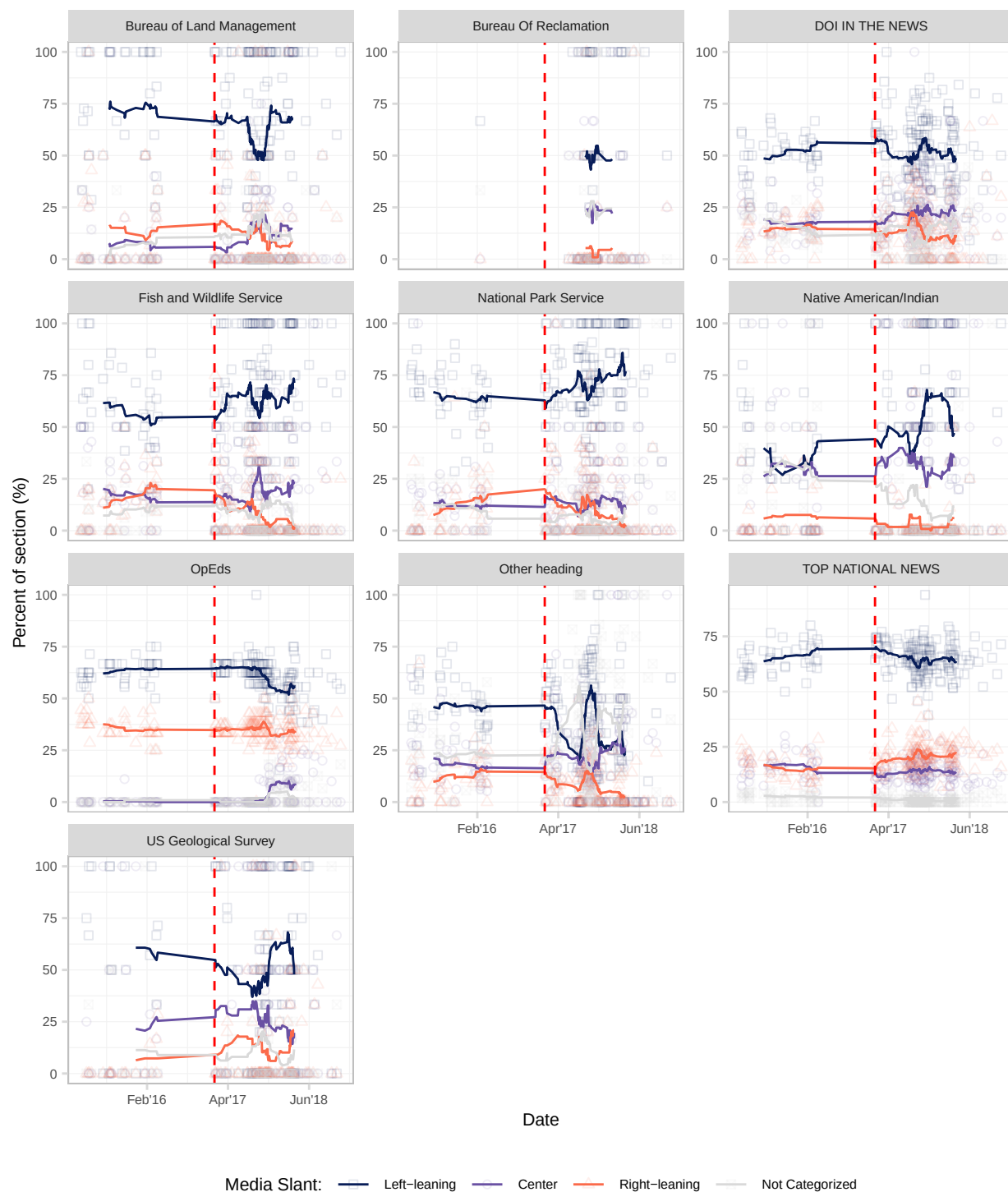


Figure A45: Over-time coverage from partisan sources in the DOI news briefings by heading. Each partisan slant category plotted as a percentage of total articles in the section. Dotted line at Trump's 2017 inauguration. Lines are 28-day rolling averages.

Media Slant of Sources in DOI News Briefings (MBFC)

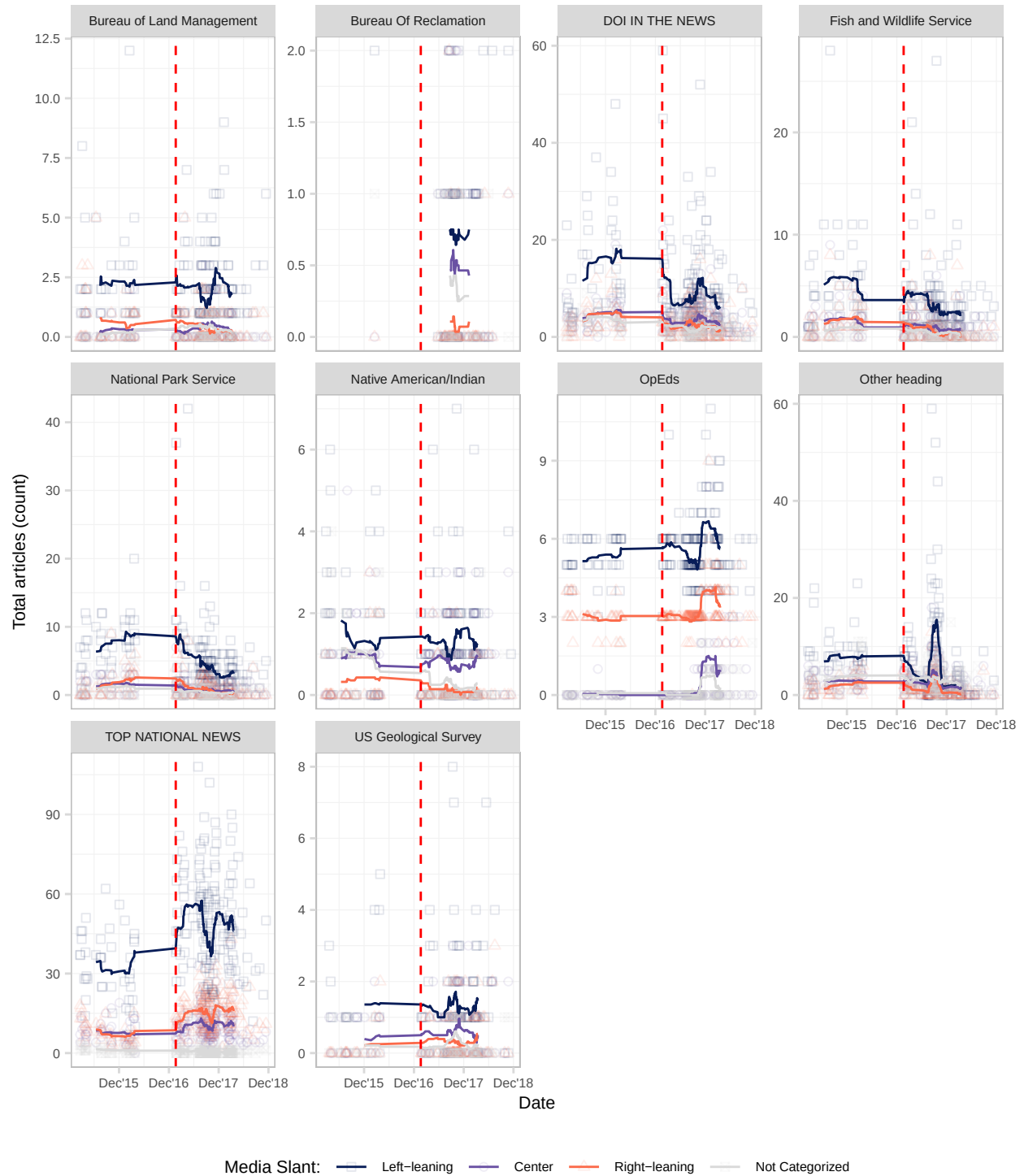


Figure A46: Over-time coverage from partisan sources in the DOI news briefings by heading. Total articles in each partisan slant category. Dotted line at Trump's 2017 inauguration. Lines are 28-day rolling averages.

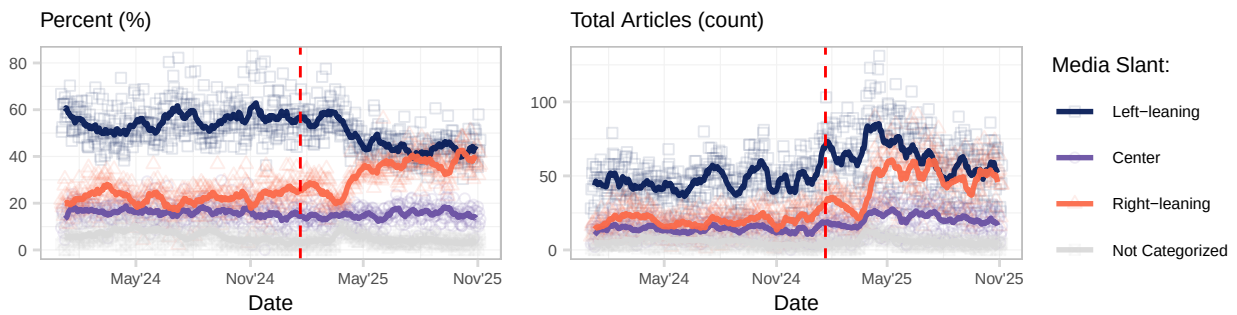
A.6.2. Robustness of Figure 5

To verify the robustness of the change observed in Figure 5, I replicate the results with different subsets of the data and measures of partisan slant.

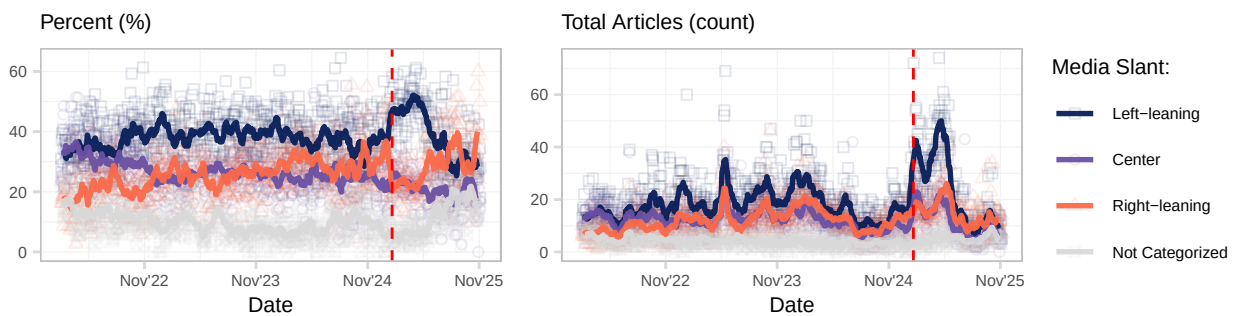
- Figure A47: Include articles from local general interest sources and government websites.
- Figure A48: Replace MBFC partisan slant with Allsides scores. Combined Allsides categories to match the MBFC categories.
- Figure A49: Replace MBFC partisan slant with Allsides scores. Original Allsides categories.
- Figure A50: Replace MBFC partisan slant with Guess (2021) scores. Recoded Guess into categories that match the MBFC categories.
- Figure A51: Plot over-time average continuous partisan slant using Guess (2021) scores.
- Figure A52: Distribution of continuous partisan bias scores in DHS briefing, grouped by month.
- Figure A53: Distribution of continuous partisan bias scores in USCIS briefing, grouped by quarter.

Keep local general interest sources and government websites

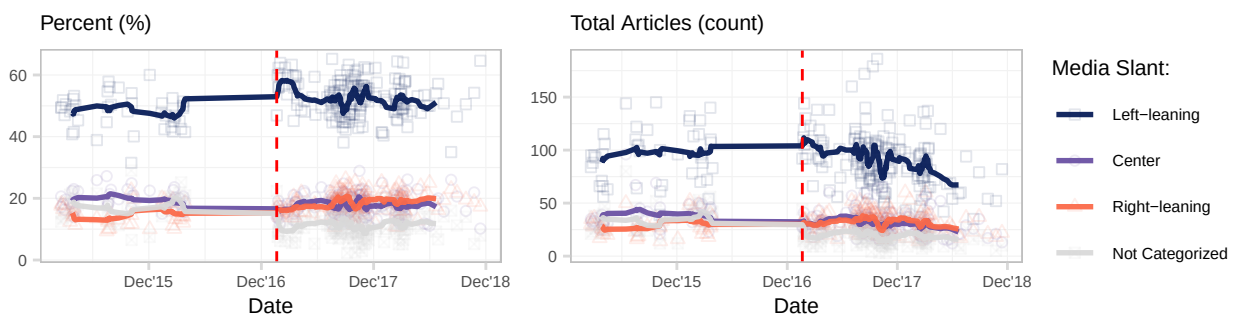
DHS Briefings



USCIS Briefings



DOI Briefings



VA Briefings

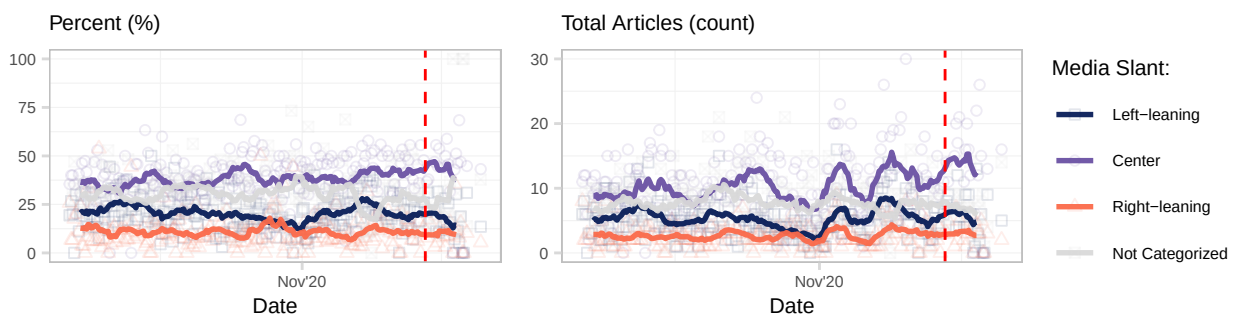
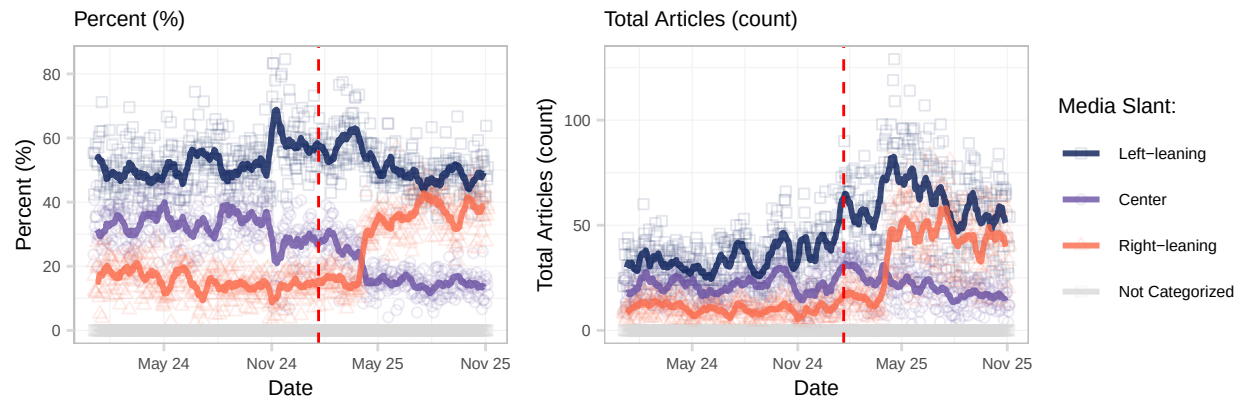


Figure A47: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Keep local general interest sources and government websites.

Over-time Composition of Partisan Bias (Allsides)

DHS Briefings



USCIS Briefings

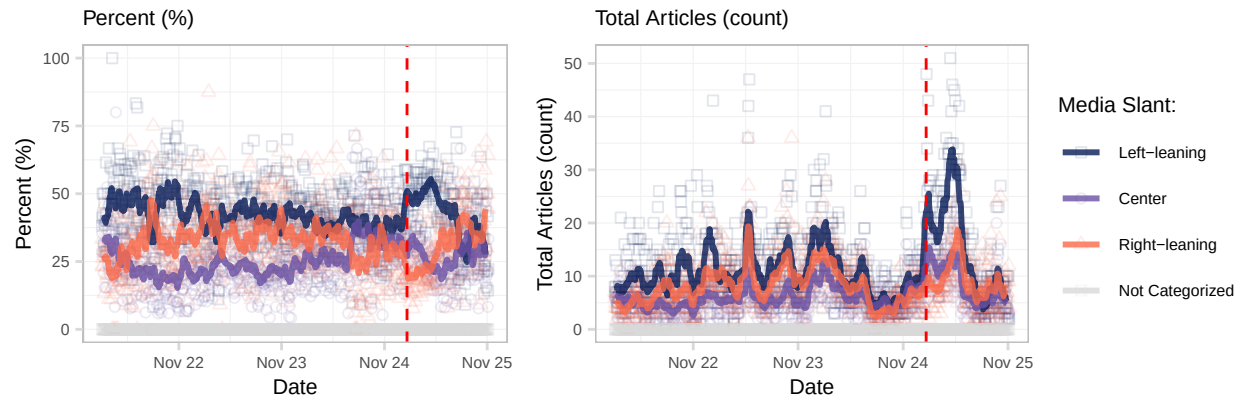
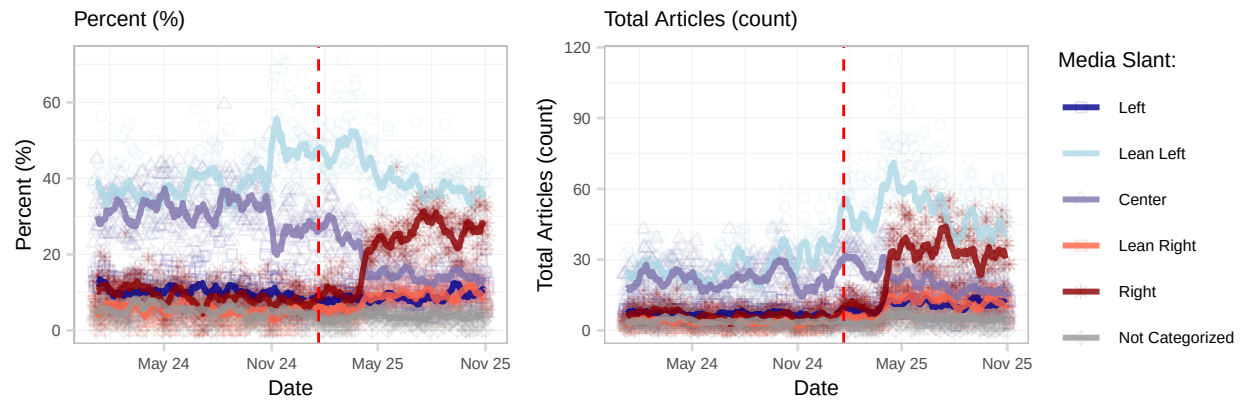


Figure A48: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Allsides partisan slant scores. Partisan media scores from Allsides. Left/Right-Leaning categories combined with Left/Right categories. Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

Over-time Composition of Partisan Bias (Allsides)

DHS Briefings



USCIS Briefings

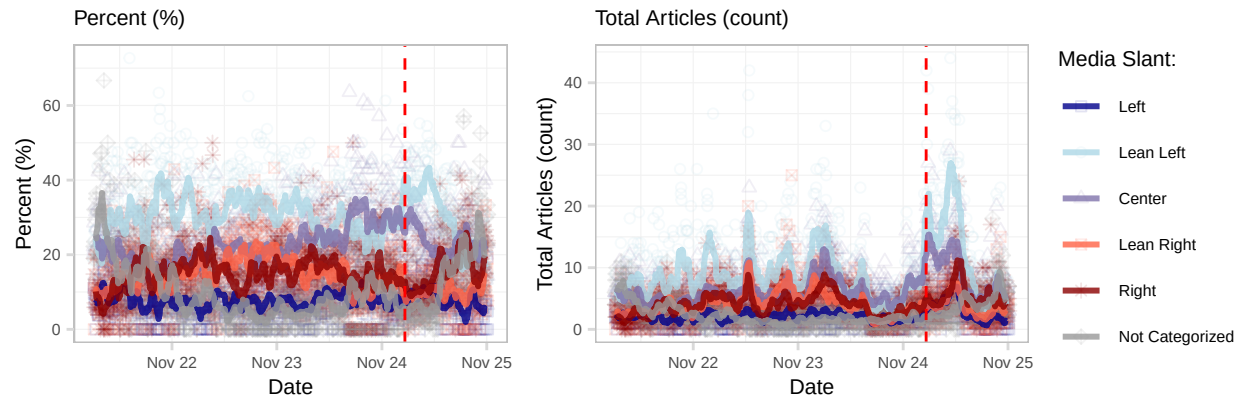
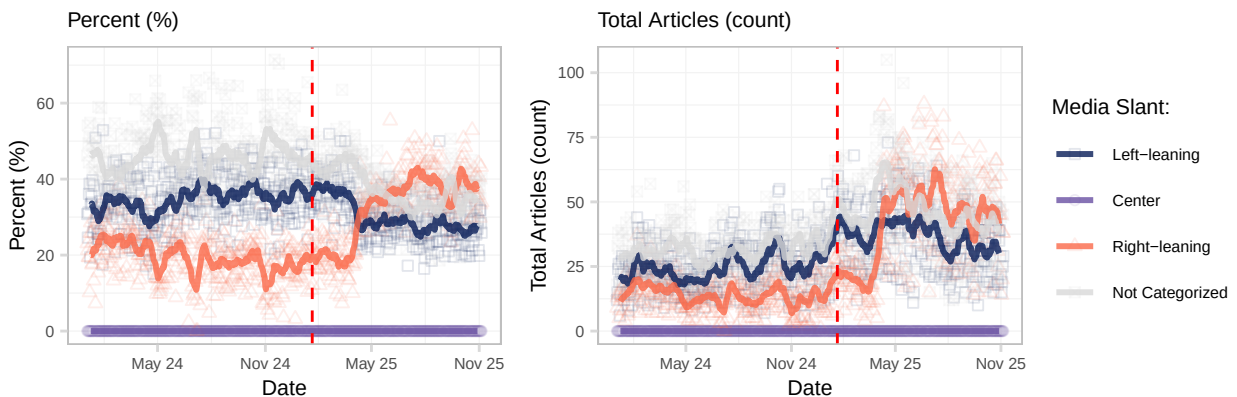


Figure A49: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Allsides partisan slant scores. Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

Over-time Composition of Partisan Bias (Guess 2021)

DHS Briefings



USCIS Briefings

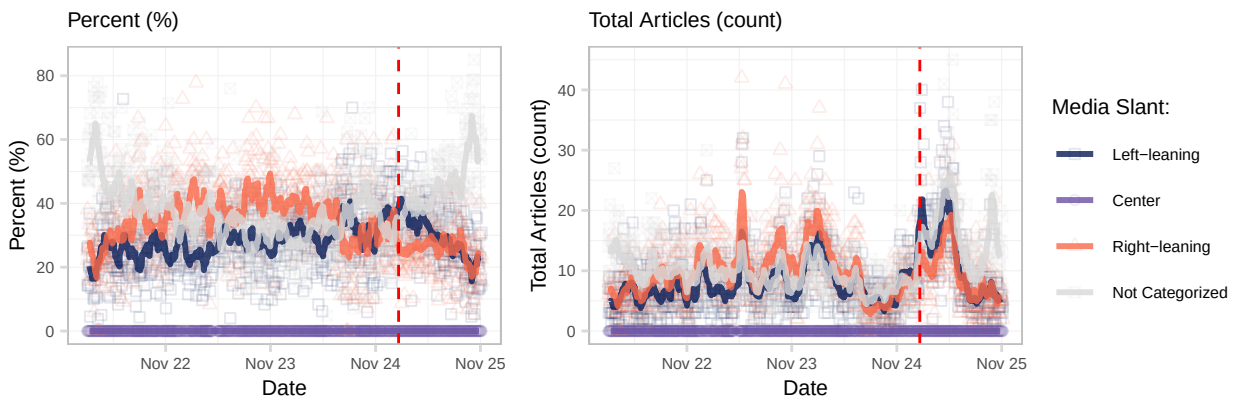


Figure A50: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Guess (2021) partisan slant scores. Left/Right-Leaning categories combined with Left/Right categories. Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

Average partisan slant score from Guess (2021)

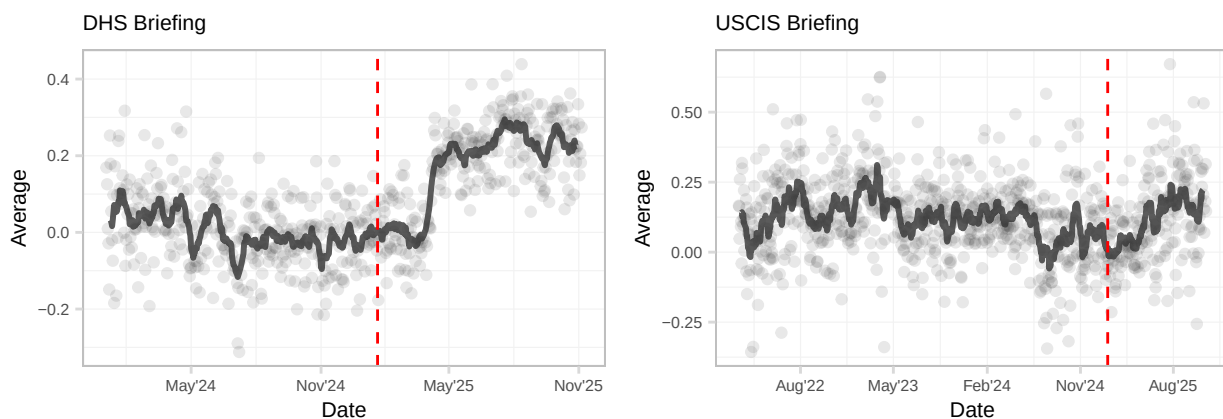
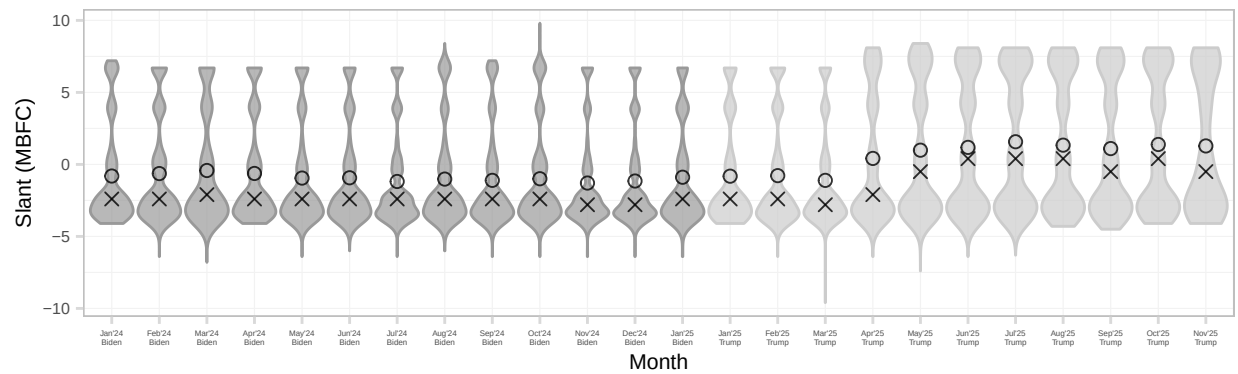


Figure A51: Average partisan bias score from Guess (2021) scores. Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

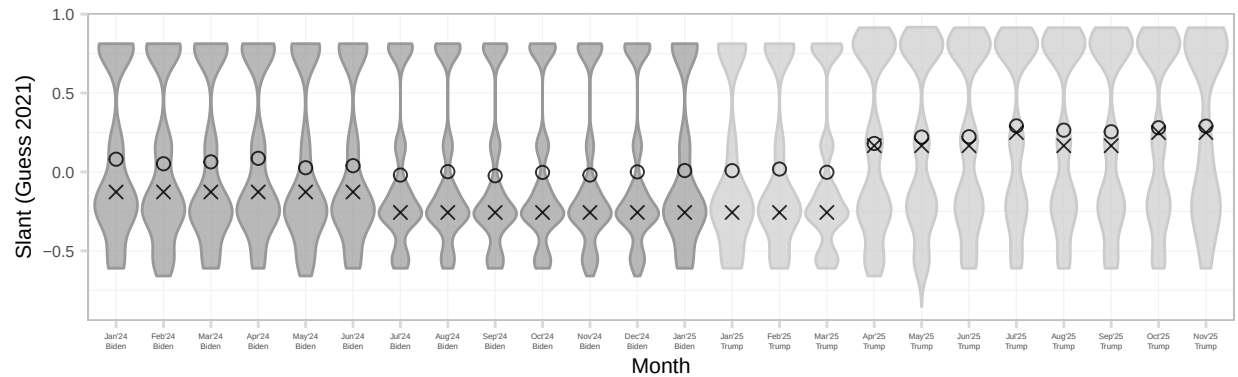
Distribution of DHS continuous partisan slant scores by month

MBFC continuous slant scores



Black x at median and circle at mean. Missing continuous bias ratings for 13% of sample.

Guess (2021) continuous slant scores

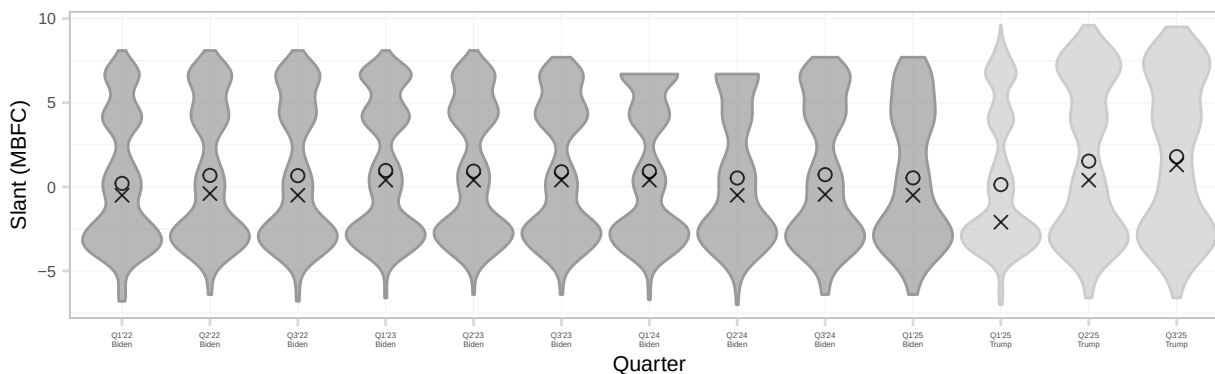


Black x at median and circle at mean. Missing continuous bias ratings for 41% of sample.

Figure A52: Over-time distribution of articles from partisan sources in the DHS news briefings. Continuous partisan media scores from MediaBiasFactCheck (MBFC) and Guess (2021). Continuous scores only available for some sources.

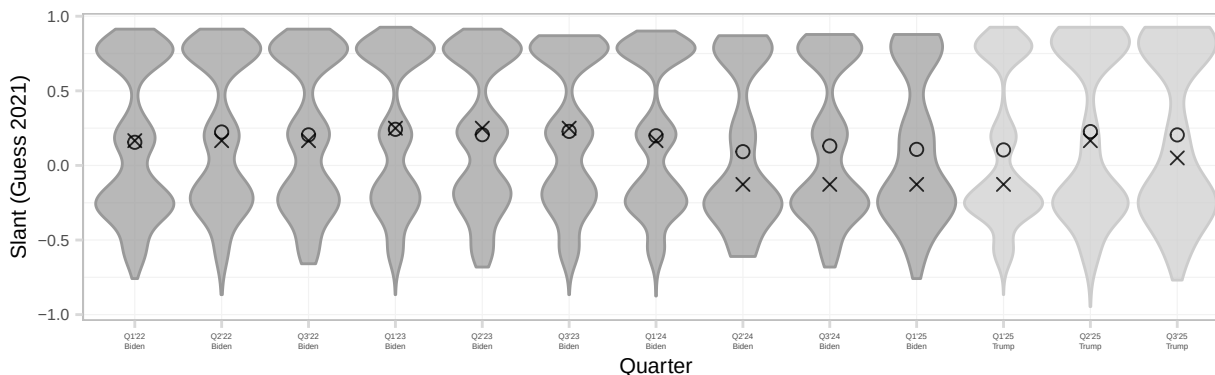
Distribution of USCIS continuous partisan slant scores by quarter

MBFC continuous slant scores



Black x at median and circle at mean. Missing continuous bias ratings for 18% of sample.

Guess (2021) continuous slant scores



Black x at median and circle at mean. Missing continuous bias ratings for 37% of sample.

Figure A53: Over-time distribution of articles from partisan sources in the USCIS news briefings. Continuous partisan media scores from MediaBiasFactCheck (MBFC) and Guess (2021). Continuous scores only available for some sources.

A.6.3. Supply-side analysis with matched data

In theory, the matched data could also be used to test whether supply explains the pattern of conservative in the briefings after March 2025. However, this comparison requires that the quality matched sample is stable over time and representative of the over-time changes in the content of the briefings. Below, I show that the matched sample is not representative. Although the point estimates suggest that the increase in right-leaning news is due to preferential selection, we should be cautious interpreting these results.

For this analysis, I use several variations of the matched data. First, I either (a) keep all of the sources cited at least once in the briefings, or I keep only the sources successfully matched at least once to the briefings. Next, I show the results for two different sets of keywords. (i) First, I show what happens when I only keep the articles that mention “Homeland Security” (DHS only). (ii) Second, I show what happens when I stack the data for all of the agencies in the DHS briefings (DHS agencies/DHS briefing). For each subagency, I search for its name in the Media Cloud database, stack the resulting set of articles, and match the stacked data to the entire DHS briefing. If an article is included anywhere on the DHS briefing, the DV (included) = 1.

Unless stated otherwise, I cluster by source and url. Partisan bias is assigned at the source-level. Because the data is stacked, an article could be included multiple times if it mentions multiple DHS agencies.

For the regression results, I modify the previous regression from A.5.2 to test whether the partisan leaning of an article’s source has become predictive of inclusion in the news briefings after March 2025. For completeness, I test this using two samples. First, I run the regression using all of the matched data for all nine DHS agencies and cluster by agency. Second, I run a simpler model with only the matched Media Cloud results for “Homeland Security.”

Without knowing the true number of articles published by each outlet, assessing the quality of Media Cloud’s data collection is difficult. However, there is some evidence that the quality of Media Cloud’s data collection varies over time, which could affect comparison across administrations.

Articles from the following sources change substantially partway through 2024:

- “bizpacreview.com” - missing after Sept 2024
- “business-standard.com” - only available from Sept to Oct 2024
- “cis.org” - missing after July 2024
- “ctvnews.ca” - missing after Jan 2025
- “politico.com” - missing after Feb 2024
- “thedailybeast.com” - missing after Oct 2024
- “voanews.com” - missing after march2024
- “washingtonpost.com” - missing after March 2024
- “washingtontimes.com” - missing after July 2024
- “theblaze.com” - highly reduced sample after Sept 2024
- “yahoo.com” - total articles drop by around 50-75% after October 2024

Unless stated otherwise, I drop all of the sources that stop being included in the Media Cloud sample. I keep blaze.com and yahoo.com, but I have experimented with dropping these as well. Doing so does not change the results.

As an initial test, I first plot the number of articles from each type of source over time, limiting the sample to only the articles matched to the Media Cloud sample (see Figure A54). If the Media Cloud sample is complete and articles are accurately matched by URL, this should reveal the composition of the articles that mention the DHS agencies by name. If the over-time pattern in the matched data is representative of the full briefing sample, we would expect to see the over-time patterns generally match. The level/intercept for each slant category may differ because it depends the exact set of sources included in the matched sample; however, the relative patterns should match. However, as can be seen in Figure A54, the trend-lines for liberal and conservative sources are very similar in the matched data. In comparison, in the actual briefing, the amount of news from liberal vs conservative sources diverge at times.

I plot different subsets of the DHS briefing data to test whether this discrepancy is because the matched sample only contains a subset of the sources in the full briefing. If so, we would expect the briefing data trendlines to differ when restricted to the sources in the matched sample. In Figure A55, I test a more expansive and a more restrictive set of matched sample sources. First, I test what happens when the briefing sample is restricted to the domains that exist in both the matched sample and one of the TechMIS briefings (DHS or USCIS). Second, I restrict the briefing sample to only domains that were successfully matched at least once to the briefing dataset. In either case, the pattern in Figure A55 is very similar to the whole briefing sample (Figure 5 in the paper).

Is matched-data representative? Probably not.

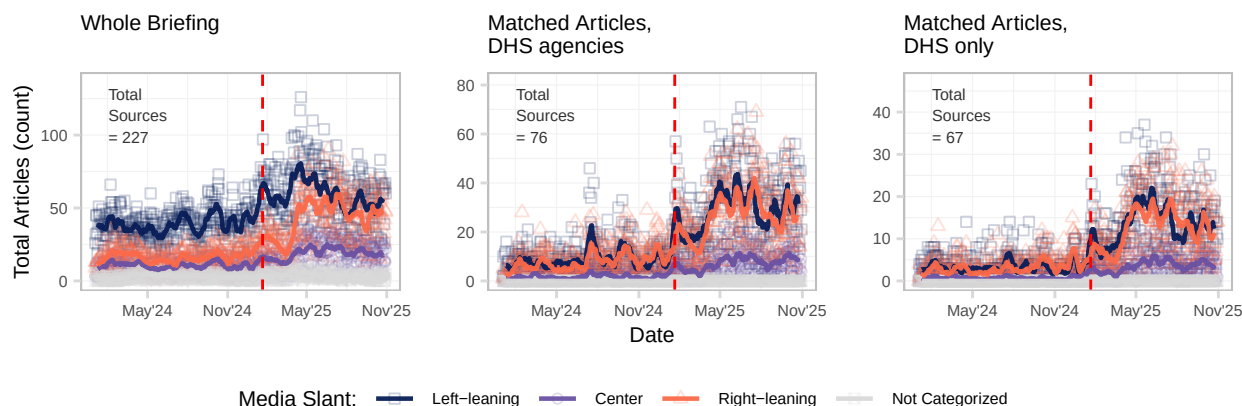


Figure A54: Over-time representativeness of DHS matched sample (included=1 only). Replication of Fig 5 in paper with media cloud articles that were matched to briefings. Dotted line at Trump’s 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages. Drops sources with incomplete Media Cloud data and international sources.

Composition of whole media cloud matched sample

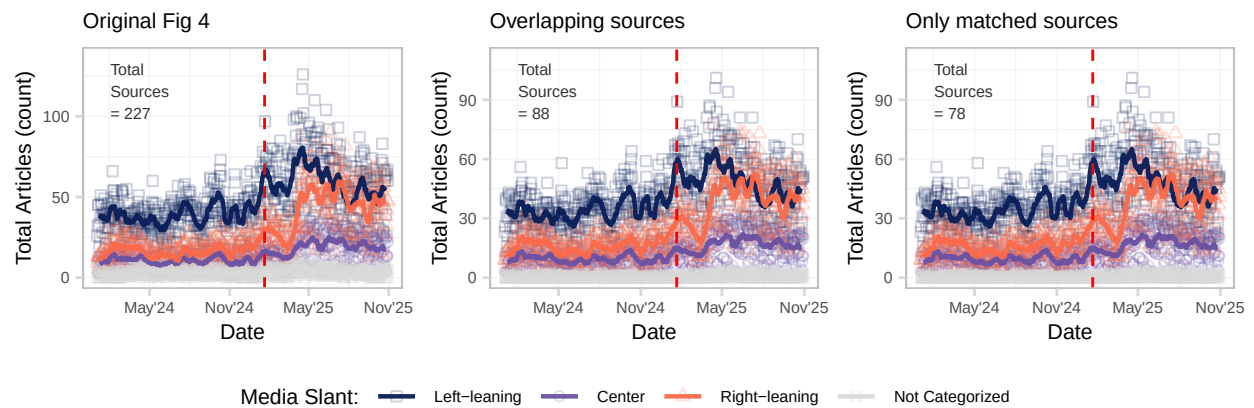


Figure A55: Over-time trend in DHS briefing data. Replication of Fig 5 in paper with domains in matched sample. Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages. Drops sources with incomplete Media Cloud data and international sources. Includes articles that mention DHS or one of its subagencies by name.

Regardless, we can test over-time changes in the supply of articles that mention DHS or one of its subagencies by name. Figure A56 shows the composition of the whole matched sample (including articles not matched to the DHS briefing) over time. It shows the composition when we look at all articles that mention DHS by name ("DHS only") and when we look at articles that mention DHS or any of the 7 DHS subagencies ("USICE", "USCIS", "USCBP", "FEMA", "CG", "TSA", "SS") by name ("DHS Agencies"). In Figure A57, I also check the pattern for several specific subagencies ("USICE", "USCIS", "FEMA").

Supply of news about DHS and DHS agencies

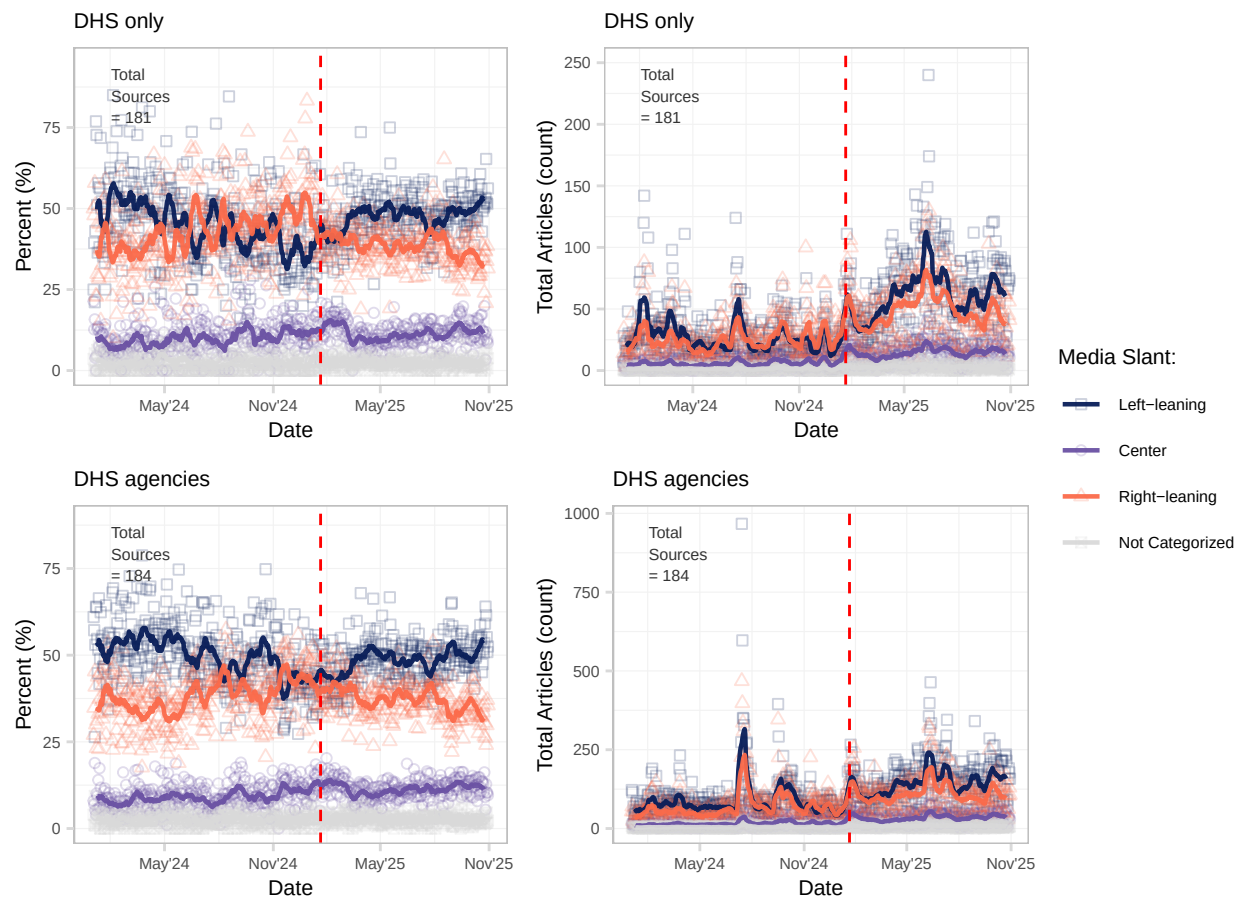


Figure A56: Partisan composition of articles in matched sample of data from Media Cloud. Sources limited to those found in TechMIS briefings (DHS and USCIS). Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages. Drops sources with incomplete Media Cloud data and international sources.

Supply of news about select DHS agencies

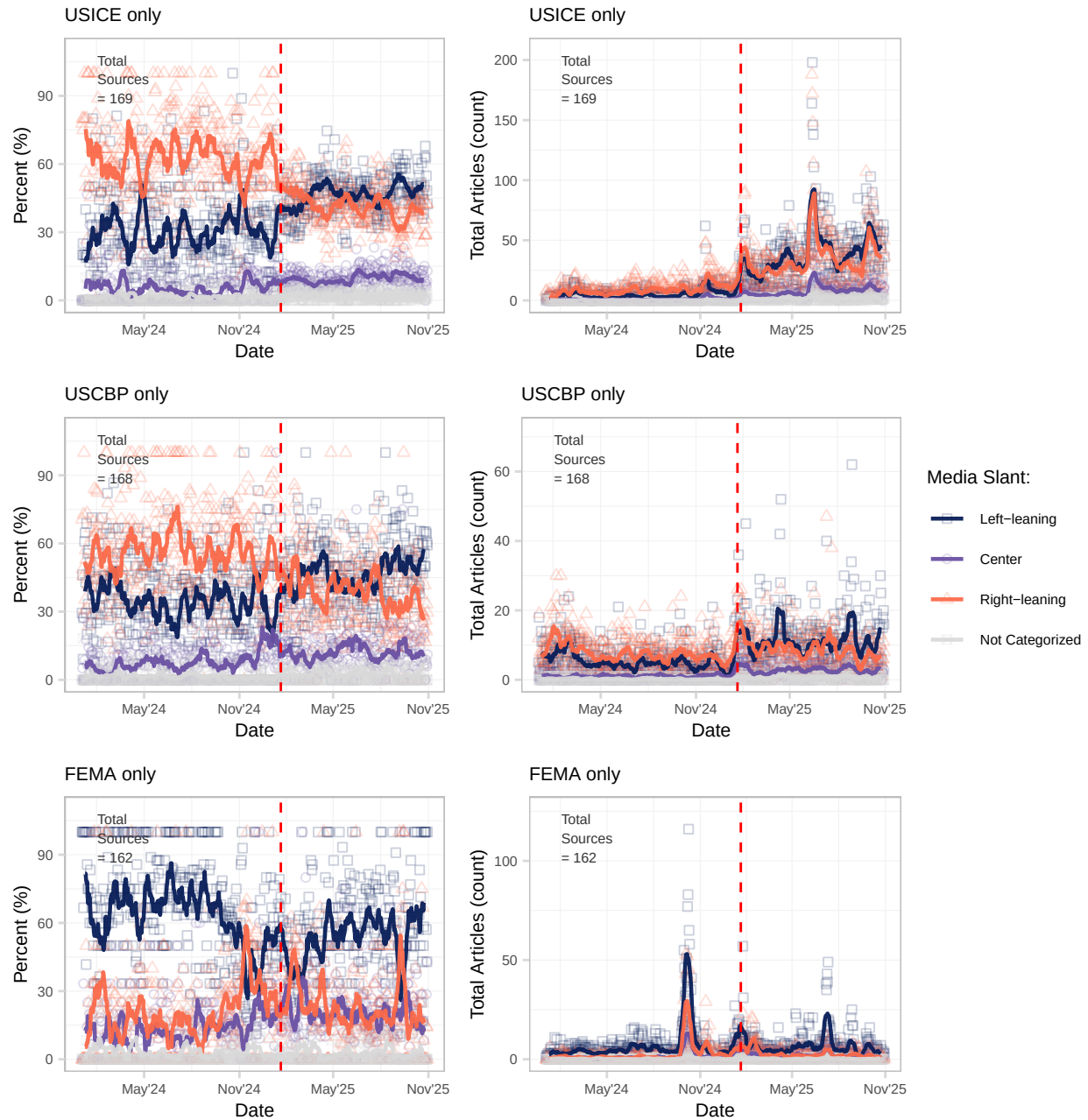


Figure A57: Articles found using Media Cloud queries by partisan source slant. Includes all queries for DHS agencies. Sources limited to those found in TechMIS briefings (DHS and USCIS). Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Dotted line at Trump's 2020 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages. Drops sources with incomplete Media Cloud data.

Next, we can calculate the probability that an article is included over time. When we look at the percent of articles that are matched to the briefings (included=1) in each partisan slant category (right-leaning, left-leaning, center, or not categorized article), we see that right-leaning articles appear to be included more often around April 2025 (see Figure A58). However, the change may not be significant (see Tables 29, 30, and 31).

Table 29: (DHS only) Relationship between media slant and Presidential term conditional on an article's publication

	DV: 1 if article included in news briefing, 0 otherwise			
	Biden	Trump		
	Jan'24-Jan'25 (Biden)	Jan'25-Oct'25 (Trump)	Jan'25-Mar'25 (Trump)	Apr'25-Oct'25 (Trump)
(Intercept)	0.116** (0.041)	0.218*** (0.054)	0.202*** (0.046)	0.222*** (0.056)
Slant Right-leaning	0.003 (0.066)	0.038 (0.084)	-0.040 (0.084)	0.059 (0.091)
Slant Not Categorized	-0.116** (0.041)	-0.210*** (0.055)	-0.196*** (0.046)	-0.212*** (0.057)
Slant Center	0.011 (0.058)	0.021 (0.094)	-0.043 (0.082)	0.041 (0.096)
Num.Obs.	22796	36247	7198	29199
R2	0.004	0.009	0.008	0.012
R2 Adj.	0.003	0.009	0.008	0.011
RMSE	0.32	0.42	0.38	0.43
Std.Errors	by: Source & URL	by: Source & URL	by: Source & URL	by: Source & URL

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Data limited to articles mentioning 'Homeland Security' and news sources cited at least once in the DHS or USCIS news briefings. Models use OLS with robust standard errors. Slant scores are based on MBFC categories. Left-leaning sources are the reference category for media slant.

What % of articles are included in the DHS briefing?

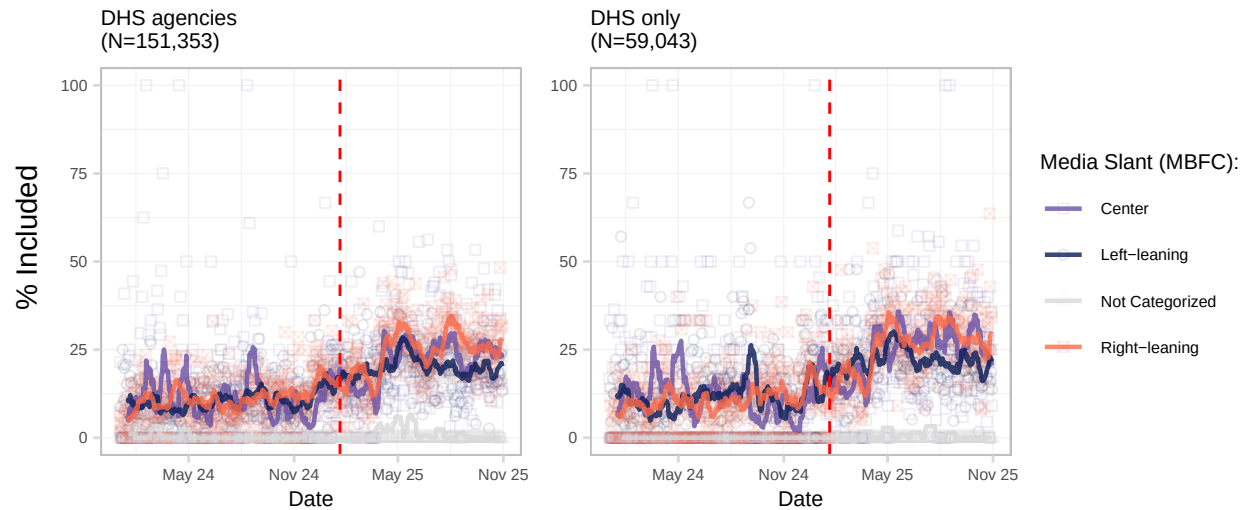


Figure A58: Over-time probability of coverage by partisan source category in the DHS news briefings. Sample limited to agencies in the DHS briefing. Outcome variable is binary indicator (1 if article included in news summary, 0 otherwise). Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day right-aligned rolling averages (for each date, average includes values for that date and 13 previous values).

Table 30: (DHS only) Relationship between media slant and Presidential term conditional on an article's publication

	DV: 1 if article included in news briefing, 0 otherwise			
	Biden	Trump	Trump	
	Jan'24-Jan'25 (Biden)	Jan'25-Oct'25 (Trump)	Jan'25-Mar'25 (Trump)	Apr'25-Oct'25 (Trump)
(Intercept)	0.101* (0.036)	0.199** (0.046)	0.181** (0.047)	0.204** (0.047)
Slant Right-leaning	0.014 (0.057)	0.039 (0.068)	-0.020 (0.077)	0.057 (0.074)
Slant Not Categorized	-0.099* (0.037)	-0.189** (0.048)	-0.173** (0.049)	-0.192** (0.048)
Slant Center	0.013 (0.048)	0.013 (0.073)	-0.037 (0.069)	0.028 (0.074)
Num.Obs.	66734	84619	18205	66744
R2	0.004	0.009	0.007	0.011
R2 Adj.	0.004	0.009	0.007	0.011
RMSE	0.31	0.41	0.37	0.41
Std.Errors	by: Source & Agency & URL	by: Source & Agency & URL	by: Source & Agency & URL	by: Source & Agency & URL

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001

Note: Data includes articles mentioning 'Homeland Security' or its subagencies and news sources cited at least once in the DHS or USCIS news briefings. Models use OLS with robust standard errors. Slant scores are based on MBFC categories. Left-leaning sources are the reference category for media slant.

Table 31: Relationship between media slant and Presidential term conditional on an article's publication

	DV: 1 if article included in news briefing, 0 otherwise	
	DHS only	DHS briefing
(Intercept)	0.115 (0.041)**	0.101 (0.036)*
Slant Right-Leaning	0.004 (0.066)	0.015 (0.057)
Slant not Categorized	-0.115 (0.041)**	-0.098 (0.037)*
Slant Center	0.010 (0.058)	0.013 (0.048)
Trump (Pre-April)	0.087 (0.022)***	0.080 (0.016)**
Trump (Post-April)	0.107 (0.031)***	0.103 (0.018)***
Slant Right-leaning:Trump (Pre-April)	-0.043 (0.031)	-0.034 (0.021)
Slant Right-leaning:Trump (Post-April)	0.055 (0.080)	0.042 (0.068)
Slant not Categorized:Trump (Pre-April)	-0.081 (0.022)***	-0.074 (0.019)**
Slant not Categorized:Trump (Post-April)	-0.097 (0.031)**	-0.094 (0.019)**
Slant Center:Trump (Pre-April)	-0.053 (0.058)	-0.049 (0.042)
Slant Center:Trump (Post-April)	0.031 (0.071)	0.016 (0.043)
Num.Obs.	59043	151353
R2	0.033	0.030
R2 Adj.	0.032	0.030
RMSE	0.38	0.36
Std.Errors	by: Source & URL	by: Source & URL & Agency

Note: Data limited to articles mentioning DHS agencies and news sources cited at least once in the DHS news briefings. DHS-only model includes only articles mentioning DHS and uses OLS with robust standard errors. DHS-agencies model includes all agencies on the DHS briefing and clusters the standard errors by agency. Left-leaning sources are the reference category for media slant. For president, briefings during the Biden administration (Jan 2, 2024 to Jan 19, 2025) are the reference category.

A.6.4. Top sources (USCIS and DHS)

DHS Top Sources

The following tables show how the composition of the DHS briefings changed after March 31, 2025. Results are broken down by source.

- Figure 32: The first table shows the number of articles before and after this cutpoint for the most common sources, ranked using their popularity after March 2025.
- Figure 33: The second table, shows the number of articles from all right-leaning sources before and after March 31, 2025.
- Figure 34: The third table shows the number of articles in the *Top News* section of the DHS briefing before and after March 31, 2025.

Table 32: Top Sources in DHS Briefings. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in DHS briefings during each time period. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

Source	Slant (MBFC)	Factual Rating (MBFC)	Rank (Pre-April)	Rank (Post-April)	Total Articles (Pre-April)	Total Articles (Post-April)
foxnews.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	2	1	3,016	2,757
apnews.com	Left-leaning	High	3	2	2,790	1,972
cbsnews.com	Left-leaning	High	5	3	2,323	1,901
thehill.com	Center	Mostly Factual	8	4	1,672	1,523
breitbart.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	5	-	1,502
nytimes.com	Left-leaning	High	6	6	2,119	1,436
reuters.com	Center	Very High	7	7	1,698	1,258
washingtonexaminer.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	9	8	1,611	1,244
newsmax.com	Right-leaning	Low	-	9	-	1,049
cnn.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	10	10	1,212	1,040
washingtonpost.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	12	11	1,151	975
nypost.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	49	12	13	949
nbcnews.com	Left-leaning	High	11	13	1,186	761
usatoday.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	14	14	836	709
go.com	Left-leaning	High	13	15	850	705
npr.org	Left-leaning	High	15	16	704	675
axios.com	Left-leaning	High	23	17	283	659
dailycaller.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	18	-	539
latimes.com	Center	High	20	19	383	524
wsj.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	18	20	538	508
bloomberg.com	Left-leaning	High	17	21	601	498
univision.com	Left-leaning	High	21	22	342	481
newsnationnow.com	Center	High	52	23	9	478
theblaze.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	24	-	460
yahoo.com	Left-leaning	High	1	25	3,554	407
dailywire.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	75	26	3	356
politico.com	Left-leaning	High	26	27	203	321
dailysignal.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	28	-	227
cyberscoop.com	Center	High	31	29	135	214
washingtontimes.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	30	30	139	210
foxbusiness.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	34	31	91	139
thefederalist.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	32	-	134

Table 32: Top Sources in DHS Briefings. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in DHS briefings during each time period. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites. *(continued)*

Source	Slant (MBFC)	Factual Rating (MBFC)	Rank (Pre-April)	Rank (Post-April)	Total Articles (Pre-April)	Total Articles (Post-April)
federalnewsnetwork.com	Center	High	25	33	257	131
telemundo.com	Not Categorized	-	28	34	163	130
newsweek.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	4	35	2,463	127
bloomberglaw.com	Not Categorized	-	56	36	7	109
telemundo51.com	Not Categorized	-	33	37	92	102
telemundo52.com	Not Categorized	-	40	38	31	90
bloombergtax.com	Not Categorized	-	-	39	-	86
rollcall.com	Center	Very High	29	40	158	73
hstoday.us	Not Categorized	-	42	41	26	54
freebeacon.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	42	-	42
nbc.com	Not Categorized	-	39	43	34	36
upi.com	Center	High	35	44	66	35
bgov.com	Not Categorized	-	71	45	3	34
borderreport.com	Not Categorized	-	16	46	648	31
nationalreview.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	-	47	-	27
defensescoop.com	Center	High	45	48	15	24
fedscope.com	Center	High	37	49	43	24
maritime-executive.com	Not Categorized	-	78	50	3	23
telemundoareadelabaha.com	Not Categorized	-	43	51	23	23
telemundo47.com	Not Categorized	-	46	52	15	20
usnews.com	Left-leaning	High	36	53	54	19
statescoop.com	Center	High	44	54	22	18
latintimes.com	Left-leaning	High	-	55	-	13
marinelink.com	Not Categorized	-	77	56	3	11
meritalk.com	Not Categorized	-	24	57	268	11
dailymail.co.uk	Right-leaning	Low	-	58	-	9
justthenews.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	59	-	9
stripes.com	Center	High	164	60	1	9
youtu.be	Not Categorized	-	70	61	4	9
foxweather.com	Not Categorized	-	51	62	10	8
outkick.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	63	-	8
cnbc.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	32	64	122	7
msnbc.com	Left-leaning	Mixed	50	65	12	6
abc.com	Not Categorized	-	-	66	-	5
aol.com	Left-leaning	High	82	67	2	5
homelandprepnews.com	Not Categorized	-	88	68	2	5
newsmatv.com	Not Categorized	-	-	69	-	5
pbs.org	Left-leaning	High	38	70	37	5
rollingstone.com	Left-leaning	High	158	71	1	5
seapowermagazine.org	Not Categorized	-	59	72	6	5
breakingdefense.com	Right-leaning	High	112	73	1	4
caribbeanationalweekly.com	Not Categorized	-	84	74	2	4
cubaheadlines.com	Not Categorized	-	-	75	-	4

Table 33: Right-leaning Sources in DHS Briefings. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in DHS briefings during each time period. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

Source	MBFC FactualReporting Rating	Days Pre- April	Days Post- April	Articles Pre- April	Articles Post- April	Articles/ day Pre- April	Articles/ day Post- April	Diff (Ar- ticles/ day)	%Articles Pre- April	%Articles Post- April	Diff(%)
breitbart.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1,502	0.000	7.019	7.019	0.000	5.332	5.332
foxnews.com	Mixed	441	214	3,016	2,757	6.839	12.883	6.044	9.063	9.787	0.724
newsmax.com	Low	441	214	0	1,049	0.000	4.902	4.902	0.000	3.724	3.724
nypost.com	Mixed	441	214	13	949	0.029	4.435	4.405	0.039	3.369	3.330
dailycaller.com	Mixed	441	214	0	539	0.000	2.519	2.519	0.000	1.913	1.913
washingtonexaminer.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	1,611	1,244	3.653	5.813	2.160	4.841	4.416	-0.425
theblaze.com	Mixed	441	214	0	460	0.000	2.150	2.150	0.000	1.633	1.633
dailywire.com	Mixed	441	214	3	356	0.007	1.664	1.657	0.009	1.264	1.255
wsj.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	538	508	1.220	2.374	1.154	1.617	1.803	0.187
dailysignal.com	Mixed	441	214	0	227	0.000	1.061	1.061	0.000	0.806	0.806
washingtontimes.com	Mixed	441	214	139	210	0.315	0.981	0.666	0.418	0.746	0.328
thefederalist.com	Mixed	441	214	0	134	0.000	0.626	0.626	0.000	0.476	0.476
foxbusiness.com	Mixed	441	214	91	139	0.206	0.650	0.443	0.273	0.493	0.220
freebeacon.com	Mixed	441	214	0	42	0.000	0.196	0.196	0.000	0.149	0.149
nationalreview.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	0	27	0.000	0.126	0.126	0.000	0.096	0.096
dailymail.co.uk	Low	441	214	0	9	0.000	0.042	0.042	0.000	0.032	0.032
justthenews.com	Mixed	441	214	0	9	0.000	0.042	0.042	0.000	0.032	0.032
outkick.com	Mixed	441	214	0	8	0.000	0.037	0.037	0.000	0.028	0.028
breakingdefense.com	High	441	214	1	4	0.002	0.019	0.016	0.003	0.014	0.011
lawenforcementtoday.com	Mixed	441	214	1	3	0.002	0.014	0.012	0.003	0.011	0.008
fortune.com	High	441	214	0	2	0.000	0.009	0.009	0.000	0.007	0.007
oann.com	Low	441	214	0	2	0.000	0.009	0.009	0.000	0.007	0.007
thepostmillennial.com	Mixed	441	214	0	2	0.000	0.009	0.009	0.000	0.007	0.007
voz.us	Mixed	441	214	0	2	0.000	0.009	0.009	0.000	0.007	0.007
americanmilitarynews.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
bizpacreview.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
business-standard.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
dnyuz.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
dupagepolicyjournal.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
express.co.uk	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
financialexpress.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
mrctv.org	Low	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
newsbusters.org	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
tennesseconservativenews.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
themailwire.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
thetstreet.com	High	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
timesnownews.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
tpusa.com	Low	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
westernjournal.com	Mixed	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
worldtribune.com	Low	441	214	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.004	0.004
ntd.com	Mixed	441	214	1	1	0.002	0.005	0.002	0.003	0.004	0.001
thedispatch.com	High	441	214	1	1	0.002	0.005	0.002	0.003	0.004	0.001
thedefensepost.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	2	1	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.006	0.004	-0.002
citizen.co.za	High	441	214	1	0	0.002	0.000	-0.002	0.003	0.000	-0.003
slaynews.com	Very Low	441	214	1	0	0.002	0.000	-0.002	0.003	0.000	-0.003
standardmedia.co.ke	Mixed	441	214	1	0	0.002	0.000	-0.002	0.003	0.000	-0.003
the-express.com	Mixed	441	214	1	0	0.002	0.000	-0.002	0.003	0.000	-0.003
tj.news	High	441	214	1	0	0.002	0.000	-0.002	0.003	0.000	-0.003
the-sun.com	Mixed	441	214	4	1	0.009	0.005	-0.004	0.012	0.004	-0.008
thecentersquare.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	14	3	0.032	0.014	-0.018	0.042	0.011	-0.031
newsweek.com	Mostly Factual	441	214	2,463	127	5.585	0.593	-4.992	7.402	0.451	-6.951

Table 34: Right-leaning Sources in DHS Top News Section. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in the Top News sections of the DHS briefings during each time period. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

Source	MBFC FactualReporting Rating	Articles Pre- April	Articles Post- April	Articles/ day Pre- April	Articles/ day Post- April	Diff (Ar- ticles/ day)	%Articles Pre- April	%Articles Post- April	Diff(%)
breitbart.com	Mixed	0	665	0.000	3.107	3.107	0.000	5.385	5.385
foxnews.com	Mixed	1,328	1,263	3.011	5.902	2.891	11.050	10.228	-0.823
newsmax.com	Low	0	514	0.000	2.402	2.402	0.000	4.162	4.162
nypost.com	Mixed	3	386	0.007	1.804	1.797	0.025	3.126	3.101
dailycaller.com	Mixed	0	285	0.000	1.332	1.332	0.000	2.308	2.308
washingtonexaminer.com	Mostly Factual	808	653	1.832	3.051	1.219	6.723	5.288	-1.435
theblaze.com	Mixed	0	232	0.000	1.084	1.084	0.000	1.879	1.879
dailywire.com	Mixed	0	208	0.000	0.972	0.972	0.000	1.684	1.684
wsj.com	Mostly Factual	156	227	0.354	1.061	0.707	1.298	1.838	0.540
dailysignal.com	Mixed	0	117	0.000	0.547	0.547	0.000	0.947	0.947
washingtontimes.com	Mixed	67	96	0.152	0.449	0.297	0.557	0.777	0.220
thefederalist.com	Mixed	0	55	0.000	0.257	0.257	0.000	0.445	0.445
foxbusiness.com	Mixed	28	52	0.063	0.243	0.179	0.233	0.421	0.188
nationalreview.com	Mostly Factual	0	16	0.000	0.075	0.075	0.000	0.130	0.130
freebeacon.com	Mixed	0	13	0.000	0.061	0.061	0.000	0.105	0.105
dailymail.co.uk	Low	0	7	0.000	0.033	0.033	0.000	0.057	0.057
outkick.com	Mixed	0	5	0.000	0.023	0.023	0.000	0.040	0.040
justthenews.com	Mixed	0	4	0.000	0.019	0.019	0.000	0.032	0.032
thepostmillennial.com	Mixed	0	2	0.000	0.009	0.009	0.000	0.016	0.016
thecentersquare.com	Mostly Factual	2	2	0.005	0.009	0.005	0.017	0.016	0.000
dupagepolicyjournal.com	Mixed	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.008	0.008
express.co.uk	Mixed	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.008	0.008
fortune.com	High	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.008	0.008
lawenforcementtoday.com	Mixed	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.008	0.008
oann.com	Low	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.008	0.008
voz.us	Mixed	0	1	0.000	0.005	0.005	0.000	0.008	0.008
thedispatch.com	High	1	1	0.002	0.005	0.002	0.008	0.008	0.000
newsweek.com	Mostly Factual	778	37	1.764	0.173	-1.591	6.474	0.300	-6.174

USCIS Top Sources

The following tables show how the composition of the USCIS briefings changed after March 31, 2025. Results are broken down by source.

- Figure 35: The first table shows the number of articles before and after this cutpoint for the most common sources, ranked using their popularity after March 2025.
- Figure 36: The second table, shows the number of articles from all right-leaning sources before and after March 31, 2025.
- Figure 37: The third table shows the number of articles in the *Top News* section of the DHS briefing before and after March 31, 2025.

Table 35: Top Sources in USCIS Briefings. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in DHS briefings during each time period. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

Source	Slant (MBFC)	Factual Rating (MBFC)	Rank (Pre-April)	Rank (Post-April)	Total Articles (Pre-April)	Total Articles (Post-April)
apnews.com	Left-leaning	High	3	1	1,391	336
newsweek.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	8	2	816	330
foxnews.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	1	3	2,717	297
washingtonexaminer.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	4	4	1,322	269
washingtonpost.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	9	5	731	245
cbsnews.com	Left-leaning	High	2	6	1,450	234
reuters.com	Center	Very High	7	7	832	212
thehill.com	Center	Mostly Factual	5	8	1,253	198
nytimes.com	Left-leaning	High	12	9	613	169
bloomberglaw.com	Not Categorized	-	13	10	519	155
breitbart.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	51	11	25	145
nbcnews.com	Left-leaning	High	10	12	694	144
bloomberg.com	Left-leaning	High	15	13	394	124
cnn.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	11	14	682	124
nypost.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	6	15	1,250	110
newsmax.com	Right-leaning	Low	-	16	-	101
usatoday.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	19	17	338	100
axios.com	Left-leaning	High	26	18	247	96
dailycaller.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	21	19	305	95
npr.org	Left-leaning	High	17	20	378	90
go.com	Left-leaning	High	20	21	321	86
politico.com	Left-leaning	High	16	22	390	76
upi.com	Center	High	28	23	220	69
wsj.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	25	24	264	68
thecentersquare.com	Right-leaning	Mostly Factual	86	25	8	65
forbes.com	Center	Mostly Factual	29	26	194	62
latimes.com	Center	High	18	27	374	61
townhall.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	300	28	1	56
newsfromthestates.com	Left-leaning	High	66	29	16	52
washingtontimes.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	14	30	479	51
theepochtimes.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	109	31	6	50
theblaze.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	32	-	39
huffpost.com	Left-leaning	Mixed	35	33	58	38
natlawreview.com	Center	High	31	34	103	34

Table 35: Top Sources in USCIS Briefings. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in DHS briefings during each time period. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites. *(continued)*

Source	Slant (MBFC)	Factual Rating (MBFC)	Rank (Pre-April)	Rank (Post-April)	Total Articles (Pre-April)	Total Articles (Post-April)
dailysignal.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	162	35	2	31
newsnationnow.com	Center	High	23	36	298	31
dailywire.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	133	37	3	30
americanbazaaronline.com	Not Categorized	-	38	38	55	29
rollcall.com	Center	Very High	27	39	233	28
elnuevoherald.com	Not Categorized	-	-	40	-	24
scrippsnews.com	Left-leaning	High	30	41	143	24
thefederalist.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	42	-	24
oann.com	Right-leaning	Low	-	43	-	22
borderreport.com	Not Categorized	-	203	44	1	21
x.com	Not Categorized	-	-	45	-	21
the-independent.com	Not Categorized	-	96	46	7	20
cibercuba.com	Not Categorized	-	159	47	2	18
latintimes.com	Left-leaning	High	139	48	3	18
nepyor.com	Not Categorized	-	-	49	-	16
san.com	Center	Mostly Factual	69	50	15	16
msnbc.com	Left-leaning	Mixed	32	51	82	14
cnbc.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	50	52	28	13
businessinsider.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	43	53	39	12
cubaenmiami.com	Not Categorized	-	-	54	-	12
time.com	Left-leaning	High	37	55	57	12
caribbeannationalweekly.com	Not Categorized	-	-	56	-	11
dailymail.co.uk	Right-leaning	Low	132	57	3	11
brownfieldagnews.com	Not Categorized	-	54	58	22	10
foxbusiness.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	45	59	36	10
indiatimes.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	65	60	16	10
iowacapitaldispatch.com	Left-leaning	Mostly Factual	73	61	12	9
reason.com	Right-leaning	High	39	62	49	9
mvariety.com	Not Categorized	-	48	63	29	8
bloombergtax.com	Not Categorized	-	77	64	11	7
newrepublic.com	Left-leaning	High	107	65	6	7
thedailybeast.com	Left-leaning	Mixed	183	66	2	7
theguardian.com	Left-leaning	Mixed	40	67	47	7
calmatters.org	Left-leaning	High	60	68	19	6
elpasomatters.org	Not Categorized	-	52	69	25	6
fairus.org	Right-leaning	Low	-	70	-	6
texasborderbusiness.com	Not Categorized	-	46	71	34	6
agri-pulse.com	Not Categorized	-	80	72	9	5
bgov.com	Not Categorized	-	41	73	44	5
cubaheadlines.com	Not Categorized	-	-	74	-	5
financialexpress.com	Right-leaning	Mixed	-	75	-	5

Table 36: Right-leaning Sources in USCIS Briefings. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in USCIS briefings during each time period. Excludes general interest sources and government websites.

Source	MBFC FactualReporting Rating	Days Pre-April	Days Post-April	Articles Pre-April	Articles Post-April	Articles/ day Pre-April	Articles/ day Post-April	Diff (Articles/ day)	%Articles Pre-April
newsweek.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	816	330	1.060	2.171	1.111	3.80
breitbart.com	Mixed	770	152	25	145	0.032	0.954	0.921	0.11
newsmax.com	Low	770	152	0	101	0.000	0.664	0.664	0.00
thecentersquare.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	8	65	0.010	0.428	0.417	0.03
townhall.com	Mixed	770	152	1	56	0.001	0.368	0.367	0.00
theepochtimes.com	Mixed	770	152	6	50	0.008	0.329	0.321	0.02
theblaze.com	Mixed	770	152	0	39	0.000	0.257	0.257	0.00
dailycaller.com	Mixed	770	152	305	95	0.396	0.625	0.229	1.42
dailysignal.com	Mixed	770	152	2	31	0.003	0.204	0.201	0.00
dailywire.com	Mixed	770	152	3	30	0.004	0.197	0.193	0.01
thefederalist.com	Mixed	770	152	0	24	0.000	0.158	0.158	0.00
oann.com	Low	770	152	0	22	0.000	0.145	0.145	0.00
wsj.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	264	68	0.343	0.447	0.105	1.23
dailyemail.co.uk	Low	770	152	3	11	0.004	0.072	0.068	0.01
washingtonexaminer.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	1,322	269	1.717	1.770	0.053	6.10
indiatimes.com	Mixed	770	152	16	10	0.021	0.066	0.045	0.07
fairus.org	Low	770	152	0	6	0.000	0.039	0.039	0.00
financialexpress.com	Mixed	770	152	0	5	0.000	0.033	0.033	0.00
westernjournal.com	Mixed	770	152	0	5	0.000	0.033	0.033	0.00
fortune.com	High	770	152	5	5	0.006	0.033	0.026	0.02
cis.org	Low	770	152	0	4	0.000	0.026	0.026	0.00
osvnews.com	Mixed	770	152	0	4	0.000	0.026	0.026	0.00
justthenews.com	Mixed	770	152	0	3	0.000	0.020	0.020	0.00
ntd.com	Mixed	770	152	0	3	0.000	0.020	0.020	0.00
washingtonstand.com	Low	770	152	0	3	0.000	0.020	0.020	0.00
foxbusiness.com	Mixed	770	152	36	10	0.047	0.066	0.019	0.10
business-standard.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	0	2	0.000	0.013	0.013	0.00
spectator.org	Mixed	770	152	0	2	0.000	0.013	0.013	0.00
texascorecard.com	Mixed	770	152	0	2	0.000	0.013	0.013	0.00
thepostmillennial.com	Mixed	770	152	0	2	0.000	0.013	0.013	0.00
tpusa.com	Low	770	152	0	2	0.000	0.013	0.013	0.00
zerohedge.com	Low	770	152	0	2	0.000	0.013	0.013	0.00
christianpost.com	Mixed	770	152	1	2	0.001	0.013	0.012	0.00
nationalreview.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	13	4	0.017	0.026	0.009	0.00
alphanews.org	Low	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
amac.us	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
city-journal.org	Mostly Factual	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
deccanchronicle.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
firstpost.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
focusonthefamily.com	Low	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
headlineusa.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
independentsentinel.com	Low	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
jewishinsider.com	High	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
judicialwatch.org	Low	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
lawenforcementtoday.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
ndtv.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
outkick.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
pjmedia.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
the-express.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
the-sun.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
theamericanconservative.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
thefp.com	High	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
thenewamerican.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
thetimes.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
wabcradio.com	Mixed	770	152	0	1	0.000	0.007	0.007	0.00
thetexan.news	High	770	152	1	1	0.001	0.007	0.005	0.00
freebeacon.com	Mixed	770	152	9	2	0.012	0.013	0.001	0.04
thedispatch.com	High	770	152	4	1	0.005	0.007	0.001	0.01
telegraph.co.uk	Mixed	770	152	5	1	0.006	0.007	0.000	0.02
americanmilitarynews.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00
amnews.com	High	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00
cato.org	High	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00
express.co.uk	Mixed	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00
heritage.org	Mixed	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00
manilatimes.net	Mixed	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00

Table 36: Right-leaning Sources in USCIS Briefings. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in USCIS briefings during each time period. Excludes general interest sources and government websites. *(continued)*

Source	MBFC FactualReporting Rating	Days Pre-April	Days Post-April	Articles Pre-April	Articles Post-April	Articles/ day Pre-April	Articles/ day Post-April	Diff (Articles/ day)	%Articles Pre-April
nationalinterest.org	Mostly Factual	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00
wng.org	Mixed	770	152	1	0	0.001	0.000	-0.001	0.00
gulfnnews.com	Mixed	770	152	2	0	0.003	0.000	-0.003	0.00
ijr.com	Mostly Factual	770	152	2	0	0.003	0.000	-0.003	0.00
thenationalnews.com	Mixed	770	152	2	0	0.003	0.000	-0.003	0.00
reason.com	High	770	152	49	9	0.064	0.059	-0.004	0.22
idahostatejournal.com	High	770	152	4	0	0.005	0.000	-0.005	0.01
washingtontimes.com	Mixed	770	152	479	51	0.622	0.336	-0.287	2.23
nypost.com	Mixed	770	152	1,250	110	1.623	0.724	-0.900	5.82
foxnews.com	Mixed	770	152	2,717	297	3.529	1.954	-1.575	12.60

Table 37: Right-leaning Sources in USCIS Top News Section. Splits briefings into before April 1, 2025 (Pre-April) and after April 1, 2025 (Post-April). Percentages are based on the total number of articles in the Top News sections of the USCIS briefings during each time period. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

Source	MBFC FactualReporting Rating	Articles Pre-April	Articles Post-April	Articles/ day Pre-April	Articles/ day Post-April	Diff (Articles/ day)	%Articles Pre-April	%Articles Post-April	Diff(%)
washingtonexaminer.com	Mostly Factual	297	153	0.46	1.03	0.57	5.37	6.42	1.05
newsweek.com	Mostly Factual	129	98	0.20	0.66	0.46	2.33	4.11	1.78
breitbart.com	Mixed	3	59	0.00	0.40	0.39	0.05	2.47	2.42
newsmax.com	Low	0	52	0.00	0.35	0.35	0.00	2.18	2.18
dailycaller.com	Mixed	27	42	0.04	0.28	0.24	0.49	1.76	1.27
theepochtimes.com	Mixed	0	32	0.00	0.21	0.21	0.00	1.34	1.34
townhall.com	Mixed	0	27	0.00	0.18	0.18	0.00	1.13	1.13
foxnews.com	Mixed	534	145	0.82	0.97	0.15	9.65	6.08	-3.57
dailywire.com	Mixed	2	19	0.00	0.13	0.12	0.04	0.80	0.76
theblaze.com	Mixed	0	18	0.00	0.12	0.12	0.00	0.75	0.75
thecentersquare.com	Mostly Factual	1	18	0.00	0.12	0.12	0.02	0.75	0.74
wsj.com	Mostly Factual	107	42	0.16	0.28	0.12	1.93	1.76	-0.17
dailysignal.com	Mixed	0	12	0.00	0.08	0.08	0.00	0.50	0.50
oann.com	Low	0	12	0.00	0.08	0.08	0.00	0.50	0.50
nypost.com	Mixed	124	40	0.19	0.27	0.08	2.24	1.68	-0.56
thefederalist.com	Mixed	0	6	0.00	0.04	0.04	0.00	0.25	0.25
dailymail.co.uk	Low	0	3	0.00	0.02	0.02	0.00	0.13	0.13
nationalreview.com	Mostly Factual	1	3	0.00	0.02	0.02	0.02	0.13	0.11
foxbusiness.com	Mixed	3	3	0.00	0.02	0.02	0.05	0.13	0.07
tpusa.com	Low	0	2	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.08	0.08
washingtontimes.com	Mixed	112	27	0.17	0.18	0.01	2.02	1.13	-0.89
osvnews.com	Mixed	0	1	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.04	0.04
reason.com	High	0	1	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.04	0.04
westernjournal.com	Mixed	0	1	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.04	0.04
freebeacon.com	Mixed	1	1	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.02	0.04	0.02
ijr.com	Mostly Factual	1	0	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.02	0.00	-0.02
telegraph.co.uk	Mixed	2	0	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.04	0.00	-0.04

A.6.5. Extremity

To visualize how the composition of the DHS and USCIS briefings changed in early 2025, I identified sources that Media Bias/Fact Check considered extreme. To do this, I used a continuous version of the MBFC score.⁴⁰ Continuous scores are only available for 48.8% of the sources in the briefings, which is why I use the categorical version elsewhere. The continuous scores range from -10 (most left-leaning) and 10 (most right-leaning). I labeled scores as extreme if they were above 5 or below -5. If the source did not have a continuous score, I labeled it as ‘unknown.’ In Figures A59 and A60, I plot the number of new sources appearing in the briefings by month. Sources are only counted if they have never been included in the briefing previously. I break down sources by their MBFC categorical score and extremity.

Figure A59 shows that an abnormally large number of extreme right-leaning sources were added to the DHS and USCIS briefings around April 2025. Even though the overall composition of the USCIS briefings was less affected, Figure A59 reveals how far-right sources were added to both briefings. The plot also illustrates how this influx of partisan sources deviates from prior time periods. When I produce similar plots for the DOI or VA briefings, the pattern of added sources is stable across presidential transitions (see Figure A60. In the Appendix, I also explore the spike in new ‘not categorized’ sources after Trump’s inauguration. Because each of these sources contributes a small number of articles to the briefings, they represent a small change to the composition of both briefings (see Figure A61). For reference, I have also plotted the total number of articles in each partisan-extremity category by month (see Figure A62).

⁴⁰ After dropping local general interest source, government websites, and sources not found in any briefing, the continuous values range from -9.6 to 9.8. The mean is -0.32 and the median is -1.3. The standard deviation is 4.81.

Partisan Extremity of New Sources Added to Briefings Each Month

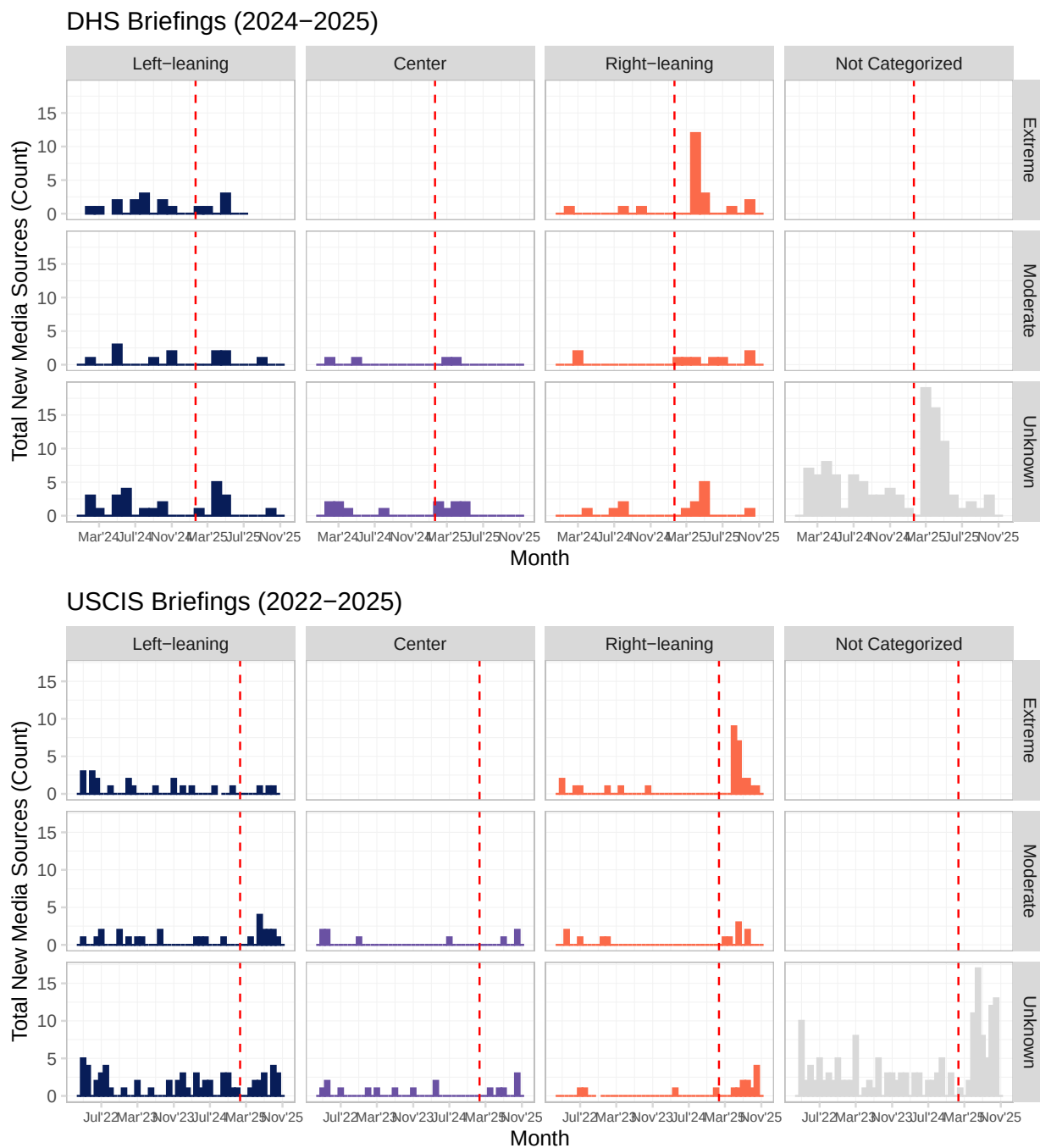


Figure A59: Number of new sources added to USCIS and DHS news briefings by month. Continuous MBFC scores are available for fewer news sources. Source extremity labeled as 'Unknown' if no continuous score is available.

Partisan Extremity of New Sources Added to Briefings Each Month

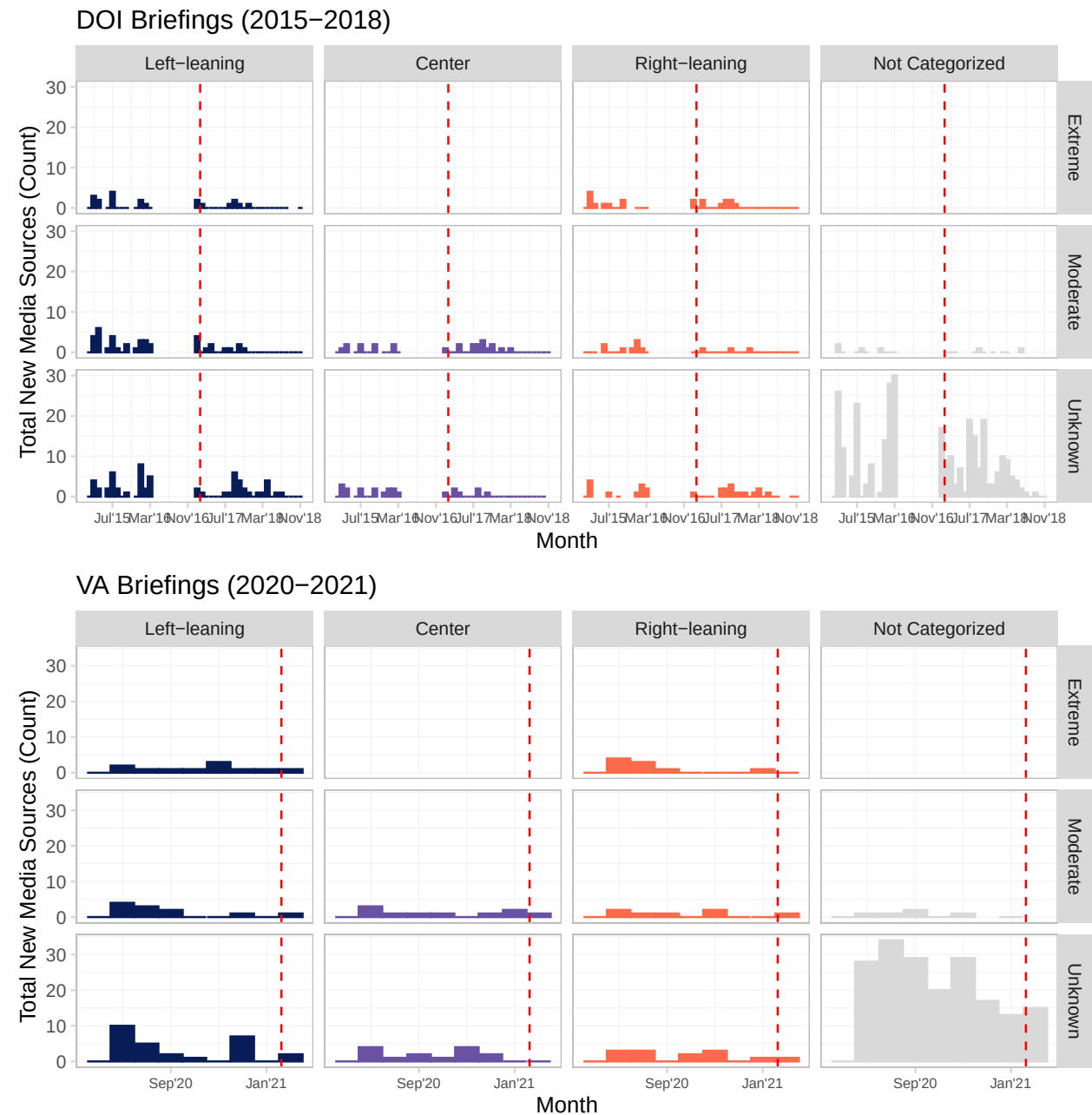


Figure A60: Number of new sources added to DOI and VA news briefings by month. Continuous MBFC scores are available for fewer news sources. Source extremity labeled as 'Unknown' if no continuous score is available.

Total articles from new sources

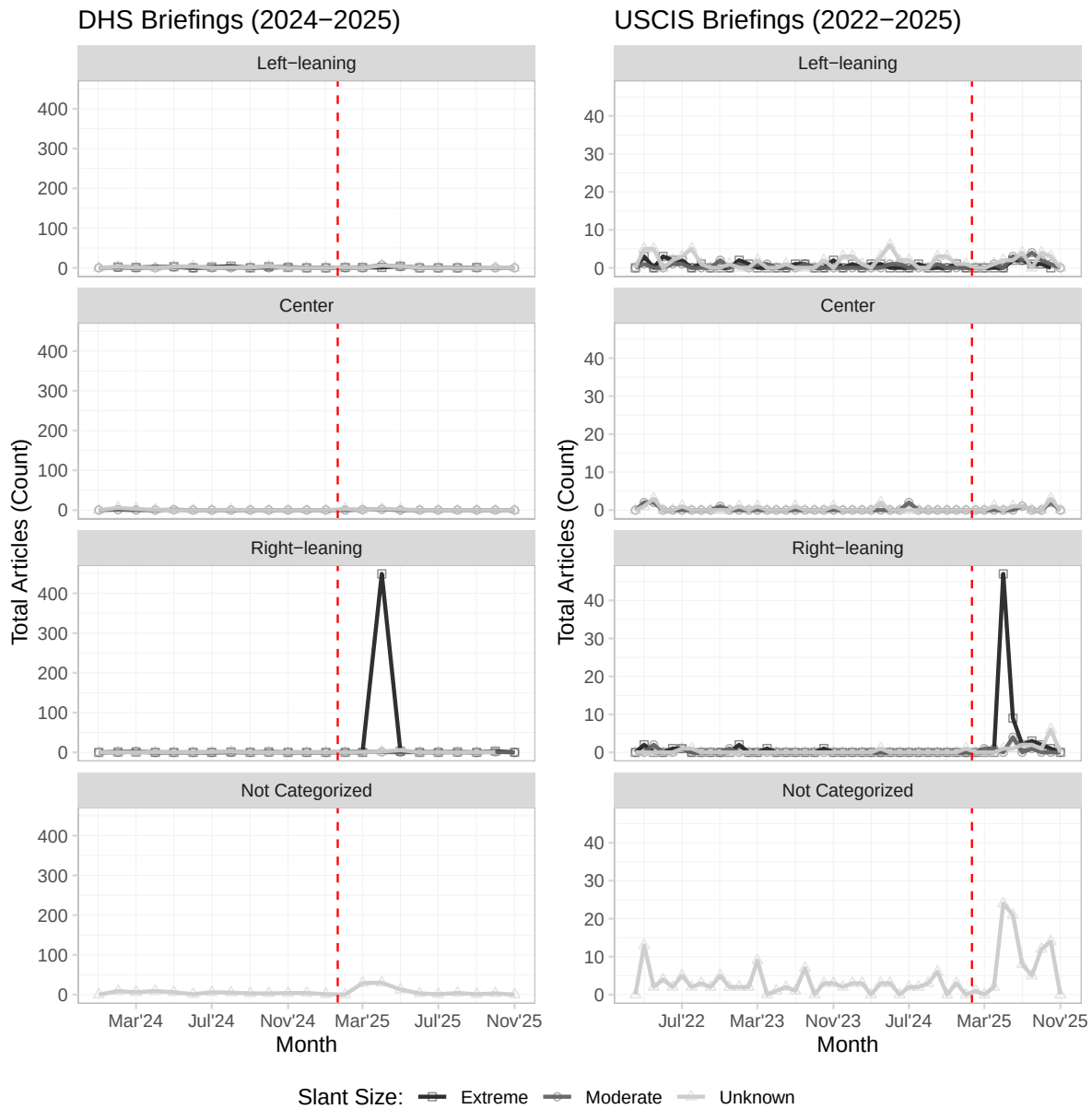


Figure A61: Total articles from new sources in USCIS and DHS news briefings by month. Partisan slant broken down by extremity. Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Calculated source extremity using a continuous measure of source slant from MBFC. Sources considered extreme if they are above 5 or below -5. Dotted line at presidential inaugurations. Continuous MBFC scores are available for fewer news sources. Source extremity labeled as 'Unknown' if no continuous score is available.

Total articles by Partisan Extremity

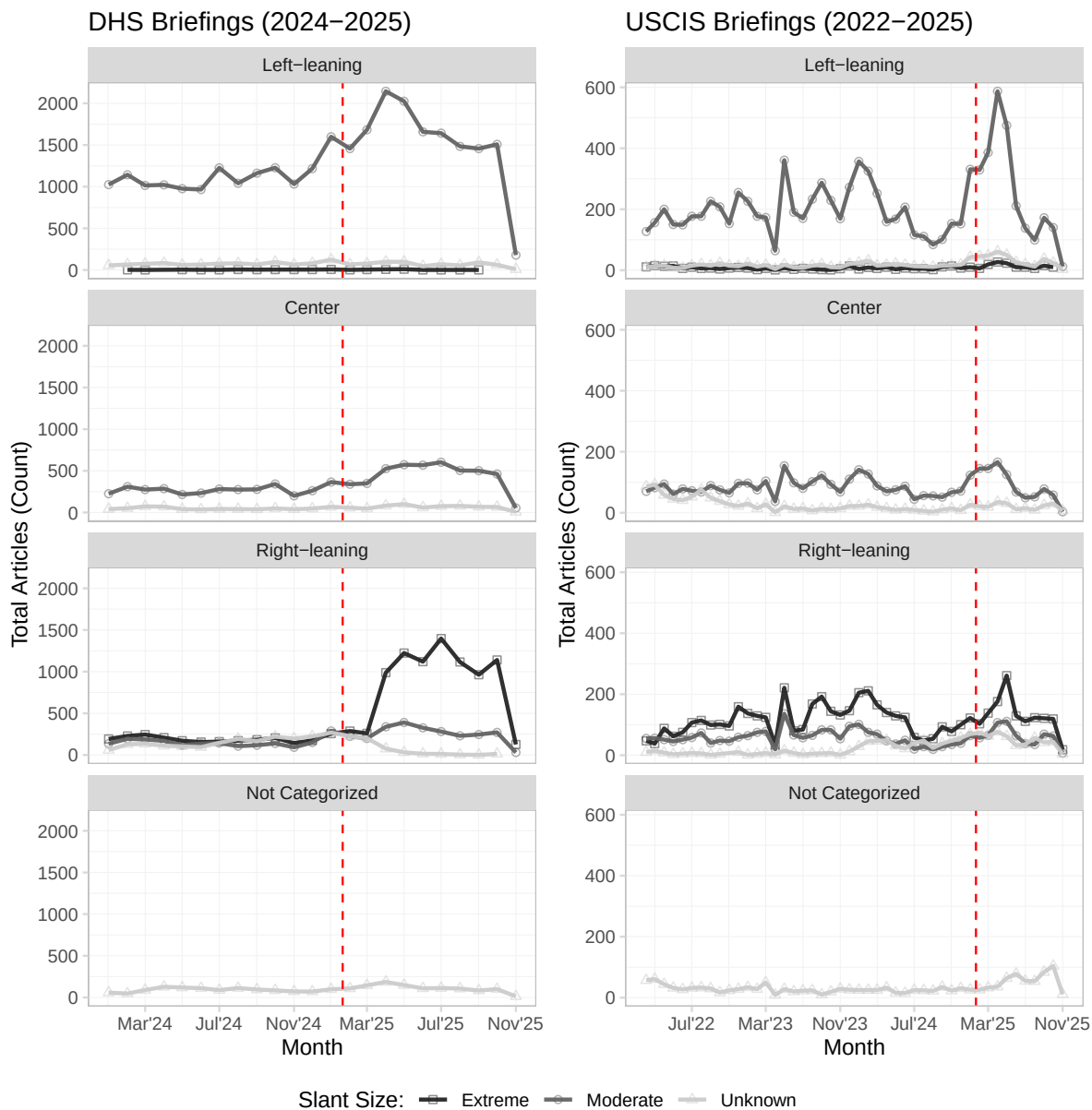


Figure A62: Total articles in USCIS and DHS news briefings by month. Partisan slant broken down by extremity. Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Calculated source extremity using a continuous measure of source slant from MBFC. Sources considered extreme if they are above 5 or below -5. Dotted line at presidential inaugurations. Continuous MBFC scores are available for fewer news sources. Source extremity labeled as 'Unknown' if no continuous score is available.

References

Document Cloud links to DOI briefings

Below are links to Document Cloud uploads used to construct the sample of DOI briefings and the metadata provided for each document.⁴¹

1. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4568159-17-00413ce/> [2,635 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Fri Jun 29 2018]
2. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4578582-17-00207cz/> [39 pages - Alex Kief (Western Values Project) - Fri Jul 06 2018; Project Eleventh Document Production for OS-2017-00207]
3. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571397-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-2/> [1,005 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Tue Jul 03 2018; Project DOI FOIA Library - Regional Records; Project Influencer]
4. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571399-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-3/> [893 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Tue Jul 03 2018; Project DOI FOIA Library - Regional Records]
5. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571396-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-1/> [1,267 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Tue Jul 03 2018; Project DOI FOIA Library - Regional Records; Project Fourth Industrial Revolution]
6. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571555-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-17/> [1,160 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Tue Jul 03 2018; Project DOI FOIA Library - Regional Records; Project Fourth Industrial Revolution; Project Influencer]
7. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4571556-Bear-Ears-Records-Part-18/> [271 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Tue Jul 03 2018; Project DOI FOIA Library - Regional Records]
8. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4565291-E-O-13792-Records-Part-3/> [893 pages - Alex Kief (Western Values Project) - Thu Jun 28 2018; Project Executive And Secretarial Orders]
9. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4565468-E-O-13792-Records-Part-18/> [271 pages - Alex Kief (Western Values Project) - Thu Jun 28 2018; Project Executive And Secretarial Orders]
10. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4560687-17-00208cg-Part-1/> [408 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Tue Jun 26 2018; Project 2017-00208 FOIA Response (Chaffetz)]
11. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4560448-17-00208cf/> [1,160 pages - Alex Kief (Western Values Project) - Tue Jun 26 2018; Project 2017-00208 FOIA Response (Chaffetz); Project Fourth Industrial Revolution; Project Influencer]
12. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191342-17-00541cab/> [509 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Fri Jul 12 2019; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records]
13. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6174118-18-00303ca/> [188 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Thu Jun 27 2019]
14. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6581648-00665cm/> [2,075 pages - Brad Hennessy (Western Values Project) - Tue Dec 17 2019; Project OS-2018-00665; Project Kohberger; Project ISP Records 2000-2025; Project ISP FL; Project IGG IDAHO4; Project Idaho Statesman; Project COPLINK CrimeTracer; Project COPLINK & ISP; Project CC Fire & EMS 2024; Project Brent Kopacka]
15. https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/21031511-00953ca-propose-redactions_redacted/ [148 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Mon Aug 02 2021; Project Influencer; _mr_agency 8998; _mr_request 40579; _mr_jurisdiction 10; _mr_status Completed]
16. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4901412-Ventings-and-Flaring-Rule/> [126 pages - Adrian Hedden (Carlsbad Current-Argus) - Tue Sep 18 2018]
17. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6988850-DOI-17-0436-A/> [1,074 pages - Content Manager (American Oversight) - Tue Jul 14 2020; Records from the Department of the Interior in response to American Oversight's request for records regarding a \$300 million contract with Whitefish, and possible connections to former Secretary Ryan Zinke. (DOI-17-0436-A; DOI-17-0436-B; DOI-17-0436-C); Project Environment Documents; Project Influencer; AO FOIA DOI-17-0436; Entity Department of the Interior; Case 18-2336]
18. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191340-18-00323ce/> [295 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Fri Jul 12 2019; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records]
19. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/3522445-Leopold-Shapiro-NPS-twitter-Trump-tweets/> [348 pages - Jason Leopold (Jason Leopold Investigations) - Wed Mar 22 2017]
20. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/3522587-NPS-Twitter-Stand-Down-Emails-Leold/> [995 pages - Jason Leopold (Jason Leopold Investigations) - Wed Mar 22 2017]
21. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191338-18-00323ce/> [650 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Fri Jul 12 2019; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records]
22. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6191344-17-00541ce/> [544 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Fri Jul 12 2019; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records]
23. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4556659-17-00707cd/> [2,147 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Mon Jun 25 2018; Project OS-2017-00707 (Lola Comms)]
24. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6559502-2019-11-Release-Set-6-Doc-19-R/> [25 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Mon Nov 25 2019; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records]
25. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4568199-17-00707/> [714 pages - Brian McLenigan (Western Values Project) - Fri Jun 29 2018; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records]
26. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5758557-55-U-S-Department-of-the-Interior-News-Briefing/> [21 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Mon Mar 04 2019; Project Influencer]
27. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6420546-17-00938de/> [641 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Wed Sep 18 2019; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records]
28. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6366765-18-01163ce/> [353 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Fri Aug 30 2019]
29. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6420529-17-00938en/> [469 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Wed Sep 18 2019; Project DOI FOIA - Other Records; Project Influencer]
30. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6178506-131-2-FOIA001-00253186-137-3-FOIA001-00242311/> [96 pages - Bowden Saunders (Western Values Project) - Mon Jul 01 2019; Project DOI FOIA Library - SES Reassignments]
31. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6178505-066-2-FOIA001-00273220-131-1-FOIA001-00253192/> [758 pages - Bowden Saunders (Western Values Project) - Mon Jul 01 2019; Project DOI FOIA Library - SES Reassignments]
32. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6166664-Combined-Docs-SOL-2019-00166-Tobias-710-pages/> [710 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Mon Jun 24 2019; _mr_agency 2660; _mr_jurisdiction 10; _mr_status Completed; _mr_request 72323]
33. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/455967-18-00616cf-Redacted/> [1,142 pages - Lucy Wollman (Western Values Project) - Mon Oct 07 2019; Project OS-2018-00616]
34. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6883326-DOI-18-0489-A/> [286 pages - Content Manager (American Oversight) - Wed May 06 2020; Records from the Department of the Interior in response to American Oversight's request for records of political appointee communications regarding Mikah Meyer. (DOI-18-0489-A); Project Resumes - American Oversight; Project Environment Documents; Project Influencer; AO FOIA DOI-18-0489; Entity Department of the Interior]
35. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6779212-WVP-Domenech-Comms-00665cm/> [2,075 pages - 10 notes - Jesse Coleman (Documented) - Tue Feb 18 2020; Project DOI Onshore; Project Kohberger; Project ISP Records 2000-2025; Project ISP FL; Project IGG IDAHO4; Project Idaho Statesman; Project COPLINK CrimeTracer; Project COPLINK & ISP; Project CC Fire & EMS 2024; Project Brent Kopacka]
36. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6168576-18-01430cb-Part1/> [882 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Tue Jun 25 2019; Project Influencer]
37. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6841764-19-Cv-02253-Combined-Supplemental-Documents/> [149 pages - Louis Galdieri (Louis Galdieri) - Fri Apr 17 2020; 3 of 5 April 2020 documents pertaining to the Boundary Waters reveal; Project Boundary Waters FOIA; Project Boundary Waters FOIA; Project Influencer]
38. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5130121-National-Park-Service-News-Bulletins/> [79 pages - Communications Team (American Oversight) - Thu Nov 15 2018; National Park Service records containing search terms related to the pardons of ranchers behind the occupation of the Malheur Wildlife Refuge in Oregon. NPS' search returned only internal news bulletins. (DOI-NPS-18-0546-A); Project Influencer; AO FOIA DOI-NPS-18-0546; Entity Department of the Interior]
39. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5682639-NPS-Records-Regarding-Intergovernmental-Panel-on/> [269 pages - Communications Team (American Oversight) - Fri Jan 11 2019; National Park Service records to our request for records related to the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change. This production includes mostly press clips, (DOI-NPS-18-0767-A; DOI-NPS-18-0767-B); AO FOIA DOI-NPS-18-0767; Entity Department of the Interior]
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41. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6434632-18-01157ca/> [705 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Mon Sep 30 2019]
42. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5772774-2018-06-Release-Set-3-Doc-91/> [43 pages - Brad Hennessy (Western Values Project) - Mon Mar 18 2019; Project DOI FOIA Library - Zinke Staff Meetings; Project Influencer]
43. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5019755-SOL-2018-00089-Haugrud-Combined-Documents-1/> [4,429 pages - Louis Galdieri (Louis Galdieri) - Thu Oct 25 2018; Project Boundary Waters FOIA; Project Boundary Waters FOIA; Project Influencer]
44. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5772884-2019-01-Release-Set-1-Doc-49/> [20 pages - Brad Hennessy (Western Values Project) - Mon Mar 18 2019; Project DOI FOIA Library - Zinke Staff Meetings]
45. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4599260-18-00774ca/> [30 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Fri Jul 13 2018]
46. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4573587-00773ca/> [47 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Tue Jul 03 2018]
47. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6595200-OS-2019-00062-December-Production/> [430 pages - Brad Hennessy (Western Values Project) - Thu Jan 02 2020; Project OS-2019-00062]
48. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6884544-18-00868ca/> [119 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Fri May 08 2020; Project Coffee]
49. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/4613746-IWCC-Public-Comment-All-FOIA-Globally-Responsive/> [190 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Thu Jul 19 2018]
50. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/5699275-18-01180ca/> [94 pages - Brad Hennessy (Western Values Project) - Tue Jan 29 2019; Project OS-2018-01180; Project Influencer]
51. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6841765-19-Cv-02253-Combined-Supplemental-Documents/> [186 pages - Louis Galdieri (Louis Galdieri) - Fri Apr 17 2020; 4 of 5 April 2020 documents pertaining to the Boundary Waters reversal.]
52. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6168574-18-01430cb-Part2/> [230 pages - Muckrock Staff (MuckRock Staff) - Tue Jun 25 2019]
53. <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/6841763-19-Cv-02253-Combined-Supplemental-Documents/> [246 pages - Louis Galdieri (Louis Galdieri) - Fri Apr 17 2020; 2 of 5 April 2020 documents pertaining to the Boundary Waters reversal.; Project Boundary Waters FOIA; Project Boundary Waters FOIA; Project Influencer]
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⁴¹ Note: to get the document to load, you may need to add “.pdf” to the end of the links. For some larger pdfs, Document Cloud does not load the file correctly. By adding “.pdf” to the end of the URL, you will be directed to the download link for the file.

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